这是一本
给你勇气提笔的GRE作文书

# GRE
# 写作高频题目及考点精析

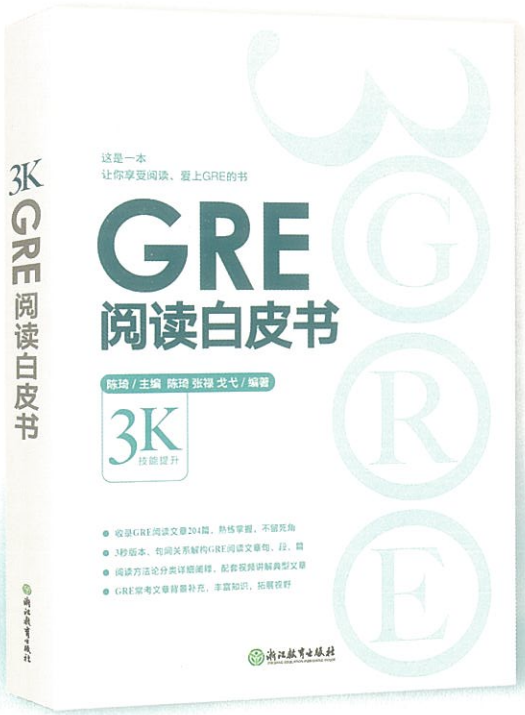
陈琦 颜余真 / 编著

3K
写作练习

- 高频题目范文精讲，难题/怪题思路剖析
- 揭露传统思维误区，直击GRE写作指令
- 典型例证使用分析，模板语言套用指导
- 破解高分评分标准，习作常犯错误总结

浙江教育出版社
ZHEJIANG EDUCATION PUBLISHING HOUSE

# GRE人气阅读书，助你轻松备考！




## 技能提升！

本书收录GRE考试阅读文章共204篇，帮助考生解决GRE考试中棘手的阅读部分。在全文翻译的基础上，本书利用“3秒版本”和“句间关系”这种简单易懂的方法来解读每篇文章，帮助考生理解并快速掌握分析文章的方法。本书配有讲解阅读方法论和阅读文章的视频，让考生身临其境，在老师的帮助下攻克阅读难关。

## 图书特色

**全文翻译：** 书中每篇文章均配有详细、准确的翻译，方便考生理解全文，加强对长难句的翻译训练。

**文章点拨：** 运用“3秒版本”和“句间关系”，对文章内容的重点、难点进行准确讲解，帮助考生提炼文章的句子、段落和篇章的核心内容，理清行文结构。

**例题讲解：** 挑选文章中的典型题目进行分析，让考生不仅能读懂文章，还能理解题目。

**背景补充：** 介绍文章涉及的背景知识、常考短语和疑难语法点，帮助考生丰富知识，拓展视野。


**购书方式**

1. 新东方大愚连锁书店购买：详情登录http://www.dogwood.com.cn/dysd
2. 新东方图书销售网点购买：详情登录http://www.dogwood.com.cn/Agentlist.html
3. 新东方大愚图书官方天猫店购买：详情登录https://xindongfang.tmall.com
4. 新东方大愚图书官方京东旗舰店购买：详情登录http://xdfdyts.jd.com

浏览更多精彩图书，请登录新东方图书网：www.dogwood.com.cn

# GRE

# 写作高频题目及考点精析

陈琦 颜余真 / 编著

浙江教育出版社·杭州

**图书在版编目(CIP)数据**

GRE写作高频题目及考点精析 / 陈琦，颜余真编著
. -- 杭州 : 浙江教育出版社，2022.3
ISBN 978-7-5722-3090-5

Ⅰ. ①G… Ⅱ. ①陈… ②颜… Ⅲ. ①GRE－写作－自学参考资料 Ⅳ. ①H319.36

中国版本图书馆CIP数据核字(2022)第013001号

**GRE写作高频题目及考点精析**

GRE XIEZUO GAOPIN TIMU JI KAODIAN JINGXI

陈　琦　颜余真　**编著**

**责任编辑**　赵清刚
**美术编辑**　韩　波
**责任校对**　马立改
**责任印务**　时小娟
**装帧设计**　大愚设计
**出版发行**　浙江教育出版社
地址：杭州市天目山路40号
邮编：310013
电话：（0571）85170300－80928
邮箱：dywh@xdf.cn
**印　　刷**　三河市良远印务有限公司
**开　　本**　787mm×1092mm　1/16
**成品尺寸**　185mm×260mm
**印　　张**　13.5
**字　　数**　277 000
**版　　次**　2022年3月第1版
**印　　次**　2022年3月第1次印刷
**标准书号**　ISBN 978-7-5722-3090-5
**定　　价**　50.00元

**版权所有，侵权必究。如有缺页、倒页、脱页等印装质量问题，请拨打服务热线：010-62605166。**

很多事物在被征服后就会褪色，GRE是个例外。

# 序 言

*Preface*

## 真正的勇士，敢于革自己的命

自从2017年出版以来，我们的《GRE写作高频题目及考点精析》（以下简称“黑皮书”）承蒙大家的厚爱，在“寄托”“一亩三分地”等留学考试论坛上得到了很多考生的推荐。在此我们非常感谢大家的支持，你们的支持是我们继续努力、不断完善自我的巨大动力。

但是，在教学的过程中，我们也陆陆续续收到同学们的反馈。从他们的意见和建议中我们发现，虽然“黑皮书”里的范文非常精彩，但是这些文章的可模仿性并不强。用一个豆瓣网友的原话来说就是：“作文写得太不接地气了。”——没错，大家在各个平台的评价和反馈我们都有关注，并且都记录了下来。什么叫做不接地气呢？有同学反映，“黑皮书”里的范文读下来觉得酣畅淋漓，但换到自己来动笔写作，即便是面对同样一道题目，也会觉得思路卡壳。换言之，“黑皮书”的范文有点“曲高和寡”的感觉。

对于这个问题，我们也一直在思考如何让大家能够更好、更快地学会写作的技巧。通过这三年的迭代，琦叔和我已经开发出了一套能确保Issue上4分的通用逻辑模板，并且投入到了线上的GRE写作OnePass Pro课程当中。这种把写作文变成做填空题的思路，在学生中的反响很好，实际出分结果也让我们感到振奋。而我们在新开的GRE写作6分屠龙班中，也设计出了一套6分标准的逻辑模板，并教授了大家提分的技巧。接下来，我们需要做的就是将这些更有可操作性的技巧集结成书——这将会是我们接下来新“黑皮书”的核心内容。

在写新书的同时，我们也没有忘记这本“黑皮书”。我们惊讶地发现，当以对GRE作文的最新理解来审视“黑皮书”时，很多曾经以为是加分项的东西变成了减分项。举例来说，“黑皮书”里Issue 148（人类行为是由外界力量而非自身品质决定）的范文采取了一个偏中立的立场：两者皆有用，很难说谁更重要。这种思路是东方思维的体现，但从西方人的视角（也就是ETS的视角）来看很容易变成“没有立场”，属于3分文章的水平。因此，把这种理论方法教给学生其实是非常危险的，稍有不慎就会翻车。

出于对自己作品负责到底的心态，我们决定对本书进行更新，大幅删除那些过时的范文（更不用说那些被题库除名的题目了），用可模仿性更强的高分文章来替换，勇敢地革自己的命。

同样以上面的 Issue 148 为例，本次改版的新范文里，我们给出了一个更明确的立场：虽然短期来看个人行为可以由自己决定，但从长期来看还是由外界决定的。这样的文章立场更鲜明，也没有丧失其思想深度。

这本改版后的“黑皮书”对旧版书中的 11 篇 Issue 范文进行了替换，拿掉了 7 篇已被删除或者少见的题目，并用 7 篇全新的范文加以替换。换言之，我们只保留了旧版书中的 2 篇 Issue 范文。Argument 部分，我们替换了 14 篇范文，保留了旧版书中的 6 篇 Argument 范文。改动幅度之大、对自己要求之严格可见一斑。

我们选择与 GRE 作文较真不是因为这件事很容易，而恰恰是因为它很难。希望这本书能够成为大家在备考 GRE 写作之路上值得信赖的同伴。

颜余真
于休斯顿

# 使用说明

*How to Use This Book*

截止到 2021 年 12 月 31 日，在美国教育考试服务中心（ETS，即 GRE 的官方出题机构）公布的 GRE 写作题库中，Issue 部分有 153 道题目，Argument 部分有 182 道题目（注：本书保留了 ETS 删除的部分 Argument 题目，对于新增的题目，我们按顺序进行了编号，顺延至题号 189）。与老 GRE 相比，新 GRE 写作部分的题目数量虽然大为减少，但仍然是一个惊人的数字。而如何从 Issue 和 Argument 的上百道题目中各选出 20 道并给出相应的范文，则是一个应该深思熟虑的问题。是按照 Issue 题目所涉及的不同领域，将题目划分为艺术、政治、科技等类别？又或是按照 Argument 题目中不同的“逻辑错误”来挑选题目？亦或是应该按照其他标准？

最终，我们选择按照 Issue 和 Argument 的具体性指令（Direction）来分类，挑选题目。Issue 部分共有 6 种具体性指令，Argument 共有 8 种（可分为 4 大类）具体性指令，我们从每一种具体性指令所对应的题目中各挑选了 2~5 道题目，构成了本书最核心的部分。

这种挑选原则其实是源于广大考生在 GRE 写作备考之时极易忽略的盲区——自 2011 年 8 月 GRE 改革以来，写作部分加入了“Direction（写作指导，或称具体性指令）”。随之改变的是写作部分的评分标准。ETS 给出的官方评分标准明确说明：**如果考生对某一道题的 Direction 照应得不充分或者模糊不清，那么考生的整篇文章得分不会超过 3 分**。在我们所批改的 700 余篇学生习作中，能够注意到 Direction 的考生比例不超过 5%。一些论点深刻、结构精巧、语言功底很不错的 Issue 作文因为完全偏离了 Direction 的写作要求而未能幸免 3 分；还有一些考生明显已经进行了长达数月的备考，看了参考书，也听了课，他们在 Argument 的写作中熟练地运用到了大量针对“逻辑错误”的表达和模板，但纵观其全文，却完全避开了 Direction 希望我们涉及的部分。对于这样的考生及其文章，我们为其扼腕叹息；但对于大多数还没有开始准备的考生，我们则希望大家在一开始就建立起“按照 Direction 来写文章”这一意识，从此避开“3 分雷区”。

虽然我们的文章是按照不同的 Direction 挑选出来的，但我们希望考生学到的不止 Direction。我们在 Issue 部分的范文中，力争做到观点深刻，并嵌入了很多为观点服务的、可以为考生所用的素材和例证；对相同意思的英文表达，我们也力求在每一篇 Issue 文章中都有所不同，从而让考生在语言多样性方面也能有所得。在 Argument 部分的范文里，每一篇文章中都可以见到“经典逻辑错误”的身影，但这种“逻辑错误”经过我们基于 Direction 要求的改写，比大家之前掌握的模板更加贴合新 GRE 的要求；另外我们提供的 Argument 的逻辑推理图，也将更好地帮助考生掌握全文的论证结构和框架。

GRE 写作的备考一定是“输入”与“输出”的结合，但考生往往耽于输入，惫于输出，在辅导教材的阅读上花费了太多时间。因此，本书没有连篇累牍的关于写作方法论的讲解，只是在每一个章节的开始部分，以及每一篇范文之后有精简的写作原理的点拨。希望考生将范文和原理点拨结合起来，通过这 40 篇范文的研读，完成“输入”部分的学习，为之后“输出”部分的篇章练习奠定良好的基础。

相较于市面上的同类参考书，本书具有如下的特点：

1. 以 40 道经典题目范文为全书主体，为考生提供语言、立场、例证等全方位参考素材。
2. 以具体性指令为核心，透彻讲解 GRE 中最易失分点，并结合学术写作要求，让 GRE 写作与研究生院写作接轨。
3. 深入讲解官方评分标准，首次将“要求”转化为“方法论”，指导学生写出符合 ETS 要求的 GRE 作文。
4. 总结七百余篇学生习作，细致梳理考生常犯错误。

本书的使用方法：

1. **备考初期：**主要研读本书的方法论部分。包括第四章对评分标准的解析、第五章中对 Direction 的解析。
2. **备考中期：**将方法论和范文相结合，深入理解范文对方法论的照应；同时借助范文进行语言素材和内容素材的积累。
3. **备考后期：**进入全文练习阶段。考生既可从本书的 40 道高频题中选择题目进行练习，也可从第二章中给出的题目中挑选题目练习。建议考生至少进行十篇全文练习（Issue 六篇、Argument 四篇；每一种 Direction 对应一篇）。

另外，我们在每一篇英文范文之后还添加了中文翻译。为了最大程度上方便大家理解句子意思，我们在翻译的时候没有太大地改动英文句子的结构，这一点请大家注意。

希望这本书能让大家在 GRE 作文的备考之路上走得更好且更远。

# 目 录

*Contents*


第一章 常见问题集锦 ..... 1

第二章 GRE 写作题库分类 ..... 5

第三章 考生常犯错误 ..... 9

第一节 内容方面 ..... 9

第二节 形式方面 ..... 20

第四章 GRE 写作官方评分标准精析 ..... 29

第一节 Issue 评分标准分析 ..... 30

第二节 Argument 评分标准分析 ..... 39

第五章 具体性指令与范文精讲 ..... 47

第一节 Issue 具体性指令与范文精讲 ..... 48

1. “是非判断类” Direction ..... 48
2. “因果类” Direction ..... 66
3. “两种看法类” Direction ..... 78
4. “敌方看法类” Direction ..... 86
5. “建议类” Direction（一） ..... 101
6. “建议类” Direction（二） ..... 115

第二节 Argument 具体性指令与范文精讲 ..... 124

1. “Assumption 类” Direction ..... 126
2. “Evidence 类” Direction ..... 144
3. “Explanation 类” Direction ..... 162
4. “Question 类” Direction ..... 179

附录 所有 Argument 3s 版本及专业词汇 ..... 202

# 第一章 常见问题集锦

### Q1：GRE 改革之后，作文部分发生变化了吗？

2011 年 GRE 改革之后，作文部分发生了两个重要的变化：

1. 截止到 2021 年 12 月 31 日，总题目数量由 486 道减少为 335 道，这减轻了大家的备考负担。

2. Issue 和 Argument 当中都加入了 Direction，这应该是最重大的改变。随之改变的是评分标准：如果没有按照 Direction 来写，分数不会高过 3 分。因此，Direction 应该是大家备考 GRE 作文中的重中之重。

### Q2：GRE 写作分成几部分？

GRE 写作分为 Analyze an Issue Task 与 Analyze an Argument Task。前者考查大家围绕一个话题发表自己的看法并对该看法做出论证的能力，后者考查大家对某一段推理过程进行分析评价的能力。

### Q3：GRE 写作的考试时间多长？

GRE 写作会在语文和数学部分之前进行测试，时长一小时。Analyze an Issue Task 与 Analyze an Argument Task 各 30 分钟，中间没有休息。写作之后会是语文部分的测试。写作与语文部分的测试之间也没有休息时间。

### Q4：作文会被几位阅卷人批阅？

一篇作文会先由一位自然人评委批阅并给出分数，之后会由机器（E-rater）批阅并给出分数。如果两个分数相差在 1 分以内，则取平均数，并以此作为考生最终得分；如果相差在 1 分以上，则引入另一位自然人评委的评审，最终分数为两位自然人评委的分数取平所得。

### Q5：考完试后能立即知道分数吗？

GRE 的语文和数学部分会在考完后立即出分，但写作部分的分数会在考完试后的 10~15 天公布。

### Q6：GRE 写作有多少道题目？

GRE 写作的题目均已在 ETS 官网上公布，截止到 2021 年 12 月 31 日，Issue 部分有 153 道题目，Argument 部分有 182 道题目。考生在考场上抽到的两道题目均来自已公布的题库，不会做任何修改。

### Q7：需要在上考场之前把 GRE 的写作题目都列提纲吗？

如果时间充足（备考时间在一个月以上），建议大家把题库中的所有题目的提纲都列一次。就算没有时间列提纲，也建议大家把所有题目都思考一遍，这样起码能够保证在考场上不会遇到陌生的题目。

### Q8：GRE 作文要写多少词？

ETS 并没有对 GRE 写作的词数做任何硬性要求。在 ETS 给出的 6 分范文中，既有接近 700 词的文章，也有的文章不足 500 词。真正重要的不是词数，而是如何用有限的词数把道理说清楚、说好。

但是，由于 GRE 写作是机考，而很多考生使用键盘打字的速度都有进步空间，因此提高打字速度是考生的必要任务。

### Q9：GRE 作文要写多少段？

和词数相同，ETS 对 GRE 写作的段落数也没有固定的要求。但一般来说，Issue 部分写五段（开头段、结尾段和三个中间段），Argument 部分写五到六段，这是比较符合实际写作时间、也便于操作的段落数。

### Q10：Issue 部分需要背很多名人名例吗？

首先，例子永远是为论证服务的。因此，只有在事理说明已经透彻的情况下才应该用例证来补充说明，而不是整篇文章都靠事例来堆积。

其次，好的例子是无所谓雅俗与真假的，真正重要的是如何使用例子。关于如何使用例子，大家可以参考对 Issue 的 6 分评分标准的解析。

### Q11：听说 GRE（包括 GRE 作文）不考查语言是真的吗？

GRE 考试是以语言为载体的考试，ETS 默认考生的语言水平已经过关了。但对于中国考生来说，语言仍然是一个老大难。

### Q12：GRE 作文里需要用很多高级复杂的语言表达吗？

这个问题和上一个问题形成了极端的对立，但都是大家常问的问题。GRE 作文考查的是大家用基本标准、正确的英语去说理、分析的能力。大家在语言层面首先需要追求正确、准确，而不需要刻意追求复杂、高级或标新立异的表达。

### Q13：Argument 有几类常见的逻辑错误？

这样问的考生想必都是把 Argument 的备考重点放在了所谓的“逻辑错误”（如臆造因果、错误类比等）的判断和分析上。这是针对老 GRE 的准备方法。面对新 GRE 的 Argument，如果只关注“逻辑错误”，最终的得分不会高过 3 分。因此，准备重心应该放在 Direction 上。大家可以参见范文之前对各类 Direction 的讲解。

### Q14：上考场之前需要进行全篇练习吗？

这个一定是需要的。但建议大家把全篇练习放在临考前十天左右。Issue 和 Argument 都可以按照 Direction 来挑选题目进行全篇练习。练习数量在 20 篇（Issue 和 Argument 各 10 篇）或以上为佳。

但一定注意，写完一篇文章之后一定要对其进行修改。建议大家至少对自己的文章进行两次修改。第一次是修改基本的语法错误；第二次是修改语法上正确，但不够准确、地道的表达。第二次修改可能对于考生自身来说有一定困难，这时大家可以和同伴结成小组进行互批互改，或请比自己有经验的师兄师姐或是老师帮忙修改。

### Q15：GRE 写作和托福写作有什么关系？

托福写作的考查对象是语言；而 GRE 写作是以语言为载体，考查考生的批判性思维和分析能力。因此对于英语为非母语的中国考生来说，GRE 写作既考查我们的语言，又考查我们的思维。就难度而言，GRE 写作和托福写作在语言层面并没有太大的差别，都要求考生运用正规的书面英语进行写作；但在内容层面，GRE 写作题目比托福写作题目更复杂，也要求考生对题目的认识更透彻，分析更全面深刻。

因此，考完 GRE 并在作文方面取得不错成绩的考生如果参加托福考试，不会在写作部分出现太大的问题。不过考生应该加强听力的训练，因为托福写作的综合写作有相当部分依赖于大家的听力能力。

而刚取得不错的托福写作成绩的考生如果要备考 GRE，则需要把重点放在 GRE 题目本身的分析上，力争把每一道题目都分析得全面、透彻。

### Q16：GRE 写作和未来的学术写作有什么关系？

GRE 写作是研究生院在录取研究生和博士生时参考的重要元素。GRE 写作所看重的批判性思维（Critical Thinking）和分析性写作（Analytical Writing）能力同样也是大家未来在进行学术写作时必不可少的能力。

因此，GRE 的准备应该以大的学术写作的要求为导向，而学术写作能力的初步形成也应该是在 GRE 写作的备考阶段。故而此书将 GRE 写作的诸多要求和考生即将接受的专业学术写作训练的要领相结合，指导考生以研究生写作为导向进行备考。让 GRE 写作的备考利在当下，功在长远。

# 第二章 GRE 写作题库分类

## Issue 题库分类

Issue 题目编号

**“是非判断类”Direction（54 道）**

1; 2; 9; 11; 17; 18; 21; 24; 26; 27; 28; 33; 34; 38; 41; 42; 43; 45; 53; 55; 56; 57; 58; 62; 63; 64; 66; 71; 74; 75; 76; 77; 78; 91; 93; 101; 103; 106; 107; 108; 112; 114; 115; 116; 117; 118; 119; 124; 137; 141; 143; 144; 146; 147

**“因果类”Direction（20 道）**

5; 8; 22; 40; 44; 49; 70; 79; 87; 88; 89; 105; 113; 120; 131; 133; 134; 139; 142; 153

**“两种看法类”Direction（18 道）**

7; 16; 20; 67; 68; 69; 85; 86; 109; 121; 125; 128; 130; 132; 138; 140; 150; 151

**“敌方看法类”Direction（25 道）**

3; 4; 13; 15; 29; 30; 32; 65; 84; 94; 95; 96; 97; 99; 104; 110; 111; 122; 123; 126; 127; 136; 145; 148; 152

**“建议类”Direction（一）（24 道）**

6; 19; 23; 25; 36; 37; 39; 46; 47; 48; 50; 51; 52; 54; 59; 60; 61; 80; 81; 82; 83; 90; 92; 129

**“建议类”Direction（二）（12 道）**

10; 12; 14; 31; 35; 72; 73; 98; 100; 102; 135; 149

## Issue 六大 Direction 破题要点总结

| Direction 分类 | 破题要点 |
| --- | --- |
| “是非判断类” Direction<br>Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the statement and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider **ways** in which the statement might or might not hold true and explain how these considerations shape your position. | 对行文并无特别要求 |
| “因果类” Direction<br>Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim and the reason on which that claim is based. | 既要提到考生同意或不同意的原因（Reason），又要提到结论（Claim） |
| “两种看法类” Direction<br>Write a response in which you discuss which view more closely aligns with your own position and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should address **both of the views presented**. | 题目中的两种观点都要讨论 |
| “敌方看法类” Direction<br>Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim. In developing and supporting your position, be sure to address the most compelling reasons and/or examples that could be used to **challenge your position**. | 不仅要阐述考生自己的立场，还要阐述敌方观点以及敌方观点背后的原因和例子 |
| “建议类” Direction（一）<br>Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the recommendation and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, describe specific **circumstances** in which adopting the **recommendation** would or would not be advantageous and explain how these examples shape your position. | 讨论建议所发生的条件 |
| “建议类” Direction（二）<br>Write a response in which you discuss your views on the policy and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider the possible **consequences** of implementing the **policy** and explain how these consequences shape your position. | 讨论政策可能带来的结果 |

# Argument 题库分类

Argument 题目编号

### “Assumption 类” Direction （50 道）

4; 9; 14; 16; 18; 23; 28; 32; 33; 34; 41; 44; 46; 49; 54; 55; 56; 59; 60; 62; 63; 65; 68; 73; 77; 87; 89; 90; 95; 98; 100; 101; 107; 109; 111; 115; 117; 121; 129; 130; 132; 137; 142; 143; 144; 148; 153; 157; 161; 173

### “Evidence 类” Direction （52 道）

1; 6; 8; 12; 13; 17; 20; 21; 25; 26; 27; 30; 31; 36; 37; 38; 39; 40; 42; 43; 47; 48; 50; 53; 57; 58; 70; 71; 72; 78; 83; 85; 86; 88; 91; 99; 105; 108; 124; 125; 126; 128; 133; 134; 135; 138; 141; 146; 147; 155; 158; 172

### “Explanation 类” Direction （17 道）

2; 15; 84; 92; 103; 104; 116; 119; 122; 165; 176; 180; 181; 182; 183; 184; 188

### “Question 类” Direction （70 道）

3; 5; 7; 10; 11; 19; 22; 24; 29; 35; 45; 51; 52; 61; 64; 66; 67; 69; 74; 75; 76; 79; 80; 81; 82; 93; 94; 96; 97; 102; 106; 110; 112; 113; 114; 118; 120; 123; 127; 131; 136; 139; 140; 145; 149; 150; 151; 152; 154; 156; 159; 160; 162; 163; 164; 166; 167; 168; 169; 170; 171; 174; 175; 177; 178; 179; 185; 186; 187; 189

## Argument 四大 Direction 破题步骤汇总

| Direction 分类 | 单段写法 | 段落连接 |
| --- | --- | --- |
| “Assumption”类 Direction<br>Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted. | ① 找出原文中各论断或结论所依赖的 Assumption<br>② 指出这些 Assumptions 在什么情况下不成立<br>③ 阐明这些 Assumptions 一旦不成立，作者的结论就会被削弱 | 根据逻辑图，作者做了几次结论推导，就写几个中间段 |
| “Evidence”类 Direction<br>Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument. | ① 指出现在还无法评价作者的某一个论断<br>② 说明为了更好地评价这一论断，还需要什么样的新证据<br>③ 用新证据削弱或者增强作者的这一论断 | |
| “Explanation”类 Direction<br>Write a response in which you discuss one or more alternative explanations that could rival the proposed explanation and explain how your explanation(s) can plausibly account for the facts presented in the argument. | ① 指出还有其他解释<br>② 说明其他解释如何解释得清楚原 Argument 中的现象 | |
| “Question”类 Direction<br>Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the recommendation is likely to have the predicted result. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the recommendation. | ① 指出现在还无法评价原 Argument 中的某一论断<br>② 说明为了更好地评价这一建议，还需要问什么样的问题<br>③ 给出问题的答案<br>④ 用答案来评价题目中的建议（既可以正面评价，也可以负面评价） | |

# 第三章 考生常犯错误

把常犯错误单独成章并放在所有方法论和范文之前，是源于我们所坚信的“不破不立”的想法。只有让大家先把一些错误的观念排除，学习方法论才更有效。

因此，我们总结了迄今为止批改过的 700 余篇学生的 GRE 作文习作，并征得学生的同意，将其写作中所犯错误提炼归纳、分门别类地总结如下。我们将错误类型分为内容和形式两大部分：内容包括文章的立意、主旨、组织等；形式即语言层面，包括用词、句式、语法等。

希望大家用心研读这一章，对于所罗列的错误，有则改之，无则加勉。

## 第一节 内容方面

### 常犯错误一 没有按照 Direction 来写

自 2011 年 GRE 改革之后，Issue 和 Argument 部分都加入了 Direction。Direction 可以翻译为具体性指令或写作指导。它本意是指导考生从具体的角度分析题目，但考生往往因为忽视 Direction 的要求而得低分（**ETS 明确表示如果不按照 Direction 来写不会高过 3 分**）。Issue 部分有 6 类 Direction，Argument 部分有 8 种（四大类）Direction。对于每一种 Direction 的处理方法请详见第五章的讲解。下面我们就从 Issue 和 Argument 的学生习作中各举一例，展示什么情况下文章会偏离 Direction 的要求。

**Issue:**

Governments should offer a free university education to any student who has been admitted to a university but who cannot afford the tuition.

Write a response in which you discuss your views on the policy and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider the possible consequences of implementing the policy and explain how these consequences shape your position.

“政府是否需要为每一个被大学录取但无力承担费用的学生提供全额补助？”很明显，这是一道关于“政府责任”的题目。下面是同学们给出的两种提纲。

**提纲一**

**总立场：**同意题目观点

**分论点 1：**政府需要这么做，因为政府有引导、保证高等教育顺利进行的责任。

**分论点 2：**政府有能力这么做，因为政府的号召力和影响力大，财力也比企业和个人雄厚。

**提纲二**

**总立场：**有保留地同意题目观点

**分论点 1**（同意题目观点）：题中的建议具有一定的必要性（necessity）。政府需要这么做，因为政府有引导、保证高等教育顺利进行的责任。

**分论点 2**（同意题目观点）：题中的建议具有可行性（feasibility）。政府有能力这么做，因为政府的号召力和影响力大，财力也比企业和个人雄厚。

**分论点 3**（反对题目观点）：但是，题目建议的必要性并不高，因为有一些替代策略（alternative options），如为学生提供半工半读的机会，让有财力的校友捐钱，等等。

**总结：**题目的问题具有复杂性，我们不能对其一概而论，而应该充分考虑到题目政策的必要性、可行性和替代观点。

提纲二看上去似乎在提纲一的基础上做了不少提升，如：

1. 增加了一个观点，阐明题目中的政策并非解决问题的唯一办法。
2. 在三个观点之中都运用了比较概括抽象的概念（necessity、feasibility、alternative options），使表意更加凝练。
3. 对全文有一个总结，说明题目的复杂性，不能对其一概而论。

纵观修改之后的论点，比原论点更全面、辩证，表意也更凝练，扩展成全文之后词数上也似乎更有保障。**但是，不论是哪一篇文章，都不会高过 3 分。因为它们都没有按照 Direction 来写。**

这道题的 Direction 中最核心的字眼是 consequence，即要求我们讨论采取题目中政策可能出现的或好或坏的结果。所以，**只要没有从结果层面对题目进行论证，就可以判为偏题。**

所以，针对新 GRE 的要求，我们应该结合 Direction 列出类似以下的观点：

**总立场：**同意题目观点

**分论点 1：**题中的建议具有一定的必要性（necessity）。政府需要这么做，因为政府有引导、保证高等教育顺利进行的责任。**政府如果不这么做，会引起人才流失，导致社会发展停滞不前。**

**分论点 2：**题中的建议具有可行性（feasibility）。政府有能力这么做，因为政府的号召

力和影响力大，财力也比企业和个人雄厚。**因此，由政府出资，可以减轻企业和个人的负担，并且引起广泛的、正面的社会反响。**

**分论点 3**：但是，题目中建议的必要性并不高，因为有一些替代策略（alternative options），如为学生提供半工半读的机会；让有财力的校友捐钱等等。**这些策略可以激励学生奋发向上，同时也在一定程度上减轻政府财政压力。**

**总结**：我们不能对题目的观点一概而论，**而应充分考虑到题目政策所带来的后果。**

这样修改之后，原本的观点并没有发生很大的变化，但却从“政策的结果”这一层面很好地照应了 Direction 的要求，也就在文章内容上突破了 3 分的瓶颈。

**Argument:**

The vice president for human resources at Climpson Industries sent the following recommendation to the company's president.

"In an effort to improve our employees' productivity, we should implement electronic monitoring of employees' Internet use from their workstations. Employees who use the Internet inappropriately from their workstations need to be identified and punished if we are to reduce the number of work hours spent on personal or recreational activities, such as shopping or playing games. Installing software on company computers to detect employees' Internet use is the best way to prevent employees from wasting time on the job. It will foster a better work ethic at Climpson and improve our overall profits."

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

下面是一位同学针对这道题草拟的提纲：

**总立场**：作者的结论看上去有理，其实错误很多。具体错误如下：

**分论点 1**：作者无端假设现在确实有需要安装这个软件，因为很有可能员工根本没有滥用网络进行娱乐活动。

**分论点 2**：作者在软件安装和员工效率提升之间臆造了因果联系，此联系很可能不成立。

**分论点 3**：作者称安装软件是防止员工浪费时间的最好办法，显然作者没有考虑其他替代措施。

**总结**：综上，作者的结论漏洞百出，除非解决以上问题，否则他的结论不可信。

列好提纲，就可以开始写文章了。这时，大家的一个普遍想法是：自己文章的分数是取决于自己的语言表达，即把提纲中的中文转化为什么档次的英文。例如：

“无端假设”：一些同学会用 The author thinks in a wrong way，而另一些同学可能会用“The author falsely assumes that...”。

“在 AB 间臆造因果联系”：一些同学可能会说 A did not cause B，另一些同学可能会说“The presumed causal relationship between A and B is open to doubt.”。

不可否认，上面这两个例子中，第二种表达比第一种看上去更加正式、准确。然而，在新 GRE 写作中，这样表达的两种文章的最后得分可能相差不大，并且一定都不会超过 3 分。**究其原因，还是没有按照 Direction 的要求来写。**

**Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.**

从这个 Direction 中，我们至少可以读出两点信息：

1. **我们现在还不能评价原 Argument；**
2. **但是在提出了新证据之后，我们就可以评价了。**

所以，应对这种 Direction 的做法应该是：

1. 给出新证据；
2. 用新证据评价原 Argument。

并且，针对这种 Direction 写出来的文章里面出现的最高频的词，就应该是该 Direction 的几个核心词：**evidence**、**evaluate**、**weaken**、**strengthen**。

可以参考的提纲如下：

**总立场：**现在证据不足，我们无法评价原 Argument。所以我们需要新证据。

**分论点 1：**我们需要新证据表明是否需要安装此软件（**主题句**）。新证据可能包括员工使用电脑的实际状况（**给新证据**）。如果新证据表明员工确实花费大量时间在个人娱乐上，那么作者的结论被增强；反之则被削弱（**用新证据评价**）。

**分论点 2：**我们需要新证据证实软件安装和员工效率提升之间是否存在因果联系。（**主题句**）（**之后的展开同上段**）

**分论点 3：**我们需要新证据去验证安装软件是否是最好方法。（**主题句**）（**之后的展开同上段**）

**总结：**当我们给出如上的一系列新证据后，我们就可以评价作者的观点了。

## 常犯错误二 Issue 立意不高

一篇 Issue 文章的好坏，很大程度上取决于**论证是否深刻**。而论证的深刻与否很大程度上又取决于对于主题的把握，或者称之为文章的立意。优秀的文章能够准确把握 Issue 问题的核心、

探索题目背后的假设、给出明确的定义。相反，普通的文章立意往往不高，受限于题目的表象，没能挖掘题目背后更为深刻的内涵。

举一个数学上的例子作为类比："三角形的内角和是 180 度。"假设这是一道 Issue 题，该如何下笔？立意高的文章能敏锐地抓住这句看似是数学公理背后的假设：**这是一个平面空间**；换句话说，这句话在欧式几何的框架内是成立的。当我们跳出平面空间这个限制，开始考虑曲面空间时，一个更为广阔的世界出现了：三角形的内角和既可以大于 180 度，也可以小于 180 度。我们不妨把地球表面想象成一个曲面空间，赤道上任何两点和极点都可以构成一个曲面三角形，但这个三角形的内角和不等于 180 度。相反，立意不够深刻的文章就会把目光聚焦在"如何证明三角形内角和是 180 度"上。诚然这样的论证本身是没有错的，但由于全文的立意只停留在问题表面，很难写出精彩的文章。

这里我们举一篇比较有挑战的 Issue 文章作为范例：

As we acquire more knowledge, things do not become more comprehensible, but more complex and mysterious.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the statement and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider ways in which the statement might or might not hold true and explain how these considerations shape your position.

如果我们仅限于题目既定的框架，很容易陷入"什么时候变得更容易理解""什么时候变得更加复杂和神秘"的分类讨论中。有一位同学的提纲就是这样的：

**总立场**：支持

**分论点 1**：过多的信息和知识会让我们难以理解世界，因为我们会更为紧张，认知能力会下降——有研究表明接触过量信息导致的 IQ 下降比吸食大麻更加明显（例证）。

**分论点 2**：过多的信息使得分析某件事情时要考虑更多因素，这时问题的更多面就会显露出来，从而变得更加复杂。例如我们从小学习物理，会发现随着物理知识的增多，世界就会变得越来越复杂（例证）。

**分论点 3**：知道得越多并不代表知道得越好和越深刻。

**总结**：随着人们获取越来越多的信息，世界并非变得更加容易理解，而是变得更复杂和更神秘。

这样的文章立论中规中矩，如果语言上没有什么大问题的话，**4 分**的水平是可以达到的。读者可能会问：为什么这个论证不能冲击更高的分数呢？原因就在于它只看到了题目的表象，没有深入挖掘 more comprehensible 和 more complex and more mysterious 之间的关系，以及这关

系背后的意义。首先我们不妨仔细看一下这三个关键词各自的解释：comprehensible 译作“可被理解的”，complex 译作“复杂的”，mysterious 译作“神秘的”。

讲到这里其实第一层立意突破就浮现了出来：一个东西能否被理解与它是否复杂有关系吗？换言之，comprehensible 和 complex 是反义词吗？显然不是的，一个复杂机器的背后是可以被理解的工程原理，但一个构造简单的混沌摆的背后却是困扰了人类数百年的三体问题。可见一个对象复杂与否与它能否被理解并没有直接关联。如果把 complex 和神秘分开来讨论，我们不禁要问：世界是否复杂？答案是显而易见的，因此我们获取更多的知识，其实只是更多看到了世界的原本的复杂面目。换言之，世界并没有变复杂，而是我们对于世界的认知复杂化了。

第二层立意突破来自 comprehensible 和 mysterious 这对反义词，虽然看起来它们是矛盾的，但如果我们进一步挖掘就会发现它们的对象发生了变化：更容易理解的是现有的问题，而神秘是源自通过知识发现的新问题。从这个层面上我们可以继续挖掘，如果知识产生了新的问题，这些新的问题以后可以被解决吗？从不同时间来看是可以的，于是 comprehensible 和 mysterious 的矛盾有可能得到解决：知识的获取可能带来新问题，从而让世界显得更加神秘，但运用更新的知识便能在未来解决这些问题。

敏感的同学看到这里，也许已经开始思考：新的知识带来新的问题，这些问题可以被更新的知识所解答，但更新的问题又出现了……我们如果在时间维度上不断迭代下去，对于最后人们的认知究竟该持悲观态度（因为总有不断的新问题出现），还是乐观态度（因为新知识总能解决问题）呢？这就是立意第三层突破口，世界究竟是不是可知的。这个问题有两派哲学观点：不可知论（agnosticism）认为诸如上帝是否存在、宇宙的起源一类的哲学问题是不可被知晓（unknowable）的，而对立的观点则认为宇宙万物的原理总是可以穷尽的，我们人类目前只是没有足够的认知能力和工具罢了。其实这道题归根结底就是在帮你寻找你自己的世界观。

由此，我们给出一篇立意深刻的 Issue 提纲供大家参考，意在说明：其实 Issue 的立论本身没有太大的限制，下文的提纲认为世界终究是可知的，但把文章的基调定位为“世界总有一部分是不可知的”也未尝不可，只要能自圆其说就好。

**总立场：**complex 部分支持，mysterious 部分反对

**分论点 1：**把 complex 单独拿出来分析，指明复杂和神秘是两个概念，复杂也并非神秘的原因，而是世界本来就是如此。故而更多的知识改变了人们的认知，让人们意识到世界比之前想象得要复杂，但客观来看，世界本身并没有变。

**分论点 2：**一方面，承认新知识解决了问题，从而让世界 comprehensible；另一方面，承认新知识也带来了新问题，从而让世界更加 mysterious。

**分论点 3：**针对 2 之中的矛盾进行解析：第一，comprehensible 和 mysterious 所针对的对象是不一样的——comprehensible 是过去的世界，mysterious 是新的世界；第二，两者在时间维度上是不一样的，comprehensible 是针对过去的事物，mysterious 是面向未来的事物。

**分论点 4：** 3 当中的讨论其实涉及世界究竟是不是 agnostic，我们认为不是，也即世界的知识是有限的，未知的东西终究可以穷尽。从这个角度来看，随着新知识解决了老问题，世界总体是 more comprehensible 的。

**总结：** 更多的知识把世界的 complexity 揭露了出来，与此同时也暴露了新的未知。但随着知识越来越多，加上我们认为世界是可知的，世界总体而言是 more comprehensible。

## 常犯错误三 Issue 中的例证不具说服力

在英文写作当中，“举例子”是最常见的论证方法，它一方面能帮助支撑论点，使文章更加让人信服；另一方面，好的例子能让文章生动活泼，不再是干巴巴的说教，从读者的角度来看是能提高文章可读性的。

在 ETS 官方的 Issue 评分标准中就明确指出了例子的重要性：6 分文章往往 develops the position fully with compelling reasons and/or persuasive examples，5 分文章往往 develops the position with logically sound reasons and/or well-chosen examples。当然，在 GRE 考试中，举例还有一个实用功能，即显著提升文章长度。由此可见，举例在 Issue 写作中非常重要，但例子要怎么举才能恰当、有效呢？我们通过一道 Issue 的真题，配合同学们的真实习作来进行讲解。

To be an effective leader, a public official must maintain the highest ethical and moral standards.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim. In developing and supporting your position, be sure to address the most compelling reasons and/or examples that could be used to challenge your position.

以下是四篇未经我们任何修改的学生文章，我们截取其中例证的部分进行点评，分析大家在举例过程当中常见的问题：

### 习作一

Finally I want to introduce the achievement of the First Emperor of Qin. He unified China in 221 BC and built the Great Wall as well as Terra Cotta Warriors and many other great things. And he died when he was 49. It is obvious that he is an effective leader but he never maintained high ethical and moral standards in any sense. He even buried Confucian scholars alive.

I think the effectiveness of a public official springs from many aspects of his or her personality, maybe one of them is maintaining high ethical and moral standards. But it is hard to believe that one must maintain highest standards to become an effective leader.

**点评：**

1. 冗余信息太多，例如秦始皇 49 岁去世有什么意义？
2. 有用的信息没有论证到点子上，为什么统一全国、建造长城和兵马俑体现出他是有效的领导人？我们不能把一切都认为理所应当（“It is obvious that he is an effective leader...”），这样的例证是没有说服力的。
3. 例子缺乏总结，仅仅是平铺直叙说完了故事之后就匆忙结尾，与结尾段的衔接显得生硬。

**习作二**

although people may have different opinions on what is an effective leader, to me the defining character of an effective leader is that who makes as more as possible substantial benefit for the public. in 1776, the xxx as an effective leader put the right to life before every other right for defending the right for public. when he wrote the law, he maintained the ethical and moral standards, but we can't sure whether the highest ethical and moral standards. the change must hurt some interest of some people.

**点评：**

1. 首先，在文章开头给出 effective leader 定义的尝试值得肯定，但为什么这种定义是合理的？原文缺乏论证，使得这个观点不够令人信服。
2. 例证环节细节太少，而且文中的 xxx 给人一种捏造的感觉。
3. 中间属于循环论证，没有说服力：xxx 是一个有效的领导人，他认为 the right to life 是最重要的。这就说明要成为有效的领导人就必须尽可能为人民的利益服务吗？
4. 最后两句表意混乱，特别是 but we can't sure whether the highest ethical and moral standards 表意不完整，而且后半部分的反驳与中心句 the defining character of an effective leader is that who makes as more as possible substantial benefit for the public 没有直接联系。
5. 每句话第一个单词的第一个字母请大写。

**习作三**

Being effective requires the leader to do the things by rules. First we have to know what the effectiveness is. Effectiveness demands the leader to use the limited time to make decisions which requires much to a person. If there is no standands to follow, it hardly makes the correct conclusion in such a short time. Only by maintaining the highest standard moral and ethical standards, can he/she think of the problems more objective having the rules to follow. For example, the prime minister of England, when he helps the queen to mange the country, it is just that he has the highest standard on moral and ethical that makes him waked and clever.

**点评：**

1. 前面一部分的逻辑演绎有可圈可点之处，但从“遵守规则”到“必须得拥有最高的道德准则”之间欠缺足够的论证。
2. 后半部分说英国首相时，“it is just that he has the highest standard on moral and ethical that makes him waked and clever” 这个 claim 本身缺乏必要的论证支持，很难给本段的观点进行有力支撑。
3. 为什么是英国首相？美国总统不行吗？中国国家主席不行吗？ 这个例子中强调英国首相的意义何在？

**习作四**

Secondly, the claim has an underlying statement that harboring the highest ethical and moral principles is a necessary condition for being effective, which remains an open debate that if a leader lacks standards of highest level could be an excellent leader. I think the story of the 32nd president of the United States, Franklin D. Roosevelt could give me an answer. With his achivements in economy and politics during the Great Depression, he dragged America out of the financial crisis and turmoil society environment. For this reason, he was titled with one of the greatest presidents in the United States, and others granted with this glory were America's founding fathers. It is undoubtable that he is an absolutely effective leader and an excellent public official. But the fact always omitted by citizens is that he had affairs with his secretary for a very long time until his death. Generally speaking, adultery is definitely a violation to basic moral principles, needless to say the highest moral standards. But no one would deny his effective accomplishment and contribution to USA only because he did not maintain the basic morality. Consequently, the statement would not hold true taking account into such circumstances. And this phenomenon is not rare among those great effective political figures. William Jefferson Clinton's sexual scandal and Obama's drug addiction when he was young, all of these give me a lesson that even the greatest celebrities may have ethical or moral flaws which could not veil their effective doings in their field.

**点评：**

1. 例子中的细节很充分，这一点做得不错。
2. 论证都落实到了点子上（With his achivements in economy and politics during the Great Depression, he dragged America out of the financial crisis and turmoil society environment. For this reason, he was titled with one of the greatest presidents in the United States, and others granted with this glory were America's founding fathers.），这都是切实的逻辑演绎，而不像第一篇习作的“It is obvious...”。
3. 缺点：稍微冗长了一些，有一些细节可以合并简化，其实大家看 Clinton 和 Obama 的例子就很好，一两句话把问题讲清楚，然后说明白例子折射出来的道理就 OK 了。

总结一下，举例时需要注意的三点：

**第一，例子本身要可信。**我们不建议捏造例子的行为，这样一方面是有违诚信的原则，另一方面捏造的例子写出来很不真实。如果大家真的想不到例子，不妨假想一个情况——例如这道题我们可以假想，当一个国家的领导人因为道德原则而使得国家利益受损时，他不是一个有效的领导人。虽然这样的故事你不一定在考场上想出来，但它是符合逻辑，可以被人接受的。在这里，大家要区分“假设性的例子”和“造假”的例子，前者可以被接受，但后者不被提倡。

**第二，so what？**用中文来解释就是问，**你所举的例子究竟说明了什么道理？这些例子是怎么支撑你的观点的？**有时作为举例的人会心存侥幸，以为读者一眼就能看明白例子的用意。但注意，GRE 归根到底是一场考试，作为考生的你需要向考官展示你自己清晰的逻辑，关键的地方宁愿多说一点，也一定不能含糊。

**第三，浓缩才是精华。**举例固然能够帮助增加文章的长度，但太长的例子有喧宾夺主之嫌（思考：Issue 作文中的“主”应该是什么？）。真正的好例子应该是起到画龙点睛的作用，毕竟最精彩的论证不需要例子——你见过多少数学定理是用穷举法证明的？大家备考 Issue 的过程中还是应该加强锻炼自己的批判性思维，然后用例证锦上添花。

## 常犯错误四 Argument 组织不当

面对一篇 Argument，要写几段，每一段包括哪些内容，这两个问题至关重要。这两个问题如果处理得好，就能有序地组织文章，也就能达到 6 分评分标准中所说的“有逻辑地组织观点（organize ideas logically）”；如果处理得不好，就可能陷入 3 分评分标准中所说的“观点的发展和组织不够有逻辑（limited in the logical development and organization of ideas）”。下面的一个例子就在组织上略有欠缺。

**原题：**

The following was written as a part of an application for a small-business loan by a group of developers in the city of Monroe.

“A jazz music club in Monroe would be a tremendously profitable enterprise. Currently, the nearest jazz club is 65 miles away; thus, the proposed new jazz club in Monroe, the C-Note, would have the local market all to itself. Plus, jazz is extremely popular in Monroe: over 100,000 people attended Monroe’s annual jazz festival last summer; several well-known jazz musicians live in Monroe; and the highest-rated radio program in Monroe is ‘Jazz Nightly,’ which airs every weeknight at 7 P.M. Finally, a nationwide study indicates that the typical jazz fan spends close to $1,000 per year on jazz entertainment.”

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

某同学对此给出的提纲如下：

**总立场：**我们还需要一些具体的证据才能评价作者提出的“在 M 新建 jazz club 会盈利”这一结论。

**分论点 1：**作者给出了“最近的 jazz 在 65 英里之外”这一证据，并以此认为新 jazz club 会拥有所有本地市场，但我们还需要一些新证据才能判断这一结论是否正确。

**分论点 2：**作者告诉我们去年有 10 万人参加了 M 的年度音乐节，但我们不知道这 10 万人是否愿意花钱在 jazz club 上。因此还需要新证据来帮助判断这一点。

**分论点 3：**有几个 jazz 音乐人住在 M，并不代表他们会去新开的 jazz club。我们需要相应的新证据来帮助判断这点。

（注：分论点 4 和分论点 5 只出现在了该同学的提纲中，因为写作时间所限，正文段中并没有出现这两点）

**分论点 4：**虽然广播音乐节目很受欢迎，但也不代表人们会去新开的 jazz club。我们需要相应的新证据来帮助判断这点。

**分论点 5：**全国的调查不一定适用于本地，我们需要新证据帮助判断本地是否也有典型的 jazz fan。

最后我们给这篇文章的参考分数是 3。究其原因，并非因为其没有按照 Direction 的要求来写（提纲中反复出现了“证据”一词，说明文章基本符合 Direction 的要求），也不是语言不合格，而是因为全文的组织不当。

我们可以对原 Argument 的结构通过以下的逻辑图来表示：

通过这个逻辑推理图我们可以清晰地看出，文章中给出的证据（①②③④⑤）并非直接推出总结论⑨的。而是由证据①推出小结论⑥，由证据②③④推出小结论⑦，由证据⑤推出小结论⑧，然后再由小结论⑥⑦⑧推出最终结论的⑨。每一次由证据推到结论的过程都是有问题的，而原文一共推了四次结论（前三次是由证据推到小结论，最后一次是由小结论推到最终结论），所以有四处推理过程都有问题。因此，理论上讲，我们应该写出四个中间段来分别评价这四次推理。具体内容应该如下：

**中间段 1**：评价由证据①推出小结论⑥的推理过程。

**中间段 2**：评价由证据②③④推出小结论⑦的推理过程。

**中间段 3**：评价由证据⑤推出小结论⑧的推理过程。

**中间段 4**：评价由小结论⑥⑦⑧推出最终结论⑨的推理过程。

如上所示，“需要写几段”“每一段应该包括哪些内容”这两个问题的答案非常明显。按这种方式组织出来的段落才最贴近原 Argument 的推理过程，才能满足 6 分评分标准中所说的“有逻辑地组织观点（organize ideas logically）”。

组织好了每一段，接下来就是从 Direction 要求的角度组织每一段的文字。大家可以参考第五章给出的这一道题目的范文。

## 第二节　形式方面

### 常犯错误一　句子连接

**错误句子 1**：Imagination is significant, we should make good use of it.

**错误句子 2**：Imagination is significant, therefore we should make good use of it.

**错误原因**：逗号“，”不能连接具有完整主谓宾的两个句子。有同学认为此时加上一个表示因果关系的词 therefore 就可以连接两个句子了，但是 therefore 是副词，同样不能连接两个完整句子（与 therefore 类似，thereby、hence、thus、consequently 等都是副词，都不能连接两个完整句子）。

**改正后的句子**：

**改法 1**: Imagination is significant; we should make good use of it.

**改法 2**: Imagination is significant. We should make good use of it.

（分号和句号前后可以连接两个完整的句子。但原句想要表达的因果关系并没有被凸显，因此不如下面两种改法）

**改法 3**: Imagination is significant, **so** we should make good use of it.

**改法 4**: **Since/Because** imagination is significant, we should make good use of it.

（so、since、because 都是连词，都可以连接两个完整的句子，而且也凸显了原文的因果关系，比较妥帖）

### 常犯错误二　代词使用

**错误句子 1**：Great leaders should be tough. That is to say, he can stick to his own principles.

**错误原因**：前一句的 leaders 是复数形式，而后一句却用第三人称单数形式的 he 和 his 对其进行指代，前后单复数不统一。

**改正后的句子：** Great leaders should be tough. That is to say, **they** can stick to **their** own principles.

**错误句子 2：** Novelists create a considerable number of brilliant novels. They contribute greatly to the society.

**错误原因：** 前一句出现了 Novelists 和 novels 两个复数形式的单词，因而我们不清楚后一句中的 they 到底指代哪一个单词。

**改正后的句子：** Novelists create a considerable number of brilliant novels. **Those novelists/Their novels/Those novels** contribute greatly to the society.

**错误句子 3：** It is unacceptable.

**错误原因：** 代词无所指代。按理说，根据代词的指代，是可以回归到上文或下文中的某个词或某个概念。而同学在写作文的时候常常使用在上下文中都找不到指代的代词。（这位同学的这句话中的 It 确实在其上下文中都找不到指代，这里因为篇幅所限，无法详尽展示其上下文）

**改正方法：** 取消代词 it 的使用，或者在上下文中明确 it 的指代对象。

## 常犯错误三 名词单复数

**错误句子 1：** We need several evidences to demonstrate the validity of this argument.

**错误原因：** 这句话在 argument 中经常用到，但 evidence 通常用作不可数名词。要表示“一条证据”，用 a piece of evidence；要表示很多证据，可以用 abundant、plentiful、ample 等词，也可以用 a body of、a mass of 等短语。

**改正后的句子：** We need several **evidence** to demonstrate the validity of this argument.

**错误句子 2：** Book enlightens us.

**错误原因：** “书本启迪我们”，这里的 book 应该是泛指意义上的书。所以要用表示泛指意义的 Books 或 A book。

**改正后的句子：** **Books** enlighten us./**A book** enlightens us.

## 常犯错误四 冠词误用

**错误句子 1：** The disagreement promotes innovation.

**错误原因：** “分歧促进创新”，这里的“分歧（disagreement）”应该表泛指，所以不需要定冠词 the。

**改正后的句子：** **Disagreement** promotes innovation.

**错误句子 2：** Disagreement of these two artists' opinions on this artwork encouraged them to delve into more thorough research.

**错误原因：** “这两个艺术家关于这幅艺术品的看法的分歧激励他们进行更全面的研究”，这里的“分歧（disagreement）”应该是特指这两个人对于某个艺术品的看法的分歧，所以需要用定冠词 the。

**改正后的句子：** **The** disagreement of these two artists' opinions on this artwork encouraged them to delve into more thorough research.

## 常犯错误五 混淆主动被动

**错误句子 1：** Comparing to the first opinion, the second one makes more sense.

**错误原因：** 非谓语动词 comparing 的逻辑主语应该和主句主语 the second one（opinion）一致。而 opinion 只能是“被比较”，而不能主动发出“比较”这个动作。

**改正后的句子：** **Compared** to the first opinion, the second one makes more sense.

**错误句子 2：** The "field" in this issue is consisted of three parts: science, literature and art.

**错误原因：** consist of 意为“由……组成”，英文释义为 to be formed from/by，已然含有被动语义。通常以 A consist of B 这样的主动形式表示“A 由 B 组成”。（要表示 B 组成 A，我们可以用 B constitute/make up A）

**改正后的句子：** The "field" in this issue **consists of** three parts: science, literature and art.

## 常犯错误六 从句误用

**错误句子 1：** This is apparently the best solution which can change the situation.

**错误原因：** 定语从句修饰的先行词 solution 被形容词最高级 the best 修饰，所以定语从句应该用 that 引导，而非 which。

**改正后的句子：** This is apparently the best solution **that** can change the situation.

**错误句子 2：** This argument is unconvincing due to several questionable assumptions lack support.

**错误原因：** “几个缺少支持的令人质疑的假设让这篇 argument 不可信”。当先行词在定语从句中充当主语时，定语从句的引导词不能省略。

**改法1：** This argument is unconvincing due to several questionable assumptions **that/which** lack support.（补全定语从句的引导词）

**改法 2：** This argument is unconvincing due to several questionable assumptions **lacking** support.（将 lack 变为非谓语动词，作后置定语，修饰 assumption）

**错误句子 3：** Educators should prevent students from choosing fields which are unlikely to succeed.

**错误原因：** which 引导的定语从句修饰先行词 field，翻译成中文是“不太可能成功的领域”，我们虽然能够明白其中文句意，但放在英文中却说不通。因为 succeed 这个动作的发出者应该是人（people），而不是领域（field）。

**改正后的句子：** Educators should prevent students from choosing fields **in which students** are unlikely to succeed.（**注意：有同学把 students 换成 they，这就犯了 “指代不明” 的错误，因为句子中有 educators 和 students 两个复数概念。**）

**错误句子 4**：The author claims this recommendation will work well and this company will make more money.

**错误原因**：that 引导并列宾语从句时，第一个 that 可以省略，第二个及以后的 that 都不可以省略。

**改正后的句子**：The author claims **that** this recommendation will work well and **that** this company will make more money.

**错误句子 5**：The reason why leaders should listen to the public is because leaders are selected by the public.

**错误原因**：the reason is because 搭配错误。当 reason 作主语时，表语从句的引导词是 that 而不是 because。

**改正后的句子**：The reason why leaders should listen to the public is **that** leaders are selected by the public.

**错误句子 6**：No matter who has the courage to break the old rules is likely to succeed.

**错误原因**：no matter who 只能引导让步状语从句，而 whoever 既可以引导让步状语从句，也可以引导名词性从句（whatever、however、wherever 等同理）。这句话中，has the courage 前缺少主语，因此我们需要主语从句的引导词 whoever。

**改正后的句子**：**Whoever** has the courage to break the old rules is likely to succeed.

**错误句子 7**：We should always doubt that whether the authority is right.

**错误原因**：doubt 后可以跟宾语从句，但宾语从句的引导词只需要一个。因此该句子中 that 是多余的。

**改正后的句子**：We should always doubt **whether** the authority is right.

**错误句子 8**：Despite the author provides several evidence, this argument is questionable.

**错误原因**：despite 后面只能跟名词性成分，而不能跟句子（与之类似的还有 in spite of）。

**改法 1**：**Although** the author provides several evidence, this argument is questionable.

（although 是连词，后面可以跟完整句子充当让步状语从句）

**改法 2**：**Despite** the evidence the author provides, this argument is questionable.

（将原句中 Despite 之后的句子改成名词性成分）

**错误句子 9**：Plausible as appears this argument, it is unconvincing.

**错误原因**：as 作“虽然”讲时可以引导倒装的让步状语从句，但同学们往往搞不清楚句子中主、谓、宾的顺序。正确的顺序应该是“*adj.* / *adv.* / 分词 / 名词（要省略冠词）+ as + 主语 + 谓语动词”。

**改正后的句子**：**Plausible as this argument appears**, it is unconvincing.

**错误句子 10**：The government should give financial support to big cities where are the major places for culture development.

**错误原因**：定语从句修饰的先行词 cities 在定语从句中作主语，因此定语从句的引导词应该用关系代词 that 或者 which。而如果先行词在定语从句中作状语，则应该用关系副词 where、when 等引导定语从句，如改法 2 的句子。

**改法 1**：The government should give financial support to big cities **that** are the major places for culture development.

**改法 2**：The government should give financial support to big cities **where** culture develops/flourishes.

**错误句子 11**：It is in small cities where artists can do whatever they want.

**错误原因**：这句话的错误比较难以发现。很多同学认为 where 引导定语从句修饰 small cities，但如果按照这种思路，我们会发现 small cities 前面的 It is in 的意思无从解释。其实，这句话是混淆了定语从句和强调句型。作者真正想表达的意思是“艺术家**只有在大城市**才能够做他们想做的事情”（强调“大城市”）。

**改正后的句子**：It is in small cities **that** artists can do whatever they want.

**错误句子 12**：One may ask: is this quality that an effective leader should have?

**错误原因**：这句话的错误比较难看出来。很多同学都认为 that 引导的定语从句修饰先行词 quality，但如果我们按照这种思路把原句换成陈述句的语序，则错误就显而易见了：this quality that an effective leader should have is。我们可以发现，is 后面缺少表语，句子不完整。因此我们需要添加表语使得句子完整。

**改正后的句子**：One may ask: is this quality **the one** that an effective leader should have?

## 常犯错误七 误用“大词”

由于花了大工夫在 GRE 单词的背诵上，因此会有同学存在一种不把它们用出来就不甘心的冲动。于是，就有了以下一些错误：

**错误句子 1**：This argument is unconvincing due to its numerous logic flaws.

**错误原因**：numerous 意为“极其多的，数不胜数的”，程度非常深。而 argument 当中所谓的“逻辑错误”虽然不少，但离“数不胜数”还有相当的距离。故 numerous 用在这里不妥。

**改正后的句子**：This argument is unconvincing due to **several** logic flaws.

**错误句子 2**：In this way the conclusion of this argument is vandalized.

**错误原因**：虽然我们在背单词的时候可能会简单地把 vandalize 记作“破坏”，但在真实使用中，vandalize 常指“对公物的蓄意破坏”，用在这里显然不合适。

**改正后的句子**：In this way the conclusion of this argument is **undermined**.

**错误句子 3**：Therefore the author's conclusion is preposterous.

**错误原因**：我们可能在背诵 GRE 词汇的时候，出于便利将 preposterous 记成“错误的”。但这个词的程度很深，而且极具负面的感情色彩，可以翻译成“荒谬绝伦的”，或“岂有此理的”，用在这里太过偏激。

**改正后的句子**：Therefore the author's conclusion is **unconvincing/questionable**.

**错误句子 4**：To draw a conclusion, while this policy might bring about some benefits, I have to argue that it is abysmal.

**错误原因**：abysmal 的意思类似于 terrible，程度极深，甚至可以夸张地翻译为“无底洞般地差劲”。而原句明明一定程度上肯定了 this policy，所以用 abysmal 就显得很不妥。

**改正后的句子**：To draw a conclusion, while this policy might bring about some benefits, I have to argue that in most cases it is **harmful**.（harmful 的程度不如 abysmal 深，再加上一个 in most cases 使得原句逻辑更加严谨）

**错误句子 5**：Clearly, she gets a sanguine opinion so she can ignore so many difficulties.

**错误原因**：作者本身希望表达的意思可能是“很明显，是她的乐观让她能够克服这许多的困难”。但是，sanguine 这个词是非常正式的书面语，用在这句话中和作者的 gets、ignore 等不太准确的表达显得格格不入。

**改法 1**：Clearly, she **has been very optimistic**, so she **could overcome** so many difficulties.
（舍弃 sanguine，让整句话更加平实但不失准确）

**改法 2**：Clearly, **it is her sanguine attitude that enabled her to surmount all the** difficulties.
（保留 sanguine，但同时也对句式和表达做一些改写，让句子更加凝练且重点突出。这句话可能会比改法 1 更为正式，或者“高大上”，但不是说我们就应该追求改法 2 这样的句子。在 GRE 中，我们追求的只是“准确”。）

**错误句子 6**：Though there are so many attractions, we should be **ascetic** to have a healthy value of life.

**错误原因**：大家对 ascetic 这个词应该很熟悉，因为它出现在单词书的 A 打头的那一章。事实上，这个词很少用在一般的作文中。因为它往往指西方宗教里所倡导的为达到精神救赎而对诸般欲望的禁锢，“六根清净”这个词也许能比较好地传达其意思。

**改正后的句子**：Though there are so many attractions, to form a healthy value of life, we should better **abstain/refrain/keep away from** some of them.

综上所述，GRE 单词还真不是我们想用就能用的。就现阶段来看，盲目使用 GRE 词汇至少可能会存在以下问题：

1. 拼不对。GRE 词汇大多不短，考场上不一定能拼对。
2. 意思用错。GRE 词汇的意思往往很窄，很容易用错。
3. 很多 GRE 词汇非常学术化，这就有可能和大家作文中的一些比较口语化的表达冲突，从而让文章的整体风格显得比较别扭。

## 附：清华外教致中国英语考生的一些话

在本书的 40 篇文章全部完成之后，我们有幸请到了清华大学外文系负责学术英语教学和商务英语教学的外教 Cassandra Woloschuk 女士为这 40 篇文章修改润色。当聊到彼此所见到的中国考生的写作短板时，我们不谋而合地提到了“乱用大词”“语义不明”等问题。在下面的几段话中，Cassandra 总结了中国考生在写作时的几个典型问题，这和本章“考生常犯错误”各自从宏观和微观两个层面为大家提供了修改自己文章的指导性建议。

另外，我们还附上了外教对我们文章修改的范例。“好文章是改出来的”，在经过自我修改、同事老师互改、学生阅读反馈等环节之后，本书的 40 篇文章依然需要更加专业权威的人士进行批评指教，Cassandra 在这方面给予了我们很大的帮助。当大家进入研究生院进行正式的学术写作并需要发表论文时，数十遍乃至几十遍的修改是在所难免的。希望大家从现在起就养成改文章的好习惯，真正为自己的笔头文字负责。

**外教寄语：**

It has been a pleasure reading and editing these responses. Their succinctness and simplicity should be the goal of any Chinese student hoping to write like a foreigner.

Teaching in China has given me new insight about how Chinese students approach the mechanics of writing. Because the immediate task facing you is to improve writing skills, I want to highlight a couple of problematic tendencies among Chinese writing in English.

Many students deliberately write long, complicated passages because they believe this makes their writing more sophisticated. Unfortunately, this practice erodes writing quality. The best writing is clear and concise. Using three words when one will do often obscures meaning. It does not matter how good an idea is if the author does not explain it clearly. Instead of sacrificing clarity, enhance your writing by focusing on coherence and cohesion, lexical resource, and grammatical range and accuracy.

Passive writing is another tendency among Chinese students—as well as in English translations throughout China. I have seen many signs that are longer than they need to be due to this passive voice preference. Writing in the passive voice may be clear but it contains redundancies that the active voice eliminates. The ability to write in the active voice is essential in academia. Writing in the passive voice damages the authoritative tone academic writing requires.

Writing is an art. Never fall into the trap of believing your first draft cannot be improved upon. Editing is a crucial process so write your first draft with your heart and your second draft with your head. By this I mean that you should first write what you feel is important then clean up the writing in the second draft. If you become attached to a particular phrase or sentence you will have difficulty editing it if necessary in a subsequent draft.

I hope that you will find the essays in this volume helpful as you strive to improve your own writing.

Cassandra Woloschuk

## 外教修改样例：

36. The following report appeared in the newsletter of the West Meria Public Health Council.

"An innovative treatment has come to our attention that promises to significantly reduce absenteeism in our schools and workplaces. A study reports that in nearby East Meria, where fish consumption is very high, people visit the doctor only once or twice per year for the treatment of colds. Clearly, eating a substantial amount of fish can prevent colds. Since colds represent the most frequently given reason for absences from school and work, we recommend the daily use of Ichthaid—a nutritional supplement derived from fish oil—as a good way to prevent colds and lower absenteeism."

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

In this report, the author alleges the efficiency of Ichthaid—a nutritional supplement derives from fish oil—in preventing colds and further asserts the capability of Ichthaid to lower absenteeism in local schools and workplaces. To buttress his recommendation, the author cites a study showing high fish consumption and low doctor-visiting frequency in Meria. We are also informed that colds are the most frequently given reason for absences from school and work. However, close scrutiny of this argument reveals a lack of critical evidence and we are therefore unable to evaluate the conclusion. As a result, further information is needed to form a better evaluation of the author's recommendation.

To start with, while the author provides information concerning the high fish consumption and less frequent medical visits for the treatment of colds in Meria, we need more evidence to demonstrate the casual relationship between the former and the latter. For example, we need to know whether high fish consumption in Meria means that people eat a large amount of fish; in addition, detailed proof will be of great significance to determine whether people visit doctors infrequently ~~due to an authentically low frequency of~~ because of a lower incidence of catching colds ~~but not~~ as opposed to other reasons, such as excessively high hospital fees. If new evidence shows that people do eat a massive amount of fish and catch colds less often, then fish's efficiency in preventing colds can be confirmed and the author's recommendation is thereby more convincing.

In addition, although the writer claims that the most frequently given reason for absences from local school and work is colds, he needs to provide more evidence to validate the assertion. Since ~~asking for absence by claiming to be sick~~ absence due to illness is widely accepted ~~usually gains greater acceptance~~ in both schools and workplaces, using colds as an excuse not to study or work is naturally a reasonable possibility. Therefore, we need additional evidence indicating whether people asking for absence have lied about the reasons ~~for leaving schools or work~~. If new evidence shows that colds

do play a crucial role in absenteeism, then we are disposed to believe that the author's conclusion is advisable. On the contrary, if the evidence shows us ~~the other way around~~ the contrary, then we remain doubtful of the recommendation given in the argument.

Even if new evidence is provided that demonstrates both fish's efficiency in preventing colds as well as the contribution colds make towards local absenteeism, we need more information to show that Ichthaid is as effective, if not more, as fish in the prevention of colds. Specifically, we need to know whether fish's ability to prevent colds originates in its oil and not in other parts such as the bones. Moreover, it would be of great help to know whether elements in fish remain functional after a series of artificial processes. In addition, the author would benefit from clarifying the relationship between the usage of Ichthaid and its efficiency in preventing colds. If it is fishbone instead of fish oil that prevents colds, or artificially processes medicine lags in efficiency, or overuse of Ichthaid ~~turns out to be~~ is found to be counterproductive, then the author's conclusion is weakened and the recommendation should therefore be rejected. Otherwise, it should be encouraged.

To sum up, the current ~~available~~ information available in this argument dose not sufficiently substantiate that the proposed usage of Ichthaid will preclude colds in schools and workplaces and further lower local absenteeism. As a result, we need more evidence to better evaluate the author's recommendation.

# 第四章 GRE 写作官方评分标准精析

对 GRE 写作官方评分标准的解析是本书的一大亮点。

我们选择对 Issue 和 Argument 的评分标准进行解析，从根本上说是因为这是我们**唯一可以参照的、由官方给出的** GRE 作文判分依据。当我们向作文得高分的师兄师姐讨教 GRE 写作的经验，或是求助于诸多辅导书的“高分秘籍”时，得到的答案都是经过个人主观加工的信息，是没有经过官方认可的。

例如，最常被问到的一个问题是：“要写多少词？”可能有师兄师姐说：“我第一次写了 500 词，得了 4 分；第二次写了 600 词，得了 4.5。”对此，我们可能就会在分数和词数之间建立起正向的因果联系，甚至觉得要得 5 分及其以上需要至少 700 词。但是，ETS 就给出过一篇 500 词不到的 6 分范文，这充分说明了词数和分数之间的关系并不如大家想得那么紧密。

虽然词数和分数是有关系的，但并非直接相关。这是因为如果我们想得到高分，就必须把观点讲清楚，而要做到这一点，对于大多数考生来说往往需要相对较多的词数。所以，**高分文章虽然可能有“词数多”这一特征，但这一特征下的本质却应该是“把观点讲清楚的能力”**。如果不了解这一点，我们很可能就会把“写多”当作第一要务，而不顾内容和语言质量，这一做法必然导致南辕北辙，最后得分也可能不尽如人意。

因此，评分标准为我们提供了明确的、也是唯一的努力方向。对评分标准的解析也自然变得非常重要。

但是，评分标准中的语言非常抽象，让考生读完之后只能明白一个大致的方向，却不知道具体应该怎样做。比如 6 分的评分标准要求文章的观点做到“insightful（有洞察力的）”，那么什么叫“有洞察力”？考生还是不知所云。而对于评分标准的处理，市面上的参考书也基本停留在翻译和同义复述的层面，如一些参考书告诉我们：为了做到 insightful，需要深刻地而不是肤浅地看问题。那何为“深刻”？何又为“肤浅”？我们仍然一无所知。

因此，我们对评分标准的解析方式是，通过对 ETS 给出的范文分析，以及将评分标准和学术写作的诸多要领相结合，最后**将“评分标准”变为“如何取得高分的方法论，即怎么做”**。因为相比于“是什么”，“怎么做”对我们来说更有指导意义。所以，我们会把评分标准中的每一个关键词都变成一个具体的、具有动词意义的词语，以此来指导考生进行写作。

更重要的是，考生们一定都能在我们的每一篇范文中找到它对评分标准的照应。解析评分标准就如同告诉大家如何生产一个符合 ETS 要求的产品，而 40 篇范文就是 40 个这样的产品。这 40 篇范文不论是在整体还是在局部上都符合对评分标准的解析，**希望考生在阅读范文之时能够结合评分标准以及范文之后的评语**，对其反复揣摩，用心体会。

# 第一节 Issue 评分标准分析

**Issue 部分的评分标准主要围绕以下三点：**

**1. 是否按照 Direction（具体性指令）来写**

**2. 立意和观点发展如何**

**3. 语言如何**

请看不同分数段对我们的要求。

【Score 6】

In addressing the **specific task directions**, a 6 paper presents a **cogent, well-articulated** analysis of the issue and **conveys meaning skillfully**.

A typical paper in this category exhibits the following characteristics:

1. It articulates a **clear** and **insightful** position on the issue in accordance with the assigned task.
2. It develops the position fully, with **compelling reasons** and/or **persuasive examples**.
3. It sustains a **well-focused**, **well-organized** analysis, **connecting ideas logically**.
4. It conveys ideas fluently and precisely, using **effective vocabulary** and **sentence variety**.
5. It demonstrates facility with the conventions of **standard written English** (i.e., grammar, usage, and mechanics) but may have **minor errors**.

**中文翻译**

**在照应具体性指令的基础上，**6 分的文章对原 Issue 题目进行了**具有说服力的、清楚的**分析，且**运用（多种）技巧传词达意**。

典型的 6 分文章具有如下特征：

1. 根据题目要求，对原 Issue 题目给出**清楚**而**有洞察力**的立场。
2. 在完整地展开立场时，运用了**严密的推理**和/或**具有说服力的事例**。
3. 全文**焦点明确，组织清晰，观点和观点之间的衔接符合逻辑**。
4. 运用**有效的词汇**和**多样的句式**，流畅、准确地传达观点意思。
5. 熟练掌握**标准书面英语**的写作习惯（语法、用法、技法等），但仍存在一些**细小错误**。

**解　析**

6分的评分标准是我们最应该详细琢磨的评分标准，因为它代表着我们努力的方向。在之后的分数段的讲解中不难发现，5分和4分的评分标准其实就是6分的弱化版，其大方向是一致的，只不过是程度上的差异。因此，请认真研读下面对6分标准中关键词的解析：

specific task direction：**照应具体性指令是得6分的最基本的要求，这也是5分和4分标准的要求。对具体性指令的照应方法详见第五章。**

convey meaning skillfully: 这是6分标准区别于5分和4分的一大亮点。6分标准要求我们运用**多种技巧**阐述论证我们的观点。因此，常见的道理论证和事例论证自不必说，其他的论证方法，如比喻论证、反证法等都可以酌情使用。

clear position: 立场和论点要清楚。这里的clear（清楚）应当包括两层意思。

1. 首先是**位置的清楚**。即要把总论点和分论点放在最显眼、清楚的位置（总论点放首段；分论点放每一段的段首）。

2. 其次是**语义的清楚**。要清楚地传达意思，需要大家对每一种表达、句式都能够信手拈来并且准确运用。但现实情况是，考生倾向于用一些“高级”的表达和复杂的句式（比如定语从句），却没有足够的语言能力去驾驭这些表达和句式，结果只能是观点表意不清。**所以，如果对自己的语言不太自信，可以在中心句的表达时尽量采用简短、清楚的词汇、短语和句式。**

insightful position: 有洞察力的立场和观点。这一要求是和GRE写作中要求的Critical Thinking（批判性思维）紧密结合的。但不论是前者还是后者，都让我们感到很大、很空，不知道具体如何操作。对此，我们把insightful（有洞察力的）这个词具象为**“全面而深刻”**。

**1. 全面**。面对一道Issue题目，我们要对其做全面的分析。这种全面可以包括但不局限于以下几方面：

①正反兼备地看问题。对题目的观点，可以既赞同，又反对。

②抓住题目中含义丰富或具有复杂性的词语，对其进行不同维度的分析。如在题目“In order for any work of art—for example, a film, a novel, a poem, or a song—to have merit, it must be understandable to most people”中，我们可以全面分析“merit（价值）”这一词。艺术品的价值可能包括审美价值、收藏价值、市场价值等，但并不是每一种价值的实现都要依赖于艺术品的通俗性。我们可以按照这样的思维展开我们的中间三段。

**2. 深刻**。一道Issue题目所讨论的问题往往不是如它表面看上去的那么简单，这时就需要我们**透过现象看本质**，抓住题目的核心问题。需要注意的是，这里的“核心问题”只是一个相对概念，且不唯一，不同的考生对于相同题目的核心问题可能有着不同的理解，但只要这些理解都相对深入即可。如，对于Issue13题所探讨的，大学是否应该让学生选修很多本专业之外的课程，表面上是在讨论要不要选专业外的课程这一问题，但有考生可能会认为这道题本质上是在探讨“专

才（specialist）”和“通才（generalist）”；而另一些考生可能会认为“同一性（conformity）”和“多样性（diversity）”才是本题的核心问题；甚至会有考生认为本题应该落脚在“知识（knowledge）”和“方法论（methodology）”的对立统一之上。这些观点都比较深入，但很难判断孰是孰非，孰优孰劣。所以，大家可以选择自己认为好写的观点对其进行论证。

compelling reason：严密的推理。这里的 reason 虽然是名词（“理由”），但我们把它动词化，翻译成“推理”，这样更便于理解。“严密的推理”其实照应的就是议论文中常见的“道理论证”。但是，大家在以往的写作中对某一观点进行道理论证时，往往是在对这一观点进行同义重复，或隔靴搔痒般的浅显解释，这在 GRE 写作中是不够的。**我们需要做的，是再现推理的过程**。即在论证观点 A 时，我们需要给出得到观点 A 的思考过程，即从 A1 到 A2 再到 A3（A4、A5...）最后到 A 的推理步骤。其中的 A1、A2 和 A3 等称为“桥梁概念”，是辅助读者理清作者的推理思路的重要概念。桥梁概念的数量并非越多越好，但却是 GRE 写作中展现我们逻辑脉络的关键要素。例如，如果我们的某个论点是“不通俗易懂的艺术作品也可以有价值”，为了论证这个论点，我们需要再现推理过程。如“艺术作品的价值主要体现在创作者的技艺和其个人世界的展现中（A1）。其技艺有时高超晦涩，其个人世界的展现往往又极具个性（A2），因此不具备相关知识的外行人，或是没有和创作者类似经历的人，往往不能理解作品的手法或内容（A3）。因此这些人也无法理解该艺术品的价值（A4）。但这并不妨碍这些作品成为有价值的作品（A）。”如上所示，从 A1 到 A 的推理过程就比较饱满，也使得论点更具有说服力。

persuasive example：具有说服力的事例，即事例论证。“举例子要有说服力”，这几乎是一句在各大英语写作考试中都耳熟能详的套话。但如何具有说服力？这却似乎是大家一直没有弄明白的问题。对此，我们给出一个总的原则和几个具体的建议，帮助大家构建具有说服力的例子。**总的原则是：照应推理过程**。具体建议如下：

1. 找同义概念。**即找推理过程中关键信息的同义或者近义概念**。如在推理过程中出现了 assume an important role 这一表达，那么在举例子的时候可以换用 play a significant part。要注意的是，推理过程中出现的表示逻辑连接的词语（如 therefore、however 等），更需要在举例子时同义重复（如 hence、nevertheless 等）。

2. 找下义概念。**即找推理过程中出现的比较宽泛的概念的具体体现**。如在推理过程中出现了 law，那么在举例子的时候可以举出更加具体的、法律的下义词 tax law。

3. 如果是对自己驾驭语言的能力缺少信心的考生，甚至可以比较机械地尝试这种做法：**在事理推理过程中写了几句话，在举例子时就参照其句式进行更加具体的仿写，依旧写出同样数量的句子**。这虽然有一点死板，但至少能保证关键信息的一一照应，也不失为构建具有说服力例证的一种方法。

well-focused：焦点明确。要做到焦点明确，只需要做到以下两点：

1. 不偏题。尤其不要偏离具体性指令的要求。

2. 文章的分论点围绕总论点展开。

well-organized：组织清晰。要做到组织清楚，需做到以下两点：

1. 各分论点之间层次清楚，且和总论点的关系紧密。
2. 多用、用准逻辑连接词。

connecting ideas logically：有逻辑地组织观点。要做到这一点，可以参照以下两条对策：

1. 在保证逻辑本身没有问题的基础上，**多用、用准逻辑连接词**。

2. 前文的相同概念在后文再次提及时，在不影响意思传达的基础上，可以尝试**同义改写或者用指示代词（this、that 等）对其进行指代**。另外，如 previous、former、aforementioned、latter、following 等词虽然不属于指示代词，但同样具有指示的作用，大家也可以多多使用，以体现前后文的联系。

effective vocabulary：使用有效词汇。“有效”词汇**首先要做到准确，在此基础上尽可能地追求生动形象**。以下两条策略可以帮助大家选择那些准确、生动的词汇：

**1. 词语意思越具体，越实在，就越准确**，这一点在动词上体现尤为明显。大家经常用到的 get、let、make 等词，往往意思太宽，在表意上不够精准。如：与其说“get a clear understanding（得到清楚的认知）”，不如把 get 换成 acquire、form 等，意思更具体，表意更准确。

**2. 具有画面感的词语比较生动，也因此更加有效**。这样的词语有很多，但需要平日的积累。如表达“A 不那么重要”时，与其说 A is not that important，不如说 A pales/dims in significance，pale 有“变得苍白”的意思，dim 有“变得昏暗”的意思，在这里和 significance 连用，极具画面感，就比单纯用 be 动词显得更加生动形象。

sentence variety：一提到句式多样性，大家可能直接会将其等同于花哨多样的句式，即语言层面的多变，但语言终究是为思想服务的。只有当我们的思维多样时，我们才会启用相应多样的语言。如：只有当我们在想要表达具有层级关系的意思时，我们才会使用从句以突出主句的地位。因此，**在追求句式多样性之前，我们首先应该追求传词达意的准确，在此基础上再求变**。在能够做到用相应句式准确表达意思时，可以适当考虑以下几点策略：

1. 倒装。我们广泛接触到的 not only...but also...、as/though、nor、only、nor 等词都可以引起倒装，大家可以酌情使用。但一定注意，只有当想要强调倒装部分时，才用倒装句式。

2. 省略。前后两句话中出现相同成分时，我们完全可以将部分成分省略，这样既显得简洁，又可以使前后的句子长短不同，错落有致。如“Such a policy is not an elixir, but (it is) just a pain-killer.（这个政策并非万灵药，而只是止痛药。）”。

3. 换主语。在表意清楚的前提上，我们可以多换主语。动词不定式、人、事、物、句子、it 等都可以作主语。如在想要表达“我们需要关注 sth”的时候，可以有以下几种表达：

a. We need to pay attention to sth.

b. It is necessary to pay attention to sth.

c. What we need to pay attention to is sth.

d. Sth requires our attention.

e. To pay attention to sth is of great necessity.

standard written English：GRE 写作要求我们运用标准的书面语。这一点看上去比较有难度，但实则却是大家掌握得最好的。因为从小学开始到大学的四、六级考试，又到托福考试，大家所学习的英语都可以算是标准的书面英语。广大中国留学生真正薄弱的环节应该是口语（这里的口语不单指“说的能力”，也是指和比较正式的“书面表达”相对立的“口语表达”）。因此，只要大家注意**不要在 GRE 写作中过度使用俗语、俚语或粗俗的表达**，就基本符合书面英语的写作要求了。

minor errors：这里的 minor 包含两层意思，其一是“**程度较轻**”，其二是“**数量较少**”。所谓“程度较轻”的错误，**是指这个错误既不影响阅读，也不会反映出作者在语法层面的能力缺陷**，如某个单词的某两个字母错位了，某个单词忘了变复数，等等，这些都是可以接受的错误类型；而所谓的“数量较少”，则是希望大家尽量把全篇文章的错误数量控制在 **5 个以内**。

综上，本书将 6 分评分标准中的每一个关键词语都做了详细的讲解，并将其转化为具体的方法论，指导大家写作。需要注意的是，6 分的评分标准（包括 5 分和 4 分的评分标准）说道：**要满足标准中的所有要求**，文章才能达到相应的分数。因此，大家需要结合上述解析，从每一个方向努力。

**【Score 5】**

In addressing the **specific task directions**, a 5 paper presents a **generally thoughtful**, **well-developed** analysis of the issue and conveys meaning **clearly**.

A typical paper in this category exhibits the following characteristics:

1. It presents a **clear** and **well-considered** position on the issue in accordance with the assigned task.
2. It develops the position with **logically sound reasons** and/or **well-chosen** examples.
3. It is **focused** and **generally well organized**, **connecting ideas appropriately**.
4. It conveys ideas clearly and well, using **appropriate vocabulary** and **sentence variety**.
5. It demonstrates facility with the conventions of **standard written English** but may have **minor errors**.

**中文翻译**

**在照应具体性指令的基础上，**5 分的文章对原 Issue 题目进行了**比较缜密的、发展充分的分析，且清楚地传词达意**。

典型的 5 分文章具有如下特征：

1. 根据题目要求，对原 Issue 题目给出**清楚**而**考虑充分**的立场。
2. 在完整地展开立场时，运用了**逻辑正确的推理**和**精心挑选的事例**。
3. 全文**有焦点，组织比较清晰，观点和观点之间的衔接恰当**。
4. 运用**合适的词汇**和**多样的句式**，清楚地传达观点意思。
5. 熟练掌握**标准书面英语**的写作习惯，但仍存在一些**细小错误**。

**解　析**

5 分的评分标准不论从哪一个角度讲其实都是 6 分的弱化版，所以大家只需要以 6 分的要求为目标努力就行了。所谓“求上得中，求中得下”，只有把目标定得高一些，才更有动力。

值得注意的是，**得到 5 分的一个前提是，要按照具体性指令来写**。这一点和 6 分相同。

**【Score 4】**

In addressing the **specific task directions**, a 4 paper presents a **competent** analysis of the issue and conveys meaning with **acceptable clarity**.

A typical paper in this category exhibits the following characteristics:

1. It presents a **clear** position on the issue in accordance with the assigned task.
2. It develops the position with **relevant reasons** and/or **examples**.
3. It is **adequately focused** and **organized**.
4. It demonstrates sufficient control of language to express ideas with **reasonable clarity**.
5. It **generally** demonstrates control of the conventions of **standard written English** but may have **some errors**.

**中文翻译**

**在照应具体性指令的基础上**，4 分的文章对原 Issue 题目进行了**足够的**分析，且**比较清楚地传词达意**。

典型的 4 分文章具有如下特征：

1. 根据题目要求，对原 Issue 题目给出**清楚**的立场。
2. 在展开立场时，运用了**相关的推理**和/或**事例**。
3. 全文**有焦点，组织基本清晰**。
4. 能**比较清晰地**传达观点意思，展示出对语言足够的驾驭能力。
5. 能够**基本**掌握**标准书面英语**的写作习惯，但仍存在**一些错误**。

**解　析**

4 分的评分标准其实是 5 分的进一步弱化版。如 4 分标准已经不要求大家的观点深刻，而只是观点清楚即可；推理与事例也不再需要严谨并具有说服力，而只需要相关。所以，Issue 取得 4 分并非遥不可及之事。

同样值得注意的是，**得到 4 分的一个前提是，要按照具体性指令来写**。

**【Score 3】**

A 3 paper demonstrates **some competence in addressing the specific task directions**, in analyzing the issue, and in conveying meaning but is **obviously flawed**.

A typical paper in this category exhibits **ONE OR MORE** of the following characteristics:

1. It is **vague** or **limited** in addressing the specific task directions and in presenting or developing a position on the issue.
2. It is **weak** in the use of relevant reasons or examples, or relies largely on **unsupported claims**.
3. It is **poorly focused** and/or **poorly organized**.
4. It has problems in language and sentence structure that result in **a lack of clarity**.
5. It contains **occasional major errors** or **frequent minor errors** in grammar, usage, or mechanics that can **interfere with meaning**.

**中文翻译**

3 分文章**对具体性指令有一定的照应**，对原 Issue 题目也有一定的分析，并且能够在一定程度上传词达意，但是文章**存在明显的缺陷**。

典型的 3 分文章具有以下的**一个或者多个**特征：

1. 文章对具体性指令的照应，以及在传达和发展立场时显得**不充分**且**比较模糊**。
2. 文章中**几乎没有**相关的推理或例证，或是**观点几乎没有支持**。
3. 全文**焦点不明**并且/或者**组织不清**。
4. 文章在语言和句式上存在问题，以至于**语意不明**。
5. 文章存在语法、用法和技法方面的**一些重大错误**或**大量细小错误**，以至于**表意不明**。

**解　析**

3 分评分标准的评分维度其实和之前的评分标准类似，但有两点需要注意：其一，所有维度的特征都转向负向评价；其二，**这些特征中只要满足一个，考生的文章就会被判为 3 分**。这一点尤其需要大家引起注意，不要在任何一个方面粗心大意，让自己的文章被判 3 分。

另外，**3 分及其以下分数的一个共同特征是：都没有很好地照应具体性指令的要求**。具体性指令一直是考生的一个盲点，从评分标准可以看出，文章很容易就踏进了 3 分的泥沼。但换句话说，如果考生的英语基础不错，再稍微注意一下具体性指令的要求，就很容易突破 3 分、冲向 4 分甚至更高的分数。

需要额外提醒一下，虽然很多同学（特别是理工科的同学）只求 3 分，事实上很多同学凭借 3 分的写作分数也去了国外。然而，这样的分数虽然可能不会成为大家踏进美国大学的致命的绊脚石，但却清楚表明大家在写作上存在着很大的缺陷。熟悉 GRE 写作分数的同学就会知道，3 分的分数表示该考生只打败了全球范围内 10% 左右的对手，这样的写作水平是远远不能满足研究生院的正常写作要求（包括日常作业、科研报告以及毕业论文等）的。因此，**强烈建议大家在去国外之前努力提升学术英语的写作能力**，才能更好地适应美国大学高强度的学术生活。

**【Score 2】**

A 2 paper **largely disregards the specific task directions** and/or demonstrates serious weaknesses in analytical writing.

A typical paper in this category exhibits **ONE OR MORE** of the following characteristics:

1. It is **unclear** or **seriously limited** in addressing the specific task directions and in presenting or developing a position on the issue.
2. It provides **few**, if any, relevant reasons or examples in support of its claims.
3. It is **unfocused** and/or **disorganized**.
4. It has serious problems in language and sentence structure that **frequently interfere with meaning**.
5. It contains serious errors in grammar, usage, or mechanics that **frequently obscure meaning**.

**中文翻译**

2 分文章**对具体性指令基本没有任何照应**，并且 / 或者在分析性写作方面存在重大问题。

典型的 2 分文章具有以下的**一个或者多个**特征：

1. 文章对具体性指令的照应，以及在传达和发展立场时显得**模糊不清**或**严重不足**。
2. 文章中**几乎没有任何**相关的推理或例证以证明其观点。
3. 全文**无焦点**并且/或者**无组织**。
4. 文章在语言和句式上存在重大问题，**严重影响意思传达**。
5. 文章存在语法、用法和技法方面的**重大错误**，使**表意严重不清**。

**解　析**

2 分文章在诸多维度上呈现出比 3 分文章更加不足的能力。2 分文章的基本特征是：没有照应具体性指令来写，并且观点肤浅，论证无力，有大量语言错误。

**【Score 1】**

A 1 paper demonstrates **fundamental deficiencies** in analytical writing.

A typical paper in this category exhibits **ONE OR MORE** of the following characteristics:

1. It provides **little or no evidence of understanding** the issue.
2. It provides **little or no evidence of the ability to develop an organized response.**
3. It has severe problems in language and sentence structure that **persistently interfere with meaning.**
4. It contains **pervasive errors** in grammar, usage, or mechanics that **result in incoherence.**

**中文翻译**

1 分文章在分析性写作方面存在**根本性不足**。

典型的 1 分文章具有以下的**一个或者多个**特征：

1. 文章**几乎没有理解**原 Issue 题目。
2. 文章中**几乎没有表现出任何组织语言的能力**。
3. 文章在语言和句式上存在重大问题，**持续影响意思传达**。
4. 文章存在**大量**语法、用法和技法方面的**错误，严重影响文章连贯性**。

**解　析**

诙谐一点说，1 分的文章同 6 分的文章一样难以企及。可以说只要具备了正常的写作能力的同学（通过了国内大学的四、六级英语考试），都不会得 1 分。

**【Score 0】**

A 0 paper is off topic (i.e., provides no evidence of an attempt to respond to the assigned topic), written in a foreign language, merely copies the topic, consists of only keystroke characters, or is illegible or nonverbal.

**中文翻译**

0 分文章完全偏离题目（或没有表现出任何答题意愿）；用非英语写作；单纯照抄题目；文章为胡乱敲击键盘所得；文章不可读或非语言。

**解　析**

考生之所以得 0 分，并非其语言水平不足，而是态度不端。0 分文章的特征是：不写或乱写。

## 第二节　Argument 评分标准分析

**Argument 部分的评分标准主要围绕以下三点：**

1. **是否按照 Direction 来写**
2. **文章组织是否有逻辑**
3. **语言如何**

和 Issue 相比，Argument 部分也同样注重对 Direction 的照应。同时，Argument 还要求考生文章组织具有逻辑性，这就需要注意到**题目本身的**推理过程和行文逻辑，并在文章中对其加以照应。

下面是具体分数标准的解析：

**【Score 6】**

**In addressing the specific task directions**, a 6 response presents a **cogent, well-articulated** examination of the argument and **conveys meaning skillfully**.

A typical response in this category exhibits the following characteristics:

1. It **clearly identifies aspects** of the argument **relevant to the assigned task** and examines them **insightfully**.
2. It **develops ideas cogently**, **organizes them logically**, and connects them with **clear transitions**.
3. It provides **compelling and thorough support** for its main points.
4. It conveys ideas fluently and precisely, using **effective vocabulary** and **sentence variety**.
5. It demonstrates facility with the conventions of **standard written English** (i.e., grammar, usage, and mechanics) but may have **minor errors**.

**中文翻译**

**在照应具体性指令的基础上，**6 分的文章对原 Argument 题目进行了**具有说服力的、清楚的**分析，且**运用（多种）技巧传词达意。**

典型的 6 分文章具有如下特征：

1. **根据题目要求，清楚地识别出了**原 Argument 题目的**各方面**，并对其进行了**具有洞察力**的分析。
2. **对观点的发展清晰有力，对观点的组织富有逻辑，**并且用**清晰的逻辑连接词**连接各观点。
3. 各主要观点都有**透彻而有力的支撑**。
4. 运用**有效的词汇**和**多样的句式**，流畅、准确地传达观点意思。
5. 熟练掌握**标准书面英语**的写作习惯（语法、用法、技法等），但仍存在一些**细小错误**。

**解　析**

和 Issue 部分一样，Argument 部分的 6 分评分标准也应该是我们详细研读并且力争达到的。有一句英文谚语说：“Jump for the Sun, at least you land on the Moon.”，大家不妨用这句话激励自己，向 6 分发起冲击。

下面我们来看一下对评分标准中关键概念的解析：

specific task direction: **照应具体性指令是得 6 分的最基本的要求，这也是 5 分和 4 分标准的要求。且与 Issue 相比，Argument 中 Direction 对大家行文的影响更大。对 Direction 的具体照应方法详见第五章。**

convey meaning skillfully: 与 Issue 相比，Argument 并不要求我们的论证方法丰富多变，**而是要求我们给出紧贴 Direction 的论证。**

clearly identify aspects of the argument: 清楚地识别原 Argument 的各方面。这里的 aspect（方面）指的是原 Argument 的推理过程当中的一些重要元素，如**结论（conclusion）、支持结论的事实（fact）或证据（evidence，证据本身也是事实的一种）、对事实的解释（explanation）**以及**作者的推理过程所依赖的假设（assumption）**。

relevant to the assigned task: 这一点和上面一点一脉相承，也至关重要。这两点告诉我们：不仅要识别出原 Argument 当中的各方面（aspect），还应该识别出和这道题（the assigned task）相关的方面。

一道题目是由题干和 Direction 组成的，也就是说，**我们还要识别出那些和 Direction 相关的方面。**结合第五章的 Direction 的讲解大家就会明白，如果原 Direction 是让我们从证据（evidence）角度切入，那我们就应该重点识别出原 Argument 的证据；而如果 Direction 要求我们着重讨论原 Argument 的假设（assumption），那我们的文章就不应该再围绕证据，而应该围绕假设来展开。**因此，识别出原 Argument 的各要素只是第一步，之后我们还应该根据 Direction 的侧重来筛选这些要素，只留下和 Direction 相关的要素，并对其进行审视和讨论。**

（examine them）insightfully: 在完成了以上两步，即从原 Argument 中挑选出符合 Direction 的元素之后，就需要进行对其进行审视和讨论（examine）了。这种审视和讨论要做到 insightful：**不仅要求正确认识这些元素本身，还需要认识到这些元素之间的关系**。这就需要结合逻辑图对原 Argument 进行分析。对逻辑图的使用大家可以参照第五章。

develop ideas cogently, organize them logically: 清晰有力地发展观点，有逻辑地组织观点。大多数考生对待 Argument 的策略是，找到一个逻辑漏洞之后，用一段话去写这个错误；找到下一个逻辑漏洞之后，另开一个新的段落。如果整个文章中有五个漏洞，而考生的时间又不够，这时考生可能就会选择其中的三个进行分析。这样的文章最后得分普遍不高。而考生对此的反省可能是：如果我能把五个漏洞分析完全，可能分数就上去了。然而事实并非如此。**究其原因，是因为大家还是在寻找 Argument 中零碎的逻辑漏洞，而没有把它看作一个完整的推理过程。大家所找出来的错误都是各自孤立的，彼此之间没有任何呼应，更没有形成一个封闭的体系**。对此，我们提倡的应对方法是，**画出逻辑推理图**。大家可以随意参见后面的任何一篇 Argument 范文，在文章之后都附有一个逻辑推理图。而文章就是在这个逻辑推理图的基础之上构建起来的。这样才能让文章的发展脉络完全对应原 Argument 的脉络。这样的分析才是有力（cogent）、富有逻辑（logical）的分析。

clear transitions: Argument 的写作对逻辑连接是异常重视的。**保证句内句间的逻辑本身没有问题之后，大家可以尽量使用正确的逻辑连接词来展现逻辑关系**。下面总结了常见的逻辑连接表达。

因果关系：therefore; thereby; hence; thus; accordingly; consequently

**注意：以上的词都是副词（词组），因此都不能连接两个完整的句子。**

并列关系：moreover; in addition; furthermore; likewise; similarly; also; besides; namely; firstly; secondly; thirdly

**注意：以上的词都是副词，因此都不能连接两个完整的句子。**

转折关系：but; yet; however; nevertheless; nonetheless; conversely

**注意：but 和 yet 表示转折时可以作连词，可以连接两个完整的句子；而 however 作连词时表示的是“不论……”的意思，如“However hard it is, I will try.”，但它在表示转折的“然而”时，是副词，不能连接两个完整的句子；其余的词都是副词，都不能连接两个完整的句子。**

compelling and thorough support: 所谓透彻而有力的支持，无非包括事理支持和事例支持，但不论是哪一种支持，**都要紧密贴合 Direction 的要求**。因此，请详细解读第五章对 Direction 的讲解即可。

effective vocabulary: 这一点和 Issue 部分的讲解相同。

sentence variety: 这一点和 Issue 部分的讲解相同。

standard written English: 这一点和 Issue 部分的讲解相同。

minor errors: 这一点和 Issue 部分的讲解相同。

【Score 5】

In addressing the **specific task directions**, a 5 response presents a **generally thoughtful, well-developed** examination of the argument and **conveys meaning clearly**.

A typical response in this category exhibits the following characteristics:

1. It **clearly identifies aspects** of the argument **relevant to the assigned task** and examines them in a **generally perceptive** way.
2. It **develops ideas clearly**, **organizes them logically**, and connects them with **appropriate transitions**.
3. It offers **generally thoughtful and thorough support** for its main points.
4. It conveys ideas clearly and well, using **appropriate vocabulary** and **sentence variety**.
5. It demonstrates facility with the conventions of **standard written English** but may have **minor errors**.

**中文翻译**

**在照应具体性指令的基础上，**5 分的文章对原 Argument 题目进行了**比较缜密的、发展充分的**分析，且**清楚地传词达意**。

典型的 5 分文章具有如下特征：

1. **根据题目要求，清楚地识别出了**原 Argument 题目的**各方面**，并对其进行了**比较具有洞察力**的分析。
2. **对观点的发展清晰，对观点的组织富有逻辑**，并且用**合适的逻辑连接词**连接各观点。
3. 各主要观点都有**比较缜密而透彻的支撑**。
4. 运用**合适的词汇**和**多样的句式**，清楚地传达观点意思。
5. 熟练掌握**标准书面英语**的写作习惯，但仍存在一些**细小错误**。

**解　析**

和 Issue 部分一样，Argument 的 5 分评分标准也是 6 分的弱化版。大家可以直接以 6 分为奋斗目标。但要注意，**5 分的评分标准仍然要求我们紧密贴合 Direction 的要求来写。**

【Score 4】

In addressing the **specific task directions**, a 4 response presents a **competent** examination of the argument and **conveys meaning with acceptable clarity**.

A typical response in this category exhibits the following characteristics:

1. It **identifies and examines aspects** of the argument **relevant to the assigned task** but may also discuss some **extraneous points**.
2. It **develops and organizes ideas satisfactorily** but **may not connect them with transitions**.
3. It **supports its main points adequately** but may be **uneven in its support**.
4. It demonstrates sufficient control of language to convey ideas with **reasonable clarity**.
5. It **generally** demonstrates control of the conventions of **standard written English** but may have **some errors**.

**中文翻译**

**在照应具体性指令的基础上**，4 分的文章对原 Argument 题目进行了**足够的**分析，且**比较清楚地传词达意**。

典型的 4 分文章具有如下特征：

1. **根据题目要求，识别并分析了**原 Argument 题目的**各方面**，但同时可能有一些**无关的讨论**。
2. **对观点的发展和组织比较好**，但**没有用逻辑连接词**衔接各观点。
3. 主要观点有**一定的支撑，但部分地方尚显不足**。
4. 文章体现出作者对英语的足够的把控能力，**能够比较清楚地**传达观点意思。
5. **基本**掌握**标准书面英语**的写作习惯，但仍存在一些**错误**。

**解　析**

4 分的评分标准实则是 5 分的弱化版，但其中有两点需要引起我们的注意：

1. 4 分文章的一个典型特征是：对具体性指令有一定照应，**但同时文章的部分内容已经偏离了要求**。如 Direction 要求从 evidence 的角度切入，但考生的文章却有一部分是在探讨 assumption。
2. 为了避免得 4 分，**大家一定要加强逻辑连接词的使用**。

**【Score 3】**

A 3 response demonstrates **some competence in addressing the specific task directions**, in examining the argument, and in conveying meaning but is **obviously flawed**.

A typical response in this category exhibits **ONE OR MORE** of the following characteristics:

1. It **does not identify or examine most of the aspects** of the argument **relevant to the assigned task**, although **some relevant examination of the argument is present**.
2. It mainly discusses **tangential or irrelevant matters**, or **reasons poorly**.
3. It is **limited** in the logical development and organization of ideas.

4. It offers **support of little relevance and value** for its main points.
5. It has problems in language and sentence structure that result in **a lack of clarity**.
6. It contains **occasional major errors** or **frequent minor errors** in grammar, usage, or mechanics that can **interfere with meaning**.

**中文翻译**

3 分文章**对具体性指令有一定的照应**，对原 Issue 题目也有一定的分析，并且能够在一定程度上传词达意，但是文章**存在明显的缺陷**。

典型的 3 分文章具有以下的**一个或者多个**特征：

1. 虽然对原 Argument 题目有**一些相关的分析**，但**并未根据题目要求识别并分析**原 Argument 题目的**绝大多数方面**。
2. 文章主要在讨论**和题目不相关的话题**，或是**推理不足**。
3. 观点的发展和组织**不够有逻辑**。
4. 主要观点**缺少相关的或有价值的支撑**。
5. 文章在语言和句式上存在问题，以致**语意不明**。
6. 文章存在语法、用法和技法方面的**一些重大错误**或**大量细小错误**，以致**表意不明**。

**解　析**

虽然 Argument 文章得 3 分的原因通常有很多，但很大程度上可以归结为没有照应 Direction 的写作要求，具体体现如下：

1. 没有识别出原 Argument 当中的诸要素，如 evidence、conclusion、explanation、assumption 等。
2. 虽然识别出了原 Argument 当中的诸要素，但没有根据 Direction 的要求对其进行筛选。
3. 完全没有按 Direction 的要求，而是按照老 GRE 的思路展开文章。即找出逻辑错误（“臆造因果”“错误类比”“问题数据”等），批判逻辑错误。

因此，为了避免得 3 分，考生虽然要在语言、文章的组织上下功夫，**但最关键的一点还是不能偏离 Direction 的要求**。

**【Score 2】**

A 2 response **largely disregards the specific task directions** and/or demonstrates serious weaknesses in analytical writing.

A typical response in this category exhibits **ONE OR MORE** of the following characteristics:

1. It does not present an examination based on logical analysis but may instead **present the writer's own views** on the subject.
2. It **does not follow the directions** for the assigned task.

3. It **does not develop ideas**, or **is poorly organized** and **illogical**.
4. It provides **little**, if any, relevant or reasonable **support** for its main points.
5. It has serious problems in language and sentence structure that **frequently interfere with meaning**.
6. It contains serious errors in grammar, usage, or mechanics that **frequently obscure meaning**.

**中文翻译**

2 分文章**对具体性指令基本没有任何照应**，并且 / 或者在分析性写作方面存在重大问题。

典型的 2 分文章具有以下的**一个或者多个**特征：

1. 文章缺少逻辑性分析，而是在**陈述作者自身对于这个话题的看法**。
2. **没有照应具体性指令的要求**。
3. **对观点没有任何发展**，或是**组织混乱**。
4. 主要观点（几乎）**没有**任何相关的或合理的**支撑**。
5. 文章在语言和句式上存在重大问题，**严重影响意思传达**。
6. 文章存在语法、用法和技法方面的**重大错误**，使**表意严重不清**。

**解　析**

对 Argument 本质没有了解的考生最容易犯 2 分禁忌中的一个错误，**即没有分析原 Argument 的论证过程，而是对 Argument 中的话题发表自己的看法**。如原 Argument 的论点是某大学要采用网络授课的形式，作者为了支持这一论点进行了一系列论证。而有的考生可能并没有分析这些论证是否合理或完善，而是发表自己对网络授课的诸多见解，如“网络授课能促进教育资源共享”“网络授课能节约资源”等。这样的写法是 Issue 的写法，而不满足 Argument 的要求，请一定切记勿犯此类错误。

**【Score 1】**

A 1 response demonstrates **fundamental deficiencies** in analytical writing.

A typical response in this category exhibits **ONE OR MORE** of the following characteristics:

1. It provides **little or no evidence of understanding** the argument.
2. It is **extremely brief and/or disorganized**, providing little evidence of an organized response.
3. It has severe problems in language and sentence structure that **persistently interfere with meaning**.
4. It contains **pervasive errors** in grammar, usage, or mechanics that **result in incoherence**.

**中文翻译**

1 分文章在分析性写作方面存在**根本性不足**。

典型的 1 分文章具有以下的**一个或者多个**特征：

1. 文章**几乎没有理解**原 Argument 题目。
2. 文章中几乎没有表现出任何组织语言的能力，文章**非常简短并且/或者无组织结构**。
3. 文章在语言和句式上存在重大问题，**持续影响意思传达**。
4. 文章存在**大量**语法、用法和技法方面的**错误，严重影响文章连贯性**。

**解　　析**

这里的讲解同 Issue 部分。

**【Score 0】**

A 0 paper is off topic, written in a foreign language, merely copies the topic, consists of only keystroke characters, is illegible, or is nonverbal.

**中文翻译**

0 分文章完全偏离题目；用非英语写作；单纯照抄题目；文章为胡乱敲击键盘所得；文章不可读或非语言。

**解　　析**

这里的讲解同 Issue 部分。

# 第五章 具体性指令与范文精讲

- **GRE 作文改革之后加入了 14 种具体性指令。**
- **每种具体性指令都有特殊的照应方法。**
- **不按具体性指令写最多只有 3 分。**
- **具体性指令会影响整篇文章的布局和行文。**

**以上所有要点，都将在本章中一一呈现。**

老 GRE 写作样题：

题干：

A nation should require all its students to study the same national curriculum until they enter college rather than allow schools in different parts of the nation to determine which academic courses to offer.

新 GRE 写作样题：

题干：

A nation should require all of its students to study the same national curriculum until they enter college.

具体性指令：

**Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim. In developing and supporting your position, be sure to address the most compelling reasons and/or examples that could be used to challenge your position.**

对比可见，新 GRE 中加入了具体性指令。

**但广大考生往往忽略了具体性指令的要求，这导致最终分数不超过 3 分。**

但很多同学仍然对此没有察觉，即使有所察觉也可能苦于找不到应对之策，因此这一章我们会用详尽的篇幅来精讲这些具体性指令。

自 2011 年 8 月 GRE 考试进行改革之后，作文部分中的一个显著变化是 Direction（具体性指令，即题目下方的几行对写作要求的说明性文字）的加入。Issue 部分加入了 6 种 Direction，Argument 部分加入了 8 种 Direction。

Direction 可以翻译为“具体性指令”或“写作指导”。随着 Direction 的加入，评分标准也相应改变。在前一章中我们已经提到，**如果对 Direction 照应得不够，文章的最终得分不会超过 3 分**。因此，虽然 ETS 在 GRE 写作部分中加入 Direction 的本意是帮助考生在学术写作方面拓展思路，指导考生从比较具体的角度破题，但现实情况是考生因为对 Direction 没有引起足够的重视或者完全忽视其存在，导致最后的得分不尽如人意。因此，在这一章中，我们会详细解析每一种 Direction，并且在讲解之后附上范文，让考生对其有更深入的理解。

## 第一节　Issue 具体性指令与范文精讲

### 1 “是非判断类” Direction

Write a response in which you discuss **the extent** to which you agree or disagree with the statement and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider ways in which the statement **might or might not hold true** and explain how these considerations shape your position.

**中文翻译**

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中讨论你在**多大程度上**同意或者不同意题目中的陈述，解释你所采取的立场的理由。在发展和支持你的立场的过程中，你应该考虑这个陈述**成立或者不成立**的情况，并且解释这些情况如何影响你的立场。

**讲　解**

这类 Direction 所对应题目的语气通常是“做判断”或者“下定义”，是在讨论某一件事情的“是”与“非”，而 Direction 则是要求我们表明：我们在多大程度上同意这种“判断”或者“定义”，并且说明我们什么时候同意、什么时候反对。**这种 Direction 对我们在行文的内容和立场上并没有本质上的影响，我们可以把它视为“最安全”的一种 Direction**。

另外，从 extent 这个词可以看出，我们可以 100% 同意题目观点，也可以 50% 同意题目观点。亦即 **ETS 对我们所采取的立场并不看重。这一点适用于 Issue 部分的所有 Direction**。

**讲解浓缩版**

**“最安全”的 Direction，对我们写作并无特别要求。**

### 学术写作拓展

在学术写作里，对某一问题的“是非曲直”做出自己的判断，并且用比较规范的书面语言表达出自己的立场是最基本的要求。这种 Direction 就是对应这样一种要求。

例如，大家以后将要写到的每一篇论文其实都是在讨论一个问题的是非曲直，如《日本前卫书法家与传统的决裂比中国书法家更明显》《储氢材料的开发会推动电动汽车的发展》。对这样一些命题采取何种态度，理由是什么，如何阐述，大家可以通过这一种 Direction 略作感受。

### 例题举证

As we acquire more knowledge, things do not become more comprehensible, but more complex and mysterious.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the statement and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider ways in which the statement might or might not hold true and explain how these considerations shape your position.

比如这道题，我们可以列出如下的提纲：

**总立场：**有保留地反对题目。

**分论点 1**（同意题目）：宇宙万物往往比我们想象得要更为复杂。我们也的确遇到了很多靠现在的知识无法解决的问题。

**分论点 2**（反对题目）：以前被我们认为很简单的事物现在变得更加复杂，这刚好证明了我们在认识事物的道路上又前进了一步。所以不是事物变复杂，而是我们的认知在完善。

**分论点 3**（反对题目）：就理论上来讲，我们终将穷尽宇宙的奥秘。而题目的观点极易让我们陷入不可知论的泥沼之中。

如提纲所示，我们表达了我们在多大程度上同意或反对题目的观点（有保留地反对），并且以三个分论段分别说明了我们同意或者反对的具体情况。所以这个提纲是符合 Direction 要求的。

## 题库范文

（注：范文题目前的序号与第二章“GRE 写作题库分类”中的序号一一对应。ETS 官网给出的题目本无序号，为了方便读者查阅题目，所以本书为题目标明了序号。）

**9** Laws should be flexible enough to take account of various circumstances, times, and places.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the statement and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider ways in which the statement might or might not hold true and explain how these considerations shape your position.

Laws dictate what we can and cannot do and play a key role in maintaining the order of our modern society. Some people suggest that laws be flexible enough to take account of various circumstances, times, and places. While this proposal seems to be reasonable and it can lead to certain benefits to individuals, I cannot fully agree with this recommendation for two reasons. First, laws should be fair and just to all, and the flexibility of laws creates opportunities for someone who break the laws to evade the punishment. Second, from a practical point of view, it is very time-consuming and resource-exhausting for the legal system to determine each case and apply the flexible laws.

To begin with, I agree to certain extent that if laws can be flexible enough to take different situations into account, on an individual level this is a commendable policy. The reason is that if laws are too rigid, individuals' reasonable action may be punished hastily and unjustifiably. To understand why this is the case, we need to keep in mind that society today, as well as one's action, is very complex. Hence, when one's action is seemingly against the law there might be justifiable reasons behind it. For instance, blood for blood and an eye for an eye have been some of the simplest rules governing our social behavior. Thus, murder is considered one of the most serious crimes and in many countries is punishable by death sentence. However, if a law simply stipulates that those who kill another person shall be executed, then it fails to take killing during self-defense into account. To be more specific, the laws here do not consider the motivation behind the action of killing. When one's own life is threatened by the aggressor, his or her defensive action leading to the death of the aggressor should not be considered as a crime. In this scenario, the specificity of the action of killing should be taken into account. Indeed, in modern laws, self-defense is a valid reason for justifying killing another person.

However, if a law becomes too flexible there will be two serious issues that are detrimental to the society as a whole. The first problem is that an over-flexible law could create loopholes for those who really commit a crime to escape the punishment they deserve. This is because that one's action, no matter how unlawful it may be, could always find certain excuses to shift the blame. If the case of justifiable killing mentioned above is a scenario where one is tested false positive for committing a crime, the issue being discussed here concerns false negativity. That is, one should be punished by laws but with the laws being too flexible, their action remains unchallenged in court. For example, speeding should certainly be considered as an offense against traffic laws, but if such laws contain several

extenuating clauses that can absolve speeder from getting punished, then the foreseeable outcome is that anyone speeding will try to justify their unlawful action by citing those clauses as their reason for speeding. The ultimate consequence would be that the traffic laws will be very hard to implement.

Of course, some may argue against my reasoning above, citing for example that the speeders will eventually be punished because our legal system is capable of effectively evaluating the case of speeding, just like the fact that trials pertaining to murder and manslaughter are always heavily scrutinized. This counter-argument is certainly built upon some valid grounds, but it is somewhat over-simplistic and too idealistic. In other words, we may not have the resources to explore each and every case. In reality, it takes time and efforts for the legal system to get to the bottom of most cases; moreover, the truth of some cases is actually not known despite efforts to shed light on them. As a result, from a practical point of view our legal system would be challenged with tremendous amount of burden if we were required to evaluate all cases and then apply corresponding laws to them. Admittedly, for some serious cases such as murder, our legal system should indeed be extra cautious, but for a speeding case we should not over-spend the resources of our legal system on them. This is perhaps the reason why in reality speeding is often met with a ticket without much room for considerations.

To summarize, it should be acknowledged that in some cases laws should be flexible enough to fully investigate the nature of the crime before reaching a monumental decision, especially severe punishments. However, if all laws become flexile, there will be loopholes that people will take advantage of and commit a crime. What's more, despite the theoretical possibility that our legal system could commit a vast amount of time and manpower to prevent those fraudsters, in reality doing so would require tremendous resources and is not socially economical. Given these considerations, I largely stand against the proposal that laws should be flexible enough. (833 words)

**中文翻译**

法律规定了什么能做什么不能做，并且在维持现代社会秩序上起到了关键作用。有些人建议法律应该有足够的灵活性，应该考虑到各种情况、时间和地点。这个提议看似合理，对于个人也有一定益处，但我不能完全同意这个建议，理由有二：第一，法律应该做到对所有人都公平公正，法律上的灵活性会给某些违法者逃避惩罚的机会；第二，从现实的角度看，司法系统要去判定每一个案件并且灵活应用法律，会耗费相当多的时间和资源。

首先，我在一定程度上同意，如果法律能够灵活地考虑到不同的情况，在个人层面上，这是一项值得赞扬的政策。原因是，如果法律过于严格，个人的合理行为可能会受到仓促和不公正的惩罚。要理解为什么会出现这种情况，我们需要记住，当今社会以及个人行为都是非常复杂的。因此，当一个人的行为看似违法时，背后可能有正当的理由。例如，血债血偿和以眼还眼一直是管理我们社会行为的最简单的规则。因此，谋杀被认为是最严重的犯罪之一，在许多国家可判处死刑。但是，法律只规定杀害他人的人应当被执行死刑，然而却不考虑正当防卫中

的杀人。更具体地说，法律没有考虑杀人行为背后的动机。当一个人的生命受到侵略者的威胁时，他（她）的防卫行为导致侵略者的死亡不应视为犯罪。在这种情况下，应考虑到杀人行为的具体原因。的确，在现代法律中，自我防卫是一个证明杀害他人是正当行为的确凿理由。

然而，如果一项法律变得过于灵活，就会产生两个对整个社会有害的严重问题。第一个问题是，过于灵活的法律可能会给那些真正犯罪的人制造漏洞，以逃避他们应得的惩罚。这是因为，一个人的行为，无论多么不合法，总能找到一些借口推卸责任。如果上面提到的正当杀人案件是一个人被证明假犯罪的情况，这里讨论的问题涉及假无罪的情况。也就是说，一个人应该受到法律的惩罚，但是由于法律过于灵活，他们的行为在法庭上仍然没有受到质疑。例如，超速当然应该被视为违犯交通法，但如果这些法律包含一些可以让超速者减轻受罚的条款，那么可以预见的结果是，任何超速的人都会试图通过引用这些条款作为超速的理由来为自己的非法行为辩护。最终的结果是交通法规将很难实施。

当然，有些人可能会对上文我的讨论有争议，他们会引用超速者最终会受到惩罚的例子，因为我们的司法系统能够有效地评估超速驾驶的案件，就像是有关谋杀和过失杀人的案子都会被严格审查一样。这种反驳当然有一些合理的基础，但它有些过于简单化和理想化。换句话说，我们可能没有足够的资源去仔细审查每一个案例。在现实中，对于大多数案件来说，司法系统要弄清事实真相需要时间和付出精力，而且尽管人们努力调查，但一些案件的真相仍然无法被人知晓。因此，从实践的角度看，如果要求我们对所有案件进行评估，然后适用相应的法律，我们的法律制度将面临巨大的负担。诚然，对于一些严重的案件，例如谋杀案，我们的法律制度确实应该格外谨慎，但是对于一个超速的案件，我们不应该在这些案件上过多花费我们的法律资源。这也许就是为什么在现实中超速常常会被罚款而没有太多考虑的原因。

总而言之，应当承认，在某些情况下，法律应当具有足够的灵活性，特别是严惩之前，充分调查犯罪的性质，以便做出重大决定。然而，如果所有的法律都变得灵活，人们就会钻空子去犯罪。更重要的是，尽管理论上我们的法律体系有可能投入大量的时间和人力来防止这些钻空子的人，但实际上这样做需要大量的资源，而且从社会层面上讲这样做不经济。考虑到这些情况，我基本上反对法律应该足够灵活的建议。

**文章解析与点评**

本题围绕“法律是否应该灵活”而展开，是一个非常抽象的题目，也因此是一道很经典的 Issue 难题。在题干中，我们并不清楚讨论的具体是哪些法律，题目也没有就情况、时间、地点给出具体的限定，因此我们在写作当中一定要将文章所描述的内容具象化。为此，这篇范文举了两组生活当中的法律例子，其一是杀人偿命，其二是超速罚款。

回到文章的立论，对于法律类的 Issue 题（以及更为广泛的社会类议题），一个比较好的出发点是从个人和集体来谈，也即一个议题对于个人而言也许是好的 / 坏的，但对于整个社会而言却是坏的 / 好的。但是，我们考虑到要以社会整体为重，所以主立场还是取决于该议题在社会层面上的好坏。这一种分析方法在接下来的范文中还会碰到。对于本题来说，显然，如果法

律足够灵活，它就能最大程度地确保个人的利益——这也是本文第一主旨段的内容，因为社会问题是复杂的，一个案件也往往不是那么非黑即白，其背后有着复杂的动因。文中举了杀人偿命和正当防卫的例子，其实构想了这样一个场景：如果法律不足够灵活，那么一个正当防卫致人死亡的例子就会被误判为谋杀，这对于个体来说无疑是一个悲剧。

但是，文章立刻指出，在社会层面上这么做却是有害的，并且给出了两个原因。其一是过于灵活会让有罪之人开脱，其二是实际操作上法律系统不一定有资源将所有案件捋清。前面这一点可以看作是第一段的对立面，也即法律太严太死板会让好人被冤枉（对个体不利），但法律太松又会让有罪之人得不到惩戒（对社会不利）。接着，文章又从理论与实践的角度来阐明，所谓法律尽善尽美的灵活性可能只是理想主义者的一厢情愿，因为要调查一个案件需要司法系统投入可观的资源，而事实上我们的社会和司法系统没有这么多资源可以消耗。笔者就有过在美国开车超速，然后上法庭的经历。在正式开庭之前有一个预审，而在预审之前公诉人找到了笔者，说念你初犯，我们来做一个交易：一会儿我把你的超速降级成一个违规停车，你也就不要上诉，直接认罪，交钱走人——这就是所谓的 plea bargain，中文叫作“辩诉交易”。究其原因，乃是如果笔者决定上诉，那么就需要后续的公堂对峙，会消耗可观的司法资源。因此，权宜之下，公诉人采取了减轻刑罚以快速解决的方案。

由此可见，这一篇文章不仅采取了个人与集体的拆解方法，还使用了理论与实践这一方法。两种思路的嵌套反映出问题的复杂性，从而提升了文章的思考深度，进而能拿到高分。另外，理论与实践是政策建议类文章的一种非常有效的破题方式，我们在后续的文章中会经常见到。

146 In any field of endeavor, it is impossible to make a significant contribution without first being strongly influenced by past achievements within that field.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the statement and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider ways in which the statement might or might not hold true and explain how these considerations shape your position.

Is it possible to make a significant contribution in any field of study without ever being strongly influenced by the achievements made by one's predecessors first? Some may argue that the influence from past achievements is not a strict prerequisite for any new advancement in a specific field. However, I beg to differ, with the only exception of being in an entirely new field of study where there are no such past achievements to begin with. In all other fields, it is almost inevitable that significant contributions are shaped by the influence of the past achievements within those fields including, quite counter-intuitively, creative fields such as painting and music.

To begin with, it should be acknowledged that in those emerging fields where any new discovery

can be regarded as breakthroughs, one does not need to be influenced by past achievements to make significant contributions. The logical justification of this argument is self-evident: if a field is completely new, there is few established achievements to begin with. One of such fields for example is machine learning and artificial intelligence, a rapidly developing field in which new exciting discoveries are being made each day. In this particular field, which is still in its infancy, past achievements are so few that researchers are almost stepping into uncharted territories. In such very specific scenarios, therefore, significant contributions do not necessarily rely upon past achievements, which are absent by nature.

Nevertheless, in other fields where human beings have accumulated a considerable amount of knowledge, substantial progresses cannot be made without the influence of past achievements. Here, my point of view applies to both natural and social sciences. First, for natural science and engineering, breakthroughs and innovations are built upon our cumulative knowledge. Step by step, researchers test new, bold hypotheses by adopting existing methodologies, which are the fruition of past achievements. On the other hand, it is hardly conceivable nowadays that a scientist would be able to make astonishingly new findings without any training in that field. Similarly, in social science past achievements still deeply influence how scholars think. For example, John Nash, who came up with the original idea of governing dynamics that later became game theory, was first under the influence of classic economic theory by Adam Smith. It is through critically evaluating the past achievements that John Nash refined the theories of human behaviors and laid the foundation of behavior economics.

Of course, some people would argue that my previous reasoning only applies to the field of science, with the realization that progresses must be made in an incremental fashion. However, they challenge that in fields that appreciate and are driven by human creativity, especially arts, one can make great contributions without any past influence. One example, French Impressionism was hailed as "The New Painting" by critics in the late 19th century. Bold and expressive, impressionist painters created a new form of art that audaciously illustrated the natural scene through a lucid brush. Clearly, as a new painting, Impressionism leaped forward to open up a whole new realm of artistic style that is not influenced by previous painters.

Such a criticism may seemingly be reasonable at first glance, but nevertheless it overlooks the importance of past achievements and their influence on human creativity. Contrary to popular belief, creativity does not stem from a vacuum; instead, in order to come up with something original, one still needs to look back and understand what has been achieved by his or her predecessors. Let's take a closer look at the example of French Impressionism quoted above. While it is true that today we regard Impressionism as a new form of art, before its emergence many painters outside France have already innovated painting techniques and philosophies that eventually became the signature styles adopted by French Impressionists. In other words, Impressionism was indeed influenced by previous achievements, although people today would mostly only appreciate the eventuality of a movement materialized by Impressionist painter: the Impressionism itself.

To summarize, I concede that in certain occasions significant contributions can be made without past achievements, when such achievements are absent. However, in all other fields it is certainly not the case. Even in fields such as arts, contributions that are seemingly creative and original at first sight actually have a deeper connection to what has been achieved in the past. (720 words)

**中文翻译**

人有没有可能在任何研究领域做出重大贡献，而不首先受到前人成就的强烈影响？有些人可能会说，受到过去成就的影响并不是在某一特定领域取得任何新进展的严格先决条件。不过，我有不同的看法：除非是在一个全新的领域，人们没有可以借鉴的过往成就，这种情况才是唯一的例外。而在所有其他领域，一些重大贡献几乎不可避免地会受到这些领域过去成就的影响，其中包括绘画和音乐等创造性领域。

首先，我们应该承认，在那些任何新发现可以被视为重大突破的新兴领域，人们不需要受过去成就的影响就能做出重大贡献。这一论点的逻辑依据是不言而喻的：如果一个领域是全新的，那么从一开始就几乎没有过往的成就。这类领域之一是机器学习和人工智能，这是一个快速发展的领域，每天都有令人兴奋的新发现。在这一尚处于起步阶段的特殊领域，以往的研究成果寥寥无几，以至于研究人员几乎进入了未知区域。因此，在这种非常具体的情况下，自然没有人在过去取得过成就，所以重要的贡献不一定依赖于过去的成就。

然而，在人类积累了大量知识的其他领域，没有过去成就的影响，人们就无法取得实质性的进步。这里，我的观点既适用于自然科学也适用于社会科学。首先，对于自然科学和工程，突破和创新是建立在我们积累的知识基础上的。研究人员一步一步地采用现有的方法来检验新的、大胆的假设，这种方法是过去研究的成果。另一方面，现在很难想象一个科学家不经过领域内的任何训练就能够做出惊人的新发现。同样，在社会科学中，过去的成就仍然深刻地影响着学者们的思考方式。例如，约翰·纳什首先受到亚当·斯密古典经济理论的影响，提出了治理动力学的最初想法，后来这个想法成为博弈论。约翰·纳什通过批判地评估过去的成就，提炼了人类行为理论，奠定了行为经济学的基础。

当然，有些人会争辩说，我之前的推理只适用于科学领域，在这个领域里进步必须以渐进的方式进行。然而，他们质疑的是，在欣赏和受人类创造力驱动的领域，尤其是艺术，一个人可以在没有任何过去影响的情况下做出巨大贡献。例如，法国印象派在 19 世纪末被评论家誉为“新绘画”。印象派画家大胆而富有表现力，他们创造了一种新的艺术形式，通过易懂的画笔大胆地描绘了自然场景。显然，作为一种新的绘画形式，印象派跃进了一个不受以往画家艺术风格影响的全新领域。

这种批评乍一看似乎是合理的，但它忽视了过去成就的重要性及其对人类创造力的影响。跟普遍的观念不同，创造力并不是凭空得来的；相反，一个人如果要创造出新的东西，他 / 她依然要回顾和理解前人的成就。让我们仔细考虑上文提到的法国印象派的例子。虽然今天我们

确实把印象派视为一种新的艺术形式，但在它出现之前，法国以外的许多画家已经创新了绘画技巧和理念，最终它们成为了法国印象派画家采用的标志性风格。换言之，印象派确实受到了以往成就的影响，尽管今天的人们大多只会欣赏印象派画家所实现的一个运动的结果：印象派本身。

总而言之，我承认在某些情况下，人没有过去的成就作为基础，也可以做出重大贡献。然而，在所有其他领域，情况肯定不是这样。即使是在艺术等领域，看起来似乎具有创造性和独创性的贡献，实际上也与过去取得的成就有着深刻的联系。

### 文章解析与点评

本文讨论的问题是一个领域的新发展与过去成就之间的关系，与之类似的题目还包括“一个领域无法在不吸纳其他领域知识和经验的前提下取得显著进步”，其背后涉及的根本问题是：人类社会的知识进步究竟是如何实现的？

面对这个问题，本文提出了一个偏务实和保守的观点，即在任何一个颇有建树的领域里，新的发展必须受到过去成就的影响。这背后的哲学思想是“渐变论”与“突变论”（或“灾变论”）的争执。虽然这两种概念首先出现于地质学，但如今它们已经广泛深入到了人类社会不同的学科之中。探究其哲学根本，核心问题在于事物的变化究竟是连续的还是非连续的，显然本文采取了前一种“渐变论”的立场。与此同时，请格外注意“颇有建树”这一前提条件，它的对立面就如同本文第一主旨段（让步段）中提到的新生领域，因为这些领域的知识太新，以至于尚未出现重量级的以往成就，这在逻辑上是说得通的。

现在让我们回到那些已经比较成熟的领域。本文首先提出，不论是自然科学还是社会科学，新的成就都需要受到过去成就影响，究其根本是我们扩展知识边界的方法论，终究是要基于前人贡献的。在这里，本文重点举了约翰·纳什的博弈论作为例子，以突出在人文领域过去成就的重要性。

对于本文观点真正有挑战的点在于艺术等需要创造力的学科，因为乍看之下一般人会认为这些需要人天马行空的学科里，人们不需要受到过去的成就影响就可以做出成就。但本文认为这是一种流于表面的看法，一个敌方观点将其引出，并且在随后进行了深刻的辩驳。如果仔细观察并思考，我们会发现艺术领域中的新人仍然要认真学习以往的成就，就像当代作曲家会学习古典主义和浪漫主义大师的杰作、后现代派的画家仍然会受到前人作品的影响。值得一提的是，本文举出了印象派画家的例子，并指出看起来像是全新的画派其实也有前人的影响。这其实源自于一篇GRE的阅读题。在GRE和TOEFL的考试当中，有很多ETS用来考我们的素材可以被“拿来我用”，我们备考的过程其实也是一个累积知识的过程。

本文有着精巧但有序的论证结构，第一主旨段给出让步（抑），随后引出己方观点（扬），第三主旨段马上提出对于己方观点的反驳（敌方观点；抑），但随着第四主旨段对于敌方观点的驳斥进一步巩固己方观点（扬），全文读下来酣畅淋漓，大快人心。

148 People's behavior is largely determined by forces not of their own making.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the statement and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider ways in which the statement might or might not hold true and explain how these considerations shape your position.

Is people's behavior largely determined by external forces rather than their own making (i.e. personal preferences and interests)? While some people may emphasize the importance of "free will" and argue that our behavior is controlled by who we are, I would like to offer an opposite view. That is, people's behavior is indeed primarily the result of external forces over long timescale and via immediate effects.

To begin with, some would claim that human beings have free wills and can decide for themselves what or what not to do. Admittedly, nobody would be willing to subjugate oneself to the order of others. Instead, out of personal motives or a sense of conscience, people's behavior will deviate from what the environment or those external factors dictate. For example, soldiers on the East side of the Berlin Wall were instructed to shoot and kill anyone defecting to the West after the end of World War II. Despite such seemingly irresistible forces by the authority, not all soldiers obeyed but they opted to follow their own conscience. Rather, what they did was deliberately missing the target and allowing the defectors to enter West Germany. This example vividly illustrates how, as a conscious human being, people will act in accordance with their personal values and can resist external forces.

However, people's behavior may appear to stem from their personal choices not the external forces, this is an illusion. This is because our personality, personal values, moral standards and etc. are fundamentally all shaped by external factors over many decades, or even several generations. In the example of soldiers disobeying direct orders discussed above, the person's morality is claimed to be responsible for their behavior. Yet, it does not investigate where such a sense of conscience eventually comes from. From my point of view, morality is the product of the long-term evolution of human interactions with each other and the environment in society. For example, the reason why cannibalism is not accepted by the majority of the society is that it violates the fundamental aspects of our values that all men are created equal. Such a value, in turn, results from a century-long debate about human rights and equality, facilitated by the increase in productivity since the Industrial Revolution. As a result, external forces have played a critical role in shaping one's own making, though implicitly and gradually, and will continue to do so.

Furthermore, even in short timespan external forces have been proven capable of effectively changing people's behavior. Thanks to modern-day research in psychology, numerous experiments have been designed to examine what controls people's behavior. What those experiments essentially

do is measure the behavioral outcome after changing certain environmental factors. If people's behavior is indeed the main result of their free will, their action should largely the same regardless of changes in the environment in which they live. On the other hand, if external forces largely dictate people's action, this should be immediately observable in those experiment conditions. Based on the results of many psychological studies, it turns out that external forces do play a critical role. For instance, studies on police officers show that when they see a speeding car in bright color (such as red), they are more likely to pull the car over and issue a ticket than seeing a black car speeding, even though parallel studies find no personal preference in colors. Here, the color of the car is the sole determinant of the officer's behavior. Another example is about people's perception on climate change, done by Dr. Elke Weber at Columbia University. When two laymen were exposed to news about global warming, the one sitting in a hotter room tends to show greater level of belief and confidence in the news than the one sitting in a cold room. Again, their reflection on the perceived information hinges directly on the environment.

To summarize, the argument presented above demonstrates that people's behavior is determined by forces instead of their own making, both indirectly and directly. Importantly, while people's free wills may often be invoked to explain our behaviors, it is crucial to realize that such free wills are ultimately shaped by our environment. (694 words)

**中文翻译**

人们的行为是否很大程度上取决于外部力量而不是他们自己的意愿（即个人偏好和兴趣）？虽然有些人可能强调“自由意志”的重要性，并认为我们的行为是由我们自己来控制的，但我想提出一个相反的观点。也就是说，人们的行为确实主要是外部力量长期直接影响的结果。

首先，有些人会声称人类有自由意志去决定自己做什么或不做什么。诚然，没有人愿意屈从于别人的命令。相反，出于个人动机或良心，人们的行为会背离环境或那些外部因素的支配。例如，“二战”结束后柏林墙东侧的士兵受命射杀任何叛逃到西德的人。尽管当局似乎有如此不可抗拒的力量，但并不是所有的士兵都服从命令，而是选择了追随自己的良心。他们故意漏射目标，允许叛逃者进入西德。这个例子生动地说明，作为一个有意识的人将如何按照个人价值观行事，并且能够抵抗外部力量。

然而，认为人们的行为似乎源于个人选择而不是外力是一种错觉。这是因为我们的个性、个人价值观、道德标准等，基本上都是由外在因素历经几十年甚至几代人塑造的。在上文士兵不服从命令的例子中，人的良心是行为的标准。然而，这种观点并没有深入研究这种良心的最终来源。在我看来，道德是人类相互作用和社会环境长期演变的产物。例如，食人行为之所以不被社会大多数人接受，是因为它违背了我们人生来平等的基本价值观。这样的价值观，反过来又源于长达一个世纪的关于人权和平等的辩论，而工业革命以来生产力的提高促进了这种辩论。因此，外部力量在塑造一个人的成长过程中起到了至关重要的作用，尽管这种作用是潜移

默化的，并且会一直发挥效果。

此外，即使在很短的时间内，外部力量已经被证明能够有效地改变人们的行为。基于现代心理学的研究，人们设计了许多实验来验证是什么控制了人们的行为。这些实验的实质是测量人在某些环境因素被改变后的行为。如果人们的行为确实是他们自由意志的主要结果，那么不管他们生活的环境发生了什么变化，他们的行为应该大体相同。另一方面，如果外力在很大程度上决定了人们的行为，那么在这些实验条件下，这应该是可以立即被观察到的。根据许多心理学研究的结果，外部力量确实起着关键作用。例如，对警察的研究表明，当他们看到一辆颜色鲜艳的汽车（如红色）在超速行驶时，和他们看到黑色汽车的情况相比，他们更可能让红色汽车停下来并开出罚单，尽管平行研究没有发现个人对颜色的偏好。在这个例子中，汽车的颜色是决定警察行为的唯一因素。另一个研究是关于人们对气候变化的看法，该研究由哥伦比亚大学的埃尔克·韦伯博士完成。当两个外行接触到有关全球变暖的新闻时，坐在较热房间里的人往往比坐在较冷房间里的人更愿意相信新闻报道。同样，他们对信息的反应直接取决于环境。

总而言之，上述论证表明，无论外部的影响是直接还是间接的，人的行为都是由外部力量而不是他们自己决定的。重要的是，虽然人们常用自由意志来解释我们的行为，但至关重要的是认识到这种自由意志最终是由我们所处的环境塑造的。

### 文章解析与点评

人类的行为由何种因素决定？这在心理学研究上是一个课题，在哲学上也是一个引人深思的话题，应当说 ETS 将其一直保留在 Issue 题库中，体现了 GRE 考试思想上的思辨性。

这篇文章常见写法是，既承认外界因素的影响，也认可人类自我意志的作用，从而写出一篇“正—反—和”的文章。这样的文章虽然看起来言之有物，但其实没有去深刻挖掘两者之间的关系，只是浮于表面地描述“可以这样”。我们不禁会发问：为什么有的时候行为取决于外在因素？为什么有的时候人们又有所谓的自由意志呢？

而这篇范文则不同。我们把人类行为从两个尺度来进行研究：短期与长期，并由此指出人类的短期行为可以分别受到个人自我意志（第一主旨段）和外界因素（第三主旨段）的影响，但从长期尺度看来，人的内在品质是由外在因素塑造的。第二主旨段对于环境对人类价值观的塑造进行了深刻讨论，并由此推导出人的行为归根结底是由外界因素决定的。我们要学习这种时间尺度上的拆分，这比泛泛而谈“人的行为既受内在品质也受外界因素影响”要深刻和高明。

最后，本文的观点其实反映出的就是“人类到底有没有自由意志”这样一个哲学命题。对于这个问题本文显然做出了否定的回答，这听起来似乎有些伤感，但也只是一家之言，大家可以批判性地进行阅读。读者完全可以在考场之外就这个哲学问题进行更加深刻的思考，提升自己的思辨能力。这也是为什么笔者很喜欢这道题目的原因——因为正是这些引人深思的题目，让 GRE 不仅仅是一门语言考试，更是成为打磨我们思想的工具。

129 The best test of an argument is the argument's ability to convince someone with an opposing viewpoint.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the statement and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider ways in which the statement might or might not hold true and explain how these considerations shape your position.

To bestow an argument, idea, contention or assertion with value, we must attempt to persuade those who hold contrasting views. Once we manage to convince our opponents, our argument seemingly gains fresh significance. This inclination to persuade others with our ideas presumably derives from the action embodied in the verb "argue": to persuade people with relevant reasons that we are correct. While this might be one way to prove our argument's validity and value, we do not always need to resort to this method. Additionally, sometimes attempts to persuade might even prove futile.

To begin with, I must express my appreciation for the reason part of this issue. It is exactly at the moment when we are forced to defend an idea against doubts and contrasting views that we begin to form a comprehensive understanding of the idea's value. It is also at such a moment that we should grasp the opportunity to show our rivals the advantages of our argument and earn their approval. This perspective is emphasized by how a debate takes place. In a debate, speakers strive to elucidate the advantages or the disadvantages of an issue in order to convince their opponents, as well as the audience of their point of view. It is also during this phase that the audience comes to establish a holistic understanding of the topic and its value. In addition, even though the debaters may not be utterly convinced by their opponents, they ultimately benefit from questioning their opponents and defending their own views, and further build up an unprecedented understanding of their argument's value.

However, tenable as the assertion may hold in most circumstances that an idea receives value by overshadowing its opponents, I contend that the value of an argument can be also realized in other ways. Consequently, this raises doubt about the issue's reason. Since we do not argue exclusively to disprove our rivals, but also to clarify our own principles, or support allegations, we do not always have to start a battle in which one argument is bound to knock down another. Academic papers serve as a simple but persuasive example. It is not difficult to find out that not all the articles we read, write or cite attempt to disprove others, but in more circumstances concentrate on either clarification of the methodologies the paper itself utilizes, or on supplementary explanation to similar studies. One semester I read a series of articles written by archeologists, historians and anthropologists regarding ancient Chinese rituals. Despite their contrasting arguments, these scholars did not focus on discrediting each other's work. On the contrary, they

simply offer different interpretations of the same issue. The value of these papers is therefore achieved through their interpretations rather than through contention between the authors.

What is more, the writer's over-optimistic attitude is betrayed in the claim of the issue, which is supported by an unsubstantiated assumption: everyone can be convinced by an opposing viewpoint. This assumption further theorizes that an absolute truth exists, or to put it in another way: everything can be explained in only one way. Clearly, this is not true. The example previously discussed about three different interpretations of one issue support my opinion. Since academic research is based on different methodologies, scholars can never be truly convinced by each other; otherwise they would have used identical systems but not diverse ones. In addition, in some circumstances, the superficial debate between two arguments actually reveals an irreconcilable conflict, which concerns more fundamental factors, such as benefits. For exemplifications, we can look at strife between political parties all over the world. Due to the irreconcilable contention about respective interests, their quarrels never cease, and probably no one can foretell the day when they will actually convince each other.

To sum up, while I partly agree with the issue's reason, I reserve my approval of both the claim and its assumption. That is to say, the value of an argument may be realized through debate with someone holding a contrasting viewpoint, yet we cannot rely on that to always be true. (677 words)

**中文翻译**

为了赋予一个论点、观点、主张或声称以价值，我们必须试图去说服那些持相反观点的人。一旦我们成功地说服对方，我们的论点似乎就获得了更多的重要性。这种试图用我们的观点去说服对方的倾向，可能来自动词“辩论”所蕴含的动作：用相关的理由去让对方相信“我方正确”。虽然这可能是一条提升我们论证有效性和价值的路径，但我们不一定非要采用这样的方式。此外，“尽力说服对方的做法”有时被证明是一种无效的尝试。

首先，我对这道题目的 reason 部分表示赞同。每当我们被迫去辩护一个受到质疑或存在对立看法的观点时，其实已经就这个观点的价值形成更为全面的认识。也就是这个时候，我们会抓住机会向我们的对手展示己方论点的优势，并尝试获得他们的认同。这种思维在辩论中体现得最为明显。在一场辩论中，为了说服对手以及他们的支持者，发言者就一个问题努力阐明其优势与劣势。也正是在这个阶段，观众对这个话题和它的价值建立起更为完善的认识。另外，尽管辩论者并未完全被他们的对手说服，但他们也终将通过质问对手、辩护己方立场而获益，从而进一步深化他们对己方论点的价值的认知。

然而，通过征服对手来使观点获得价值，尽管这种说法在大多数情况中都具说服力，但我依然认为一个论点的增值还可以通过其他方式获得，这也就质疑了这道题目的 reason 部分。由于我们争论的目的并不只是推翻对手，同时还有阐释己方的原则，或者支持己方的论点等目的，所以我们就没有必要总是掀起一场“只有一方能够幸存”的论战。比如说，学术论文是一个简

单且富有说服力的例子。不难发现，并不是所有我们看到的、写的、引用的文章都是以推翻其他文章为目的；相反，在更多的情况下，这些文章专注于对论文本身采用的方法论的阐释，或者对相似研究进行的补充说明。记得有一个学期，我阅读了一系列由考古学家、历史学家和人类学家写作的有关古代中国仪式的文章。尽管这些文章的观点各不相同，但文章的作者并未执着于推翻彼此的观点。相反，他们只是就相同的问题提出不同的解释。因此，这些论文的价值来源于其各自的阐释，而非对彼此观点的推翻。

另外，这个题目的 claim 部分还暴露了作者过度乐观的态度，因为 claim 部分被一个未被证实的假设所支持：每个人都能被相反的观点说服。这个假设还进一步假定：绝对真理存在于世，或者说，所有事物都只能有唯一的解释。很明显，这并不正确。前文讨论过的对同一话题的三种不同解释的例子能够支持这一观点。由于学术研究基于不同的方法论，所以学者之间并不能完全说服彼此；除非他们采用相同的系统。另外，在一些情况下，两方之间一次肤浅的争论也可能揭示出无法调和的冲突，而这种冲突往往与更为基本的元素相关，比如利益。举例来说，我们可以关注世界各地的政党间的冲突。因为基于各自利益的不可调和的争论，它们之间的争吵永不停息，并且也无人能预测到他们能够说服彼此的那一天。

总的来说，尽管我部分同意题目的 reason 部分，但我对这个题目的 claim 和 assumption 仍持保留态度。也就是说，论点的价值可能通过说服对立观点来获得，但我们也需要意识到，这并不是唯一的途径。

### 文章解析与点评

这道题目本身的内容比较抽象，如果单纯考虑支持或者反对，很容易陷入无话可说的窘境。为了充实文章内容，我们要做的事情就是考虑敌方观点。例如本题我们可以试着思考，为什么说服别人有可能是测试一个观点的最好方法呢？大家最容易想到的或许是，当我们尝试用一个观点去说服对立观点时，确实能发现这个观点的价值。辩论赛作为一个常见的例子，很好地支持了这个观点。因为辩论赛的双方都是在尝试说服对方和观众的过程中发现自身观点的价值。因此我们在文章开头部分赞同了敌方观点。

然而，要认识并实现一个观点的价值，并不总需要试图用它驳倒对立的观点。从这个层面上讲，文章是要压制和反对敌方观点的。例如，我们经常遇到的学术论文就并不总以攻击或者说服观点相反的论文为写作目的，而更多的时候，我们写论文是为了阐明自己的理论或者方法论，或者深化、支持我们的同盟者的观点。在这里，文章列举了作者在学习中遇到的一篇关于中国古代宗教礼仪的文章。这个事例非常贴近生活，并不是所谓的“名人名例”，但依然能很好地支持文章的观点。

最后，我们对题目进行深挖，满足 ETS 对于题目分析 insightful 的要求。我们发现，题目所依赖的假设其实是有问题的：“所有对手都能够被说服”；或者说，“所有事情只能用一种方式来解释”。事实并非如此，在这里，文章又诉诸于之前所提到的宗教礼仪的文章，指出：很多

论文虽然讨论的话题是类似的，但使用的方法论却是不同的，因此这些论文的作者从一定层面上讲并不能完全说服其他人，亦或是被其他人说服。在这里，文章对相同的例子进行了不同侧面的解析，展示出批判性思维的辩证的特点，是一种高级的论证技巧，值得大家在冲击作文高分的过程中模仿。另外，有一些表面上的不同实则是掩盖着更加深层次的不可调和的矛盾，比如不同政党之间的无休止的斗争。像这样的诸多观点，是很难被彼此说服的。

**21** As we acquire more knowledge, things do not become more comprehensible, but more complex and mysterious.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the statement and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider ways in which the statement might or might not hold true and explain how these considerations shape your position.

We live in an era of knowledge explosion: hundreds and thousands of research articles are being published each day and we now have access to more knowledge than our predecessors could possibly imagine. How does the accumulation of knowledge shape our understanding of the world around us? One would naturally expect that more knowledge could better shed light on mysteries and enigmas, but some people claim that things actually become more complex and mysterious as more knowledge is acquired. From my point of view, within the existing knowledge framework it is true that more knowledge makes things more comprehensible, provided that the previous understanding is correct. When the new discoveries fundamentally change the existing framework of comprehension, however, things do appear more complex and mysterious as a result of such new knowledge.

To begin with, I agree that within the frame of existing knowledge, more knowledge is conducive to a better comprehension. This is because the broader frame of knowledge remains the same, so new discoveries do not raise new questions. For example, scholars in the ancient Greece have been painfully debating on the nature of the movement of celestial bodies. It was not understood why fruits would fall from trees in autumn, but stars always shine in the night sky. Then came Sir Isaac Newton. The three laws of motion named after him provide a satisfactory explanation to the aforementioned observations. One could confidently argue that the new knowledge discovered by Newton gave rise to a much clearer and more thorough understanding of an object's motion.

The lines of reasoning and the example cited above do prove that in some cases new knowledge makes things more comprehensible, but there is one unspoken prerequisite: existing understanding cannot be totally wrong and becomes contradictory to new discoveries. If this very prerequisite is not met, one could imagine the confusion brought about by the clash of information. A case in point here

is human beings' quest for understanding Earth's place in the universe. Due to its appealing religious interpretations, geocentricism has long dominated people's perception until the Copernicus offer a heliocentric alternative. Copernicus's model, based on diligent observations of celestial movement, shocked his contemporaries. All of a sudden Earth's place became more complex and inscrutable, but in hindsight we could attribute this confusion to the faulty understanding of the geocentric model. Hence, new knowledge could indeed make things appear more mysterious and complex if at odds with existing knowledge that is based on inaccurate understanding.

Finally, the discussion above hinges on one important premise: the framework of knowledge is preserved throughout the acquiring of knowledge. Yet in reality many discoveries shook such framework, and it becomes an inevitable consequence that the emergence of new, foreign information makes things less comprehensible. Two examples could strengthen my point here. Since early human beings started using stones and forging metals, we have been studying the property of materials and accumulated a considerable amount of knowledge. Yet, progresses in nano-technology in the 1980s discovered a surprising series of properties that cannot be explained by existing theories, because on nano-scale materials obey a set of rules different from the traditional materials. Another example is the classification of life. Historically philosophers and biologists divided all living beings into animals and plants, but the microscope invented in the late 1500s led to the discovery of microorganisms. The existence of such previously invisible tiny living beings made people become greatly perplexed and realize the enormous complexity of life. To them, life suddenly became more mysterious and it forced scholars to come up with a new paradigm for life classification. These two examples demonstrate a field will appear to be much more complex and mysterious than previously thought in light of the discoveries that fundamentally reshape the knowledge framework.

To sum up, when we acquire new knowledge that is compatible with the framework of existing knowledge, things become more comprehensible. That said, if the new knowledge is in direct contradiction to current know-how, or if the new knowledge represents a fundamental shift in the framework, things do appear more complex and mysterious. (681 words)

**中文翻译**

我们生活在一个知识爆炸的时代：每天都有成百上千篇的科研文章发表，我们现在获取的知识多到让前人无法想象。我们积累的知识是如何影响我们对周围世界的认知呢？人们会自然而然地期待更多的知识能够更好地揭示秘密和谜团，但有些人声称，随着人们获取更多的知识，事情实际上变得更加复杂和神秘了。在我看来，在现有的知识框架内，知识越多，事情就越容易理解，前提是先前的理解是正确的。然而，当新发现从根本上改变了现有的理解框架时，由于这些新知识，事情确实显得更加复杂和神秘。

首先，我同意在现有知识的框架内，更多的知识有助于更好的理解。这是因为更广泛的知

识框架保持不变，所以新的发现不会引起新的问题。例如，古希腊的学者们一直在苦于争论天体运动的性质。他们不明白为什么秋天树上会落下果实，而星星总是在夜空中闪耀。接着艾萨克·牛顿爵士登场了。以他的名字命名的三大运动定律为上述观察提供了令人满意的解释。人们可以自信地说，牛顿发现的新知识使人们对物体的运动有了更清晰、更彻底的理解。

上述的论证和例子确实证明，在某些情况下，新知识使事情变得更容易理解，但有一个不言而喻的先决条件：现有的理解不能是完全错误的，并与新的发现相矛盾。如果不满足这一前提条件，人们可以想象信息冲突带来的混乱。这方面的一个例子是人类对理解地球在宇宙中位置的探索。由于其吸引人的宗教解释，地心说长期以来一直主导着人们的看法，直到哥白尼提出了日心说。基于哥白尼对天体运动孜孜不倦的观察，他的模型震惊了他的同时代人。突然之间，地球的位置变得更加复杂和难以捉摸，但事后看来，我们可以将这种混乱归因于对地心模型的错误理解。因此，如果与现有的基于不准确理解的知识相冲突，新知识确实可以使事物看起来更神秘和复杂。

最后，上述讨论基于一个重要的前提：知识的框架在知识的获取过程中始终保持不变。然而，在现实中，许多发现动摇了这种框架，而且不可避免的结果是，新的外来信息的出现使事情变得不那么容易理解。这里有两个例子可以增强我的观点。从早期人类开始使用石头和锻造金属以来，我们一直在研究材料的性质，并且积累了相当多的知识。然而，由于 20 世纪 80 年代纳米技术的进步，人们发现了一系列现有理论无法解释的令人惊讶的物理特性，因为在纳米尺度上，纳米材料遵循一套不同于已知材料所遵循的规则。另一个例子是生命的分类。历史上哲学家和生物学家把所有的生物分为动物和植物，但是在 16 世纪末发明的显微镜导致了微生物的发现。这种原本看不见的微小生命体的存在使人们深感困惑，并且使人们认识到了生命无比巨大的复杂性。对他们来说，生命突然变得更加神秘，这迫使学者们想出一种新的生命分类范式。这两个例子表明，从根本上重塑知识框架的发现来看，一个领域将会比以前想象的复杂和神秘得多。

综上所述，当我们获得与现有知识框架相适应的新知识时，事情就变得更容易理解了。那就是说，如果新知识与现有的知识直接互相矛盾，或者如果新知识意味着现有框架的根本转变，那么事情确实显得更加复杂和神秘。

### 文章解析与点评

本题是一篇“反直觉”的题目，通常在我们的理念中，新的知识应该是让我们的世界越来越清晰易懂，但本题却提出了一个反向的观点：新的知识让世界变得更加神秘和难懂。面对这种违背人们直觉的论断，我们更要静下心来思考。具体到本题而言，新的知识究竟怎样改造了我们对世界的认知？这要取决于新的知识究竟是补充性（complementary）的还是颠覆性（disruptive）的。

很显然，如果新的知识是颠覆性的（如本文第三主旨段所说），推翻了原有的认知世界的框架和知识体系，那它当然会带来困惑与不解，因为我们更好地认识到了世界的复杂性。这里要提醒读者注意的一点是，有的同学可能会认为这是一种“不可知论”，但事实上并非如此，

颠覆性的知识给我们展示的是世界的复杂性，但世界的本质没有改变。换言之，客观世界仍然是那个客观世界，但是新知识让我们看到了更多。按照这个思路继续推论，人类也许会有彻底认清世界的那一天，只有在那个我们对世间万物已经无所不知、无所不晓的时刻，我们才可以说新知识再也不会带来更多的困惑和神秘。对此，笔者推荐大家去阅读著名科幻作家阿西莫夫的小说《最后的问题》（*The Last Question*），思考当有一天人类穷尽了所有的问题，走入了时间的尽头，宇宙和智慧生命将以何种姿态存在。

现在再让我们回到“补充性”的知识这一栏，正如本文第一和第二主旨段所说的那样，如果新的知识和信息不与现有的认知体系相冲突，又会有什么结果呢？本文认为这要看新旧知识之间是否存在矛盾与冲突，具体来说，得看过去的认知是否正确。如果我们过去的认知是错误的，显然新的知识会带来（短暂的）混乱。当然，我们要承认从更长远的角度来说，补充性的知识也会让世界变得更加易懂，因为错误的认识会被正确的认知所取代，如同地心说被日心说取代，而日心说被当代的宇宙学取代一样。结合上面所述知识的最终边界，这暗示本题另一种破题方法是短期与长期，读者不妨试试从这个角度下笔，用本题来做一个写作训练。

## 2 “因果类” Direction

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with **the claim and the reason** on which that claim is based.

### 中文翻译

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中讨论你在多大程度上同意或者不同意题目中的**结论以及**支持这个结论的**理由**。

### 讲　解

这类 Direction 对应的是新 GRE 写作中的一种全新题型，题干由两部分组成：一部分叫作 claim，也就是一个观点或者结论；另一部分叫作 reason，也就是支持这个结论的理由。这种题型所对应的 Direction 我们称之为“因果类” Direction，**它要求我们既谈到题目中的结论（claim），又提到题目中支持结论的原因（reason）**。在谈到原因时，我们还应该注意：就算原因成立，但它是否是构成该结论的原因？也就是说，有没有其他原因也可以推出该结论？

对于这种 Direction，希望大家注意：**我们对题目中原因和结论的态度到底是同意还是反对其实并不重要**，因为正如第一种 Direction 的讲解里说到的，ETS 并不在意我们的立场。

### 讲解浓缩版

**既要提到题目中的原因，又要提到结论。**

### 学术写作拓展

在将来的学术写作中，如果我们只是单纯地对某一论断或者看法表示同意或反对，未免显得肤浅和片面。更多时候我们应该透过这种看法，找寻它背后的原因或理由，全面理解得出这种看法的分析或者论证过程。对这种 Direction 的备考应该就会为我们以后的学术分析能力奠定基础。

例如，当阅读别人的某一科学实验报告时，我们不能只是对其实验结果进行同意或反对，还要顺着结果找到其理论依据或方法论指导并对其进行评价。“因果类”Direction 恰好就是这一分析模式的微型缩略。

### 例题举证

Claim: Researchers should not limit their investigations to only those areas in which they expect to discover something that has an immediate, practical application.
Reason: It is impossible to predict the outcome of a line of research with any certainty.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim and the reason on which that claim is based.

这道题的 reason 部分说：我们不能准确预测研究的结果；claim 部分说：研究者不能只是把他们的研究放在那些会有立竿见影的效果或应用的领域。其实这道题的推理思路是：正是因为研究结果无法预测，所以可能出现意料之外的惊喜，进而我们不能只关注那些可以知道结果的领域，也应该关注那些我们暂时还无法预测结果的领域。

一个可供参考的提纲如下：

**总立场：**有保留地反对题目

**分论点 1**（同意 reason）：一些科技研究的结果我们确实无法预知。（举例：核能、克隆技术等的研究初期，结果是不明朗的。）

**分论点 2**（反对 claim）：当我们资金一定时，我们确实只能去关注那些结果可知且有立竿见影效果的领域。

**分论点 3**（反对从原因到结论的推理过程）：我们是否关注一个领域的研究，可能不是取决于其结果是否可预知，而是取决于其是否能最终造福人类。

这个提纲的前两个分论点分别讨论题目中的 reason 和 claim，**这就已经照应了 Direction 的要求**。而第三个分论点讨论了从 reason 到 claim 的推理过程，**这一点其实是锦上添花的一点。我们建议有余力的考生可以对其进行一番思考**。

## 题库范文

139 Claim: No act is done purely for the benefit of others.
Reason: All actions — even those that seem to be done for other people — are based on self-interest.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim and the reason on which that claim is based.

Is there any act that is truly altruistic? To some people the answer is a firm no. They claim that there is not a single human act that is purely in the interest of others. Instead, it is argued that all those actions are actually motivated by self-interest, even including those actions which appear to be examples of altruism. Although I acknowledge the facts that certain behaviors, though seemingly altruistic, are driven by self-interest, it cannot be denied that there are indeed actions done purely for the benefit of others in the society or the benefit of his or her fellow countrymen.

First, on an individual level, I agree with the notion that some seemingly altruistic actions may have indeed been motivated by self-interest. Here, the recognition of being altruistic itself is morally rewarding, and hence the pursuit of this very moral reward leads to altruistic behaviors. For example, charity donation is commonly considered to be altruistic and a philanthropist may seemingly rightfully claim that they do so in order to help the poor with little expectation for favors in return. While this is the case on the surface, we must not forget that such actions are often accompanied by applause and admiration from the public, meaning those who donate to the charity actually benefit from their behaviors in a largely non-material fashion. Hence, from an individual perspective, there are certainly cases where self-interest may indeed partially drive some of our actions that at first glance seem completely altruistic.

Second, on family level, some even question the concept of altruism that is purportedly existing between parents and children. Conventional thinking always praises the great sacrifice made by parents for their children and regards it as a noble form of altruism. Yet, another school of thinking actually argues that such actions also have self-based motives. The fundamental premises of their lines of reasoning are that the goal of our survival is to pass the genetic information, embedded in the DNA of our cells as well as in those of our offspring. As a consequence, the sacrificial behaviors of parents can be interpreted as a way of the so-called "selfish genes" to ensure their passage to the upcoming generations. This hypothesis explains why in certain animals the mother would kill her offspring when she determines that the chances of survival for the baby are slim. To conclude, even the parents' seemingly altruistic devotion to the children cannot always be seen as without any self-interest.

Despite the aforementioned examples showing that many purportedly altruistic actions are done based on self-interest, it would be logically going too far to argue that all actions are based on self-interest. There are still many cases in which an act is done for the benefit of other people. Particularly speaking, the survival of the group, be it an ethnic group, a nation, or the entire human race, prevails the self-interest and leads the individual to commit selfless act. In animals such group survival instincts abound. For example, certain old preys will proactively sacrifice their lives to predators in a way to ensure the younger population still survive. Similar principles can also be applied to human society. In the Civil Rights Movement, Dr. Martin Luther King sacrifices his life to fight for the equal rights of black people in the United States. Soldiers are willingly ready to sacrifice their lives to achieve the greater good for their fellow countrymen in the time of wars. In the finale of recent blockbuster series *Avengers,* Tony Stark, the Iron Man, knowingly give up his life for the survival of the human race as well as other species in the universe. Though the final example is a pure fiction, together with other real-life example, it still vividly and forcefully illustrates the existence of true altruism in our society.

To sum up, I cannot fully agree with the claim that no act is done purely for other people and the reason that all actions are based on self-interest. While there are many seemingly altruistic actions that can be interpreted in a selfish fashion, many other actions are indeed carried out for the benefits of the others and at the sacrifice of those who do it. (701 words)

**中文翻译**

有没有真正利他的行为？对某些人来说，他们的答案肯定是“没有”。他们声称，没有一种人类行为纯粹是为了其他人的利益。相反，这些人认为，所有这些行为实际上都是出于自身利益，甚至包括那些看似利他主义的行为。虽然我承认某些行为表面上是利他的，但实际上是由私利驱使的，但也不能否认，有些行为确实纯粹是为了社会上其他人的利益或是为了同胞的利益。

首先，在个人层面上，我同意这样的观点，即一些看似利他的行为可能确实是出于私利。在这里，利他主义本身被认可是道德上的回报，因此追求这种道德上的回报会产生利他主义行为。例如，慈善捐赠通常被认为是利他主义的，慈善家似乎可以以一种理所当然的态度声称，他们这样做是为了帮助穷人，而对回报很少有期望。虽然表面上是这样，但我们不能忘记，公众对这种行为往往给予掌声和钦佩，也就是说，那些向慈善机构捐款的人实际上从他们的行为中获益，而这些益处往往是非物质的。因此，从个人的角度来看，确实存在这样的情况：自利可能确实在某种程度上驱使我们的某些行为，而且乍一看，这些行为似乎完全是利他主义的。

其次，在家庭层面，有些人甚至质疑存在于父母和孩子之间的所谓利他主义。传统的思维总是赞扬父母为孩子做出的巨大牺牲，并将其视为一种高尚的利他主义。然而，另一种学派认为，这种行为也有自我为本的动机。他们推理的基本前提是，我们生存的目标是传递基因信息，这些信息嵌入在我们细胞的 DNA 和我们后代的 DNA 中。因此，父母的牺牲行为可以被理解为所谓的“自私基因”确保它们后代继承的一种方式。这个假设解释了为什么在某些动物中，当

母亲确定婴儿存活的机会很小时，她会杀死她的后代。综上所述，即使是父母表面上对孩子的无私奉献，也不能总是被视为没有任何私利。

尽管上述例子表明，许多据称是利他主义的行为都是基于自身利益的，但从逻辑上讲，认为所有的行为都是基于自身利益的说法太过于绝对。在许多情况下，一项行为是为了他人的利益而采取的。特别是群体的生存——无论是一个民族、一个国家，还是整个人类的生存——都压倒了自我的利益，并且引导个体做出无私的行为。在动物中，这样的群体生存本能比比皆是。例如，在捕食者面前某些老年动物会主动牺牲自己的生命以确保年轻种群的生存。类似的原则也适用于人类社会。在民权运动中，马丁·路德·金博士为争取美国黑人的平等权利而牺牲了自己的生命。在战争时期，士兵们甘愿牺牲自己的生命为同胞创造更大的利益。在最近轰动一时的《复仇者联盟》系列电影最后一部中，钢铁侠托尼·史塔克为了人类以及宇宙中的其他物种的生存，主动放弃了自己的生命。虽然最后一个例子是纯粹虚构的，但与其他现实生活中的例子一起，仍然生动有力地说明了真正的利他主义在我们社会中是存在的。

综上所述，我不能完全同意这样的说法，即任何行为都不是纯粹为了他人，所有行为都是基于自身利益。虽然有许多看似利他的行为可以用自私来解释，但仍然有许多行为确实是为了他人的利益而牺牲自己的利益进行的。

**文章解析与点评**

本题是 2019 新收录题库的一道 claim+reason 类题，它的主观点是：没有任何纯粹为他人利益而做出的行为；给出的理由是：所有行为都是基于自己的利益，哪怕是那些看起来是为了他人的行为。很多同学看到这道题目觉得如鲠在喉，只看到利他主义四个字，觉得无话可说，原因如下：

首先，利他主义这个概念太抽象了。利他主义，指的是个体的行为不是为了自己的利益，而是出于他人的利益，或者说把他人的利益置于自己的利益至上。其次，利他主义本身也是有争议的，这篇文章的思辨性就在于此。有学者认为所谓的利他主义并不存在，比如在地铁上让座，这看起来是一个利他的，但让座的行为会给让座者带来声望上的奖励，还是利己的。同样，有一派进化生物学者认为，父母对于子女的关爱其实也是受到基因驱动的，因为作为基因，想要延续自身的存在，就需要靠后代的繁衍。这其实是理查德·道金斯《自私的基因》一书中的观点，建议大家可以快速浏览一下，会让你对生命有一个新的认知视角。

回到这篇文章，实际它就是我们上面所说的，认为利他主义完全不存在的学派。但注意到这是一个是非判断，而且语气非常绝对，那么我们就可以思考：到底有没有一种行为是真正利他的？如果有，那么作者的观点就可以被反对。当然，我们承认地铁让座和父母带小孩存在一定的利己因素，可以作为让步段。但在我看来，利他主义行为是确实存在的，在社会和集体层面，牺牲小我、成就大我就可以看作是利他的。比如马丁·路德·金为了黑人民权运动而奉献了自己的生命，又比如解放军战士冒着生命危险抗洪救灾。不知不觉中，这篇文

章的三个层面已经显现出来了，分别是个人层面（让步）、家庭层面（让步）以及社会层面（主观点）。我们认为社会层面上利他主义行为是确实存在的。

本篇文章正文段可以写三段，每一段都可以至少举一个例子，加上个人——家庭——社会这三个视角层层递进，思路严谨，文章要拿到高分相对容易。尤其请留意本文最后一个主旨段的例子，我们使用了电影《复仇者联盟》中钢铁侠为了宇宙和平而牺牲自己作为范例。很显然这是一个虚构的角色，钢铁侠的行为在这世界也并非真实存在，但为什么它还可以用来作为例子呢？这个问题留给大家去思考。

138 Claim: Though often considered an objective pursuit, learning about the historical past requires creativity.
Reason: Because we can never know the past directly, we must reconstruct it by imaginatively interpreting historical accounts, documents, and artifacts.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim and the reason on which the claim is based.

"The farther back you can look, the farther forward you are likely to see." These words from Winston Churchill clearly demonstrates that understanding the past is of great importance. The method to study the history, however, remains debated. Some argue that because we could never directly probe into the past, we can only reconstruct it by imaginatively interpreting historical accounts, documents, as well as artifacts. As a result, creativity actually becomes an essential requirement for learning about the past, even though such efforts are considered to be an objective pursuit. In my opinion, I largely agree with the lines of reasoning above, although I find problems with the premises that the past cannot be directly known and the unsubstantiated assumption that pursuit of learning about history is an objective endeavor.

To begin with, let's look at the argument that it is impossible to know the past directly, which I cannot fully agree with. From my own point of view, the history itself can actually be directly known, as there are abundant historical documents that faithfully record what exactly happened in the past. For instance, the assassination of President John F. Kennedy was broadcast live in front of the American public so any future historian interested in this event will have direct access to such important archives. Even for some events in the very remote past, there can still be documents on what happened, both recorded in artifacts and in nature. The origin of agriculture for instance is believed to happen around 13,000 years ago beginning in the Fertile Crescent in the Middle East. This is based on evidence of the remains of agricultural equipment discovered from modern-day Syria and Iraq dating back to that period. Fossil record showing the emergence of domesticated crops also firmly informs us the transition

from hunter-gathering to a sedentary lifestyle known as farming. Therefore, it is not reasonable to claim that the historical past can never be directly known.

That being said, even though we can directly know the past events, what remains unclear is people's motivation and what is in their mind. This turns out to be where imagination is needed. As a result, I by and large agree with the claim that learning about the past requires creativity. Let's take the case of John F. Kennedy's tragic death as an example. Although his assassination is clearly documented, even to this day it is still not clear why the alleged assassin committed such a crime. This mystery is compounded by fact that the suspect was murdered soon afterwards, forcing people to rely on imagination to infer his motivation. Hence, even though the past can be known directly, understanding what is behind the historical facts requires imaginative capacities. For such an event with detailed documentation and extensive investigations, we still need to creatively interpret some of its elements, so it is not surprising that for events occurring in the more distant past with little or no direct archiving, imagination becomes critical. Similarly, even though we could determine from a wide range of evidence the timing of when agriculture started, one has to speculate the reason why people changed their lifestyle. Could it be the change in Earth's climate? Could it be simply a coincidence? The real causes for many historical events do not carry a simple, straightforward answer and instead challenge our imaginative faculty.

However, before concluding my argument, I need to point out one more issue within the original claim. It is claimed that learning about the history is thought to be objective, but I do not think this is the case. To understand the reason, we must go back to the fundamentals on how history is learned. People understand history based on our interpretation of the archives. While it is true that historical documents and artifacts are objective, the interpretation on them is very much subjective. Despite their academic training, historians are still human beings and have biases and preferences. As a result, there could be different views on the same object. For example, the Easter Island, located in the South Pacific, is known for the giant stone statues. Historians have long speculated their purpose and significance: some claim they are the personification of deities, while other argue they represent the ancestors of the island habitants with no religious implication. A different interpretation on the statues could paint a drastically different picture on the island's religious culture. To date, the mystery of Easter Island stone sculptures remains unresolved, and it illustrates the subjective nature of studying history.

To conclude, because historical documents are either sparse or do not record people's inner thinking, learning about the past does require certain level of imagination and creativity. That said, it does not establish the inability to know the past directly, and in the meantime, learning about the past is actually a highly subjective endeavor because it involves our interpretation of historical documents and artifacts. (816 words)

**中文翻译**

"往后看得有多远，向前也会看得有多远。"温斯顿·丘吉尔的这句话清楚地表明，理解

历史非常重要。然而，研究历史的方法仍有争议。有人认为，由于我们永远无法直接探究过去，所以只能通过想象力来解释历史记录、文献以及文物来重建过去。因此，创造力实际上成为了解过去的必要能力，尽管研究历史被认为是一种客观的工作。在我看来，我基本上同意这种推理，尽管我发现这个推理的前提是人不能直接了解过去，以及学习历史是一项客观的工作这种假设没有事实依据。

首先，我不能完全同意“直接了解过去是不可能的”这一论点。我个人的观点是，人们可以直接地了解历史，因为有大量的历史文献忠实地记录了过去发生的事情。例如，肯尼迪总统遇刺事件是在美国公众面前直播的，因此任何对这一事件感兴趣的历史学家都可以直接查阅重要的档案。即使是一些非常遥远的事件仍然在人工制品和自然中有其对应的记录。例如，农业起源于大约 13 000 年前，始于中东肥沃的新月地带。这是基于从现代叙利亚和伊拉克发现的那个时期农业设备遗骸的证据。化石中记录的人工培育作物的出现也坚定地表明，从狩猎采集到久坐不动的生活方式的转变被称为农业化。因此，声称历史永远不可能被直接知晓的论点是不合理的。

但是，尽管我们可以直接知道过去发生的事情，但我们仍不能清楚地了解人们的动机和他们的想法，这就是我们需要发挥想象力的时候。因此，我大体上同意这样的说法：了解过去需要创造力。让我们以肯尼迪的悲惨死亡为例，尽管对他的暗杀有明确的记录，但疑犯很快就被谋杀了。所以即使到今天，人们仍不清楚被指控的刺客为何犯下这样的罪行，这就迫使人们依靠想象来推断他的动机，使得这个谜团更加复杂了。因此，即使人们可以直接了解过去，了解历史事实背后的秘密仍需要想象力。对于肯尼迪被刺案这样一个有详细文件和广泛调查的事件，我们仍然需要创造性地解释其中的一些要素。因此，对于发生在更遥远的过去、很少或没有直接存档的事件，声称想象力变得至关重要也就不足为奇了。同样，尽管我们可以从广泛的证据中确定农业开始的时间，但我们必须推测人们改变生活方式的原因。可能是因为地球气候的变化吗？可能这只是巧合吗？许多历史事件的真正原因并不是简单、直接的答案，而是对我们想象力的挑战。

然而，在结束我的讨论之前，我需要指出原题论点中的另一个问题：研究历史被认为是客观的工作，但我认为情况并非如此。要理解原因，我们必须回到一个基础问题上来，即我们到底怎样学习历史。人们通过诠释档案记录来理解历史。虽然历史文献和文物是客观的，但对它们的解释却非常主观。尽管受过学术训练，历史学家仍然是人，他们有着偏见和偏好。因此，对同一个对象，他们可能有不同的解释。例如，位于南太平洋的复活节岛以巨大的石像而闻名。历史学家长期以来一直在猜测它们的目的和意义：有人声称它们是神的化身，而另一些人则认为它们代表的是岛上居民的祖先，没有任何宗教含义。对这些雕像的不同解读可能会给岛上的宗教文化描绘出截然不同的画面。复活节岛石雕之谜至今仍未解开，说明了历史研究的主观性。

综上所述，由于历史文献的稀少，或是由于它们没有记录人们的内心思考，了解过去确实需要一定程度的想象力和创造力。尽管如此，这并不能证明我们不能直接了解过去，同时，了解过去实际上是一种高度主观的尝试，因为它涉及我们对历史文献和文物的解读。

**文章解析与点评**

历史类题目（如何研究历史以及历史与现实之间的关系）在 GRE Issue 题库中一共有五个，本题是其中之一。作为一道 2019 年加入题库的新题，本题认为：研究过去的历史需要创造力，因为我们不能直接获知过去发生了什么，所以要富有想象力地去解读历史记录、文献以及器件。注意本题分为了 claim 和 reason 两个部分，我们需要分开进行讨论。

首先，我们来思考 reason 当中的陈述，我们究竟能否直接获知过去发生的事情呢？本文认为是可以的，因为大量的史实记载了过去究竟发生了什么，譬如肯尼迪总统于 1963 年在达拉斯被刺杀，整个过程被新闻直播记录了下来——请注意在原文的举例过程中，我们并没有强调肯尼迪是在何时何处被刺杀的，这是因为例子举得好不好并不在于细节的多少，而是例子本身是否恰当。接着本文进一步延展，认为即便是发生在远古时期、没有文献记录的事情我们也可以知晓，譬如农业的出现。换言之，我们清楚地知道肯尼迪总统被刺杀这一事实，也知道农业在何时出现，因此说“直接了解过去是不可能的”这一点并不成立。

但是，本文也承认创造力在历史研究当中的重要性，这是因为我们不能获知历史事件的原因。在这里，本文使用了一种高明的论证技巧，即对原有例子的新解读。在主旨段第二段中，我们仍然使用了肯尼迪总统被刺杀以及农业出现的例子，并指明：虽然我们有各种历史事件的直接或间接记录，但是它们为什么会发生需要想象力。这里我们延续了上一段同样的例子，但给出了不同的解读，这等于在论证和论据两个层面同时完成了反转，读起来更加令人信服。

如果文章到这里就结束的话，可能会是一篇 4.5 分左右的文章，但本文对于原文 claim 进行了进一步分析，从而将文章提升到了 5.5~6.0 分的水平。具体来看，原文中有一个让步状语从句，说“尽管（研究历史）被认为是客观的”，这句话很多同学在写文章时把它漏掉了。对于考生而言，想要拿高分就一定要充分利用题目中的信息，所以我们在第三主旨段对这一让步状语从句提出了质疑，认为研究历史本身就是一个主观的过程，因为它包含了我们对史料的解读和对原因的揣测，这些解读（interpretation）都会受到个人的主观偏好影响。

这道题给我们的启迪是，我们一定要意识到 Issue 题干当中任何一个词、一句话都是蕴含了信息的，如果是像本题一样有一个完整的从句，那更应该要引起我们的注意——ETS 不会将一句没用的话放在题干里。

136 Claim: While boredom is often expressed with a sense of self-satisfaction, it should really be a source of embarrassment.
Reason: Boredom arises from a lack of imagination and self-motivation.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim and the reason on which that claim is based.

In the fast-paced modern-day life, people sometimes feel bored by their daily routines. Should boredom be viewed as an expression of self-satisfaction or should it be considered a source of embarrassment? While in certain cases boredom is the result of repetitive, non-inspiring activities, most cases boredom indeed originates from a lack of imagination and self-motivation. As a result, boredom under many circumstances should be a source of embarrassment because it means that one has not done his or her best. That being said, I do not agree with the claim that boredom is often expressed with a sense of self-satisfaction.

First let's begin with the reason. Some may challenge the proposition that boredom arises from a lack of imagination and self-motivation, something related to our internal motives. Instead they view boredom as the inevitable consequence of external pressure. As a result, one's expression boredom cannot be attributed to his or her own mental qualities. For example, in his classic pantomime *Modern Times*, Charlie Chaplin vividly illustrates a streamline worker devoid of personalities and becoming a single piece of a greater, collective machinery. Even to date, many white-collar workers today are overburdened with the amount of work they have to deal with, most of which is repetitive and not intellectually stimulating enough to spark aspiration. Overtime, such uninspiring work makes them numb and start to feel bored. In this case, it is hardly their fault or their lack of imagination that leads to the feeling of boredom, at least at first glance.

From my point of view, the lines of reasoning above seem to be convincing, but in reality, those who feel bored by their work are still entitled to choose other more challenging and rewarding endeavors. For example, those white-collar workers could quit their job and start working on what is truly of interest to them. However, such actions take courage and motivation because of the risks in initiating the changes. A corollary hence follows: a lack of change from those who feel bored implies the absence of such motivating characteristics. As a consequence, while boredom can appear to originate from external factors, our own characteristics, such as imagination and self-motivation plays a more direct role in causing and getting rid of the feeling of boredom.

Now that we have demonstrated the origin of boredom being a lack of imagination or self-motivation, should it be considered a source of embarrassment? My answer to this question is yes, although I need to point out that boredom is not always expressed with a sense of self-satisfaction as some people may have claimed. Their main argument is that boredom is the direct result of feeling satisfied by what one has accomplished, and hence its expression implies one's success in certain fields. I cannot fully agree with this view; instead, from our discussion above, in many cases the expression of boredom actually reflects one's dissatisfaction of the present. At any rate, even though various reasons are capable of invoking the emotion of boredom, one should indeed feel embarrassed by such a feeling, because feeling bored means that one has forsaken his or her options to make change to life. That is, boredom is a passive and negative reaction to the external stimuli, be it positive or negative.

On the other hand, true warriors of life will neither be self-complacent by their previous achievements, evidenced by the likes of Elon Musk, or become disgruntled by life, such as Dr. Martin Luther King. Elon Musk is a serial entrepreneur who instead of becoming merely satisfied by his early successful investment holds a greater vision, while Dr. King is an activist who has committed his entire life to the cause of civil rights movement. Instead of getting bored of the status quo, both chose to challenge to the equilibrium and made a difference in history.

To sum up, while boredom may seemingly arise from external factors, I consider its primary cause to lie within our mind and heart. That being said, boredom is not always expressed with a sense of self-complacency, but in many cases with dissatisfaction as well. Either way, though, boredom should indeed be a source of embarrassment because it means a lack of courage to change what makes people feel bored. (707 words)

**中文翻译**

在快节奏的现代生活中，人们有时会对自己的日常生活感到厌烦。无聊应该被视为一种自我满足的表现，还是应该被视为一种羞耻之源？虽然在某些情况下，无聊是重复性、非激励性活动的结果，但大多数情况下，无聊确实源于缺乏想象力和自我激励。因此，在许多情况下，无聊应该是一种羞耻之源，因为它意味着一个人没有做到最好。尽管如此，我不同意这样的说法，即无聊往往是以自我满足感来表达的。

首先，让我们从论述原因开始。有些人可能会质疑这样一个命题：无聊源于缺乏想象力和自我激励，这与我们的内在动机有关。相反，他们认为无聊是外部压力的必然结果。因此，一个人的无聊不能归因于他或她自己的心理素质。例如，查理·卓别林在经典哑剧《摩登时代》中生动地出演了一个缺乏个性的流线型工人，并且成为一个更大的集体机器的一部分。即使在如今，许多白领仍然承受着繁重的工作量，其中大部分工作都是重复性的，没有足够的智力刺激来激发他们的远大志向。随着时间流逝，这样枯燥乏味的工作让他们感到麻木、无聊。在这种情况下，至少乍一看，并不是他们的过错或缺乏想象力导致无聊感。

在我看来，前面的论证似乎很有说服力，但实际上，那些对自己的工作感到厌烦的人仍然可以选择做出更具挑战性和更有价值的努力。例如，那些白领可以辞掉工作，然后从事他们真正感兴趣的工作。然而，这种行动需要勇气和动力，因为做出改变是有风险的。因此，可以做出推论：对于那些感到无聊的人，缺乏改变意味着缺乏这种激励性特征。因此，虽然无聊似乎是由外部因素引起的，但我们自身的特点，如想象力和自我激励，在造成和消除无聊感方面起着更直接的作用。

既然我们已经证明了无聊的根源是缺乏想象力或自我激励，那么它是否应该被视为一种羞耻之源呢？我对这个问题的回答是肯定的，尽管我需要指出的是，无聊并不是像有些人所说的那样总是以一种自我满足感来表达的。他们的主要论点是，无聊是对自己所取得的成就感到满

足的直接结果，因此，它意味着一个人在某些领域取得了成功。我不能完全同意这个观点，相反，从我们上面的讨论来看，在很多情况下，无聊的表达实际上反映了一个人对当下的不满。无论如何，尽管各种各样的理由都能唤起无聊的情绪，但人们确实应该为这种感觉感到尴尬，因为感到无聊意味着放弃了选择去改变生活。也就是说，无聊是对外界刺激的一种被动消极的反应，不管这种刺激是积极的还是消极的。从另一方面来说，生活中真正的勇士既不会因为自己以前的成就而自满，比如埃隆·马斯克，也不会对生活产生怨念，比如马丁·路德·金博士。埃隆·马斯克是一个连续创业者，他并未仅仅满足于早期投资的成功，而是拥有更大的远见。而金博士则是一位将一生奉献于民权运动事业的活动家。他们没有厌倦现状，而是选择挑战平衡，并在历史上有所作为。

总而言之，虽然无聊似乎是由外部因素引起的，但我认为其主要原因在于我们的思想和内心。也就是说，无聊并不总是表现为一种自满，而是在很多情况下也表现为不满。不管怎样，无聊确实应该是一种羞耻之源，因为它意味着缺乏勇气去改变让人感到无聊的事情。

### 文章解析与点评

这又是一篇非常抽象的题目，题干中“枯燥无聊”“自我满足”“羞耻”“想象力”“自我激励”这一系列词汇都是容易让人不知所措、无从下笔的关键词。下面我们来讲解如何搞定这篇难度极大的文章。

题目分成了 claim 和 reason 两个部分，所以我们也将这两句话分别来看。首先看 reason，一个人感觉到枯燥乏味是因为缺乏想象力和自我激励吗？在这里，不同的世界观和价值观会有不同的回答，具体来说分为外在因素和内在因素两种观点。本文认为感到枯燥其实是内在因素主导的，是因为我们对于生活失去了奋发向上的勇气，从而不去改变现状，久而久之难免对现状产生厌倦感。的确，这是很多都市生活的青年人面临的问题，即所谓的“厌世”。

在确定了 reason 之后，我们再来看 claim 的立场，它说“尽管感觉无聊通常被认为是自我满足的表达，但其实应该成为羞耻之源”，我们要将其拆分来看。对于后面这一句是否应该感到羞耻，延续上文我们可以得到一个肯定的结论，无聊是一种消极的反应。但是无聊是不是真的如题所述的那样是表达自我满足呢？这里本文提出了异议，认为无聊并非自我满足，可能更多时候只是牢骚罢了。但不论是自满还是抱怨，无聊和枯燥的感觉归根到底还是自身缺乏改变现状的勇气和决心。文章举了马斯克和马丁·路德·金的例子，这些被世人钦佩的人物都有一个特质，那就是不安于现状——不论这个现状是好的（对于创业成功的富翁马斯克而言）还是不好的（对于权益受到压迫的黑人金博士而言）。

除了对于 claim 的拆解之外，本文能够拿高分的另外一个原因是对于 reason 部分的论证。在第一个主旨段中，本文提出了敌方观点，认为在我们身处的时代，个体非常容易感到无聊——这也许是工业时代下个体价值越来越小的必然趋势，每个人都是工业链条上可以被替代的一环。但在第二主旨段中，我们马上对这种观点进行反驳，并认为外界的客观因素的确会带来枯燥，

但是个体不去进行改变才是这种无聊心态的根本原因。通过引出敌方观点并进行驳斥，我们可以更好地建立起己方观点，这是一个值得认真学习的 Issue 论证技巧。

## 3 “两种看法类” Direction

Write a response in which you discuss which view more closely aligns with your own position and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, **you should address both of the views presented**.

### 中文翻译

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中讨论哪个观点和你的立场最接近，解释你所采取的立场的理由。在发展和支持你的观点立场的过程中，**必须考虑到双方观点**。

### 讲　解

这类 Direction 对应的是新 GRE 写作中的第二种全新题型，题干包含两种观点，这两种观点可能是相互排斥的，也可能在本质上并不是矛盾的。**相对应的 Direction 要求我们在写作时不能只提到题目中的一种观点，而要兼顾两种观点**。对于这种 Direction，有这样两个注意事项：

① Direction 中虽然要求我们明确说明哪个观点和我们的立场最接近，但真实情况完全可以是“两种观点和我们的立场一样接近”，因为正如之前所说，我们的立场并不重要。

②我们虽然要提到两种观点，但以多长的篇幅去提及却并没有要求。例如我们的中间段有三段，我们可以用两段讨论一种观点，用一段讨论第二种观点；而如果我们的中间段有四段，我们可以分别用两段谈论两种观点。

### 讲解浓缩版

**题目中的两种观点都要讨论。**

### 学术写作拓展

这种 Direction 的要求其实是在照应我们在学术写作，特别是论文写作中的“文献综述（Literature Review）”部分。在学术写作中，我们总会遇到很多他人和前人的看法，这些看法可能和我们的看法相似，也可能相斥，而这些看法之间还可能存在相似或相斥之处。如何看待、处理这些看法，是我们必须应对的问题。ETS 借用这样一个 Direction 其实是希望我们对这种问题提前做好准备。

例题举证

Some people believe that college students should consider only their own talents and interests when choosing a field of study. Others believe that college students should base their choice of a field of study on the availability of jobs in that field.

Write a response in which you discuss which view more closely aligns with your own position and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should address both of the views presented.

参考提纲如下：

**总立场**：认为两种看法并不矛盾

**分论点 1**（同意第一种看法的合理之处）：兴趣是学习的动力，而天赋能够让学生在自己擅长的领域迈出更好的第一步。

**分论点 2**（同意第二种看法的合理之处）：大学是学生从学生身份向社会人转化的重要场所，工作是社会人的重要属性之一，因此学生应该在选择专业之时考虑就业情况。

**分论点 3**（这两种看法其实并不矛盾）：首先，一些学生所喜欢并擅长的专业可能就是社会需求量大的专业；其次，就算学生根据自己的兴趣和爱好所选择的领域并非社会需求量最大的专业，也可以通过努力让自己成为本专业最出色的人才，这样一来仍然不会缺少工作机会。

分论点 1 和分论点 2 分别探讨了第一种看法和第二种看法，**这就已经照应了 Direction 的要求**。而分论点 3 辩证地探讨了这两种看法的关系，**这一点属于锦上添花，建议大家可以尝试着思考**。

## 题库范文

54 Some people believe that society should try to save every plant and animal species, despite the expense to humans in effort, time, and financial well-being. Others believe that society need not make extraordinary efforts, especially at a great cost in money and jobs, to save endangered species.

Write a response in which you discuss which view more closely aligns with your own position and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should address both of the views presented.

Human beings are increasingly capable of modifying the environment surrounding us, which has led to a growing number of species facing the threat of extinction. Should society make efforts to save endangered plant and animal species? Some people believe that people should try to protect and save every endangered species on this planet despite the tremendous cost, while others object saving endangered species at the cost of the society. From my point view, we should indeed make efforts to save them due to at least two practical reasons.

To start, those who believe that society need not save endangered species may claim that the pending extinction of species is not necessarily the result of human activities. If human beings are not responsible for such extinction, humankind carries no moral obligation to save them. Throughout the history of our planet, they argue, life has risen and fallen a number of times. For example, multiple mass extinction events exist in Earth history and they have time after time decimated a large percentage of the living things. Such events predated the modern humans and apparently the extinction of many species is a pure consequence of Nature. Similar natural processes capable of wiping out species are still at play today. As a result, if the danger of becoming extinct today for a species is not because of human activities, we should not disturb the cycle of Nature and instead should just let such species go extinct, especially given the fact that saving them would inflict a considerable financial and labor cost to our society.

While the argument above seems reasonable at the first glimpse, in reality there is a major flaw in its assumption. It assumes that we can tell confidently whether humans are responsible for the species becoming endangered. In some cases, this is easy to determine. For example, poaching by human beings is the fundamental factor in driving rhinos into the verge of extinction. And yet, in other cases the reasons may be murky and there could be multiple reasons involved, while human factors are often hard to identify. For instance, human beings have profoundly changed the surface environment of the Earth, by converting forest into cities and turning lands into urban metropolis. In this process, the climate and the habitat of wildlife have been affected, which in turn could lead to the potential demise of a species. Illegal hunting of tigers for instance is undeniably one reason for tigers' endangered status; at the same time, human beings are also indirectly responsible because our actions have adversely affected the health of rainforest that tigers call home. By extension, even if some species are endangered by seemingly natural reasons, it is certainly possible that human beings are an indirect factor. Hence, there is still a moral obligation to save them.

Furthermore, even if human beings have truly no responsibility whatsoever in the possible extinction of a species, does it mean that we should do nothing and let the extinction happen? I doubt so, because from a practical point of view a plant or animal species may carry values to our society. Sometimes such values are direct, such as some substances found in herbal plants have demonstrated

abilities to fight certain cancers. In other cases, such values can be indirect and are not easily seen. For instance, certain bird species may seem to have little direct value to human society, and yet the fact that they prey on locust means they could provide essential ecological service to our society. The ongoing locust crisis in East Africa and the Near East poses a great threat to the stability of societies in those regions. In this case, those bird species can prove extremely valuable to human beings. Hence, given the possible service those species can provide, we should save endangered species from extinction.

To sum up, from a pure naturalist's point of view human beings shouldn't intervene in the process of a species' natural extinction since the moral burden does not fall onto our shoulder. Yet, practically speaking, because we cannot know for sure if a species' extinction is the result of human actions and any species may provide valuable service to human society, we should save every endangered animal and plant species. (707 words)

**中文翻译**

人类改变周围环境的能力越来越强，这导致越来越多的物种面临灭绝的威胁。社会应该努力拯救濒危动植物吗？有些人认为，尽管这样做会付出巨大的代价，我们还是应该努力保护和拯救这个星球上的每一个濒危物种，而另一些人则反对以社会为代价来拯救濒危物种。在我看来，出于两个实际的原因，我们确实应该努力拯救它们。

首先，那些认为社会不需要拯救濒危物种的人可能会声称，物种即将灭绝并不一定是人类活动的结果。如果人类不应对这种灭绝负责，就没有道德义务去拯救濒危物种。他们认为，纵观我们这个星球的历史，生命曾有过多次兴衰。例如，地球历史上存在多次大灭绝事件，很大一部分生物在一次又一次的灭绝中消亡了。这类事件早于现代人类的出现，显然许多物种的灭绝是纯粹自然结果。类似的能够消灭物种的自然过程至今仍在发挥作用。因此，如果一个物种如今灭绝的危险不是因为人类活动，我们就不应该扰乱自然的循环，而是应该让这些物种灭绝，特别是考虑到拯救它们会给我们的社会带来相当大的财政和人力成本。

虽然上述论点乍一看似乎是合理的，但事实上，它的假设有一个重大缺陷。它假设我们可以自信地判断人类是否对物种濒危负有责任。在某些情况下，这很容易确定。例如，人类偷猎是导致犀牛濒临灭绝的根本因素。然而，在其他情况下，原因可能是模糊的，并且可能涉及多种因素，而人为因素往往很难确定。例如，人类已经深刻地改变了地球的表面环境，把森林变成了城市，把土地变成了大都市。在这一过程中，气候和野生动物的栖息地可能会受到影响，然后这会导致物种的灭亡。例如，不可否认的是，非法猎杀老虎是造成这一物种濒危的一个原因；同时，人类也负有间接责任，因为我们的行为对老虎的家园——雨林的健康产生了不利影响。推而广之，即使有些物种看似因为自然的原因而濒临灭绝，人类活动也有间接影响的可能。因此，人类仍然有道义上的义务去拯救它们。

更进一步说，如果人类对于物种灭绝没有任何责任，那这就意味着我们应该对物种灭绝袖手旁观吗？我对此表示怀疑，因为从实际的角度来看，一种植物或动物可能会给我们的社会带来价值。这些价值可以是直接的，比如人类在某些草本植物中发现了一些具有抗癌作用的物质。在其他情况下，这些价值可能是间接的，不容易被看到。例如，某些鸟类对人类社会似乎没有什么直接价值，但它们能捕食蝗虫，这意味着它们可以为我们的社会提供必要的生态服务。东非和近东地区正在发生的蝗灾危机对这些地区的社会稳定构成巨大威胁。在这种情况下，鸟类对于人类的价值非常高。因此，考虑到这些物种可能带来的益处，我们应该拯救濒临灭绝的物种。

综上所述，从纯粹的自然主义者的观点来看，人类不应该干预物种自然灭绝的过程，因为道德的重担并不在我们人类肩上。然而实际上，由于我们不能确定一个物种的灭绝是否是人类行为的结果，并且考虑到任何物种都可能为人类社会提供有价值的服务，所以我们应该拯救每一个濒临灭绝的动植物物种。

### 文章解析与点评

本文是 GRE Issue 题库中为数不多的自然保护类的题目，另外一题是关于“是否要立法保护荒野区”。对于此类型的题目，我们最容易想到的思路是从自然保护与经济发展这两个角度出发，这自然是可以的，而且很容易就可以写出一篇 4 分的文章。但本文没有采取这种常规的思路，而是另辟蹊径，从理论和实践两个维度进行分析，并且引入了更加深层次的思考：如果物种的灭绝本身就是一个自然的过程，那人类还需要为之负责并拯救这些物种吗？

这其实是很深刻的一个问题，因为它根本上反映了人类究竟该如何评估自身在自然界中所处的位置，以及应该起到什么作用。如果我们认为人类是自然界的主宰，那么人类的地位高于其他物种也就需要考虑到其他物种的生死。相反，如果认可人类只是自然界中平等的一员，那么我们就无须为其他物种的自然灭绝而操心。本文就考虑了后面这一种观点，并将其作为一个很有力的敌方观点提出，即如果物种灭绝是自然过程，人类无须负责。这种观点当然在理论上有其合理性，但是本文马上从实践层面进行了反驳：首先，我们不一定能知道物种灭绝究竟是不是人类活动所致；其二，即便灭绝与我们真的无关，袖手旁观会不会让人们付出更多的代价。换言之，从务实的角度出发，我们还是应该要保护那些濒临灭绝的物种。

本文的新颖之处在于跳出了“保护环境就是保护自己”这种空泛的政治宣传式口号，而是用一个很深刻的敌方观点从客观上抬高了自身论证的高度，这样最终得出来的结论说服力自然更强。有人说“最好的敌人就是最好的朋友”，这篇文章则告诉我们想要拿高分，不妨从最有挑战的敌方观点下手。

137 Some people believe that the most important qualities of an effective teacher are understanding and empathy. Others believe that it is more important for teachers to be rigorous and demanding in their expectations for students.

Write a response in which you discuss which view more closely aligns with your own position and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should address both of the views presented.

Education has long been one of the hotly debated topics of societal issues. One question related to education asks what the most important quality of an effective teacher is. Two schools of thoughts present two contradicting views: the first claims that to be effective, teachers must be able to understand and feel empathy for their students, while the second states that the more important qualities of an effective teacher are rigorous and demanding in his or her expectation for students. The latter view more closely aligns with my own position on this issue, although I do not deny the importance of empathy. In other words, while it is certainly important for teachers to possess qualities like understanding and empathy, being able to be rigorous and demanding are the more important qualities to be an effective teacher.

To begin, admittedly teachers should learn to understand their students and be able to feel for them, for the reason that a child's development in school is not only intellectual and physical but also mental. If the teacher ignores the understanding and empathy for students, they could get lost and may not be able to follow the correct path. For example, in recent decades we have seen a number of tragic cases of school shooting committed by disgruntled and desperate students. The shooting suspects vary from high school teens to PhD candidates. Subsequent investigations revealed that such students do not feel welcomed at school and abandoned by their peers as well as their teachers. Had those teachers learnt to give the troubled students sufficient attention and cares, they would much be less likely to commit the crime. Therefore, since one of teachers' responsibilities is to promote students' mental health, qualities such as understanding and empathy are certainly important for teachers.

However, while it is important for teachers to learn to understand the students, it is not the decisive factor in evaluating a teacher's effectiveness. Instead, I argue that it is more important for teachers to be rigorous and demanding in the expectation of the students. Such expectations not only concern academic performance but are also related to becoming an independent individual capable of overcoming adversities. Regarding the expectations on academic performance, I feel the urge to point out that the practical purpose of education is to select talents from the young for the society. An example is that almost in every culture education is associated with certain forms of examination. While some may see exams as a mere way to test the performance of students, in reality they serve as a differentiating tool to classify different levels of learners. As a result, on an individual level, to

survive in future society it is necessary to stand out in the process of education. Teachers, on the other hand, have the responsibility to help the society identify talents and allow them to receive high-quality education. To fulfill this responsibility, it becomes apparent that teachers must set rigorous expectations for the students, a responsibility authorized by the very nature of education.

Furthermore, beyond the simple purpose of identifying talents, educators also have the responsibility to prepare the younger generation for embracing the challenges of the society. Compared to the ivory tower of campus, the society is a much harsher place. For instance, immediately after the announcement of the 2016 Presidential Election result in the USA, many students who support Hilary Clinton cannot accept the fact that Donald Trump had just won the election. Many of them had mental meltdown and just refused to believe in the reality. Obviously simple denial won't change what happened; what those students should do instead is to learn to face the challenges and adversities and eventually fight for change. Such an attitude cannot be gained unless teachers set up demanding expectations for the students. In fact, critics attribute the mental weakness of many of those aforementioned students to the lax style of teaching they receive in school, which essentially becomes a greenhouse that protects the students from the adversities in life.

To summarize, I acknowledge that teachers should possess qualities such as understanding and empathy, but it is more important for them to be rigorous and demanding in order to become effective. Here, the effectiveness can be evaluated in two parts: whether academically teachers are rigorous and demanding enough to identify talents, and whether students are challenged to become a mentally strong individual. (727 words)

**中文翻译**

长期以来，教育一直是社会热点问题之一。一个与教育有关的问题是，一名有成效的教师最重要的素质是什么。两个学派提出了两种相互矛盾的观点：第一种观点认为，要取得成效，教师必须能够理解并对学生有同理心；而第二种观点则认为，一位卓有成效的教师更重要的素质是对学生严格和苛刻。后一种观点更接近我自己在这个问题上的立场，尽管我并不否认移情的重要性。换言之，虽然教师具备理解力和同理心等素质当然很重要，但能对学生严格要求是成为一名高效教师更重要的素质。

首先，诚然教师应该学会理解他们的学生，并且能够感受到他们的情绪，因为孩子在学校的发展不仅是智力和身体上的，而且是精神上的。如果教师忽视了对学生的理解和同理心，他们可能会迷失方向，无法走上正确的道路。例如，在最近几十年里，我们看到了许多不幸的校园枪击案，这些案件是由心怀不满和绝望的学生所为。枪击案嫌疑人从中学生到博士生都有。随后的调查显示，这些学生在学校里并不受欢迎，被同龄人和教师抛弃。如果这些教师学会给予问题学生足够的关注和关心，他们就不太可能犯罪。因此，由于教师的责任之一是促进学生的心理健康发展，理解和移情等素质对教师来说无疑是重要的。

然而，虽然说教师要学会理解学生是很重要的，但这并不是评价教师有效性的决定性因素。相反，我认为对教师来说，更重要的是对学生未来发展期望有着严格的要求。这种期望不仅与学业成绩有关，而且与成为一个能够克服逆境的独立个体有关。关于对学业成绩的期望，我觉得有必要指出，教育的实际目的是为社会选拔青年人才。例如，几乎在每一种文化中，教育都与某种形式的考试有关。虽然有些人可能认为考试只是测试学生成绩的一种方式，但实际上，考试是区分不同水平的学生的一种工具。因此，在个体层面上，要在未来社会中生存，就必须在教育过程中脱颖而出。另一方面，教师有责任帮助社会识别人才，让他们接受高质量的教育。为了履行这一责任，显然教师必须对学生设定严格的期望，这是教育本质赋予的责任。

此外，除了选拔人才的简单目的外，教育工作者还有责任让年轻一代做好迎接社会挑战的准备。与校园的象牙塔相比，社会是一个更加严酷的地方。例如，2016 年美国总统大选结果公布后，许多支持希拉里·克林顿的学生无法接受唐纳德·特朗普刚刚赢得大选的事实。他们中的许多人精神崩溃，就是拒绝相信现实。显然，简单的否认并不能改变所发生的一切；相反，这些学生应该学会面对挑战和逆境，并最终为改变而奋斗。除非教师对学生提出高要求的期望，否则学生是不可能获得这种态度的。事实上，批评家将上述许多学生的心理弱点归因于他们在学校接受的松散的教学，这种教学实质上成为一个温室，保护学生免受生活中的不幸。

总而言之，我承认教师应该具备理解力和同情心等素质，但更重要的是他们必须有严格的要求才能有成效。在这里，有效性可以从两个方面来评估：一是在学术上，教师是否足够严格以识别人才；二是学生是否能够面对挑战，成长为一个有着坚强精神的个体。

### 文章解析与点评

教育类的题目是 GRE Issue 中非常喜欢考查的类别，围绕学生、教师、家长、学校乃至政府都可以设计出花样繁多的题目。这个题目讨论的是教师应该如何教学，当中提到了两种对立的观点：究竟是应该能理解学生、表达共情，还是要对学生严格要求、毫不留情（rigorous）。这两种立场反映了两种不同的教育理念，即教师是应该唱红脸为主，给学生提供鼓励式教育，还是应该唱黑脸为主，像“虎妈”那样提供严格的教育。本文选择了后一种观点（虽然认可同理心的重要性，并且在第一主旨段做出了让步），同时给出了两个理由。值得注意的是，这两个理由都根植于本文对于教育目的的定义。

教育的目的究竟是什么？我们的小孩为什么需要去学校进行统一的学习？这背后其实有着一套内在的逻辑，哪怕不是为了写 Issue 作文，这些问题也是值得我们去思考的——毕竟我们在学校学习了这么多年，考 GRE 是为了出国，还得再读几年。本文首先提出一个鲜明的观点：教育的目的（从社会整体的角度来看）其实是为了更好地选拔人才，这是因为我们人类社会本质上是“择优制度”（meritocracy）。而对人才的选拔，我们需要一个公平有效的方式，这就是考试。故而教育的目的实则就是提供一个公平的平台让学生的能力得以被评估。这也许听起来有一些铁面无情，但客观来说，教育的确起到了筛选人才的作用（想想我们经历的千军万马过独木桥的高考吧），所以教师作为筛选人才机制的一部分，需要强硬。另一方面，对于学生来说，教

育可以看作是他们进入复杂社会之前接受洗礼的过程。如果是这样的话，一个严师的好处就不言自明了——社会是残酷的，学生们需要在学校里就接受挫折教育，否则会成为温室里的花朵，在社会的大风大浪前不知所措。综上，按照题目所说对学生严格要求，既是为了学生好，也是出于整个社会利益的考量。

本文值得学习的地方在于对“教育的目的”进行的探讨。在 Issue 题目当中，不仅仅是教育类的题目，广泛深入挖掘题目内涵是一种提分手段。当然，读者不一定要认同本文对于教育的定义，但我们需要知道的是写文章的过程中可以这么做，而且这样做有好处。因此大家可以多思考诸如 “教育的目的是什么” “科学技术的目的是什么” “政府的目的是什么”这一类看起来很形而上的问题，思考这些问题会对大家的学术写作提升有显著帮助。

## 4 “敌方看法类” Direction

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim. In developing and supporting your position, **be sure to address the most compelling reasons and/or examples that could be used to challenge your position.**

**中文翻译**

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中讨论你在多大程度上同意或者不同意题目中的观点，解释你所采取的立场的理由。在发展和支持你的立场的过程中，**注意讨论那些可以被用来反驳你观点的有力理由和 / 或例子。**

**讲　解**

**这种 Direction 要求我们不仅阐明自己的观点，还要讨论那些可能被用来反对我们立场的观点。即，要提到“敌方”的观点。**

比如，针对题目“国家需要让全国学生在进入大学之前学习相同的课程”，如果我们的观点是“国家**不需要**让全国学生在进入大学之前学习相同的课程”，而这时所谓的“敌方观点”则是“国家**需要**让全国学生在进入大学之前学习相同的课程”。由此可以看出，“敌方观点”是什么这一问题是由**我们的观点**决定的，而不是由题目决定的。

对于这样一种 Direction，有以下几点需要注意：

① 我们建议大家针对一种敌方看法展开一段论证，至于全文要提到多少敌方看法，即写多少段，这个是无关紧要的。**但至少应该有一段是在讨论敌方看法。**

② 大多数考生在讨论敌方观点时是这样的：简略提到敌方观点，然后再驳倒。其实，这种写法往往很难写多。

针对这种 Direction，我们建议大家采用以下的思维模板进行思考：

**“敌方看法 + 我对敌方看法的分析 + 我对敌方看法的评价”**

从这个思维模板可以看出，我们不一定要反对敌方的看法，也可以承认其合理性，亦或是站在辩证的立场上，既反对又同意，甚至说敌方看法和我的看法在本质上是不矛盾的。另外，我们还应该在草率地对敌方看法做出评价之前，对其进行分析，分析对方为什么会反对我、他的出发点和依据是什么。这样的分析和评价过程，才会让我们对这种 Direction 照应得既饱满又深刻。大家可以详细参照对例题的解析。

### 讲解浓缩版

**参照思维模板提到敌方观点。**

### 学术写作拓展

在学术写作，或者在一次学术会议，甚至是班级讨论中，我们必然会遇到那些反对我们的声音。对于这些声音，我们不仅要坦然面对，还要对其进行深刻的分析和全面的评价。针对不同学科里的那些反对的声音，各科目的回应方式在细节上略有不同。但不论是什么专业的考生，都可以参照我们给出的思维模板，在 GRE 写作的备考中迈出第一步，为以后的学术写作奠定基础。

### 例题举证

Universities should require every student to take a variety of courses outside the student's field of study.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim. In developing and supporting your position, be sure to address the most compelling reasons and/or examples that could be used to challenge your position.

参考提纲如下：

**总立场：**不同意题目观点

**分论点 1**（我的看法）：学生精力不够，无法同时兼顾专业和专业外的学习。

**分论点 2**（我的看法）：如果贸然开设丰富多样的课程，学校的师资、物资可能捉襟见肘。

**分论点 3**（敌方看法）：有人可能会反对我的观点。他们认为：学生的确应该选择专业之外的课程（**对敌方看法的陈述**）。他们之所以这样认为，一来可能是因为希望学生拓宽知识面；另一方面可能是因为这样做能够让学生借鉴不同学科的方法论，从而加深对本专业知识的理解。（**对敌方看法的分析**）但是我认为，虽然这样的看法具有一定的合理性，但并非所有学生选择了课程就一定能认真听讲并且充分消化知识，最后做到灵活运用。而如果要中和两种看法的矛盾，我们可以为学生提供选修课的机会。（**对敌方看法的评价**）

分论点 1 和 2 都是“我的看法”，**而真正照应 Direction 要求的应该是分论点** 3。其实这里的分论点 3 已经不是提纲了，而我们之所以把这一点展开得如此详尽，是希望大家看到应该如何应用我们的思维模板。

在这一段中，我们不仅陈述了敌方看法，还分析了敌方为什么会有这样的看法，以及我们对敌方看法的评价。**考生应该尤其注意评价的部分**，因为我们不仅承认了敌方看法的合理性，也看到了其局限性，最后还提供了一种解决方法以解决敌方看法和我方看法的矛盾。这种思考模式就比大家之前的思考模式更全面，也更深刻。

## 题库范文

**88** To be an effective leader, a public official must maintain the highest ethical and moral standards.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim. In developing and supporting your position, be sure to address the most compelling reasons and/or examples that could be used to challenge your position.

Political pundits often debate what characteristics a political leader must have. Some argue that in order to be effective, a government official has to hold the highest ethical and moral standards so that they can amass enough followers to lead. Although this argument seems reasonable at first glance and can be supported with several examples, I do not think that sticking to the highest ethical and moral standards necessarily leads to an effective leader.

To begin with, those who underscore the importance of ethical and moral standards would claim that in order to become an effective leader, one has to demonstrate a personal charisma to attract followers. A corollary is that he or she must be morally sublime. Mohandas Gandhi for example is undeniably a great leader in Indian National Liberation Movement. His principle of non-violent disobedience not only laid the foundation of his struggle against the British colonial power but also inspired future national liberation movements across the globe. Some would argue that it was his high level of personal morality that drew millions of followers at home and abroad, while he was alive and after his passing away. His posthumous title “Mahatma”, which literally means “great-souled”, serves as a living proof of his reputational legacy.

That being said, I find the lines of reasoning and the example above not sufficiently convincing, because a high moral and ethical standard does not necessarily mean an effective leader. In the case of Mahatma Gandhi, I do not deny that Gandhi is characterized by a near perfect personality and extremely admirable moral principles, but it remains unproven that it is his very moral principles that made him widely revered by people around the world. Here, I venture to argue that admiration of Gandhi’s

morality is more directly related to the cause of Indian independence and his non-violent resistance. Moreover, his competence and success in uniting people in the Indian subcontinent also contributed to his esteemed reputation. The bottom line is that moral standards alone could not necessarily guarantee an effective leadership. The case of Emperor Wanli could serve as an appropriate example here. The 13th Emperor of the Ming dynasty held the supreme power for more than four decades, but despite his maintaining high ethical and moral principles in accordance with traditional Confucius teaching, little was achieved under his reign. Indeed, his indifference to political affairs is often thought to make possible the fight for power between different factions. This internal power struggle, originating from Wanli's ineffective leadership, ultimately led to the weakening of the Ming dynasty.

Finally, I would like to demonstrate that even if a public official does not hold the highest moral or ethical standards, he or she may still become an effective leader. For instance, Winston Churchill is well regarded as an effective leader for his contribution in leading the British people against the invasion of Nazi Germany. Yet from a personal perspective, Churchill was an imperialist who believed in the superiority of the white Anglo-Saxon people to other races. Such a blatant expression of racism would deprive him of any moral superiority, but it did not render him an effective leader. A similar example is Donald Trump, 45th President of the United States of America. Since his election bid, Trump has been surrounded by scandals, ranging from his racist and sexist remarks to allegations of sexual harassment. At any rate, it would be difficult to argue that Trump maintains the highest moral standards, but he did manage to execute several orders according to his conservative political vision. In the eyes of many conservative Republican voters, Trump may be the most effective president since Ronald Reagan. These two prominent political figures illustrate that admirable moral principles are not the requisite for an effective leader, because fundamentally speaking, the purpose of public officials is to serve the people that vote the leaders into office. If the officials succeeded in fulfilling the promise made to the voters, they could be viewed as effective.

To summarize, the existence of ineffective leaders sticking to rigorous moral principles and effective leaders with blemishes on their personalities argue against the notion that officials must hold the highest moral standards in order to be an effective leader. While for certain leaders—such as Gandhi—their effective leadership may seemingly arise from their impeccable moral records, there are still many other factors at play in determining leadership effectiveness. (731 words)

**中文翻译**

政治专家经常争论一个政治领导人必须具备什么样的特征。一些人认为，要想有成效，政府官员必须持有最高的伦理道德标准，这样他们才能聚集足够的追随者。虽然这一论点乍一看似乎是合理的，并且可以用几个例子来佐证，但我不认为一个领导者坚持最高的伦理道德标准就必然会卓有成效。

首先，那些强调伦理标准重要性的人会声称，要成为一个有成效的领导者，就必须表现出个人魅力来吸引追随者。一个推论就是他或她必须在道德上是高尚的。例如，莫罕达斯·甘地无疑是印度民族解放运动中的一位伟大领袖。他的非暴力不合作原则不仅奠定了他抗击英国殖民政权的基础，而且鼓舞了未来世界各地的民族解放运动。有人会说，正是他高水平的个人道德，在他生前和去世后吸引了国内外数以百万计的追随者。他死后的头衔“圣雄”，字面意思是“伟大的灵魂”，是他声誉的活生生的证明。

尽管如此，我发现上面的论证和例子还不够令人信服，因为一个领导者有很高的伦理道德标准并不一定意味着他或她就是有成效的。以圣雄甘地为例，我不否认甘地具有近乎完美的人格和极为令人钦佩的道德原则，但我们仍然无法证明，正是他的道德原则使他受到全世界人民的广泛尊敬。在这里，我冒昧地认为人们对甘地道德的敬仰更直接地与印度独立事业和他的非暴力抵抗有关。此外，他在团结印度次大陆人民方面的能力和成功也为他赢得了崇高的声誉。不论如何，仅靠保持道德标准不一定能保证有效的领导。万历皇帝可以作为一个适当的例子。作为明朝第 13 位皇帝，他的统治超过了四十年，尽管他按照孔子的传统教诲保持着高尚的伦理道德，但他的统治却成效甚微。事实上，他对政治事务的漠不关心常常被认为是不同派系之间争夺权力的可能原因。这种源于万历皇帝领导不力的内部权力斗争，最终导致了明朝的衰弱。

最后，我想证明，即使一个官员没有最高的伦理道德标准，他或她仍然可能成为一个卓有成效的领导者。例如，温斯顿·丘吉尔因领导英国人民反抗德国纳粹入侵而被公认为是一位卓有成效的领导人。然而从个人角度来看，丘吉尔是一个帝国主义者，他相信盎格鲁 - 萨克逊白人比其他种族优越。如此明目张胆地表达种族主义会使他丧失任何道德优越感，但这并不影响他卓有成效的领导。类似的例子是美国第 45 任总统唐纳德·特朗普。自竞选以来，特朗普被丑闻包围，从种族主义和性别歧视言论到性骚扰指控。无论如何，人们很难辩称特朗普保持着最高的道德标准，但他确实按照自己保守主义的政治理念成功地实施了几项政令。在许多保守的共和党选民看来，特朗普可能是继罗纳德·里根之后最有成效的总统。这两位著名的政治人物证明，令人钦佩的道德原则并不是成为一个有成效的领导人的必要条件，因为从根本上讲，公职人员的目标是为选民服务。如果官员们成功地履行了对选民的承诺，那他们就可以被视为是有成效的。

综上所述，坚持严格道德原则的无效领导者和人格上有缺陷的有效领导者的存在，与官员必须具备最高道德标准才能成为一名有效领导者的观念相矛盾。虽然对于某些领导人，如甘地，他们的有效领导似乎来自自身无懈可击的道德，但在决定领导效力方面还有许多其他因素在起作用。

### 文章解析与点评

本文是 GRE 最为经典的政治类 Issue 题之一。它看起来说的是道德准则的重要性，但实则更为深层次的话题是：一个有效的领导人到底需要什么品质。针对这个问题，我们的落脚点最终会变成什么是 effective，而为此我们必须要思考政府中领导的目的是什么。换言之，我们要思考的问题是“政府的目的是什么？”。

在本文中，第三主旨段的最后一句话点出了文章的核心思想：只要一个领导人能够履行对选民的承诺、并为他或她的选民服务，那么这个领导人就可以被认为是卓有成效的。这很明显是一种功利主义（utilitarianism）的思路，但笔者想为此找一些传统政治学理论上的背书。这篇文章背后的逻辑可以用卢梭《社会契约论》中的理论来解读。卢梭认为：政治的本质是当权者与公民之间的一种契约关系，这种契约的必要性源自个体的脆弱与低效和集体的强大与高效。在这个契约中，公民放弃了自身的一部分自由，并且赋予了当权者（政府）一定的权力。而相反，被公民赋权的政府则需要为公民服务，提供诸如国防、教育、医疗等公共服务。因此，如果政府和政治家能够完成其基本的义务，那就是其有效性的体现。值得注意的是，在政府所需要实现的目的中，拥有最高的道德准则本身并不是其中之一。尽管如同第一段所说，一个圣人的道德感召力会增强其领导力，但这种看法其实也默认了道德只是实现领导力的一个促进因素，而非领导力本身。这就是为什么可能会存在“道德感很高但无力的领导人”（第二主旨段）和“道德感很差但有效的领导人”（第三主旨段）。想清楚这一点或许就不难理解，为什么当下西方许多政治家在个人道德上不堪，但民众却依然买他们的账——原因就是选民在选举过程中更看重政治家能否为他们的利益服务。在道德主义者看来，这无疑会是令人万分沮丧的局面，但“也许这就是生活”，是一种更基于实用主义的政治哲学。

有了这些思考，本文的思路就呼之欲出了。要强调的是，本文举出了很多名人故事作为例证，这些需要日常生活当中的积累和有针对性的准备。另外，本文举了中国古代皇帝的例子，这对于外国人来说可能会比较陌生，因此在行文过程中一定要花额外的笔墨进行介绍。

**69** It is no longer possible for a society to regard any living man or woman as a hero.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim. In developing and supporting your position, be sure to address the most compelling reasons and/or examples that could be used to challenge your position.

Can any living man or woman be considered as a hero in our society today? For many the answer is negative, because media scrutiny can eventually diminish one's reputation. While I fully acknowledge the power of the media, I can neither fully agree with the claim nor the reasoning behind it. Instead, from my perspective it is still possible for a society to have living man or woman as a hero.

First, regarding the reasoning that media scrutiny will harm a hero's reputation, it is undeniably true that no one, even a hero, is perfect. As the adage goes, "To err is human", so it is understandable that heroes will have personal flaws. Sir Winston Churchill, the political leader who led the United Kingdom against Nazi Germany is a hero of his age in the eyes of British people. However, his bad temper is also well-known and exploited by his political adversaries through media. This is also true to business leaders such as Steve Jobs, the hero who led the revival of Apple and made it the most valuable

company in human history. Although Jobs is a genius in business decision, his reputation is also plagued by his bad temper and tainted private life in the past.

That being said, while it is true that no man is perfect, one critical assumption behind the claim and the reason is that media will dig into the personal imperfections of a hero and expose them to the public. Moreover, it is assumed that the public will see and accept the reporting. Both of the two assumptions, however, are problematic. First, it is questionable that the media will scrutinize all heroes under the microscope simply in hopes of finding their flaws so the heroes shall be struck down, because the resources for a media outlet is inherently limited. There is a fixed amount of manpower and time that can be committed, and one has to question what priority the media has.

Meanwhile, readers also have a limited amount of mental resource that can be allocated to certain stories. Nowadays with the explosion of information, it has become increasingly difficult to grab the attention of the readership. As a consequence, even if some media indeed pursue heroes and publish reports that could adversely impact heroes' reputation, the magnitude and the scale of the impact remains uncertain. What is more, a concerning observation of the past years is that the credibility of media has been in steady decline. In the United States, for example, Republican voters have little faith in left-leaning media such as CNN and *Washington Post*, whereas Democratic voters regard Fox News as a mouthpiece of the Republican Party. The increasing distrust in media means that even if people see a damaging piece of information about a hero, they may not accept or believe it.

Finally, even if we acknowledge the possibility that media exposure of one's flaws does diminish one's reputation, he or she may still be called heroes. To understand the reason, we must look back and consider what makes a hero in the first place. To become a hero, one must possess outstanding traits and/or have remarkable achievements that no other people have. Those are the defining characters of a hero. Even if the image of a hero is tarnished by media scrutiny, as long as his or her achievements still stand, people can still consider him or her to be a hero. For example, despite Churchill's bad temper, people during WWII and even today still admired him for his courage and persistence that eventually won the war. A similar imperfect but still heroic figure is Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., who led the United States' Civil Rights movement in the mid-20th century. No one would deny Dr. King being a true hero for African Americans, a reputation which his sexual scandals and anti-gay attitudes did not and do not invalidate.

To summarize, while I agree that no one is perfect and the media can expose the dark side of a hero and diminish one's reputation, heroes are made because of their superior personal qualities and/or applaudable achievements. In this light, it is entirely possible for the society to regard someone as a hero today despite their personal flaws. (709 words)

中文翻译

在当今社会，我们还可以把任何在世的男人或女人视为英雄吗？对于许多人来说，答案是否定的，因为媒体的审查最终会削弱一个人的声誉。虽然我非常认可媒体的力量，但我不能完全同意这种说法和其背后的理由。相反，在我看来，一个社会中在世的男人或女人仍然有可能成为英雄。

首先，关于媒体审查会损害英雄声誉，一个无可否认的理由是没有人，甚至是英雄，是完美的。正如谚语所说，“人都会犯错”，我们可以理解为即使是英雄也会有缺点。温斯顿·丘吉尔爵士是一位带领英国对抗纳粹德国的政治领袖，在英国人眼里，他是那个时代的英雄。然而，他的坏脾气也是众所周知的，他的政治对手通过媒体利用了这一点。像史蒂夫·乔布斯这样的商界领袖也有这种情况。乔布斯引领了苹果的复兴，使其成为人类历史上最有价值的公司。尽管乔布斯在商业决策方面是个天才，但他的坏脾气和过去的不良私生活也让他的声誉受到了损害。

虽然没有人是完美的，但这一说法和其理由背后的一个关键假设是，媒体会挖掘英雄的个人缺陷，并将其暴露在公众面前。此外，这个假设也认为公众会看到并接受媒体的报道。然而，这两个假设都是有问题的。首先，值得怀疑的是，媒体会在显微镜下仔细审视所有英雄人物，只希望找到他们的缺点，从而打倒他们，因为媒体的资源本来就有限。媒体可以投入的人力和时间是固定的，人们不得不质疑媒体优先要做什么事。

同时，读者能够分配给某些故事的注意力是有限的。在信息爆炸的今天，媒体越来越难以吸引读者的注意。因此，即使一些媒体确实在追踪英雄人物，发表可能对英雄声誉造成负面影响的报道，但这种影响的大小和规模仍然是不确定的。更值得注意的是，在过去的几年里，媒体的公信力在稳步下降。以美国为例，共和党选民对 CNN 和《华盛顿邮报》等左倾媒体信任不足，而民主党选民则把福克斯新闻视为共和党的喉舌。民众对媒体越来越不信任意味着，即使人们看到了一条有损于英雄的信息，他们也可能不会接受或相信。

最后，即使我们承认媒体曝光一个人的缺点确实会损害一个人的声誉，但他或她仍然可以被称为英雄。要理解这个原因，我们必须回首过去，思考是什么造就了英雄。要成为英雄，一个人必须具备别人所没有的优秀品质，或者卓越的成就。这些都是英雄的典型特征。即使英雄的形象被媒体审查玷污了，只要他或她的成就依然存在，人们仍然可以认为他或她是英雄。例如，尽管丘吉尔脾气暴躁，人们在“二战”期间甚至在如今仍然钦佩他赢得战争的勇气和毅力。马丁·路德·金博士也是一位不完美但仍然有英雄气概的人物，他在 20 世纪中叶领导了美国的民权运动。没有人会否认金博士是非裔美国黑人的真正英雄，他的性丑闻和反同性恋的态度在过去和现在都没有使这个名声失效。

总而言之，虽然我同意没有人是完美的，媒体可以揭露英雄的阴暗面，贬损一个人的声誉，但英雄的产生是因为他们有卓越的个人品质，或值得称赞的成就。从这个角度来看，尽管一个人有缺陷，但当今社会完全有可能将这个人视为英雄。

**文章解析与点评**

在 GRE 题库中，关于英雄一共出现了两个 prompt，本题是其中之一，另一题是“研究一个社会的最有效方法是去研究该社会所认定的英雄男女”。回答这两个问题最简单有效的方法就是，思考英雄为何成为英雄。从我们身边的例子就不难想到，英雄的存在是因为他们身上所具有的某些品质是社会稀缺的、积极向上的。注意社会并没有要求英雄各个方面都完美无缺，因此只要英雄的那些“决定性品质”（defining characteristics）存在，英雄就不会消亡。这构成了本文的基础，大家不妨也尝试用上述的思路去写另外一道英雄的 Issue 题。

回到本文，一般来说，这个题目如果想拿 4 分，那只需要说两个主旨段即可：一是承认英雄越来越少，作为让步段；二是反驳“再无英雄”这一理论——这里只需举出现实中的英雄例子即可。这样的回答看起来逻辑完备，但还是缺乏足够的深度。在本文中，我们将敌方观点进行了更为深入和全面的思辨，将“媒体的曝光会影响英雄的声誉”拆成了两个问题：“媒体曝光真的能影响英雄声誉吗？”和“就算影响了，真的会让英雄跌落神坛吗？”第二个问题的回答是否定的，在开头我们已经说过了，原因是只要“决定性品质”不破，英雄就依然会存在。本文更值得玩味和学习的论证是第二和第三主旨段，它们提出了这两个问题：在如今资讯爆炸的年代，精力有限的媒体会不会去深挖英雄的黑料？就算有关于英雄的新闻，民众对于媒体的态度会如何？从这两个角度出发，对让步段进行更为深层次的反驳，会比只写现在的第四主旨段让文章更为深刻，论证更加让人信服。

本文还展现了这样一个现象：证伪一个问题比证明一个问题更加容易。这是由证明和证伪的内在逻辑决定的——证伪只需要一个反例。从写文章的角度来说，驳斥一个观点也比证明一个观点更加精彩。从这个意义上来说，该 Issue 题目的 direction 中要求我们考虑敌方观点，我们不仅仅是在逻辑上需要更加全面，更不妨将其视作是一种华丽的、更有戏剧性的论证技巧。

**1** Universities should require every student to take a variety of courses outside the student's field of study.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim. In developing and supporting your position, be sure to address the most compelling reasons and/or examples that could be used to challenge your position.

After undergoing a marathon journey from primary to high school and then to university, students are confronted by another dilemma: how to strike a balance between their majors and courses in other fields. A similar quandary must have perplexed educators for decades as they grappled with designing university courses. While at first glance it may seem appealing to require students to take various courses outside of their fields of study, I remain doubtful of such a proposal. If we hastily carry out the advice, it would probably jeopardize education's purpose of facilitating students' well-roundedness.

Advocates of this claim will reject my position. They may argue that knowledge gained from other fields contributes to innovative approaches to understanding the majors. The blending of different methodologies from various fields exemplifies this argument. For supporting examples, we can no further turn to the cooperation of linguistics and literature and the combination of math and economics. What bind these pairs are similar methodologies. By transferring a methodology from one field to another, students are able to understand the essence of both fields and this leads to the emergence of creative ideas and more profound understanding. However, not all fields relate as readily as the aforementioned pairs, so we cannot expect to apply principles from any field to another. Therefore, only when the courses share similar methodological principles can the author's recommendation come into effect.

Opposition to my argument also comes from current students' limited range of knowledge and narrow horizons. From this point of view, university students should be equipped with holistic capabilities in diverse fields so that they can better accustom themselves to diverse work in the future. In modern society, we are not surprised to encounter a professional lawyer who excels at public speaking; nor will it shock us when a mathematician assumes the role of a philosopher. An abundance of these generalists demonstrates the very advantage of a mastery of comprehensive skills and expertise. Nevertheless, I argue that generalists choose to be excellent, but are not required to be. It is their insatiable desire for knowledge that drives them to conquer new fields one after another, and it is their proficiency in the previous fields that enables them to excel in the new ones. Students nowadays are exceedingly short of time and universities should foster, in most circumstances, specialists rather than generalists. Consequently, while we welcome generalists, it might be more reasonable if we step back from the decision requiring students to choose courses in various disciplines, and adopt an alternative policy: encourage them to take extra courses and do whatever we can to facilitate this process.

Although I maintain that encouraging course selection may function better than a mandatory requirement, some people may dispute my position. They claim that the latter overshadows the former in terms of efficiency, since sluggishness is human nature and it is only through compulsory course requirements that students will really make progress in their major fields. The beginning of every course, they argue, inevitably stumbles on questioning and even emphatic repudiation; however, such questioning and repudiation will be followed by subsequent acceptance and students will quickly absorb new knowledge. Consistent might this claim appear with the reality, I tend to say that students do not learn for the sake of learning, and instead they learn in order to pass tests. Whatever form is used to test students, be it an exam, a paper submission or group work, students always tend to focus on the test itself, but not on the accumulation of knowledge. Without adjusting students' attitude towards learning, the introduction of various new courses will remain well-intentioned but will inevitably result in a meaningless struggle against the exam-oriented education system.

Taking extra courses outside one's original field goes far beyond the decision of whether or not to take them, but raises more fundamental and far-reaching issues. We may tentatively implement the issue's recommendation, but a complete change in the design of university courses requires more careful consideration. (662 words)

**中文翻译**

从小学到中学再到大学，在经历完这一段马拉松式的艰辛旅程之后，学生们遇到了另一个难题：如何在本专业与非专业课程之间寻得平衡。几十年来，类似的困境也让那些设计大学课程的教育工作者感到纠结不已。尽管乍看之下，要求学生选修各类非专业课程显得格外诱人，但我却对这个建议持怀疑态度。如果贸然推行这条建议，那么我们将很可能破坏教育的初衷——促进学生的综合发展。

这条建议的拥护者可能会反对我的观点。他们也许认为，从其他专业获得的知识能够为学生深入理解其专业贡献新的途径。各领域的方法论的综合似乎能够佐证这一观点。其中，最为恰当的例子莫过于语言学与文学的穿插、数学与经济学的交织。相似的方法论将这些组合成功联结起来。通过将一个领域中的方法论转移到另一个领域，学生们能够同时理解这两个领域的精髓，并在此基础上进一步催生各类新颖的观点以及更为深刻的理解。然而，并非所有领域都如前面列举的组合那般紧密相连，我们不能期望任何领域之间的原理都能相互适用。因此，只有在方法论原理近似的科目之间，作者的建议才能产生实际意义。

反对我的观点还可能会提到：当今学生的有限知识与狭窄视角。从这个角度来看，大学生确实应该具备多种领域的综合能力，以便于他们未来能够更好地适应各种工作。在现代社会，如果遇到一名职业律师精通公开演讲，我们不会感到惊讶；同样，如果看到数学家能像哲学家一样思考，我们也不会诧异。大量的通才向我们反复证明掌握多门技巧和专长的益处。然而，我认为通才的产生是自行选择的结果，而非强制要求使然。正是由于知识本身永不满足的欲望，使其能够不断征服新的领域；也正是因为对前一领域知识的精通，帮助其在后续领域中占据优势。当今学生的时间已然十分有限，在大部分情况下，大学应该培养专才而非通才。因此，尽管欢迎通才，但更为合理的做法是：我们放弃要求学生选修大量非专业课程的决定，转而采取另一条政策：鼓励学生选修非专业课程，并尽一切可能帮助他们加速成为通才。

尽管我认为鼓励而非强制学生选课会达到更好的效果，但有人可能会站出来反对我的观点。从效率来看，他们认为后者明显强于前者，因为懒惰是人类的天性，所以只有通过强制选课，学生们才能在其本专业领域取得进步。他们可能相信，一开始这些课程会不可避免地遭到学生们的质疑甚至怨怼；但是，这样的质疑或斥责将逐渐被接纳所取代，随后学生将开始迅速吸收新的知识。然而在我看来，与这条建议更为相符的现实是：学生并不会为了学习而学习；相反，会为了通过考试而学习。不论以任何形式出现的考试：测验、个人作业或者小组作业，学生们总是会注重测试本身，而非任何知识上的积累。如果不对学生们的学习态度进行调整，而贸然引入各类非专业课程，那么此举只能停留在好心办坏事的层面，并最终使学生身陷以考试为导向的教育系统中，做着毫无意义的挣扎。

选修非专业课程，其探讨意义已经超出了是否应该这样做，进而牵涉到了更为根本且深刻的问题。我们可以试探性地尝试题干所给出的建议，但对大学课程设计进行彻底的修改，仍需要我们更为妥帖的考量。

### 文章解析与点评

这篇文章很好地回答了一个被经常问到的问题：面对“敌方看法（他人看法）”类的Direction，我们需要用多少篇幅去写那些反对我们立场的观点？

将本文与其他两篇敌方看法类的文章相结合，我们可以得出结论：面对敌方看法类的Direction，我们少则用一段，多则可以用三段（假设中间段有三段）来讨论敌方看法。

也因为这篇文章的中间段三段都在照应Direction，这也给我们提供了很好的思维模板和语言素材。比如，在陈述敌方看法时，这三段分别用了这样的句式：

1. Advocates of this claim will reject my position. They may argue that...
2. Opposition to my argument also comes from...
3. Although I maintain that..., some people may dispute my position.

而每一个中间段在陈述了他人看法之后，还对他人看法做了进一步的分析和评价，这些部分的内容和语言也值得大家学习。

另外值得一提的是本文的观点。在面对“大学是否应该要求学生选修多种多样的课”这一话题时，同意这个建议的考生最容易想到的观点是“多样的课程能拓宽学生的视野，增强他们的综合素质”；而反对者最容易诉诸的观点则是“学生没时间，精力不够”。这些观点不是不可以，只是很多考生都写，便很难出彩了。而这篇文章给大家提供了一些新的思路，如：

1. 学习其他课程可能会加深对本专业知识的理解，但这仅局限于方法论相似而且可以互相借鉴的学科。
2. 大学不排斥通才，但更应该培养专才。
3. 当学生被要求选很多课时，他们看似学到了很多知识，但只是在应付考试而已。

**135** We learn our most valuable lessons in life from struggling with our limitations rather than from enjoying our successes.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the claim. In developing and supporting your position, be sure to address the most compelling reasons and/or examples that could be used to challenge your position.

Our life is filled with successes, failures, and constant struggles in between. From what do we learn our most valuable lessons in life? Although some may proclaim that it is the success that teaches us the most valuable lessons, I feel that the struggle with our limitations also gives rise to some of the best

lessons in life. More broadly speaking, valuable lessons can come from many occasions, so it may be an over simplistic view that the most valuable lessons only come from one specific type of personal experience.

To begin with, those endorsing the importance of successes would argue that the success can boost our confidence. The excitement and enjoyment of success would reinforce and provide a positive feedback to our good behaviors and make us more likely to succeed in the future. For example, it is commonly considered a success to earn a prestigious scholarship for a student, which will earn him or her fame and monetary support. By rewarding him or her the scholarship, the student learns that hard work and diligence pays off. This is certainly a valuable lesson that would benefit the student's future endeavors as well. At the same time, experiences from the previous success could potentially lead to more future triumphs. An example is in competitive sports, where the most important lessons often emerge when the player or the team finally defeat the opponents. Not only could the confidence be boosted, but the player will also be able to remember what tactics make the success possible and therefore extend the winning spree into the future.

Now let's look at the struggles with our limitations. From my point of view, the most valuable lessons learnt are more likely coming from struggles and sufferings. The reasons are at least two-fold. First, human beings are far more sensitive to pains and struggles than to joys. This, some evolutionary psychologists argue, is rooted in our DNA because it is almost inevitable for ancient humans to pay extra attention to negative experiences. After all, in a harsh environment, the likelihood of survival depends on one's ability to perceive and avoid danger. In other words, our ancestors were forced to develop a heightened sense of potential threats. The consequence of this evolutionary preference is that modern humans pay more attention to their struggles and failures than to successes. Hence, the most valuable lessons are more likely to originate from such struggles because of the additional attention they receive. Second, from struggles and failures we are more likely to identify what goes wrong, which could become precisely the valuable lesson we need to learn. The disaster of space shuttle *Challenger* taught us the fragility of polymers and it is through this hard-learned lesson that the future safety of space programs can be improved. Similar examples abound in our society today where innovators constant try and fail. Through those struggles with our limitations, we—not only as individuals but also as a collective group—learn most valuable lessons.

Finally, it should be noted that the most valuable lessons are not limited to one's personal successes and struggles. A book, a movie, or even a conversation with a sage could become the most valuable lesson. To understand why, one has to take a step back and consider what valuable lessons really mean. Lessons are something previously unknown but to be learned from an experience. Their values are not determined by the nature of the experience, but by their influence on the individual. In this light, it becomes self-explanatory why both successes and struggles as discussed above can bring the most

valuable lessons: successes boost confidence and struggles lead to vigilance. It could also explain why Liu Bei, emperor of the Shu dynasty in the Three Kingdoms era, remarked that his most important lessons in life came from his multiple visits to invite Zhuge Liang to join his forces as chief strategist. It was Zhuge's brainpower that helped Liu Bei found the Kingdom of Shu. This monumental visit by Liu Bei was neither an apparent success nor a life-or-death struggle, but an informative conversation that shed light on the Liu's future path to power.

To sum up, although in some cases successes bring positive experiences that are extremely valuable, the most valuable lessons are not limited to struggles and failures because what truly matters is what can be learned from the lessons. In other words, the most valuable lessons can come in the form of a success story, a personal suffering, or even a simple conversation. (753 words)

**中文翻译**

我们的生活充满了成功、失败和不断的奋斗。我们从什么中学到人生中最宝贵的一课？虽然有些人可能会说，成功给我们上了最宝贵的一课，但我觉得，在与自己的局限做斗争的过程中我们也会获得一些最好的经验。更广泛地说，有价值的经验教训可以来自许多情况，因此认为最有价值的经验教训只来自一种特定的个人经历，可能是一种过于简单化的观点。

首先，那些赞同成功重要性的人会说成功可以增强我们的信心。成功带来的兴奋和快乐会加强我们的良好行为并提供积极的反馈，这使我们更有可能在未来取得成功。例如，通常人们认为学生获得著名奖学金是一种成功，因为这将为他或她赢得声誉和金钱。学校通过授予他或她奖学金，让这个学生明白努力和勤奋会得到回报。这无疑是一个宝贵的经验，它将有利于学生今后继续努力。同时，以往成功的经验可能会带来更多的未来胜利。例如在竞技体育中，当运动员或团队最终击败对手时，最重要的教训往往会出现。运动员的信心得到了增强，而且他们也将会记住什么战术使得他们成功，从而将胜利的狂喜延续到未来。

现在让我们来考虑我们与自身局限斗争的问题。在我看来，最有价值的经验教训更可能来自斗争和痛苦。原因至少有两个。首先，人类对痛苦和斗争的敏感度远远高于对快乐的敏感度。一些进化心理学家认为，这源于我们的 DNA，因为古人几乎不可避免地会对负面经历给予额外的关注。毕竟，在恶劣的环境中，生存的可能性取决于一个人感知和避免危险的能力。换言之，我们的祖先被迫对潜在的威胁产生了高度的感知。这种进化偏好的结果是，现代人更关注他们的斗争和失败，而不是成功。因此，最有价值的教训更有可能来自这种斗争，因为它们得到了更多的注意。第二，从斗争和失败中，我们更有可能发现哪里出了问题，这可能恰恰成为我们需要吸取的宝贵教训。“挑战者号”航天飞机的灾难让我们认识到了聚合物的脆弱性，正是通过这一惨痛教训，未来太空项目的安全性才能得到改善。类似的例子在我们当今社会中比比皆是，创新者们在不断地尝试和失败。通过与自身局限性的斗争，我们不仅作为个人，而且作为一个集体，吸取了最宝贵的教训。

最后，应该指出的是，最有价值的教训并不局限于个人的成功和奋斗。一本书、一部电影，甚至与一位智者的对话都可能带给我们最有价值的一课。为了理解原因，我们必须退后一步，思考有价值的经验教训到底意味着什么。经验教训是过去未知的但要从经历中吸取的东西。它们的价值不是由经验的性质决定的，而取决于它们对个人的影响。鉴于此，上文所讨论的为什么成功和奋斗都能带来最有价值的教训就不言而喻了：成功能增强信心，而奋斗能提高警惕。这也可以解释为什么三国时期的蜀王刘备说，他一生中最重要的一课是三顾茅庐邀请诸葛亮作为总战略家。正是诸葛亮的聪明才智帮助刘备建立了蜀国。刘备这一意义深远的拜访，既不是表面上的成功，也不是一场生死搏斗，而是一次内容丰富的对话，它为刘备未来的权力之路指明了方向。

综上所述，虽然在某些情况下，成功带来了极其宝贵的积极经验，但最有价值的教训并不局限于斗争和失败，因为真正重要的是人们可以从中吸取什么教训。换言之，最有价值的教训可以是一个成功的故事、一个人的痛苦经历，甚至是一段简单的对话。

### 文章解析与点评

这是一个很有思辨性的题目，它表面上问的是人类从成功中还是从奋斗中学到得更多，但更加深层次的问题是，人类通过什么途径去认识这个世界给人的印象最为深刻。虽然题目给出了两种选择——正面的与负面的——但在日常生活当中，不是所有的事情都有黑白对错，因此要想拿高分，就一定要跳出题目所预设的框架。如果我们仅仅在这个框架内部描述正面的成功和负面的挣扎对于人的意义，那文章最多只能得 5 分。

不过，虽然说最终要跳出这个框架，但要写出 6 分的文章，我们首先必须把这个框架给捋清楚。在成功和挣扎两者之间，笔者认为挣扎是更能让人类学习的东西。中文当中把 lesson 除了翻译成“课”“经验”之外，还有一个意思叫“教训”，也就是那些值得引起后人警惕的负面事件。从它带有倾向性这一点我们不难看出，人类对于负面的东西印象更为深刻。正如本文所举的航天飞机的例子，人们可能记不住航天飞机有多少次成功的发射，但永远会记得“挑战者号”和“哥伦比亚号”航天飞机的悲剧事故。这似乎是人类的本性，从进化心理学的角度来说也可以找到理论支撑，我们在第二主旨段已经进行了详尽的分析。

但真正让本文出彩的还是第三主旨段的分析。其中我们不再把 lesson 的定义限定于那些负面的东西；相反我们将其定义为一个需要通过特定过程被我们获取的信息。因为信息本身是中立的，所以我们就不用强调教训自身的负面属性。因此这个时候我们便可以说，既然对于信息本身我们已经没有了正负偏好，那么任何途径获取的信息都可能是有价值的。在这里，对 lesson 一词下定义非常重要，这种我们反客为主，主动把话语权掌握在自己手中的做法，值得大家学习模仿。

## 5 “建议类”Direction（一）

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the recommendation and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, describe **specific circumstances** in which adopting the recommendation **would or would not be advantageous** and explain how these examples shape your position.

### 中文翻译

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中讨论你在多大程度上同意或者不同意题目中的建议，解释你所采取的立场的理由。在发展和支持你的立场的过程中，描述一下你认为这个建议**有利或者不利的具体情况**，并且解释这些情况如何影响你的立场。

### 讲　解

这种 Direction 对应的题目都是一条建议。Direction 要求我们讨论这条建议在什么时候有利（advantageous），什么时候不利（not advantageous）。很多考生在写这类题目的时候，谈了很多该建议的“必要性”“紧迫性”“充分性”等。然而，我们只有在谈论建议所产生的结果之时，才会用“有利”或“不利”来形容。**因此，这种 Direction 其实是要求我们谈谈在什么情况下，该建议会产生什么样的结果。所以，如果一旦偏离“结果”的范畴，我们也就偏离了 Direction 的要求。**

### 讲解浓缩版

**讨论什么情况下会产生什么有利或不利的结果。**

### 学术写作拓展

在谈论一个建议时，我们不能只是单纯地谈论我们对它或推崇或抵制的态度，而应该列举出具体的情况，说明这个建议在该情况下会带来什么样的结果，这样才能以理服人。在学术写作中，我们也会遇到各种各样的研究方法和理论。同样的，我们不能单纯地对某个理论示以好恶，而应该说明这个理论在什么样的情况之下会带来什么样的结果，而正是这些或好或坏的结果决定了我们在研究中是否应采用这种理论或者方法论。这样的启示也适用于下一条 Direction。

### 例题举证

A nation should require all of its students to study the same national curriculum until they enter college.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the recommendation and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, describe specific circumstances in which adopting the recommendation would or would not be advantageous and explain how these examples shape your position.

参考提纲如下：

**总立场**：有保留地同意题目观点

**分论点 1**（题目建议会带来的有利结果）：全国学生学习一套课程，可以保证考试内容相同，这样更方便高校录取人才，促进教育公平。

**分论点 2**（题目建议会带来的有利结果）：全国学生学习一套课程，方便教师的培训和备课。这就客观促进了教师资源的可流动性，方便不同地区间教师的相互补给。

**分论点 3**（题目建议会带来的不利结果）：全国学生学习一套课程，可能导致区域间的多样性匮乏，学生千人一面，缺少个性。

分论点 1 和 2 是在讨论题目中建议有利的情况，分论点 3 是在讨论不利的情况。而不论是哪一个分论点，都紧紧扣住了题目中建议可能产生的“结果”，也因此很好地照应了 Direction 的要求。

## 题库范文

49 People should undertake risky action only after they have carefully considered its consequences.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the recommendation and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, describe specific circumstances in which adopting the recommendation would or would not be advantageous and explain how these examples shape your position.

Commercial catchphrases like “Just do it” and “Impossible is nothing” have dominated almost every media platform ranging from newspapers to mobile phone screens. These well-written slogans aim at encouraging people to be brave enough to take risks without giving a second thought to their possible outcome. However, I argue that most of the times people should indeed go through serious and thorough considerations about the potential outcomes before taking a risky action. The only exception is urgent cases where time is critical and fast action is a necessity. In such specific scenarios such as wars and

natural disasters, people should act first even without considering the possible consequences.

To begin with, I concede that in a situation where time and speed are critical, a careful thought about the consequences in advance would not be desirable because of the urgent nature of the issue. In such cases, time itself is a precious resource we ought to factor in when making decisions. In other words, taking too much time to carefully consider the consequences itself may lead to even more negative outcomes. In the battlefield for instance, if a commander cannot decisively take risky action, his army would perish in a blitzkrieg. For example, Marcus Luttrell, an Afghan war veteran in US elite special forces, writes in his firsthand battlefield account *Lone Survivor* that the field commander must have a keen intuition to determine the next step. Because the battlefield situation is evolving by every minute, there is simply no time or reason for careful consideration of an order. A similar case is natural disaster rescue, in which every second counts in saving lives. Just like any action in a war, a decision in such rescue missions is inherently dangerous because it could be a life-or-death choice. If the search-and-rescue team spends too much time in pondering possible outcomes, people could have died by the time the deliberation had concluded.

However, when there is ample time for preparation, a second thought before taking risks can significantly reduce unnecessary harms and losses, because careful consideration of the consequences would lead to better preparation. The example of the famous mountaineer David Lama could lend strong support to my argument. Not fully prepared, he failed thrice to climb the Himalaya Mountains. The failure resulted from a lack of properly consideration of the consequences of being at extreme high elevation and in harsh climate: he neither had enough oxygen supply with him nor the physical stamina demanded by climbing. In 2018, however, after re-evaluating the whole venture and making proper preparations accordingly, Lama finally achieved his goal in reaching the top of the 6907-meter-high Lunag Ri peak. Lama's story, along with the successes and failures of many other mountaineers, demonstrates the necessity of carefully considering a risky action's consequences before undertaking it.

Of course, some may disagree with my statement above and argue that careful considerations of risky action are only possible when one is dealing with relatively simple and straightforward issues. In knotty situations, they claim, people cannot and should not consider the consequences of their risky actions because the complexity involved. While this logic appears reasonable at first glance, there is a fatal assumption underlying the lines of reasoning here. That is, it is assumed that complexity equals inscrutability, which I cannot agree. From my point of view, a complicated issue can still be broken down into a series of smaller and simpler steps, whose consequences can and should be studied and evaluated. For example, although the stock market is commonly perceived as an extremely intricate and risky system, people can still persistently make money out of this seemingly overwhelming entanglement. The secret to the success of Ray Dalio and his 120-billion-dollar Bridgewater hedge fund is to decompose the complex stock market as a whole to smaller, more fragmented elements,

including long-term economic outlook, mid-term profitability of the industry, and short-term investor mentality. Then, the consequences of every investment action can be evaluated by those more specific metrics. Therefore, the statement of undertaking risky actions only after a careful consideration of its consequence still stands firm in more complicated occasions.

To recap, while in some extreme cases time is a precious resource we cannot afford to spend too much on the evaluation of consequences, I to a large extent agree with the statement that people should consider the consequences of their risky action before undertaking it. (733 words)

**中文翻译**

流行广告语像“只管去做吧”和“一切皆有可能”的句子几乎占据了从报纸到手机屏幕等各个媒体平台。这些精心写就的广告语旨在鼓励人们勇于冒险，而根本不用考虑后果。然而，我认为大多数时候人们在做有风险的事情之前，确实应该对潜在的后果进行一番认真和彻底的思考。唯一的例外是时间紧迫、必须迅速采取行动的紧急情况。在战争和自然灾害等具体情况下，人们应该先行动起来，甚至不考虑可能的后果。

首先，我承认在时间和速度至关重要的情况下，由于问题的紧迫性，事先仔细考虑后果是不可取的。在这种情况下，时间本身就是一种宝贵的资源，我们在做决定时应该考虑进去。换言之，花太多时间仔细考虑后果本身可能会导致更负面的结果。例如，在战场上，如果指挥官不能果断地采取冒险行动，他的军队就会在闪电战中灭亡。例如，美国精锐特种部队的阿富汗战场老兵马库斯·卢特雷尔在其根据亲身战地经历写就的《孤独幸存者》中说道，野战指挥官必须有敏锐的直觉来决定下一步行动。因为战场形势每时每刻都在变化，根本没有时间和理由仔细考虑命令。一个类似的例子是自然灾害救援，每一秒对于拯救生命都至关重要。就像战争中的任何行动一样，在这种救援任务中做出决定本身就是危险的，因为这可能是一个生死攸关的选择。如果搜救小组花太多时间思考可能的结果，那么在商议结束时，救援对象可能已经死亡了。

然而，当我们有足够的时间做准备时，在冒险之前再三考虑可以大大减少不必要的伤害和损失，因为对于后果的认真考虑可以让人做出更充分的准备。著名登山运动员大卫·拉马的例子可以有力地支持我的论点。由于没有充分准备，他三次都没能爬上喜马拉雅山。这些失败是因为他没有认真考虑极端高海拔和恶劣气候会产生的后果：他既没有足够的氧气供应，也没有攀登所需的体力。然而，2018 年，拉马在重新评估了整个过程并做好了相应的准备后，终于实现了登顶 6907 米高的卢纳格里峰的目标。拉马的故事，以及许多其他登山者的成败，都表明了在进行冒险行动之前仔细考虑后果的必要性。

当然，有些人可能不同意我上文的说法，认为只有在处理相对简单和直截了当的问题时，才有可能仔细考虑风险。他们声称，在棘手的情况下，人们不能也不应该考虑他们冒险行为的后果，因为这涉及复杂度的问题。虽然这种逻辑乍一看似乎是合理的，但在这里的推理过程中有一个致命的假设。也就是说，假设复杂性等于不可测性，这一点我不能同意。在我看来，一

个复杂的问题仍然可以分解成一系列更小、更简单的步骤，其后果可以而且应该得到研究和评估。例如，虽然股票市场通常被认为是一个极其复杂和风险极高的系统，但人们仍然可以持续地从这个看起来非常复杂的系统中赚钱。瑞·达利欧及其价值 1200 亿美元的桥水对冲基金成功的秘诀在于，将复杂的股市整体分解为更小、更分散的元素，包括长期经济前景、行业中期盈利能力和短期投资者的心态。然后，每个投资行为的后果都可以通过这些更具体的指标来评估。因此，在更复杂的情况下，谨慎考虑后果后才采取冒险行动的说法仍然站得住脚。

回顾前文，虽然在某些极端情况下，时间是一种宝贵的资源，我们无法承担花费太多时间分析影响而产生的后果，但我在很大程度上同意人们在采取有风险的行动之前应考虑其后果的观点。

### 文章解析与点评

这又是一篇涉及人类行为的题目，不过与前面的“人类行为由哪些因素决定”（Issue 148）所不同的是，这篇文章讨论的是人们应该如何行动。题目的 prompt 当中提到，人们只有在认真思考了危险行为的可能后果之后才能采取行动。对此，一种最简单的破题方法是首先承认这样做在理论上的好处，即能让我们更为审慎，进而避免不好的后果。第二段马上反驳这样做在实践过程中的难处，其中最容易想到的是，人类对于复杂的世界可能无法做出准确的判断。应该说在这种思路下，很容易写出一篇 4 分左右的文章。

但这种观点下的文章很难达到 6 分，因为它缺乏一个足够深刻的视角，只是对表象进行理论和实践的分析。如果进一步思考，其实我们会回到一个更为深层的问题：这个世界是不是可知的？如果一个人认为是世界可知的，那么就该承认，我们可以考虑清楚每一个行为的后果——只要有足够的时间。请注意这后面跟随的限定条件——时间。生活中的很多事情其实并不是我们没有能力去想通，而是客观上时间紧迫，我们必须在限定的时间内做出抉择而已。因此本文的思路变成了从时间的充裕与否来分析这个题目，然后点明：即便是复杂问题也可以拆解成若干个更基本的问题，并各个击破。这样即便是面对复杂的情况，我们也可以分析出危险行为的后果（诚然这需要时间）。

顺便再说一句，在上面的分析和本文第三主旨段的论证中，提到了复杂事物可以看成是更简单事物的总和来理解，这种哲学思想叫作还原论（reductionism）。应当说这是许多现代科学背后的哲学方法论，譬如牛顿力学，是把力的存在与相互作用从具体事物中剥离开的。但是，近几十年随着复杂系统特别是混沌体系的发现，大家逐渐意识到本质是线性的还原主义可能并非永远万能，因为太多系统是非线性的。当然我们写 GRE 的文章并不需要下潜到这个深度，我个人甚至反对这么做——因为以大多数中国学生的英语表达能力很难把这么复杂的问题说清楚。但就个人思考的深度而言，把问题考虑到这个层面对我们认识自己所处的学科是有益的。

**66** All parents should be required to volunteer time to their children's schools.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the recommendation and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, describe specific circumstances in which adopting the recommendation would or would not be advantageous and explain how these examples shape your position.

How should parents participate in their children's education? Some claim that all parents should be required to volunteer their time to the schools of their children, which certainly does have some benefits. That said, I do not agree with the notion that every parent should be required, because it may not be practical for all parents to volunteer. More profoundly speaking, it is self-contradictory to require people to volunteer their time.

To begin with, it should be acknowledged that participating in children's education is beneficial on several levels. For students, the presence of parents in schools will make them more engaged in the process of learning. A recent study on children's performance in fifteen Indian kindergartens has demonstrated that when the parents are present in the classroom, the children will be significantly more active in classroom engagements. A possible explanation is that children yearn to be praised and acknowledged by their parents, and hence are more motivated. Additionally, the proposal of volunteering can be beneficial for parents as well, for the reason that the bonding between parents and children will be greatly strengthened. The same study cited above also discovered a higher level of affinity between the children whose parents participate in school activities and their parents. To sum up, because volunteering largely means physical presence in school, by devoting time to their children's schools parents can benefit both the children's education quality and the relationship with the children.

Despite the potential benefits discussed above, I cannot agree with the claim that all parents ought to be required to participate in volunteering activities in the school. The reason is that from a practical point of view, not all parents have the time and/or resources to participate. For some parents, their work may be so busy that they do not have sufficient time to spend in their children's schools. In China for example, some workplaces adopt a "996" schedule, meaning that a workday begins at 9 in the morning and ends at 9 o'clock at night. Six days are workdays in a given week. Needless to say, it would be extremely hard for parents, who are already exhausted by their intense work schedules, to make any firm commitment to their children's schools given a lack of available time. A number of longitudinal studies have indeed found that the level of direct participation of Chinese parents in their children's school is in significant decline over recent years. At the same time, in the United States where interactions between schools and communities are encouraged, there are families who are faced with financial challenges. In such households, parents often have multiple jobs that occupy a significant chunk of their time, making

volunteering in schools an impractical option. In these cases, volunteering time to schools is a luxury that those parents simply cannot afford.

Finally, even if time is not a limiting factor, I would still like to point out the contradictory nature of the words "volunteer" and "require" on a philosophical level. The former word implies an action whose nature is voluntary. In the case of parents' involvement in their children's school life, volunteering means committing oneself to school participation out of parents' free will. On the other hand, the proposal to require parents to participate in their children's school life is inherently mandatory, which is in clear contradiction of the voluntary nature of the volunteering. For example, when people talk about volunteers in art museums, no one would expect they are at work to fulfill certain requirement. Instead, volunteering one's time in an art museum most likely means their interest in art and their passion to share art with others. The same logic also applies to parents volunteering in schools. If the act of participation is required, it cannot be considered as volunteering.

To sum up, while I do not deny the potential benefits of parents volunteering in their children's schools, one has to be pragmatic in terms of how feasible it is for parents to engage in school activities. In fact, many parents do not have the necessary time for volunteering due to various reasons. On top of this practicality issue, the nature of volunteering is not compatible with the status of being required. I therefore disagree with the proposal that all parents should be required to volunteer. (716 words)

**中文翻译**

父母应该如何参与孩子的教育？有些人认为，应该强制要求所有的家长自愿抽出时间到孩子的学校去，这当然有一些好处。但是，我不同意应该要求每一位家长都这么做的提议，因为让所有家长自愿参加可能并不实际。更深层的原因是，家长自愿抽出时间和强制要求他们这么做是自相矛盾的。

首先，我们应该承认家长参与孩子的教育在一些方面是有益的。对学生来说，家长在学校会让他们更加投入地学习。最近一项关于 15 所印度幼儿园儿童表现的研究表明，当家长在场时，孩子们在课堂上的表现会明显地更加活跃。一种可能的解释是，孩子渴望得到父母的表扬和认可，为此他们变得更有动力了。此外，志愿服务的提议对父母也有好处，因为父母和孩子之间的联系将大大加强。上文提到的同一项研究还发现，父母参加学校活动的孩子和他们父母之间的亲密度更高。综上所述，由于志愿服务在很大程度上意味家长身处学校之中，他们把时间花在孩子们的学校，既有利于提高孩子受教育的质量，也有利于促进家长与孩子们的关系。

尽管我在上文中讨论了一些潜在的好处，但我不能同意所有家长都必须参加学校志愿活动的说法。原因是从实际来看，并不是所有的父母都有时间或者资源。对于一些家长来说，他们的工作可能太忙，以至于没有足够的时间去孩子的学校。例如，在中国，有些公司采用“996”工作制，即一个工作日从早上 9 点开始，晚上 9 点结束，一周需要工作 6 天。自然，对于那些

已经为紧张的工作心力憔悴的父母来说，在缺少时间的情况下，他们很难对孩子的学校做出任何肯定的承诺。一些纵向研究确实发现，近年来，中国父母对子女学校的直接参与程度显著下降。与此同时，在鼓励学校和社区之间互动的美国，也有一些家庭面临着经济上的挑战。在这样的家庭里，父母经常有多份工作，从而占据了他们很大一部分时间，因此在学校做志愿者是不切实际的选择。在这些情况下，家长志愿去学校是一种奢侈，他们根本负担不起。

最后，即使时间不是一个限制因素，我还是要指出“志愿”和“要求”这两个词在哲学层面上的矛盾本质。前一个词意味着一种行为，其性质是自愿的。在家长参与孩子的学校生活的情况下，志愿服务意味着家长出于自由意志而承诺参与学校活动。另一方面，要求家长参与孩子学校生活的建议本身就是强制性的，这显然与志愿服务的自愿性质相矛盾。例如，当人们谈论艺术博物馆的志愿者时，没有人会期望他们参与这份工作是为了满足某种要求。相反，在艺术博物馆里做志愿者很可能意味着他们对艺术有兴趣，乐意与他人分享艺术。同样的逻辑也适用于在学校做志愿者的家长。如果家长是被强制要求参与的，那这种参与就不能被视为志愿行为。

综上所述，我不否认家长在学校从事志愿活动所带来的可能好处，但我们应该对家长参与学校活动是否可行采取务实的态度。事实上，由于种种原因，很多家长没有时间做志愿服务。除此之外，志愿服务的性质与强制要求的行为不符。因此，我不同意所有家长必须去学校做志愿者的提议。

### 文章解析与点评

本文是一篇教育类的文章，围绕着学校、家长以及子女的教育展开。对于这篇文章，我们有很多的破题方法，譬如极端词（围绕 require all 论证）、理论与实践（这样做的好处以及实际上的困难）等。本文的第一和第二主旨段就是这样的思路。如果本文只写到第二主旨段就结束，那么文章大概是 4.5 分上下的水平，有 0.5 的加分是源自于两段当中的举例。具体来说，第二段中，我们使用了中国这种“996”的例子，这对于我们的读者、身处国外的评卷人来说是有理解上的挑战的，他们习惯了朝九晚五和有完整双休日的工作，或许想不到为什么有人会愿意工作这么长的时间，因此我们需要用额外的笔墨去描述“996”的内容。

但如果要把文章提升到 6 分，我们就需要挖掘题目本身的深刻性了。在本题当中，“要求家长做志愿者”，用到的词是 require 和 volunteer。require 的语气和态度是非常强硬的，有点带强迫的意味；但 volunteer 这个词翻译成“志愿”，隐含了一个行为是自愿的。想清楚这两个词背后的深意后，我们会发现“强迫要求别人做志愿者”是这一观点的荒谬性，究其原因是两个词的内在逻辑相矛盾。这就是本文第三主旨段的内容，也是文章能够达到 5.5~6 分这一档评分的原因。

这种对题干中单词意思进行深挖的方法，我们在之前的文章中已经有过介绍，譬如对于“什么叫有效领导”和“教育的目的”给出了明确的定义。这篇文章里，我们其实也是在围绕单词的意思进行讨论，要实现对一个英语单词意思的深刻理解，大家一定要翻看英英词典，否则很难理解为什么 require 和 request 都可以翻译成“要求”，但两者的语气强弱可能差了两个数量级。

42 In order to become well-rounded individuals, all college students should be required to take courses in which they read poetry, novels, mythology, and other types of imaginative literature.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the recommendation and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, describe specific circumstances in which adopting the recommendation would or would not be advantageous and explain how these examples shape your position.

Issues related to education have always been under heated debate. For example, one controversial question revolving around college education is: should all college students be required to take courses in which they read imaginative literature so they will become a more well-rounded individual? At first glance, this piece of recommendation has certain benefits, as imaginative literature could emancipate people from cliché thoughts and enable them to embrace a more diverse and open dimension of life. Closer examination, however, reveals that we imaginative literature does not necessarily always lead to "well-roundedness". Furthermore, there are several practical factors that could render the recommendation of making imaginative literature compulsory in class not desirable. Given these reasons I cannot agree with this proposal.

To begin with, I do not deny the benefits of imaginative literature in expanding one's dimension of perspective, as the advocate of this piece of recommendation implicitly suggests. Because there is no physical boundary to the imaginative literature, it greatly stimulates a reader's creativity, an attribute often deemed valuable in not only college education but also in society in general. For example, Bob Dylan, the godfather of folk music as well as a Nobel Prize laureate, was immersed in poetry, fictions, and novels during his youth. A fervid fan of Balzac, Victor Hugo, and Charles Dickens, Dylan ingested the wisdom and imaginative force in literature, thereby exploring the richness of life and delving deep into the nature of humanity. Thanks to these epiphanies from imaginative literature, Dylan's creativity later led to his classic musical pieces such as *Blowin' in the Wind* and *Like a Rollin' Stone*. Likewise, for college students who have just embarked on the journey of adult life and entered a new stage of acquiring knowledge, studying imaginative literature can certainly boost their creativity.

That being said, I find that the recommendation above is based on an unsubstantiated assumption that all students are inherently lacking imagination and hence are in need of reading imaginative literature to become well-rounded. It is admittedly true that science and engineering students typically conform to the existing doctrines and lack originality, and hence taking courses on imaginative literature shall in theory help them become more well-rounded individuals. By contrast, students in humanities and social sciences often are not limited by their imagination; instead, they typically lack the

capacity for meticulous observation and logical reasoning, which means that taking mandatory courses on imaginative literature may not be as helpful to them in terms of well-roundedness. In this light, classes on logical and quantitative reasoning would be more conducive. This is why in more and more universities economics and sociology students are required to take classes in advanced mathematics and statistics. At any rate, reading poetry, novels, mythology, and other types of imaginative literature is not necessarily conducive to becoming well-rounded individuals for all students.

Finally, even if we acknowledge the theoretical benefits of imaginative literature in helping science and engineering students become more well-rounded, from a pragmatic point of view whether such courses should be mandatory demands a second look. Here, the practical issue is that many students in science and engineering major have the limited amount of time and energy under the tremendous pressure from their major courses. A recent survey of STEM (science, technology, engineering, and mathematics) students in the United States reveals that on average they have to spend more than 7 hours in their workload per day. If they were required to take imaginative literature courses in college, a heavier workload would ensue. As a result, students' performance in their major studies would likely deteriorate. At the same time, it is possible that their interest in literature will actually decline because they regard the intense reading as a burden rather than an enjoyment. Eventually, students would dislike imaginative literature despite its theoretical advantages, a counterproductive result that is actually unfavorable to becoming a well-rounded individual.

To summarize, while imaginative literature, as the marvels of humanity, guides one into a freer world full of possibilities and imaginations, their merits does not justify the mandatory courses for all students. One reason is that not all students lack imagination. What is more, even for students who can need benefit from imaginative literature, making such courses mandatory may adversely affect their performance in the major field of study and may, counterproductively, diminish their interest in literature reading. (722 words)

**中文翻译**

与教育有关的问题一直是人们讨论的焦点。例如，围绕大学教育的一个有争议的问题是：是否应该要求所有的大学生都参加阅读想象类文学作品的课程，从而使他们成为更加全面发展的人？乍一看，这个建议有一定的益处，因为富有想象力的文学可以使人们从陈旧的思维中解放出来，使他们能够拥有一个更加多样化和开放的生活维度。然而，进一步研究表明，想象类文学并不一定总能促进“全面发展”。此外，有几个实际因素可能会导致在课堂上强制学生阅读想象类文学是不可取的。鉴于这些原因，我不能同意这个建议。

首先，正如这个建议的支持者们建议的那样，我并不否认想象类文学在拓展眼界方面的益处。因为想象类文学没有物理边界，它极大地激发了读者的创造力，这一属性不仅在大学教育中，而且在整个社会中都被认为是有价值的。例如，民乐教父、诺贝尔奖获得者鲍勃·迪伦年轻时

就沉浸在诗歌和小说中。作为巴尔扎克、雨果和狄更斯的狂热粉丝，迪伦吸收了文学中的智慧和想象力，从而探索生命的丰富性，并深入探究人性的本质。多亏了这些来自想象类文学的顿悟，迪伦的创造力后来让他写出了经典音乐作品，如《答案在风中飘扬》和《就像一块滚石》。同样，对于刚刚踏上成人生活征程、进入知识获取新阶段的大学生来说，学习想象类文学无疑可以提高他们的创造力。

话虽如此，我发现上文的建议是基于一个未经证实的假设，即所有学生天生缺乏想象力，因此需要阅读想象类文学作品才能全面发展。诚然，理工科学生通常遵从现有的教条，缺乏独创性，因此，学习想象类文学课程在理论上有助于他们成为更加全面发展的人才。相比之下，人文社科专业的学生往往不受想象力的限制；相反，他们通常缺乏细致的观察和逻辑推理的能力，这意味着想象类文学必修课对他们的全面发展可能没有那么大的帮助。从这一点上讲，逻辑推理和定量推理的课程会更有帮助。这就是为什么越来越多的大学要求经济学和社会学的学生上高等数学和统计学课程。无论如何，阅读诗歌、小说、神话和其他类型的想象类文学并不一定有利于所有学生成为全面发展的人才。

最后，即使我们承认想象类文学对帮助理工科学生全面发展有理论上的优势，从实用主义的角度来看，这类课程是否应该成为必修课，也需要我们重新考虑。一个现实问题是许多理工科学生学习专业课程压力巨大，时间和精力有限。最近一项对美国 STEM（科学 science、技术 technology、工程 engineering 和数学 mathematics）学生的调查显示，他们平均每天要花超过 7 小时去学习。如果要求他们在大学里学习想象类文学课程，那么他们的任务量就会更大。因此，学生在专业学习中的表现可能会变得糟糕。同时，他们对文学的兴趣也有可能下降，因为他们会把大量的阅读看作是一种负担而不是一种享受。最终，尽管想象类文学有理论上的优点，但学生们会厌恶这种文学，这是一个适得其反的结果，实际上不利于学生成为全面发展的人才。

综上所述，尽管想象文学是人类的奇迹，它引导人们进入一个充满可能性和想象力的自由世界，但这种优点并不是其成为所有学生必修课的理由。原因之一是并非所有的学生都缺乏想象力。更重要的是，即使是对那些需要从想象文学中获益的学生来说，将这类课程设定为必修课程可能会对他们的专业学习产生不利影响，并可能适得其反地削弱他们对文学阅读的兴趣。

### 文章解析与点评

本文讨论的问题是“如何成为一个全面发展的学生”，这里我们可以继续沿用前面说过的方法，去思考题目中最关键一词的定义。很显然，在本题中关键词就是 well-rounded，也即所谓的“全面发展”。顾名思义，全面发展意味着一个人在各个方面都能得到均衡的发展，注意这个词背后所涵盖的“平均”之意。有了这个概念之后再看题目所说的，“所有学生都应该去学习想象类文学的课程”，背后的假设就呼之欲出了：当下，我们的学生缺乏想象力，因此为了均衡发展，需要从大学的课程中进行补充（还得以必修课的方式）。

当我们挖掘出题目的内在假设之后，文章立刻就好写了：对于理工科的学生来说，也许他们真的缺乏想象力，需要额外补习和阅读想象类文学；但对于人文社科类的同学，这个政策就不那么恰当了。正如第二主旨段所说，人文社科类的同学或许缺乏的不是想象力，而是逻辑推理能力和定量思考的能力。以上是从全面发展的定义出发，根据学科进行分类讨论，光靠这两段文章可以很容易上 4 分。而为了提升到 6 分，我们又引入了理论和实践这两个视角，阐述了强迫所有理工科学生阅读文学作品也许会带来不好的后果，这也契合了文章 direction 考虑政策后果的要求。

最后从本文的题目出发，我来聊一聊现实中的一点观察。相对而言，GRE 写作在理工科研究生申请中的比重低于文科申请。同样，一般人也认为人文社科类学生的 Issue 水平应该显著高于理工科学生。但根据笔者多年的 GRE 写作教学，发现并非如此。很多人文社科类的同学确实很雄辩，写起文章洋洋洒洒，看似能够旁征博引，妙语连珠，乍一读起来觉得很厉害；但实际考出来的作文分数却不尽如人意。仔细批改他们的文章之后，我意识到他们恰恰是缺乏一种工程师思维，在写文章的时候缺乏章法。对于 Issue，他们往往没有一个明确的观点和对于观点的清晰表达；而到了 Argument，他们又开始谈论自己的看法。这两者都是 GRE 作文当中的大忌。大家一定要记住，GRE 考试归根到底是一项以英语为载体的逻辑能力测试，英语是载体，重点是逻辑，这和托福与雅思这类考查表达能力的语言考试有着本质上的区别。对于人文社科专业的同学来说，写 Issue 时面对思如泉涌的情况，更要学会克制和审慎，注意行文的逻辑。

**27** College students should be encouraged to pursue subjects that interest them rather than the courses that seem most likely to lead to jobs.

Write a response in which you discuss the extent to which you agree or disagree with the recommendation and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, describe specific circumstances in which adopting the recommendation would or would not be advantageous and explain how these examples shape your position.

Each year colleges and universities worldwide matriculate freshmen to their campus and open up doors to a myriad of subjects to learn. Concerning how students should choose what to study in college, I believe that while personal interest is of considerable importance, reality often dictates that many students have to consider factors other than interest, particularly the career prospect. Furthermore, it should be pointed out that not all students have a firm interest in an object. Given these considerations, college students should actually be encouraged to pursue subjects that seem most likely to lead to jobs.

To begin with, many people would highlight the importance of interest in choosing major, citing that one's interest is the ultimate force capable of motivating one's endeavors. Carl Gauss, perhaps

the greatest mathematician of all times, for example, demonstrated an extremely profound interest in mathematics during his youth. Although raised in a financially challenged family, Gauss went ahead with the encouragement from his mother and chose the field of math as his major of study. Eventually Gauss made a wide range of awe-inspiring breakthroughs and became the founder of modern mathematics. A more recent example illustrating the power of interest is Facebook co-founder Mark Zuckerberg, whose immense interest in programming and human behaviors prompted him to double-major in computer science and psychology. During his time at Harvard, it was also his interest that gave birth to Facebook, the largest social network site on this planet. These personal success stories share a common point: one's interest drives their academic and professional endeavors and ultimately leads to success.

However, the success of Gauss and Zuckerberg may be occasional and could not be replicated in everyone else's life. Not only did Gauss and Zuckerberg possess strong interest, but they were also extremely talented. Gauss was famously known as a prodigy in his hometown at early age and Zuckerberg was admitted into the Johns Hopkins Center for Talented Youth summer camp. Such talents cannot be overlooked in their later achievements. Another factor to consider in choosing one's major is the financial situation of the family. If one was born and raised in a wealthy family, it is true that she or he could pursue what interests her or him since livelihood is not a concern. For others coming from a lower socioeconomical class, they may have to consider the career prospect to make ends meet. What's more, in many countries including the United States, the cost of higher education poses a formidable challenge to even many middle-class families. Since many college students have to apply for student loans to pay the college tuition, a lucrative job is crucial for them to repay all the debts. This is why finance and computer sciences are sought-after majors for some college students and some other counterparts are working hard to be able to attend law and medical schools.

Finally, while the discussion above seems to revolve around a cruel choice between the romance of personal interest and the harsh reality of survival, I feel the urge to point out that this dichotomy may actually be a false proposition. I argue that not everyone has a clear understanding of his or her personal interest. To understand why, we need to consider the definition of interest and differentiate it from a sudden impulse. From my point of view, finding one's true interest demands time and efforts, while keeping the interest equals a strong commitment. Dr. Wu Jun, former President of Chinese Internet conglomerate Tencent and senior researcher working for Google, took his daughter to audit in 13 world-class universities to find what truly interests her. Genuine interest is not a reckless decision with little rational reasoning. Instead, it can be found after a careful consideration, like what Dr. Wu Jun's daughter had experienced firsthand in college classrooms.

To recap, I acknowledge the importance of interest, but out of practical reasons students should be encouraged to pick promising fields that are likely to bring a good career. On a more fundamental level,

not all students have discovered what truly interests them, so to encourage them to pursue their personal interest is built upon an unrealistic premise. (692 words)

**中文翻译**

每年世界各地的高校都会招收新生，并为他们敞开各类学科的大门。关于学生应该如何选择在大学的学习内容，我认为，虽然个人兴趣是相当重要的，但往往迫于现实，很多学生不得不考虑兴趣以外的因素，特别是职业前景。此外，应该指出的是，并不是所有的学生都对某个研究对象有坚定的兴趣。考虑到这些因素，大学实际上应该鼓励学生选择那些看起来最有可能让他们找到工作的学科。

首先，很多人会强调兴趣在选择专业时的重要性，他们认为兴趣是激发努力的首要力量。例如，卡尔·高斯可能是有史以来最伟大的数学家，他在年轻的时候就表现出了对数学极其强烈的兴趣。虽然高斯在一个经济困难的家庭中长大，但他还是在母亲的鼓励下，选择了数学作为他的专业。最终高斯取得了一系列令人惊叹的突破，成为现代数学的奠基人。最近一个表明兴趣的力量的例子是 Facebook 联合创始人马克·扎克伯格，他对编程和人类行为的巨大兴趣促使他主修计算机科学和心理学。在哈佛期间，也是他的兴趣催生了世界上最大的社交网站 Facebook。这些个人成功的故事有一个共同点：一个人的兴趣驱动着他们的学术和专业努力，并最终致使他们成功。

然而，高斯和扎克伯格的成功也许只是偶然，并不能被其他人复制。高斯和扎克伯格不仅有浓厚的兴趣，而且极有天赋。高斯早年在家乡以神童而闻名，扎克伯格也被约翰·霍普金斯天才青少年中心夏令营录取。这些才能在他们后来的成就中不容忽视。在选择专业时，另一个需要学生考虑的因素是家庭的经济状况。如果一个人在一个富裕的家庭里出生并长大，他（她）确实可以追求自己感兴趣的东西，因为生计不是一个问题。对于那些来自较低社会经济阶层的人来说，他们可能不得不考虑职业前景来维持生计。更重要的是，在包括美国在内的许多国家，高等教育的成本甚至对许多中产阶级家庭构成了巨大的挑战。由于许多大学生不得不申请助学贷款来支付学费，一份赚钱的工作对他们偿还所有债务至关重要。这就是为什么金融和计算机科学是一些大学生选择的热门专业，而其他一些学生却在努力进入法学和医学院。

最后，虽然上面的讨论似乎围绕着一个痛苦的选择，即追求个人兴趣的浪漫情怀还是面对生存的残酷现实。我觉得有必要指出，这种二分法实际上可能是一个伪命题。我认为并不是每个人都清楚地了解自己的兴趣。为了理解这一原因，我们需要考虑兴趣的定义，并将其与一时的冲动区分开来。在我看来，找到真正的兴趣需要时间和努力，而保持兴趣则意味着坚定的承诺。中国互联网巨头腾讯前总裁、谷歌高级研究员吴军博士带着女儿到 13 所世界一流大学进行旁听，以找出她对什么真正感兴趣。真正的兴趣不是没有理性思考的鲁莽决定。相反，经过慎重考虑它是可以被发现的，就像吴军博士的女儿在大学教室中亲身经历的那样。

总而言之，我承认兴趣的重要性，但出于实际原因，学校应该鼓励学生选择能让他们找到好工作的有前景的领域。从根本层面上看，并不是所有的学生都发现了真正让他们感兴趣的东西，所以鼓励他们追求个人兴趣是建立在一个不切实际的前提之上的。

### 文章解析与点评

关于“如何去选择自己的专业”在 GRE 题库当中有不少题目在进行讨论。对于这一类型的文章，一种常见的 4 分写法是：承认定专业时考虑工作前景的必要性，但是指出兴趣是最好的老师，为了实现最好的学习效果还是要以自己的兴趣为主。这是一套政治正确的话术，甚至我们还可以再加上一段，说“入学时根据就业选择的专业可能到了毕业就不再吃香了”，以此更进一步地佐证考虑工作的专业选择在实践上是不可取的。

上面这种观点或多或少有一些理想主义的影子，本文则从实用主义的角度出发，反其道而行之。首先我们承认在理论层面上，兴趣对于一个人的学习有着积极的作用，但是从实际角度出发，一味追求自身兴趣而忽略未来的个人财务前景或许并不可取——尤其在西方国家，大学教育是一笔沉重的经济负担。换言之，不考虑就业前景去追求自己的兴趣其实是一种奢侈（luxury），这么做需要足够的物质基础作为支撑。如果我们把个人的专业选择放在更长远的家族发展来看，就不难理解为什么有人会说“一代科学工程，二代金融法律，三代文学艺术”了。在第三主旨段，文章更是对于“选专业应当遵从自己的兴趣”这一观点提出了更为尖锐的批判：我们在选专业时真的了解自己的兴趣爱好吗？我们如何将自己的一时兴趣与真正的热爱区分开来？前文所述的 4 分写法没有回答这个问题。

最后，本文针对的是本科阶段的学习，但研究生阶段、特别是博士阶段的学习就完全不一样了。选择去读博士就基本意味着未来要走科研和学术路线，即便是以后去公司也肯定是走技术岗。一方面来，你的就业道路一下子窄了很多；另一方面，博士阶段的学习和工作与本科阶段完全不同，如果没有一颗强大的内心和对事业的热情很难坚持下来，因此在选专业方向和导师的时候一定要慎重。

## 6 “建议类” Direction（二）

Write a response in which you discuss your views on the policy and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider **the possible consequences** of implementing the policy and explain how these consequences shape your position.

### 中文翻译

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中讨论你在多大程度上同意或者不同意题目中的政策，解释你所

采取的立场的理由。在发展和支持你的立场的过程中，考虑一下你认为**这个政策可能产生的结果**，并且解释这些结果如何影响你的立场。

### 讲　解

这种 Direction 对应的题目是在谈论一个政策（policy）。政策和建议在本质上是类似的，只不过政策显得更加强硬，实施主体也通常是国家、政府、学校等。而 Direction 中的 consequence 这个词明确地告诉我们，**我们应该把文章的论述重点放在这个政策可能带来的结果上**。所以，与上一个 Direction 类似，如果考生通篇都在论述政策的“必要性”“紧迫性”“充分性”等，就偏离了 Direction 的要求。

由此看来，这种 Direction 和上一条 Direction 对我们的要求几乎一致：**都是要谈题目中建议所带来的“结果”**。唯一的细微差别是：上一条 Direction 还要求我们阐述不同结果产生的情况，但这条 Direction 并没有对此做明确要求。但可以想见，如果我们能在论述结果之时也对该结果产生的情况加以说明，无疑可以使我们的论证更加完善。

### 讲解浓缩版

**与上一条 Direction 的要求基本一致，要讨论政策可能带来的结果。**

### 例题举证

Nations should pass laws to preserve any remaining wilderness areas in their natural state, even if these areas could be developed for economic gain.

Write a response in which you discuss your views on the policy and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider the possible consequences of implementing the policy and explain how these consequences shape your position.

参考提纲如下：

**总立场：**有保留地反对题目

**分论点 1**（题目建议会带来的有利结果）：国家只有用法律手段限制野生区域的开发，才能杜绝一些个人和企业为了自身利益而对野生区域进行无限度的开发利用，进而防止生态失衡。

**分论点 2**（题目建议会带来的不利结果）：有一些野生区域已经基本不存在任何植物或动物，对这些区域的保护可能费时费力，最后得不偿失。

**分论点 3**（题目建议的延伸）：对一些野生区域，我们可以把经济开发和自然保护结合起来，如将其发展为野生植物园等。这样既能促进自然环境良性发展，还取得了经济效益。

分论点 1 是讨论题目建议可能产生的正面结果，分论点 2 是在讨论负面结果，而分论点 3 则是对原题目中建议的延伸，以替代建议的方式提供了一种双赢的结果。但不论是哪一个分论点都紧紧围绕着“结果”二字，这也正是 Direction 的要求。

## 题库范文

132 In any field — business, politics, education, government — those in power should be required to step down after five years.

Write a response in which you discuss your views on the policy and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider the possible consequences of implementing the policy and explain how these consequences shape your position.

It has been argued that those in power should step down after five years in any field, be it business, politics, education, or government. The reason for this policy recommendation is that it is the revitalization through new leadership that paves the surest path to success for any enterprise. In my opinion, while it might be beneficial to introduce new leadership, the success of an enterprise depends on more than leadership; in some cases, new leadership may actually be counterproductive. Finally, forcing leaders to step down after five years may create a toxic culture, in which leaders will not think for the long-term development of the organization.

First, it should be acknowledged that new leadership, or at least the very idea of a potential competitor to power, adds a healthy dose of competition to the organization. Therefore, in politics and business, those in power must cater to the general public and the employees, and in education those on the upper ladder of the echelon must make efforts to justify their leadership. Furthermore, if there is no challenger to existing leadership, the organization will be stagnated and may hardly move forward, for the reason that innovations require changes to the organization. Those already in power, however, represent the so-called “establishment” in the organization and, by their nature, are reluctant to change. Such a phenomenon happens a lot in first-generation family businesses, where the founder’s family has total control of the company. Because the leadership faces no challenger, it often refuses to change. As a consequence, after a few generations such companies go bust. In short, without new leadership an organization may be difficult to evolve fast enough to cope with the ever-changing landscape of the society.

That being said, new leadership alone may not be silver bullet to guarantee the success of an organization. Today we live in a complex world, which means that for a complex organization to survive and thrive, it takes more than one person’s effort. For example, Steve Jobs is often considered

to be the godfather of Apple and taking credits for Apple's tremendous success. However, one cannot ignore the efforts by Apple's designers, programmers, and engineers who make the Apple product a reality. Moreover, Apple's products are essentially the assemblage of individual components supplied by various companies, without which Apple's success cannot be guaranteed.

What's worse, in certain cases new leadership may attempt to eradicate the efforts by its predecessors and be counterproductive to the collective well-being, which is most common in the world of politics. A policy signed by a governor may be challenged and invalidated by later administrations not because such a policy is ineffective, but because it is ideologically in conflict with new leadership. Obamacare, for example, has been partly repealed by the Trump administration, along with a wide range of regulatory measures established when the Democrat president was still in the Oval Office. The back-and-forth in policy-making processes creates confusion to the country and brings inconvenience to people's life. As a result, instead of revitalization, it may be chaos and uncertainties that new leadership brings.

Based on the reasons mentioned above, I do not agree with the claim that leaders must abdicate their power after five years in any field. Although such a move is morally admirable and has some theoretical benefits, it may in reality create more negative consequences than positive ones and cannot 100 percent ensure the organization to be successful. Another reason against this proposal is that, once enacted, it will change the mentality of leaders, who now can see little beyond their five-year tenure. What follows is that they have few, if any, incentives to work harder or think for the long-term fate of the organization. The consequence is that their policy will be myopic and extremely conservative. In the worst-case scenario, they may even seek to just benefit financially from the leadership role, which is certainly detrimental to the organization.

To sum up, despite the potential benefits of new leadership, we cannot underestimate its danger. Therefore, I cannot fully agree with the notion that the surest path to success is guaranteed by new leadership and certainly oppose the idea that leaders in any field must step down from power after five years. (706 words)

**中文翻译**

有人认为，无论是在商业、政治、教育还是政府领域，掌权者都应该在五年后下台。人们提出这项政策的原因是，新领导层注入的活力将会为任何企业的成功铺就一条最可靠的道路。在我看来，虽然引入新的领导层可能是有益的，但事业的成功不仅仅取决于领导力；在某些情况下，换上新领导层实际上可能产生适得其反的效果。最后，强迫领导者在五年后下台可能会造成一种领导者不会考虑组织长期发展的有害文化。

首先，我们应该承认，新的领导力，或者至少是有潜在的权力竞争对手的想法，为组织增

加了健康的竞争活力。因此，在政治和商业领域，当权者必须迎合大众和雇员；在教育方面，上层阶级必须努力证明自己的领导是正当的。此外，如果没有对现有领导层的挑战者，组织的发展将会停滞，几乎无法前进，原因是创新需要对组织进行变革。然而，那些已经掌权的人代表了组织中所谓的“建制派”，从本质上讲，他们不愿意改变。这种现象在第一代家族企业中经常发生，创始人家族拥有公司的全部控制权。因为领导层没有挑战者，所以他们经常拒绝改变。结果，几代人之后，这样的公司就会破产。简言之，没有新的领导，一个组织可能很难迅速发展，以应付不断变化的社会格局。

尽管如此，新的领导力可能并不是保证一个组织成功运行的灵丹妙药。今天，我们生活在一个复杂的世界中，这意味着一个复杂的组织要想生存和繁荣，需要不止一个人的努力。例如，史蒂夫·乔布斯通常被认为是苹果的教父，并且苹果公司的巨大成功归功于他。然而，人们不能忽视苹果的设计师、程序员和工程师们为苹果产品付出的努力。此外，苹果产品从根本上是由不同公司提供的单个零件组装而成，没有这些零件，苹果的成功就无法保证。

更糟糕的是，在某些情况下，新领导层可能会试图消除前任的努力，并对集体利益产生反作用，这在政治世界中最为常见。一项由州长签署的政策可能会被后来的政府质疑和废除，并不是因为这项政策无效，而是因为它在意识形态上与新领导层冲突。例如，特朗普政府废除了部分奥巴马医改，同时还废除了民主党总统在位时制定的一系列监管措施。决策过程中的反复，给国家造成混乱，给人民生活带来不便。因此，新领导层带来的可能不是振兴，而是混乱和不确定性。

基于上述原因，我不同意领导人在任何领域任满五年后必须放弃权力的说法。尽管这一举措在道义上令人钦佩，也有一些理论上的好处，但在现实中，它可能产生更为消极的后果，不能百分之百地确保组织的成功。我反对这项提议的另一个原因是，一旦通过，它将改变领导人的心态，他们在任时视野只会局限在五年任期内，很少能放眼未来。接下来的情况是，他们几乎没有动力去努力工作或为组织的长期命运考虑。其结果是他们的政策将是短视和极端保守的。在最坏的情况下，他们甚至可能只想从领导角色中获得经济利益，这对组织无疑是有害的。

综上所述，尽管新领导层可能会带来好处，但我们不能低估其危险性。因此，我不能完全同意这种观点：最可靠的成功之路是由新的领导层铺就的，当然我也反对任何领域的领导人必须在五年后下台的观点。

### 文章解析与点评

本文是 GRE 写作中的一道高频题目。看到本题一个最“懒”的办法就是从 any 这个词入手，加上题目已经预先分好的几个类别，去讨论在不同领域该政策是否合适。但这种写法不够深刻，因为在不同的领域也许会有不同的答案，但我们能否跳出领域的表象，找到一个通用的准则呢？这就是这篇范文的立足点，这样一来就比“分情况讨论”的思路要高一个档次。

具体来说，我们要思考两个方面的问题：其一，新领导层会给组织带来什么样的影响（第一和第二主旨段）；第二，获知自己只有五年任期这一预期，会对领导层本身带来什么影响（第三主旨段）。第一点很容易想到，我们不再细说，顺带说一句，其实只写第一点也是可以的，那么文章大概会是 4.5 分的水平。对于第二点，我们自己要如何想到呢？这里介绍一个思路，那就是“当某一方对另一方施加影响时，反过来后者也会对前者施加影响”。这一点乍看起来有点像牛顿第三定律，作用力与反作用力大小相等方向相反，但我觉得还是不够准确，因为现实生活中的影响一方面不好量化，另一方面也不是对等的。但不管怎样，在 Issue 当中如果我们看到了一个主体和一个客体，那么既可以按照题目所说讨论主体对客体的影响，也可以反过来思考客体对主体的影响。

注意这篇文章虽然对题目所持的观点提出了深刻的批判，但我们并没有进一步给出自己的解决方案，事实上我们也不建议这么做。究其原因，并不是说 Issue 不允许我们发表自己的看法，而是对 Issue 我们倾向于一种保守的态度，选择就题目本身进行分析，宜深入挖掘，不宜发散。大家会发现，本书的绝大部分题目我们都是采用这种方法论。

**84** Colleges and universities should require their students to spend at least one semester studying in a foreign country.

Write a response in which you discuss your views on the policy and explain your reasoning for the position you take. In developing and supporting your position, you should consider the possible consequences of implementing the policy and explain how these consequences shape your position.

With countries becoming increasingly interconnected thanks to globalization, there are ample opportunities for college students to spend some time in a foreign country. Some people even claim that students should be required to spend at least one semester abroad, which I cannot fully agree. While it is true that studying abroad may be beneficial to students, but it is not advisable to demand all students spend time abroad on two levels.

First, from an individual perspective, I agree that spending time in studying abroad could be advantageous to their academic endeavors if the destination institution has a reputable program. For example, the United States is renowned for its advanced biological and medical research lab, so for a biomedical student from a developing nation, studying in the United States would be beneficial. Similarly, students majoring in fine arts would reap benefits from spending time in Paris, a destination that nearly every artist in history admires. The artistic capital of Europe, numerous museums in Paris would boost the students' taste in art appraisal and knowledge in art history. Moreover, this very

experience of living abroad could also help students in the future, because the exposure to a foreign culture could broaden the horizon of the students and a diploma from a foreign prestigious institution could enhance the students' competitiveness. To sum up, under some specific circumstances students could significantly benefit from an oversea learning experience.

However, the lines of reasoning above hinge on an important assumption: academic institutions abroad must be well-regarded. In reality, this assumption may not always hold true. A Chinese student majoring in traditional Chinese literature could hardly benefit much from spending time in Europe; a Japanese seismology student has already received world-class earthquake-related education; and a Hawaiian oceanographer could enjoy easy access to the ocean and a vast number of academic resources within the State of Hawaii. At the same time, it should be kept in mind that spending time abroad also bears a cost. If the continuity of the curriculum at the student's home institution is broken by the semester away, he or she would have to spend extra time in resuming the study. The system of medical education for example in many countries has substantial difference and countries may not approve or accept the education received in a foreign country. Imagine an American medical student spending a semester studying in China, where the classes he or she takes would not be acknowledged back home. After returning, the student would still have to pick up where he or she left, and the experience in China did little help to his medical education at home. All in all, from a personal point of view there needs to be considerable advantages of studying abroad to justify this investment of time.

Next, speaking on behalf of the educational institutions, it is beneficial to send students abroad in theory. Exchange students can be seen as an academic and cultural ambassador, who can better bridge the not only schools abroad and at home but also the two countries. For example, in late 1800s students selected by the Chinese governments to study in the United States learned western knowledge, and in turn presented ancient Chinese culture to the American people, strengthening the ties and understanding between the two great nations. Yet, the recommendation to require students studying in foreign colleges and universities for at least a semester could backfire despite its theoretical advantages if it is not executed properly. For instance, living abroad, especially in a developed country, will incur significant costs to the students, whose family may not be able to afford. In this case, asking every student to study abroad could lead to a conflict between the schools and the students.

To summarize, it should be acknowledged that spending some time abroad is certainly beneficial for the students as well as the educational institutions, but this policy is not necessarily applicable to everyone. For those who would not benefit much from a foreign experience and those who have financial hardship associated with living abroad, spending abroad should not be a mandatory requirement for them. (682 words)

**中文翻译**

随着全球化让各国之间的联系越来越紧密，大学生们有足够多的机会去国外待上一段时间。有些人甚至声称学生至少要在国外待一个学期，对此我不能完全同意。虽然出国留学确实对学生有好处，但是从两个层面上来说，要求所有学生都去国外是不明智的。

首先，从个人的角度来看，如果目标院校有一个著名的项目，那么我同意学生花时间在国外学习对他们的学业有好处。例如，美国以其先进的生物和医学研究实验室而闻名，所以对于一个来自发展中国家的生物医学学生来说，在美国学习是有益的。同样，对于美术专业的学生来说，在巴黎学习是有好处的，因为这个城市是历史上几乎每一位艺术家都向往的地方。作为欧洲的艺术之都，巴黎众多的博物馆会提高学生艺术鉴赏的品味和对艺术史的认知。此外，这种在国外生活的经历也有助于学生将来的发展，因为接触外国文化可以拓宽学生的视野，而获得国外知名院校的文凭可以提高学生的竞争力。综上所述，在某些特定情况下，学生可以从海外学习经历中受益匪浅。

然而，上文的论述取决于一个重要的假设：国外的院校都有不错的口碑。在现实中，这种假设可能并不总是正确的。对一个主修中国古代文学的中国学生来说，去欧洲学习几乎没有什么益处；一个地震专业的日本学生已经接受了世界先进的地震相关教育；一个夏威夷的海洋学家在夏威夷州内可以很容易接触到海洋和大量学术资源。同时，我们应该了解，学生在国外留学也要付出一定代价。如果学生所在学校的课程连续性在出国时被打破，他或她将不得不花额外的时间来重新学习。例如，许多国家的医学教育制度有很大差别，各国可能不认可或接受学生在外国接受的教育。试想，一个美国医学生在中国学习一个学期，那么回国后他或她所上的课程是不被承认的。回国后，学生还是要继续之前中断的学习，在中国的经历对他或她在国内的医学教育几乎没有帮助。总而言之，从个人角度来看，出国留学需要有相当大的优势来证明这种时间投入的合理性。

其次，站在院校的角度考虑，派学生出国从理论上讲是有益的。交换生可以被看作是学术和文化的大使，他们不仅可以架起国内外院校交流的桥梁，而且可以作为两个国家之间的纽带。例如，在 19 世纪末，中国政府挑选学生赴美学习西方知识，进而向美国人民介绍中国古代文化，加强了两个伟大国家之间的联系和了解。然而，要求学生在国外大学学习至少一个学期的建议，如果执行不当，可能会适得其反。例如，学生在国外生活，尤其是在发达国家，会产生一笔很大的费用，他们的家庭可能负担不起。在这种情况下，要求每个学生出国留学可能会导致学校和学生之间的冲突。

总而言之，我们应该承认学生在国外待上一段时间对学生和院校都是有益的，但这项政策并不一定适用于所有人。对于那些不会从国外经历中受益太多的人和那些在国外生活有经济困难的人来说，出国读书不应成为强制性要求。

### 文章解析与点评

相信大部分同学如果在考场上看到这一篇文章会很开心，因为这更像是一道托福口语题或者大作文。围绕“出国学习一个学期”的好处，我们可以说的东西太多了。大家看到出国学习，会不会立刻想到一个词组叫 broaden the horizon？想到了不用怕，我们这篇文章的第一主旨段也提到了，但怕的是只想到这一点就不再继续往下想：为什么去国外能拓展我们的视野？就算我们拓展了视野，它能有什么好处？

这篇文章第一主旨段的精彩之处就在于，它既说了人人爱听的漂亮话，而且还指出了出国留学的具体好处，即如果出国留学的地方比学生所在国家的教育更加发达，那么从追求更高水平教育的目的出发，出国留学是有好处的。另外这一段还有简略的一句“拥有国外的文凭更适合我们未来找工作”，这其实是可以进一步展开的，但在文中限于篇幅只能一笔带过。其实我们可以拿自身做一个思想实验，思考这样一个问题：我们为什么要出国留学？如果我们的回答仅仅是扩展视野，那它不能解释为什么去西方发达国家的人要显著多于去落后的发展中国家的人，也不能解释为什么大家都渴望去名校。我想大部分在阅读这本书的同学未来有出国留学的梦想，希望你在阅读这篇范文的过程中也能够自己想一想为什么要出国。你想从出国这件事情中获得什么？你准备好应对出国的挑战了吗？想清楚了之后，如果是确定要出国深造，那么就要有破釜沉舟的气魄，坚定不移地向前进。

回到本文，有了第一主旨段这种务实的态度之后，我们再去看第二主旨段中的反驳就非常自然了：如果目的地国家的科教文化水平不如自己的国家，那么出去留学并无必要，甚至还可能带来不利的影响。最后，在讨论了对学生的影响之后，我们再从学校的角度来说这个政策有何利弊。之所以这么想，是因为题干当中说的是“学校应该要求学生”。正如我们上一篇范文里说到的主体和客体间的相互影响，我们既要从动作的接受方（学生）角度出发，也要从动作的施加者（学校）角度出发，这种思路可以用在绝大多数“A 应当要求 B”的题目上。

## 第二节 Argument 具体性指令与范文精讲

和 Issue 类似，新 GRE 的 Argument 也新添了 8 种（四大类）Direction。我们分别将其称为“Assumption 类”“Evidence 类”“Explanation 类”和“Question 类”。对于 Argument 这个词，我们可以把它理解为“用论据论证结论的过程”。因此，每一道 Argument 的题目就是一个论证过程。而我们要做的，就是从上述四大类 Direction 的角度去评价该论证过程是否完善。

需要注意的是，Argument 的 189 道题目中，有一些题目的题干非常类似甚至完全相同，但 Direction 不一样，这也就决定了我们的破题角度不一样。

与 Issue 部分一样，Argument 的评分标准中也明确提到，如果对 Direction 照应得不够，文章的分数不会超过 3 分。而通过之后的讲解，大家会发现 Argument 的 Direction 对我们行文的影响更大，换句话说，与 Issue 相比，Argument 的 Direction 更加“危险”。

然而，大多数同学在备考 Argument 的时候，仍然把破题角度放在了所谓的“逻辑错误”上，如“错误类比”“臆造因果”“问题数据”等等。很多同学也背了不少针对每种逻辑错误的语言模板。然而，这些语言模板基本上没能很好地照应新 GRE 中 Argument 的 Direction。所以，即便大家能够清楚地识别出 Argument 中的逻辑错误并且用已经背熟的语言将其表达出来，最终可能仍然免不了 3 分的结局。究其原因，就是因为没有按照 Direction 来写。

Argument 的 Direction 对我们行文影响巨大，这既是 Argument 备考的难点，其实也让我们的备考变得更有针对性和高效。因为面对 189 道 Argument 题目，我们只需要掌握四种思维和语言模板，分别对应四大类 Direction 就可以了。相比于老 GRE 中的十多种“逻辑错误”，新 GRE 中的四大类 Direction 更简洁，也更贴近 Argument 的论证本质。

下面就是一道 Argument 题目所应依循的破题步骤：

1. 通读文章，准确定位文章当中的论据和结论。
2. 依据论据和结论，在纸上（或在脑中）用逻辑图的方式再现原 Argument 的推理过程。（这一点非常重要，会影响到大家的全文结构和段落组织！）
3. 依照 Direction 的要求对原 Argument 进行分析。

下面我们就用一道题来具体说明以上三个步骤。其中的步骤 3 会分散到每一种 Direction 的讲解中。

例题举证

The following was written as a part of an application for a small-business loan by a group of developers in the city of Monroe.

"A jazz music club in Monroe would be a tremendously profitable enterprise. Currently, the nearest jazz club is 65 miles away; thus, the proposed new jazz club in Monroe, the C-Note, would have the local market all to itself. Plus, jazz is extremely popular in Monroe: over 100,000 people attended Monroe's annual jazz festival last summer; several well-known jazz musicians live in Monroe; and the highest-rated radio program in Monroe is 'Jazz Nightly,' which airs every weeknight at 7 P.M. Finally, a nationwide study indicates that the typical jazz fan spends close to $1,000 per year on jazz entertainment."

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

步骤 1：找出文章当中的论据和结论

**结论：**在 M 新开一个爵士乐俱乐部会很赚钱。

**论据：**（在这道题中，很多同学把除结论以外的部分都称为证据，其实这还不够准确，我们应该对剩下的部分再做如下的细分）

**分论点 1：**新爵士乐俱乐部在本地没有竞争对手。

**分论点 2：**爵士乐在 M 很受欢迎。

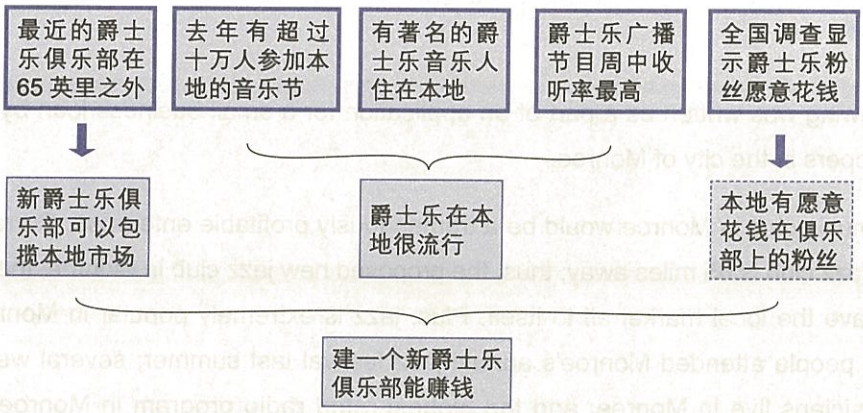
**分论点 3：**M 存在相当数量的愿意把钱花在爵士乐俱乐部上的粉丝。

其中的分论点 1（或称理论论据）是被"最近的爵士乐俱乐部在 65 英里之外"这个事实论据（即证据）所支持的；分论点 2 是被三个证据共同支持（超过十万人参加了去年的音乐节；有著名爵士音乐人住在本地；爵士乐广播节目在周中晚上收听率第一）；分论点 3 是被一个全国性调查所支持。

不难看出，分论点 3 并不是作者直接给出的，而是我们总结出来的。这种从证据中总结出论点的能力是大家需要培养的。

步骤 2：列出逻辑图

在步骤 1 中，我们不仅找出了证据和结论，而且已经把文章的论证框架进行了大致的梳理。下面我们通过逻辑图的形式让这一框架更加明显：




上图中，最上面一层的五个粗框代表作者给出的事实性的证据；中间一层的三个细框是作者由此推导而出的分论点，或称为理论论据，到这里作者一共做了三次推导，每次推导的结果就是一个新分论点的产生。其中第二层最右边的蓝框用虚线表示，代表这是作者没有在题目中明确提到的论点；最下面的框代表由三个分论点共同推出的文章的最终结论，在这里作者又做了一次推导。

无疑，每一次推导过程中都存在漏洞，使得文章的论证不够完善。而我们接下来的任务，就是根据不同具体性指令的特殊要求，从不同侧面对这道题的论证过程进行评价。

需要注意的是，每个同学列出的逻辑图可能都有所不同，特别是虚线框的部分会因人而异，这不要紧，重要的是逻辑图能够帮助我们整理作者的论证框架。在本书中，我们给出的每一篇范文后面都附有一个逻辑图，这些逻辑图的画法并非唯一，而我们遵循的原则是：大家可以根据这个逻辑图读懂作者的论证逻辑，同时也可以根据逻辑图组织出篇幅适宜的文章。所以，我们的大部分逻辑图都是以让大家写出 3~4 个中间段为目标所构建的。

下面我们就来看一下如何根据逻辑图，按照不同 Direction 的要求来分析题目。

## 1 “Assumption 类” Direction

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

**中文翻译**

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中，考查该文章提到的或者没有提到的前提条件。解释这些前提条件是如何支持题目的，并说明如果这些前提条件没有被证实会产生什么结果。

讲 解

每一道 Argument 的逻辑漏洞都出现在其推理过程中。而推理过程之所以有问题，就是因为存在一些可能不成立的 Assumption。我们通常把 Assumption 翻译为“前提”或者“假设”，其实，我们可以更加简易地将 Assumption 理解为“poorly supported claim（没有被很好地支持的论断）”。

需要注意的是，根据这种 Direction，我们需要找出题目中的 Assumption，但这些 Assumption 可能是作者明确提到的（stated），也可能是作者没有明确提到的（unstated）。

在上文的例题中，作者根据“旧爵士乐俱乐部在 65 英里外”这一事实证据，直接得出了“新爵士乐俱乐部在本地没有竞争对手”这一论断。显然，这一论断不一定成立，因为它缺乏足够的支撑信息，而这一个论断就可以被看作作者明确提到的论断（stated assumption）。而这一论断，又是进一步被其他主观臆造的 Assumption 所支持的。比如作者认为，人们没有车，所以会觉得 65 英里远，因此会去新开的爵士俱乐部；或者旧爵士乐俱乐部的服务、音乐品质等都不如新开的爵士乐俱乐部。而这些 Assumption，就属于作者没有明确提到的论断了（unstated assumption）。很明显，这些 Assumption 不一定成立，进而作者的“新爵士乐俱乐部在本地没有竞争对手”这一论断也就不成立。此时，全文的最终结论“新爵士乐俱乐部能赚钱”也就被削弱了。

同理，作者还根据“超过十万人参加去年的音乐节”“有著名爵士音乐人住在本地”“爵士乐广播节目在周中晚上收听率第一”这三个证据得出了“爵士乐在 M 很受欢迎”这一明确提到的论断（stated assumption）；并且根据一个全国调查得出了“M 存在相当数量的愿意把钱花在爵士乐俱乐部上的粉丝”这一暗示性的论断（unstated assumption）。最后，作者得出了“新爵士乐俱乐部能赚钱”这一结论。这几个论断和结论都不一定成立，就是因为在这些论断和结论的推导过程中还存在可能不成立的 Assumption。而我们需要做的，就是像上面一段所演示的那样，找到这些 Assumption，指出其不成立的情况，并且说明这些 Assumption 一旦不成立，作者的最终结论就会被削弱。

值得注意的是，Assumption 的数量是不一定的，找多少 Assumption，能写多少 Assumption，这完全取决于考生的能力和考试时间。

那么，我们要写几个自然段呢?

很多考生在遇到一道题的时候，对如何组织每一个自然段，以及要写几个自然段都是不清楚的。往往在认定 Argument 中的一句话有逻辑漏洞时，会用一段来论述这个问题；接着发现另一句话也有逻辑漏洞，则开启新的一段来论述这个问题。那么如果文章中有五句话都存在漏洞，可能就会写五个中间段（如本题）。殊不知，有一些自然段是可以合并的。而合并的依据，其实就是逻辑图。从逻辑图中我们可以清楚地看到，作者一共做了四次结论的推导，其中三次是从证据推导出分论点，第四次是从分论点推导出总结论。既然作者做了四次结论的推导，那我们就可以写四个中间段，每一个中间段分别讨论作者的每一次推导是否合理，有何缺陷。至于

如何讨论，那就要结合 Direction 了。比如这里，我们就需要从 Assumption 的角度来讨论。

至此，我们可以来总结一下如何应对 Assumption 类的 Direction：

如何写单段（每一段中都应包含下面所示的①②③，而不是①②③各成一段）：

① 找出原文中各论断或结论所依赖的 Assumption。

② 指出这些 Assumption 在什么情况下不成立。

③ 阐明这些 Assumption 一旦不成立，作者的结论就会被削弱。

如何把各个中间段组织起来：

根据逻辑图，作者做了几次结论的推导，就写几个中间段。

## 题库范文

**44** The following appeared in a letter to the editor of a journal on environmental issues.

"Over the past year, the Crust Copper Company (CCC) has purchased over 10,000 square miles of land in the tropical nation of West Fredonia. Mining copper on this land will inevitably result in pollution and, since West Fredonia is the home of several endangered animal species, in environmental disasters. But such disasters can be prevented if consumers simply refuse to purchase products that are made with CCC's copper unless the company abandons its mining plans."

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

In this letter to a journal on environmental issues, the author calls for a boycott of Crust Copper Company's product (CCC) because CCC's alleged mining plan in West Fredonia, home to endangered wildlife, will inevitably produce pollution and environmental disasters. Although it might be true that CCC's plan will have a huge environmental impact, the validity of the author's conclusion and the potential effectiveness of his or her recommendation depend on a number of assumptions. Unfortunately, such assumptions are open to challenge from at least four different angles.

To start with, the most fundamental assumption in the author's argument is that CCC buys those lands to mine copper. Yet, this may not be correct, because the land can be used in many ways. It is possible that this land purchased by CCC will be devoted to a research and development complex, which will produce far less pollution than conventional copper mining. If this is the case, the validity of the author's accusation and the recommendation will be seriously questioned.

Even if we acknowledge for a moment CCC will mine copper on the land of West Fredonia, the so-called "inevitable" causal linkage between mining and pollution assumed by the author requires a second look. After all, there are many technological solutions to pollution prevention, containment, and mitigation. For example, the waste water from mining activities could be treated and the toxins be neutralized before they are discharged into the environment. In the case of CCC, we are not sure if there will be equipment and protocols to deal with pollution, but if there is a well-established procedure to eliminate pollution, it's unreasonable to suggest CCC would be unavoidably polluting West Fredonia environment.

Provided that CCC indeed produces pollution as an inevitable consequence of copper mining taking place in its mining facilities, questions remain whether pollution will impact endangered animals in the area in West Fredonia. Here the author basically assumes that pollutants are lethal to endangered species, an assumption susceptible to challenges. It might be the case that pollution can be local and its impact does not reach the wildlife in West Fredonia. Or the severity of the pollution produced by CCC is low, posing only a very limited threat to wildlife habitats, refuting the author's claim and weakening his or her recommendation.

Granted that CCC is seriously polluting the natural habitat of several endangered species, the author's suggestion of boycott may not work. The underlying assumption behind such a suggestion is that the general public is the clients of CCC's copper products, which however is a weak one. For example, if CCC primarily sells its copper to military contractors, which use copper for manufacturing ordinance, and its business does not involve civilian consumers at all, the effect of consumer boycott may have little effect on CCC's behavior. Equally possible is that CCC's business revolves around raw materials and does not directly produce consumer products; it is the buyers of CCC's copper that do. In that case, consumers may find it very hard, if not impossible, to find out if the products they are to purchase contain copper from CCC. Either one of the cases, if true, will invalidate the assumption the author makes and render any consumer boycott against CCC futile.

To summary, the author's conclusion and suggestion to boycott CCC for the sake of wildlife protection is built upon a series of problematic and uncorroborated assumptions. Clearly when those assumptions are disproved by emerging evidence, the author's conclusion will be seriously weakened despite his or her good intentions in environmental conservation. (587 words)

**中文翻译**

在这封写给环境问题杂志的信中，作者呼吁抵制 CCC 的产品，因为 CCC 在濒危野生动物的家园西弗雷多尼亚所谓的采矿计划将不可避免地产生污染和造成环境灾难。尽管 CCC 的计划

可能会对环境产生巨大影响，但作者结论的有效性和建议的潜在成效取决于许多假设。不幸的是，这些假设至少从四个不同的角度受到挑战。

首先，作者的论点中最基本的假设是 CCC 购买这些土地来开采铜矿。然而，这并不一定正确，因为土地可以用于许多方面。CCC 购买的这片土地有可能被用来搞研发，这样产生的污染将远远低于传统的铜矿开采。如果是这样，作者的指控和建议的有效性将受到严重质疑。

即使我们暂时承认 CCC 将在西弗雷多尼亚的土地上开采铜矿，作者所假设的采矿和污染之间所谓“不可避免”的因果关系也需要重新审视。毕竟，在污染预防、控制和缓解方面，有许多技术解决方案。例如，采矿活动产生的废水可以进行处理，使毒素在排放到环境中之前可以中和。就 CCC 而言，我们不确定是否会有处理污染的设备和协议，但如果有一个完善的程序来消除污染，那么认为 CCC 将不可避免地污染西弗雷多尼亚的环境是不合理的。

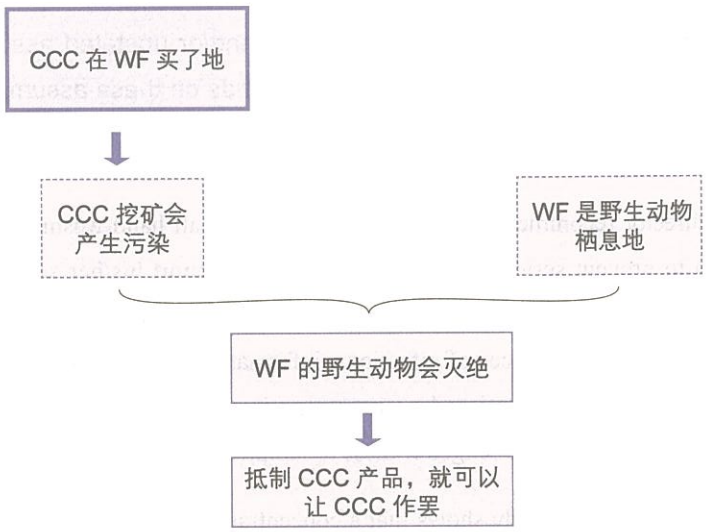
如果 CCC 的采矿设施中的铜矿开采不可避免地会产生污染，那么污染是否会影响西弗雷多尼亚地区的濒危动物仍然是个问题。在这里，作者基本上假设污染物对濒危物种是致命的，但这一假设容易受到挑战。污染可能是局部的，有可能不会影响到西弗雷多尼亚的野生动物。或者 CCC 造成的污染严重程度较低，对野生动物栖息地的威胁非常有限，这就驳斥了作者的说法，削弱了他或她的建议。

假如 CCC 严重污染了几种濒危物种的自然栖息地，作者的抵制建议可能行不通。这一建议背后的基本假设是，公众是 CCC 铜产品的客户，然而，这是一个很弱的观点。例如，如果 CCC 主要向军事承包商销售其铜产品，而军事承包商有铜制造条例，并且其业务根本不涉及平民消费者，那么消费者抵制的效果可能对 CCC 的行为影响不大。同样有可能的是，CCC 的业务围绕原材料展开，并不直接生产消费品；真正生产消费品的是 CCC 铜的买家。在这种情况下，消费者可能会发现即使不是不可能，也会很难查明他们要购买的产品是否含有来自 CCC 的铜。以上任何一种情况，如果属实，那么将使作者所做的假设无效，并使消费者抵制 CCC 的行为无效。

综上所述，作者基于保护野生动物的目的而给出抵制 CCC 的结论和建议是建立在一系列有问题的和未经证实的假设基础上的。显然，当这些假设被新出现的证据推翻时，尽管作者在环境保护方面有良好的意图，但是他或她的结论还是会受到严重削弱。

**文章解析与点评**

本文是 Argument 题库当中一道比较简单的题目，因为其逻辑基本上是线性的：从开头的信息（CCC 在西弗雷多尼亚购买土地）推导出会产生污染，进而导致物种灭绝，最后得出可以通过抵制产品来阻止这一生态灾难的发生。因为本题的行文结构很简单，中间没有复杂的支线推导，因此很适合刚开始准备 Argument 不久的同学练手。其逻辑导图如下所示：




逻辑导图中的箭头就是我们要挖掘的作者的逻辑问题和假设所在。

首先，作者在原文中说“在这片土地上开采铜矿不可避免地会造成污染（Mining copper on this land will inevitably result in pollution）”，但是我们要注意到作者其实假设了“买地就一定会用来挖矿”，但买地不一定会产生污染，这是我们的第一段。

第二，就算产生了污染，野生动物是否会灭绝？作者这里做了一个非常强的假设（“会造成环境灾难”），我们可以设想挖矿产生的污染被有效控制了，或者污染的强度或者范围不足以影响野生动物的存活。本文中我们对于这两点都进行了阐述，如果大家在考场上时间不足的话，可以只选取一点来写，而把时间留给下一段。

第三段是本文最重要的一个段落，因为它是题目最终的结论：通过抵制 CCC 公司的产品就可以避免环境灾难的发生。但我们不妨这样思考：在什么样的情况下抵制会是失败的？首先有可能 CCC 的产品不面向零售用户，其次有可能 CCC 的铜制品在产业链的上游，消费者无法识别哪些物品使用了 CCC 的铜，因此在这两种情况下抵制是无效的。本文中我们将这两点融合成一段来说，对于打字速度较快的同学而言可以拆解成两个独立的自然段，这样全文可以写成五个主旨段，内容上就很容易达到 5.5~6.0 分。

**62** The following appeared in a memo from the director of a large group of hospitals.

"In a laboratory study of liquid antibacterial hand soaps, a concentrated solution of UltraClean produced a 40 percent greater reduction in the bacteria population than did the liquid hand soaps currently used in our hospitals. During a subsequent test of UltraClean at our hospital in Workby, that hospital reported significantly fewer cases of patient infection than did any of the other hospitals in our group. Therefore, to prevent serious patient infections, we should supply UltraClean at all hand-washing stations throughout our hospital system."

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

In this memo, the director recommends supplying UltraClean to all hand-washing stations throughout the hospital system to prevent serious patient infections. To support his/her suggestion, the director presents two separate studies, one conducted in a lab and the other in the field. Although UltraClean may indeed help reduce the occurrences of infections, information currently available is not conclusive because there are several unsubstantiated assumptions in the author's reasoning. The director's recommendation will be seriously challenged if these assumptions prove to be unwarranted.

To start with, the laboratory study shows that a concentrated solution of UltraClean is excellent at reducing the number of bacteria. Based on an unstated assumption that the non-concentrated version of UltraClean is similarly effective, the director endorses the use of regular UltraClean in the hospitals. However, this assumption is potentially problematic because intuitively speaking a concentrated solution of UltraClean may naturally outperform the non-concentrated version. Even if we acknowledge this assumption, UltraClean may not necessarily be as effective as the liquid hand soap currently used in the hospitals. If this is the case, the director's assumption will not hold and his/her recommendation will be clearly weakened.

Additionally, the Workby hospital field study demonstrating that UltraClean use in hospitals can reduce cases of patient infections requires further examination. Whether or not UltraClean should be credited for this depends upon the assumption that the Workby hospital is comparable to those in other areas. For example, if the Workby hospital is extremely small and only receives a handful of patients each day, it would not be a surprise to see fewer numbers of infections. Moreover, the Workby hospital may be the best-staffed one in the region, and it is their attentiveness and expertise that keeps patient infections in check. For that reason, UltraClean may not necessarily be the key to few infections in the Workby hospital. As a result, the value of supplying UltraClean to other hospitals is debatable.

Even if we concede the aforementioned assumptions, the recommendation may still not be advisable because UltraClean is not shown to deal specifically with serious infections. The lab and field studies focused little, if at all, on serious infections. The director's recommendation here essentially relies on the two assumptions: (1) serious infections are caused by bacteria and (2) regular and serious infections are caused by a common agent which UltraClean can effectively eliminate. Both of these assumptions need more support. It is not impossible that serious infections are drastically different in terms of its pathological nature and are caused by viruses or parasites rather than bacteria. In this case,

it is very questionable if UltraClean, which only proves to be able to fight bacteria and reduce normal level of infections, can satisfactorily prevent serious patient infections.

To sum up, whether or not serious patient infections can be prevented by the use of UltraClean is still questionable and worth further investigation. The answer could turn out to be positive, but only after the director can reasonably demonstrate the validity of his/her assumptions by offering more compelling evidence. (503 words)

**中文翻译**

在这篇备忘录中，主任建议为整个医院系统的洗手站提供 Ultraclean，以防止严重的患者感染。主任为了支持自己的建议，提出了两个不同的研究——一个在实验室中进行，另一个则在实地进行。虽然 Ultraclean 可能确实有利于减少感染的发生，但现有信息并不足以得出这一结论，因为在作者的推理中有几处未经证实的假设。如果这些假设被证明是不合理的，那么主任的建议将受到严重的挑战。

首先，那项实验室研究表明 Ultraclean 的浓缩溶液在减少细菌数量上表现出色。主任基于没有言明的假设，即 Ultraclean 的非浓缩版本同样有效，赞同在医院使用普通版的 Ultraclean。然而，这个假设可能是有问题的，因为就直觉而言，Ultraclean 的浓缩溶液自会优于非浓缩版本。即使我们承认这一假设，Ultraclean 也不一定像目前医院使用的液体洗手皂一样有效。如果是这样的话，主任的假设不能成立，他的建议也将被明显削弱。

此外，我们需要进一步考察 Workby 医院的实地研究，该研究证明在医院使用 Ultraclean 可以减少患者感染的病例。（患者感染的减少）是否归功于 Ultraclean，这取决于 Workby 医院和其他地区的医院是否有可比性。例如，如果 Workby 医院规模很小，每天仅接收少量患者，那么他们有更少数量的感染并不奇怪。此外，Workby 医院可能是该地区员工素质最高的医院，员工的专注和专业知识使患者感染得到了控制。因此，Ultraclean 不一定是 Workby 医院感染数少的关键原因。向其他医院提供 Ultraclean 的建议的价值是有争议的。

即使我们承认上述假设为真，该建议仍可能是不可取的，因为我们不知道 Ultraclean 是否能专门应对严重感染。实验室和实地研究几乎没有关注严重感染。主任的建议本质上建立在两个假设上：1）细菌导致严重感染；2）普通感染和严重感染都是由 Ultraclean 可以有效消除的同一媒介物引起的。这两个假设都需要更多的支持。就病理性质而言，严重感染是截然不同的，它可能是由病毒或寄生虫而不是细菌引起的。在这种情况下，只被证明能抗菌和降低普通感染的 Ultraclean 能否有效防止严重的患者感染是非常可疑的。

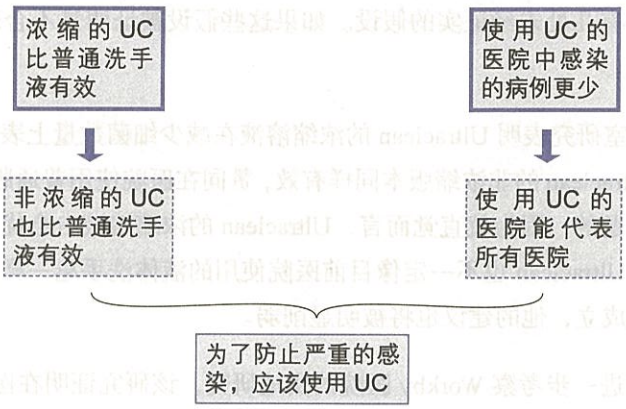
总而言之，使用 Ultraclean 能否防止严重的患者感染仍然存疑，并需要进一步调查。只有在主任通过更有力的证据、合理地证明其假设的有效性后，我们才能打消疑虑。

**文章解析与点评**

这篇文章本身的逻辑结构比较简单，但我们需要还原出一些主任暗示的 Assumption（见原文逻辑图）。

值得一提的是文章的第四段，文章对于主任在论证过程当中存在的细微的逻辑问题把握得很到位。实验中明确说道：UltraClean 在对抗 bacteria 时是有效的，但题目最终的结论是 UltraClean 能够 prevent serious patient infections 这一结论。这之间的推理值得商榷，如：serious infection 是否只由 bacteria 造成？如果其他原因也能造成 serious infection，那么 UltraClean 是否依然有效？

另外，文章每一段的论证结构十分清晰，先指明问题和 Assumption 所在，再解释原因，随即提出可能的反例，并最终分析 Assumption 不成立时的后果，这种论证的步骤大家可以借鉴。




**28** The following appeared in the summary of a study on headaches suffered by the residents of Mentia.

"Salicylates are members of the same chemical family as aspirin, a medicine used to treat headaches. Although many foods are naturally rich in salicylates, for the past several decades, food-processing companies have also been adding salicylates to foods as preservatives. This rise in the commercial use of salicylates has been found to correlate with a steady decline in the average number of headaches reported by participants in our twenty-year study. Recently, food-processing companies have found that salicylates can also be used as flavor additives for foods. With this new use for salicylates, we can expect a continued steady decline in the number of headaches suffered by the average citizen of Mentia."

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

In the summary of a study, the commercial use of salicylates is considered as the main cause of the decline in the average number of headaches suffered by the residents of Mentia, and thus the new use of this chemical as flavor additives will surely bring continued steady decline in the number of headaches. While the new use for salicylates may have the predicted result, this conclusion relies on several assumptions, but the evidence listed in the summary is neither strong nor pertinent enough to support the claim. When these assumptions prove wrong, the projection of the continued decline in the number of headaches will be greatly weakened.

First, the article cites a twenty-year study that reveals a steady decline in the number of reported headaches with an implicit assumption that the study is valid. Nonetheless, little information other than its 20-year duration is provided about the details of this study, and it raises the suspicion whether this study is well-founded in the first place. For example, if the study only tracks a very small number of participants, its result may not be statistically significant. Moreover, if the participants did not faithfully report their feelings about headaches, the conclusion of the study would be seriously challenged. As a result, without first demonstrating the logical soundness of the study, any further inference built upon that study remains questionable.

Even if we acknowledge for a moment that the study is valid and sound, it remains to be seen if the declining number of headaches suffered by Mentia residents can be confidently attributed to the commercial use of salicylates merely based on the fact that the decline is concurrent with an increased use of salicylates as food preservatives. Behind the author's lines of reasoning lies the assumption that concurrence equals causality, but in fact this type of causal association may well be false. Indeed, as mentioned in the passage, other kinds of medicines such as aspirin can also be used to treat headaches, providing a potential alternate cause for the purported decline in the number of headaches. It is possible that the participants in the study suffer less from headaches now because they have been taking other kinds of medicine or headache-curing substances. Unless additional evidence shows that the participants have not been taking any other medicines to treat headaches, the author's assumptive causal inference between the use of salicylates and the declining headache cases cannot be convincingly established. In this scenario, the subsequent prediction on the basis of this assumption will be cast into significant doubt.

Next, granted that the decline in the number of headaches is indeed caused by the increase in the commercial use of salicylates as preservatives, it remains questionable whether the new use of salicylates as flavor additives will cause a continued steady decline of headaches. The author assumes

that salicylates as preservatives will have the same effect as salicylates as flavor additives, but this assumption lacks evidence to support. For instance, the concentration of salicylates as flavor additives might be so low that it is incapable of producing any noticeable effect on reducing the number of headaches. It is also possible that other ingredients added to the foods as flavor supplements will adversely affect the effects of salicylates. If salicylates undergo certain biochemical reactions with other ingredients in the body after digestion and form new compounds without any treatment effects on headaches, there may be no further steady decline in the number of headaches. Either way, salicylates may not continue to produce the same treating effects as they did in the study, and the number of headaches may therefore not witness a steady decline in the future.

All in all, the assumptions made by the author are not convincing enough to lead to the predicted continued steady decline in the number of headaches. To establish a causal relationship between the new use of salicylates as additives and firmly corroborate the projected decline, more investigation must be made to exclude the possibilities listed above that can falsify the author's conclusion. (607 words)

**中文翻译**

在一项研究的总结中，水杨酸盐的商业用途被认为是曼蒂亚居民平均头痛次数下降的主要原因，因此，将这种化学物质作为风味添加剂的新用途必将使头痛次数持续稳定下降。虽然水杨酸盐的新用途可能有预期的结果，但这一结论依赖于几个假设，而该总结中列出的证据既不有力，也不相关，是不足以支持这一说法的。如果这些假设被证明是错误的，那么对头痛人数持续下降的预测将被大大削弱。

首先，文章引用了一项为期 20 年的研究，该研究揭示了报告的头痛人数稳步下降，并暗示了这项研究是有效的。然而，除了为期 20 年的研究这个信息之外，几乎没有提供有关该研究细节的信息，这首先就让人们怀疑该研究是否有充分根据。例如，如果研究仅追踪了极少数的参与者，则其结果可能不具有统计学意义。此外，如果参与者没有如实地报告他们对头痛的感受，则该研究的结论将受到严重挑战。因此，在没有证明该研究的逻辑合理性的情况下，任何建立在这项研究基础上的进一步推论都是值得怀疑的。

即使我们暂时承认这项研究是有效并且合理的，但是否将曼蒂亚居民头痛数量的下降归因于水杨酸盐的商业用途还有待观察，尽管数量的下降随着水杨酸盐作为食品防腐剂的使用在增加。在作者的推理思路背后，存在着并发等于因果关系的假设，但事实上，这种因果关系很可能是错误的。的确，正如文中提到的，阿司匹林等其他药物也可以用来治疗头痛，这为所谓的头痛数量下降提供了一个潜在的替代原因。这项研究的参与者可能因为服用了其他药物或治疗头痛的替代药物而减少了头痛。除非有其他证据表明参与者没有服用任何其他药物来治疗头痛，否则作者在使用水杨酸盐和头痛病例减少之间的假设因果推断不能令人信服。在这种情况下，基于这种假设的后续预测将受到重大质疑。

其次，假设头痛数量的下降确实是由于水杨酸盐作为防腐剂的商业用途的增加造成的，那么水杨酸盐作为风味添加剂的新用途是否会导致头痛持续稳定地下降仍然值得怀疑。作者认为作为防腐剂的水杨酸盐与作为风味添加剂的水杨酸盐具有相同的效果，但这一假设缺乏证据支持。例如，作为风味添加剂的水杨酸盐的浓度可能太低，以至于在减少头痛人数方面不能产生任何明显的效果。食品中添加的其他成分作为风味补充剂也可能对水杨酸盐的作用产生不利影响。如果水杨酸盐在消化后与体内其他成分发生某些生化反应，形成新的化合物，对头痛没有任何治疗作用，那么患有头痛的人数可能不会进一步稳定下降。不管怎样，水杨酸盐可能不会继续产生与研究中相同的治疗效果，因此未来患有头痛的人数可能不会稳步下降。

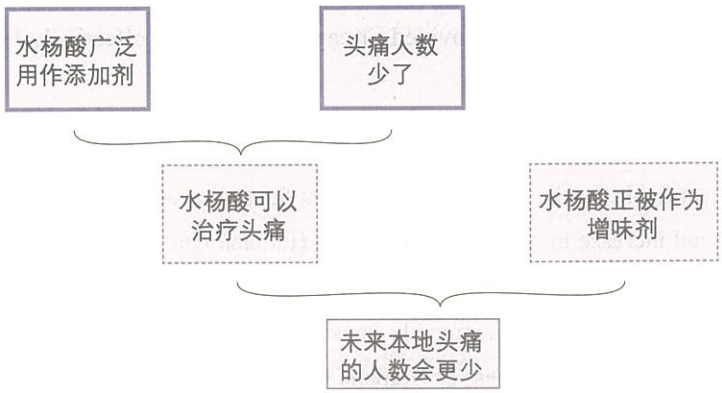
总而言之，作者所做的假设不足以令人信服，从而导致预计的头痛人数持续稳步下降。为了确定水杨酸盐作为添加剂的新用途之间的因果关系，并坚定地证实预计的下降，必须进行更多的调查，排除上述可能会歪曲作者结论的可能性。

### 文章解析与点评

本题存在两个很经典的 Argument 逻辑问题，也很适合刚刚上手的同学练习，以学习掌握这些经典逻辑问题的写法。首先，文章的论证建立在受访者报告头痛的人数下降这一信息之上，而这个研究如同一般的调查、问卷、访谈等研究一样，作者都是先假设其是正确的。那么我们自然可以发问，这些研究是如何进行的？其中受访者的数量有没有足够大并且随机？样本是不是具有普遍的代表性？如果这些回答是否定的，那么建立在这一信息之上的后续论证都存在问题。

第二，当我们认可了研究数据本身的可靠性之后，接下来存在的第二个经典逻辑问题我们可以称之为“同时发生的事情不一定有因果关系”。在本题中，作者把“上升的水杨酸使用量”和“下降的头痛数”用一个因果关系联系了起来，认为前者是后者的原因。但我们知道相关性不能代表因果关系，有可能是后者引起了前者，也有可能头痛人数的下降是其他因素导致的，与水杨酸的使用仅为巧合。我们在第二段中把作者所做出的“同时发生等于因果关系”这一假设指明。

最后我们将本题的逻辑框架罗列如下，以供大家参考。



**49** The following is part of a memorandum from the president of Humana University.

"Last year the number of students who enrolled in online degree programs offered by nearby Omni University increased by 50 percent. During the same year, Omni showed a significant decrease from prior years in expenditures for dormitory and classroom space, most likely because online instruction takes place via the Internet. In contrast, over the past three years, enrollment at Humana University has failed to grow and the cost of maintaining buildings has increased. Thus, to increase enrollment and solve the problem of budget deficits at Humana University, we should initiate and actively promote online degree programs like those at Omni."

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

In this argument, the author suggests that long-distance degree programs should be implemented and actively promoted in Humana University. To justify his or her recommendation, the author points out that the enrollment at Humana University has declined while the expense has ascended. On the contrary, Omni University, which has launched long-distance courses last year, saw a 50% increase in enrollment as well as a remarkable reduction in expenditures for classrooms and dormitories. This argument is obviously built upon several unsubstantiated assumptions, and thus, not strong enough to firmly justify a long-distance program in Humana University.

To begin with, the implications of the statistics about the enrollment of Omni University are vague because the author assumes that a 50% increase is substantial. However, this number is open to different interpretation since the percentage of increase is a relative figure determined by the enrollment not only in that year but also a year before. We are not informed of the actual number of students who registered for the long-distance program at Omni University, so it remains unsolved whether there was a real significant growth in enrollment. If, for example, only a tiny number of students participated in those courses the year before last, the 50% increase might turn out to be insignificant. Therefore, unless more detailed information about the data is provided, it cannot be used to effectively sustain the author's proposal.

Granted that the statistics presented above does suggest a considerable increase in student enrollment, it's unjustifiable for the author to assume that the policy adopted by Omni University could also lead to significant increase in student enrollment at Humana University. The reason is that without the information such as the reputation, location, faculty number and quality, available financial support and so on of the two universities, it is extremely questionable to rush to the conclusion that a distance degree programs can also achieve success at Humana University. For example, Omni University might

probably rank among the top universities worldwide and enjoys a great reputation, while Humana University is just a low-ranking one only few have ever heard of. Few people would pay attention to or trust the long-distance program of Humana University in that case.

Moreover, even if we concede that similar online program will attract more students to Humana, a concrete connection between the success of the online courses and the diminishment of the budget deficits is not convincingly established. In fact, launching such a program might be costly to the extent that Humana University's budget deficit could worsen as a result. After all, setting up a new long-distance, online program involves installation of new equipment, constant maintenance, active advertising, etc. Here, the author assumes that the large expenditures invested towards the online program would be covered by the additional tuition fees from the increased enrollment thanks to the long-distance degree program. Nevertheless, this is not a conclusion that can be confidently reached from the existing information. If it turns out that the cost of a new online program substantially outweighs the potential revenue increase, the author's recommendation will be much less persuasive.

To sum up, this proposal relies upon a series of problematic and unproven assumptions, which, when prove unwarranted, would render the author's conclusion less convincing. In order to fully evaluate whether a long-distance education program will succeed both in terms of student enrollment and of finance, a number of questions must be thoroughly investigated, including whether the purported success at Omni University is real, whether Humana can attract more students, and if it can, whether the cost of the online program will be smaller than the resultant increased revenue. (601 words)

**中文翻译**

在此论证中，作者建议在 H 大学实施并积极推广远程学位项目。为了证明他或她这一建议的合理性，作者指出 H 大学的入学率下降了，而花费却增加了。相反，去年推出远程课程的 O 大学，入学人数增加了 50%，而教室和宿舍方面的支出也明显减少。这一论点显然是建立在几个未经证实的假设之上的，不足以证明在 H 大学开办远程课程就是合理的。

首先，关于 O 大学的入学人数，其统计数据的含意是模糊的，因为作者认为 50% 的增长率是实质性的。然而，这个数据可以有不同的解释，因为增长的百分比是一个相对的数字，它不仅取决于当年的入学人数，而且还取决于前一年的入学人数。我们并不知道注册 O 大学的远程学习项目的实际学生人数，因此入学率是否确实有显著增长，尚无定论。例如，如果前一年只有极少数的学生参加了这些课程，那么 50% 的增加率可能就显得微不足道了。因此，除非提供更详细的数据信息，否则它不能有效支持作者的提议。

鉴于以上统计数据确实表明了学生入学人数有显著增加，作者因此认为 O 大学的政策同样可能会使 H 大学的学生入学人数大幅增加，这是不合理的。原因就在于，如果没有两所大学的声誉、地理位置、师资数量和质量、可获得的财政支持等信息，就急于得出远程学位项目也会

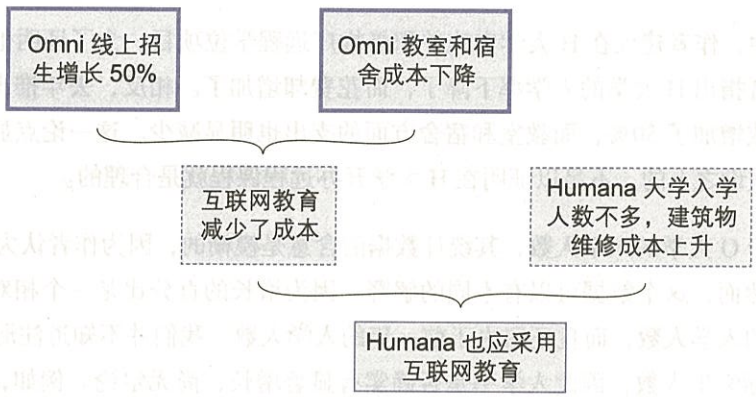
在 H 大学取得成功这样的结论是很令人质疑的。比如，O 大学可能位列全球顶尖大学之列，享有很高的声誉，而 H 大学只是一所只有很少人听说过的排名较低的大学。在这种情况下，很少有人会关注或信任 H 大学的远程教育项目。

此外，即使我们承认类似的在线项目会吸引更多的学生来 H 大学学习，但是关于在线课程的成功与预算赤字的削减之间的具体关联是很难让人信服的。事实上，启动这样一个项目有可能会让 H 大学的预算赤字更加糟糕。毕竟，设立一个新的远程在线课程项目需要安装新设备，还要进行不断的维修以及要积极地进行广告宣传。因此，作者假设，由于远程学位课程的实施，在线课程的巨额投资将由入学人数的增加所产生的额外学费来支付。然而，这不是一个可以从现有的信息中得出的结论。如果事实证明新的在线项目的成本大大超过了潜在收入增长，那么作者的建议就不会那么有说服力了。

总而言之，这一建议依赖于一系列有问题的且未经证实的假设，如果这些假设被证明毫无根据时，就会使作者的结论缺乏说服力。为了全面评估远程教育项目是否会在招生和财务方面取得成功，许多问题还需要进行彻底地调查，包括 O 大学所谓的成功是否属实，H 大学是否可以吸引更多的学生，以及如果 H 大学可以吸引更多的学生，在线项目的成本是否会少于由此而增加的收入。

**文章解析与点评**

本文是题库当中的一道高频题目，其中的逻辑问题也是很经典的“类比论证”，也即：一个政策和措施在别的地方看起来取得了成功，因而建议把这一套做法拿到本地来实施。其简要的逻辑框架如下图所示：




对于这一类论证而言，我们可以思考三个方面的问题：第一，所谓的成功是真正的成功吗？第二，就算真的成功了，我们可以把原因归为题目中所说的政策吗？第三，就算政策真是有效的，在别处成功的经验可否复制到本地？这一套逻辑可以适用于几乎所有类比论证的 Argument 题目，大家可以将这种模板记在心中。

对于本题来说，50% 的增长真的是巨大的进步吗？这是可以讨论的第一点。然后就算招生人数真的代表了 Omni 大学的成就，这是不是因为互联网教育的缘故呢？这一点我们没有在文章中写出，但是大家不妨想一想，也许 Omni 除了网络教育之外还采取了一些新的政策，例如更多的奖学金等，这才使得招生数量上升。再者，就算 Omni 成功了，这一策略也不一定适用于 Humana，因为两者不一定具备可比性。

当然，在本题当中我们选择了上面的第一和第三点进行分析，而在后续论证过程中增加了一段关于成本和收益的考虑。之所以这么写，是因为题目最终落足于“减少 Humana 大学的财政赤字”这一点上。作者认为，通过开启线上课程可减少宿舍和教室的支出，但是作者没有考虑这个线上项目本身也是需要开支的，如果这部分的成本高于减少的支出，那么最终从预算来看是得不偿失的。如果大家在考场上有充足时间的话，不妨把四段论证全部写出来，这样文章可以冲击 5.5~6 分。

144 The citizens of Forsythe have adopted more healthful lifestyles. Their responses to a recent survey show that in their eating habits they conform more closely to government nutritional recommendations than they did ten years ago. Furthermore, there has been a fourfold increase in sales of food products containing kiran, a substance that a scientific study has shown reduces cholesterol. This trend is also evident in reduced sales of sulia, a food that few of the healthiest citizens regularly eat.

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

In this argument, the author claims that Forsythe citizens have adopted a more healthful lifestyle based on a survey and some market facts. Although this conclusion might be correct, there are some flaws in his lines of reasoning that prevent us making an informed judgment. Specifically, his or her conclusion relies upon a series of unfounded assumptions, which, when prove unwarranted, will seriously weaken the claim that Forsythe citizens have adopted a healthier lifestyle.

To start with, the author cites a survey about people's conformity to nutritional recommendations with an underlying assumption about the validity of this survey. Yet, no additional supporting information is provided and this survey could be problematic because we do not know where it was conducted and how many people were interviewed. If it turns out that this survey was done in a grocery store specialized in organic foods that targets a specific group of people, the result could be potentially biased while in reality most consumers would not conform to national nutritional recommendations better than they did ten years ago. In this case the survey would be invalid, and the subsequent interpretation wouldn't be meaningful.

Second, before the implication of the change in the sale of products containing kiran could be made, we need to consider if such products are truly wholesome as the author implicitly assumes. While kiran itself may contain health benefits, other substances in those products might be detrimental, because of the toxic chemicals they might contain during the manufacturing processes. Such scenarios cannot be confidently rejected by the available information presented by the author, and a thorough report on the health effects of the food products containing kiran is needed to evaluate different possibilities. The author's argument could be weakened should the report find those products capable of producing negative impacts on human health.

Third, the author quotes the decrease in the sale of sulia, which the healthiest citizens rarely eat, and assumes this is a piece of evidence that people have acquired a more healthful lifestyle. Nonetheless, he or she does not conclusively establish that the change is driven by people's health awareness. In reality, many factors can change the sale of a particular food product. Given the limited amount of information we can't determine if health awareness is the decisive one. For example, it may later turn out that people refrain from purchasing sulia due to its exorbitant price, and in this case the sale of sulia does not lend any support to the author's conclusion.

Finally, even if we acknowledge that all the aforementioned assumptions are valid and the interpretation of the change in sales of different products is reasonable, a critical question still needs our close attention: can eating habits accurately and faithfully reflect people's health lifestyle? While the author here assumes a strong link, the true answer may not be the case. A more comprehensive study on the lifestyles of Forsythe residents would be highly valuable with regard to this question. If the new study reveals a strong commitment to physical exercise and mental well-being in addition to nutrition intake, the author's conclusion will undoubtedly be more convincing.

To sum up, although it may be true that Forsythe citizens now have a more healthful lifestyle, this conclusion cannot be safely deduced from the author's argument and lines of reasoning due to some of his or her questionable assumptions. When these assumptions turn out to be wrong, his or her conclusion about the lifestyle of the citizens of Forsythe will be substantially undermined. (578 words)

**中文翻译**

在这封信中，作者基于一项调查和一些市场情况，就认为福赛斯市民已采取了更健康的生活方式。尽管这个结论可能是正确的，但他或她的推理思路中仍有一些缺陷，妨碍我们做出明智的判断。具体来说，他或她的结论依赖于一系列毫无根据的假设，当这些假设被证明是毫无根据的时候，将严重削弱福赛斯市民已经采取更健康的生活方式这一说法。

首先，作者引用了一项有关人们遵从营养建议的调查，并对该调查的有效性做了基本假设。但是，没有提供其他支持信息，这项调查可能是有问题的，因为我们不知道调查是在哪里进行的，

也不知道采访了多少人。如果这项调查是在一家专门针对特定人群的有机食品杂货店进行的，结果可能会有偏差，而实际上大多数消费者也不会比十年前更好地遵守国家营养建议。在这种情况下，调查将是无效的，后续的解释也将毫无意义。

第二，在给出含有 kiran 的产品销量发生变化的暗示之前，我们需要考虑这些产品是否如作者所声称的那样是真正有益健康的。虽然 kiran 本身可能是有益健康的，但这些产品中的其他物质可能有害，因为它们在制造过程中可能含有有毒化学物质。作者提供的现有资料不能完全否定这种情况，需要一份关于含 kiran 的食品对健康影响的详细报告，以评估不同的可能性。如果报告发现这些产品能够对人类健康产生负面影响，那么作者的论点可能会被削弱。

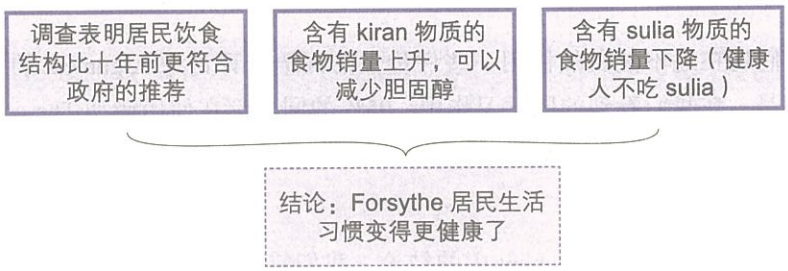
第三，作者引用了健康市民很少吃的 sulia 销量下降的例子，并假设这是一个证据，可以证明人们已经获得了更健康的生活方式。尽管如此，他或她并没有最终确定这种变化是由人们的健康意识推动的。在现实中，许多因素可以改变一种特定食品的销售。鉴于信息量有限，我们无法确定健康意识是否是决定性因素。例如，后来可能会发现，由于 sulia 的价格过高，人们不再购买它，在这种情况下，sulia 的销量并不能支持作者的结论。

最后，即使我们承认上述所有假设都是正确的，对不同产品销量变化的解释也是合理的，一个关键问题仍然需要我们密切关注：饮食习惯能否准确、忠实地反映人们的健康生活方式？虽然作者在这里假设了一个强有力的联系，但真正的答案可能不是这样。针对这一问题，对福赛斯居民的生活方式进行更全面的研究将具有很高的价值。如果新的研究表明，除了营养摄入外，人们还非常重视体育锻炼和精神健康，那么作者的结论无疑会更有说服力。

综上所述，尽管福赛斯市民现在的生活方式可能更健康，但由于作者的一些可疑的假设，不能从作者的论证和推理中有效地得出这一结论。当这些假设被证明是错误的，他或她关于福赛斯市民生活方式的结论将被大大削弱。

### 文章解析与点评

这道题目的结构很简单，作者通过三个并列的证据得出了 F 地居民生活习惯变得更为健康的结论，框架如下：




我们不难看出，这三个信息本身都存在一些问题，这些变化不一定真实反映出 F 地居民在饮食习惯上的变化。例如某种物质的摄入量发生了变化，究竟是人们的健康意识发生了改变，

还是仅仅是这些物质的价格发生了变化？针对每一个单独的点我们都可以进行分析，这是最为简单的分析方法。

但是，如果只分析以上的内容，文章的分数不会高于 5 分，因为本文还有一个很重要但是却很隐秘的点——饮食习惯能否真实反映出健康的生活习惯？这里作者其实做了一个偷换概念的假设，把生活习惯与饮食习惯等同了起来。这一类型的“偷换概念”在 GRE 作文中往往是不容易发现的点，但是却非常重要。很多时候一个概念的变化可以成为破题的关键（请看本书中 Argument 第 50 题薰衣草治疗失眠一题，位于下一章 Evidence 类题目讲解中），其他时候则成为了冲击高分的必备段落。

## 2 “Evidence 类” Direction

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

**中文翻译**

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中，讨论一下需要哪些具体的证据来评价这个 Argument，解释这些证据将如何加强或削弱这个 Argument。

**讲　解**

其实，这种 Direction 的思路和 Assumption 类 Direction 的思路大体一致。原 Argument 的逻辑漏洞主要出在推理过程中，亦即原 Argument 的推理过程是不完善的。

如何不完善呢？我们无法确认其中的一些 Assumption 是否成立。

那为什么我们无法确认呢？因为重要证据不足。

所以，由于重要证据的缺失，我们还无法判断 Argument 的一些 Assumption 是否成立，也就因此无法判断其结论是否成立。

因此，我们现在还不能贸然使用一些评价性的词语来评论原 Argument 的结论是否成立或者正确。但是，在我们看到的同学习作中，95% 的同学都在使用诸如 The conclusion of the argument is wrong/unconvincing/flawed 一类的评价性的表达。这样一来，其实就偏离了 Direction 的要求。

既然现在我们无法评价 Argument 中的结论，我们需要怎么做呢？——我们需要完善推理过程。如何完善？——我们需要像 Direction 所要求的那样，提供新的具体的证据（specific evidence）。有了新的证据，我们就可以评价原 Argument 的结论了，并且，这种评价既可以是正面（加强其结论 /strengthen）的，也可以是负面（削弱其结论 /weaken）的。

还是拿那道题举例，为了更好地评价“新爵士乐俱乐部在本地没有竞争对手”这一论断是否真的成立，除了作者给出的“旧爵士乐俱乐部在 65 英里外”这一证据之外，我们还需要找出其他证据和信息。诸如：本地人的私家车拥有量，旧爵士乐俱乐部的服务质量、音乐品质、消费水平，等等。如果新证据表明本地人有车，或者旧的爵士乐俱乐部的服务好、音乐品质高、消费低，那么人们可能就不会去新开的爵士乐俱乐部，这样一来，作者的结论就被削弱了。如果新证据表明相反的内容，那么作者的结论就被增强了。

这道题剩下的部分，以及诸段落的组织方式，都可以参考上一种 Direction 的讲解。唯一的区别，就是我们现在要从 Evidence（证据）的角度来评价作者的结论。

让我们来总结一下如何应对 Evidence 类的 Direction：

如何写单段（每一段中都应包含下面所示的①②③，而不是①②③各成一段）：
① 指出我们现在还无法评价作者的某一个论断。
② 说明为了更好地评价这一论断，我们还需要什么样的新证据。
③ 用新证据削弱或者增强作者的这一论断。

如何把各个中间段组织起来：
根据逻辑图，作者做了几次结论的推导，就写几个中间段。

## 题库范文

6 Arctic deer live on islands in Canada's arctic regions. They search for food by moving over ice from island to island during the course of the year. Their habitat is limited to areas warm enough to sustain the plants on which they feed and cold enough, at least some of the year, for the ice to cover the sea separating the islands, allowing the deer to travel over it. Unfortunately, according to reports from local hunters, the deer populations are declining. Since these reports coincide with recent global warming trends that have caused the sea ice to melt, we can conclude that the purported decline in deer populations is the result of the deer's being unable to follow their age-old migration patterns across the frozen sea.

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

In this argument, the author cites reports from local hunters as evidence for the decline of the arctic deer populations, and subsequently attributes this decline to global warming, which allegedly makes deer unable to follow their migration patterns across the frozen sea. Although the argument seems plausible at first glance, a close scrutiny will reveal that additional evidence is necessary for an effective evaluation of its validity.

Firstly, the author asserts a decrease in the deer populations merely based on reports from local hunters. However, such reports may not serve as a convincing indicator, since the deer might have intentionally avoided direct contact with hunters in order to survive the hunting. Therefore, more persuasive evidence must be presented for a better evaluation of the populations. For example, a scientific study surveying the entire area could offer much stronger evidence for the change in deer populations. If the results of the study show that the overall populations are indeed on the decline, it will be justifiable for the argument to further discuss the reasons for it. On the other hand, if the results evidence constant or even increasing populations, the discussion of reasons for the decline in populations in the argument will be rendered groundless.

Secondly, specific evidence regarding the change of temperature in the arctic regions is also needed to evaluate the author's reference of global warming. This is because the earth's climate is an intricate system and the trend of global warming does not necessarily result in an increase in temperature and cause sea ice to melt in the local arctic regions of interest. If local temperature data illustrate a non-varying or even colder climate, the adoption of global warming to account for phenomena in these regions will be highly suspicious. On the contrary, local temperatures that manifest a climate change consistent with the general trend of global warming will help strengthen this point of reasoning in the argument.

Furthermore, even if we corroborate the decline in deer populations and acknowledge a warmer climate in the arctic regions, further evidence is still necessary for an evaluation of the author's causal association of the decline in deer populations with the increased local temperatures. As a matter of fact, the populations of deer depend on more factors than climate alone, such as the quantity of their predators and epidemics. Consequently, it is of great significance to examine all the possible causes for population changes, and find out evidence for the roles they are playing. If evidence demonstrates that reasons other than increased temperatures are primarily responsible for the observed population decline, the purported link between this decline and climate change will be greatly weakened. Nevertheless, on condition that evidence is found to be able to testify the negligibility of all the other influences and rule out all the alternative explanations for the population decline, the causal relationship between the decrease and warmer climate, claimed in the argument, will be considerably strengthened.

Finally, granted that the deer populations do decline due to increased local temperatures associated with the global warming, concrete evidence still remains desirable to evaluate the author's assertion that it is via disturbing the deer's migration patterns that the warmer climate reduces the populations. As mentioned above, the survival of deer relies on numerous factors, many of which are likely to be affected by temperature, and hence evidence from investigation into all these temperature dependent factors has to be obtained. Provided that such evidence reveals, for instance, that the higher temperatures endanger plants the deer mainly feed on and that the population drop is a result of food shortage caused by increased

temperatures but not inability to migrate, the conclusion of the argument will prove untenable. Conversely, evidence undoubtedly exhibiting that the warmer climate melts the sea ice and leads to the deer's failure to follow the old-aged migration pattern and ultimately their massive death will be in strong support of the proposed reason for the drop of deer populations in the argument.

To sum up, evidence beyond what has been brought forward by the author is required for a legitimate evaluation of the reasoning and conclusion of the argument. Specifically, detailed and reliable evidence concerning the deer populations, the climate change in the arctic regions, as well as all the factors that are capable of affecting the deer populations, whether temperature dependent or not, will be helpful with evaluating the credibility of the argument. (735 words)

**中文翻译**

在这一论证中，作者引用了当地猎人的报告作为北极鹿数量下降的证据，并随后将这种下降归因于全球变暖，据称全球变暖使得鹿无法按照它们穿越冰冻海洋的迁徙模式迁移。尽管这一论证乍一看似乎是合理的，但仔细研究就会发现，要有效评估其正确性，还需要另外的证据。

首先，作者仅根据当地猎人的报告就断言鹿群的数量正在减少。然而，这样的报告可能不能作为一个令人信服的指标，因为鹿可能为了生存故意避免与猎人直接接触。因此，必须提出更有说服力的证据，以便更好地评估鹿的数量。例如，一项调查整个地区的科学研究可以为鹿群数量的变化提供更有力的证据。如果研究结果表明，鹿的总数量确实在下降，那么进一步讨论其原因是有道理的。另一方面，如果结果表明鹿的总数量是不变的，甚至是不断增加的，那么该论证中关于鹿的总数量下降原因的讨论就毫无根据。

其次，还需要有关北极地区气温变化的具体证据来评价作者对全球变暖的援引。这是因为地球的气候是一个复杂的系统，全球变暖的趋势并不一定会导致气温上升，也不一定会导致北极地区的海冰融化。如果当地的气温数据表明气候是不变的，甚至更冷，那么用全球变暖来解释这些地区的现象将令人怀疑。相反，当地的气温表明气候变化与全球变暖的总趋势一致，这将有助于加强这一论证的推理。

此外，即使我们证实鹿的数量减少了，并承认北极地区的气候变暖，仍然需要进一步的证据来评估作者关于鹿群数量减少与当地气温升高的因果关系。事实上，鹿的数量取决于更多的因素，而不仅仅是气候因素，例如捕食者数量和流行病。因此，研究所有可能导致数量变化的原因，并找出它们所起作用的证据，具有十分重要的意义。如果有证据表明，除了气温升高之外，其他原因是导致观察到的鹿群数量减少的主要原因，那么这种减少与气候变化之间的所谓联系就会被大大削弱。然而，如果找到证据能够证明其他影响因素可以忽略不计，并排除所有其他导致数量减少的解释，那么，该论证所主张的数量减少与气候变暖之间的因果关系就会大大加强。

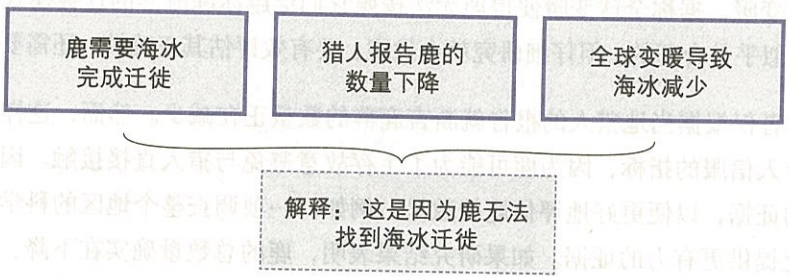
最后，尽管鹿群数量确实由于全球变暖导致的当地气温上升而减少，但仍然有确凿的证据来评估作者的论断，即气候变暖是通过干扰鹿群的迁徙模式而导致鹿的数量减少的。如上所述，

鹿的生存依赖于许多因素，其中很多可能受到气温的影响，因此必须通过对所有这些依赖于气温的因素的调查来获得证据。例如，如果这些证据表明，较高的气温危及到鹿赖以生存的植物，而且鹿群数量的下降是由于气温升高而引起的食物短缺，而不是由于无法迁徙，那么该论证的结论将站不住脚。相反，如果有证据表明气候变暖引起海冰融化，从而导致鹿无法遵循古老的迁徙模式，并最终大量死亡，这将有力地支持该论证中提出的鹿群数量下降的原因。

总而言之，除了作者所提出的证据之外，还需要有其他证据来合理地评价该论证的推理和结论。具体来说，关于鹿的数量、北极地区气候变化以及所有能够影响鹿的数量的因素（无论是否依赖于气温）的详细可靠证据将有助于评估其可信度。

### 文章解析与点评

本题围绕着几个独立的线索得出一个总的结论：鹿的数量下降（根据猎人的汇报）是源自于全球变暖导致的海冰减少，进而引起鹿群无法迁徙。其逻辑导图如下所示：




和之前所看到的单线程递进推导不同，本文的题干是纯粹的并联，也即基础的信息之间彼此不相关，因此在论证过程中我们可以各个击破。

本文第一段我们选择了猎人的报告，这里本质上是一个调查——调查数据能否真实反映客观世界的情况？对于本题来说，就是猎人的感觉是不是客观且真实的？显然这是不一定的，因为猎人的观测本质上是一种主观的感受，可能与客观世界的情况存在偏差（bias）。譬如本文所说的鹿也许变聪明了，刻意躲着猎人，这样即便鹿的总数不变，也会给猎人一种鹿的数量在下降的错觉。因此，我们指出还需要更多的证据来判断鹿的数量是否真的在下降。这里有同学可能会问，为什么我们不把“鹿需要海冰完成迁徙”这句话放在第一段讨论呢？原因在于这一句话本身在此处是背景信息的介绍，而非进行逻辑上的推论，因此在写 Argument 的过程中不需要分析其正确与否。

接下来在确认鹿群数量下降之后，我们可以开始思考其下降的原因。原文给出的理由其实包含两层：第一层是宏观上的全球变暖，第二层是微观上的作用机制——海冰融化之后鹿群无法迁徙。为此，我们也要拆解成两段进行分析，并按照逻辑的演绎先分析是否与全球变暖相关，再分析就算与之相关，具体的机制又有哪些。相信想到这两层的同学肯定会想到，能导致一个种群数量变化的因素太多了，一方面是天敌，一方面是食物。这里我们选择天敌（人类）作为全球变暖之外的另一种可能原因，而把因气候变暖导致的食物短缺当作海冰减少的竞争选项。

而这些可能性都是现有的信息无法判断的，我们还需要更多的证据来进行评价。至此，文章的三个论证段就呼之欲出了。

最后需要提醒大家注意的是，本题也曾在老 GRE 时代的作文题库中出现过，因此目前网络上可能流传着本文早期的“高分版本”。但需要注意的是，随着新写作指令的引入，除了 Assumption 以外的题目已经不能用老 GRE 的思路来应对了。如果强行生搬硬套，会导致题目不符合 direction 从而打低分。比如下面是一段老 GRE 的文字，大家可以感受一下与本文的区别，但不要模仿。

“Firstly, the author alleges there has been a decrease of deer population merely based on the report from local hunters, which is questionable since local hunters cannot cover the whole arctic region, and thus be unable to provide accurate data concerning deer population. It is very likely that deer have intentionally avoided direct contact with hunters in order to survive the hunting. In such a case, hunters would have naturally observed less deer while the whole population remains the same or even rises. Hence, with inadequate information offered by the author, it's unclear whether the deer population has decreased or not.”

**1** Woven baskets characterized by a particular distinctive pattern have previously been found only in the immediate vicinity of the prehistoric village of Palea and therefore were believed to have been made only by the Palean people. Recently, however, archaeologists discovered such a “Palean” basket in Lithos, an ancient village across the Brim River from Palea. The Brim River is very deep and broad, and so the ancient Paleans could have crossed it only by boat, and no Palean boats have been found. Thus it follows that the so-called Palean baskets were not uniquely Palean.

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

The author of this article argues that since a type of basket that is originally thought to be produced solely in the prehistoric village of Palea was found in Lithos, the purportedly “Palean baskets” are not uniquely Palean. To further support this argument, he/she emphasizes that as Palea and Lithos are divided by the broad and deep Brim River, the only means of transportation between them is by boat. Since boats have not been found in Palea thus far, the basket could not have been transported across the river. Although the presence of an alleged Palean basket in Lithos may indeed suggest that Lithos also produced similar baskets, more evidence is needed to help us evaluate the author's conclusion. Close scrutiny reveals several key conclusions in his/her argument that lack critical support.

Firstly, evidence revealing Brim River's geologic past is critically needed to assist the evaluation of the author's assertion that the Brim River has always been deep and broad and could only have been

crossed by boat. Thus far, this assertion does not receive any support and could possibly be wrong, since Earth's geologic features could have changed over thousands of years. A long and continuous record of river sediments may help us determine the Brim River's history. If it shows the Brim River was indeed broad and inaccessible when civilizations in Palea and Lithos first developed and thrived, the author's argument will be undoubtedly strengthened. If, however, it turns out that the Brim River was a shallow creek or even did not come to existence at all when humans first settled in this region, then we must reject the assertion that Palean baskets could only have reached Lithos by boat.

Secondly, even if we acknowledge for now that the Brim River has always been broad and deep since the human settlement in Lithos and Palea, more evidence is needed to help us evaluate whether boats were unavailable in the entire region. The author mentions that no boats were found in Palea, but gives no information regarding boats in other villages. If new discoveries indicate that Lithos villagers possessed boats, the transportation of Palean baskets by boat was possible and the Palean basket found in Lithos could indeed have been transported in this way. On the contrary, new evidence revealing an absence of boats in the entire Brim River vicinity during this time would help support the conclusion that the so-called Palean baskets are not unique to Palea.

Finally, granted that no boat was available to cross the Brim River, we must consider the possibility that the baskets could have been transported indirectly on land from Palea to Lithos. Yet, based on current information offered by the author it is challenging to evaluate the likelihood of such a scenario. If additional evidence emerges suggesting that trade was prevalent in this region and that both Lithos and Palea were actively engaged in trade, the author's argument will be weakened, since the baskets could have been merchandise that made its way from Palea to Lithos via a large trade network. On the other hand, if we have evidence such as local chronicles indicates Palea and/or Lithos societies were relatively isolated and had limited interaction with nearby prehistoric villages, then it is unlikely that Palean baskets could have arrived in Lithos. In this case, the author's conclusion is strengthened.

To summarize, the evidence which the author quotes does not provide conclusive information about the origin of the basket found in Lithos. As a consequence, we need additional information to better evaluate of the author's claim. (593 words)

**中文翻译**

本文的作者认为由于在 Lithos 发现了最初被认为只在史前村庄 Palea 生产的篮子，因此所谓的“Palea 篮子”并不是为 Palea 所独有的。为了进一步支持这一论点，他/她强调 Palea 和 Lithos 被一条既广且深的 Brim 河所分隔，它们之间唯一的交通工具是船只。由于目前为止还没有在 Palea 发现船只，篮子不可能被跨河运送。虽然在 Lithos 存在的那个所谓的 Palea 篮子可能确实证明了 Lithos 也生产类似的篮子，但我们需要更多的证据来评价作者的结论。仔细的研究揭示出，作者论点的几个重要结论都缺乏关键证据。

首先，我们极为需要能揭示 Brim 河地质变迁的证据，来帮助评价作者的主张——Brim 河一直以来都既广且深，只能坐船通过。到目前为止，没有任何证据支持这一主张，它可能是错的，因为地球的地貌在数千年的时间中可能已经发生了改变。一份长期而连续的河流沉积的记录可以帮助确定 Brim 河的历史。如果它表明 Brim 河过去也很宽，在 Palea 和 Lithos 的文明首次发展和繁荣时，它并不能轻易通过，那么作者的论点无疑就被强化了。然而，如果事实证明 Brim 河一度是条浅溪，或在人们第一次定居此地时尚不存在，那么我们就不能同意“Pelea 篮子只能通过船被运到 Lithos”的主张。

第二，即使我们暂且承认 Brim 河自人们定居 Lithos 和 Palea 以来就既广且深，我们也需要更多的证据来帮助我们评估整个地区是否都没有船只。作者提到 Palea 没有发现船只，但没有提供有关其他村庄的船只信息。如果新的发现表明 Lithos 村民有船，那么用船运输 Palea 篮子是有可能的，而在 Lihos 发现的 Palea 篮子可能正是如此被送过去的。相反，若有新的证据表明整个 Brim 河附近地区在这一时期都没有船，那么作者“所谓的 Palea 篮子并不是 Palea 独有”的结论就获得了支持。

最后，即使姑且认为没有船能让人通过 Brim 河，我们也必须考虑篮子可以间接地经陆路从 Palea 运到 Lithos 的可能性。然而，根据作者提供的现有信息，评估这种情况的可能性存在一定挑战。如果有额外的信息表明该地区的贸易十分普遍，且 Lithos 和 Palea 都积极参与贸易，那么作者的论点就被削弱了，因为篮子可能经由一个大型贸易网络从 Palea 被卖到了 Lithos。另一方面，如果我们有如本地编年史这样的证据表明 Palea 和 / 或 Lithos 社会相对孤立，并且与附近的史前村庄互动有限，那么 Palea 篮子就不太可能被卖到 Lithos。在这种情况下，作者的结论就得到了强化。

总而言之，作者援引的证据不能提供关于在 Lithos 发现的篮子的确切起源信息。因此，我们需要更多的信息来更好地评估作者的主张。

### 文章解析与点评

文章的基本语气客观，并没有强调论证作者一定错了，而是在每一段都反复强调“现有证据不足以支撑作者的观点”，同时举出了作者可能错误的情况。

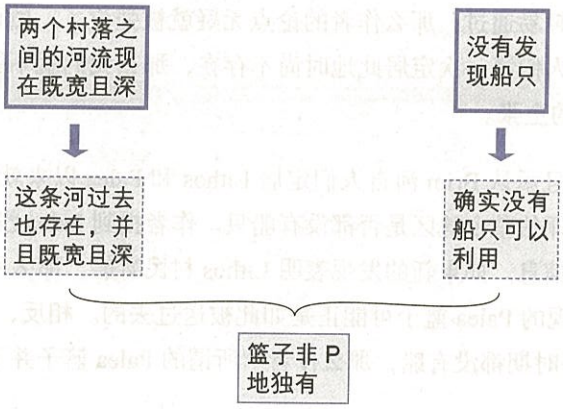
本文的两个论证要点是：1. 两个村落之间的河流在过去可能不存在，或者并不如现在这样既宽且深，所以人们可以自由渡河；2. 现在没有发现任何船只，不代表过去就没有可以利用的船只。另外，即便人们过去因为河流既宽且深而且没有可以利用的船只，但篮子依然可以通过其他方式从 P 地达到外地。

正文部分的过渡和衔接非常平顺自然，通过让步句（even if we acknowledge for now that the Brim River has always been broad and deep 和 granted that no boat was available to cross the Brim River）把各个段落有机地结合了起来。

注意写作指令中提到了 explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument，文章对此有很好的照应：在每一段说明需要新证据之后，既分析了什么样的证据能够削弱作者观点，

也分析了哪些证据能够增强作者观点。根据我们的经验，很多考生在写作过程中容易忽略增强作者观点的证据。

文章的句式变化、词汇选择都比较得体，这也是拿到 Argument 高分的必要条件。




**70** The following appeared in a memo from a vice president of a large, highly diversified company.

"Ten years ago our company had two new office buildings constructed as regional headquarters for two regions. The buildings were erected by different construction companies—Alpha and Zeta. Although the two buildings had identical floor plans, the building constructed by Zeta cost 30 percent more to build. However, that building's expenses for maintenance last year were only half those of Alpha's. In addition, the energy consumption of the Zeta building has been lower than that of the Alpha building every year since its construction. Given these data, plus the fact that Zeta has a stable workforce with little employee turnover, we recommend using Zeta rather than Alpha for our new building project, even though Alpha's bid promises lower construction costs."

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

In this memo, the vice president of a large company recommends using Zeta instead of Alpha for their newly proposed building project. The vice president insists that Zeta is a better choice despite Alpha's more competitive bid because of buildings Alpha and Zeta constructed ten years previously. Although Zeta's construction costs were higher than Alpha's, its building's maintenance costs and energy consumption have been lower than those of the Alpha-constructed building. Moreover, the vice president cites Zeta's stable workforce and low turnover rate in hopes of proving Zeta's competency. Although this argument may seem quite convincing at first glance, the vice president does not

conclusively justify his/her endorsement of Zeta. More evidence is needed in order to fully assess the vice president's recommendation.

To begin with, more information about maintenance costs and energy consumption of the two buildings is needed. This is because the vice president implies that the difference in maintenance costs and energy consumption is due to Zeta and Alpha's work quality. This could be wrong, however, because environmental factors can also affect both maintenance costs and energy consumption. For example, the building Alpha erected may be located in a region with a cold, harsh climate and frequent extreme weather, which would result in higher maintenance costs due to weather damage and more expensive energy bills due to higher heating demands. If the evidence suggests this, the vice president's argument will be considerably weakened. On the other hand, if evidence indicates a close similarity between the two regions in terms of natural conditions, the vice president's comparison is more reasonable.

Even if higher maintenance costs and energy consumption are the direct result of Alpha's construction, it is unclear whether the Alpha-constructed building's total costs are higher than the building erected by Zeta. By the total cost, I refer to the sum of construction costs and subsequent operation costs. The vice president mentions that the Zeta building's construction costs were higher so it is possible that Zeta's building was more expensive in terms of total cost. However, a lack of quantified information prevents detailed evaluation. We certainly need the exact construction costs and operation figures over the past ten years to determine which company actually offers a better economical solution.

What is more, even if the Zeta building's overall cost is lower than the Alpha building's, whether or not Zeta should win the contract remains questionable because cost should not be the only factor considered. Besides cost, factors such as building quality, safety standards and speediness of construction ought to be taken into consideration. If Zeta's building, though cheaper, is very shabby or contains high levels of toxic materials which pose a serious health threat to its inhabitants, it would be dangerous to give Zeta the project. On the contrary, a report from a certified independent quality-control agency endorsing the Zeta building's overall quality would certainly boost the vice president's recommendation.

Additionally, the author mentions that Zeta has low employee turnover and thus has a more stable workforce. However, it is not clear whether a company's workforce stability is equivalent to its service quality. Alpha's allegedly higher turnover rate (though this has not yet been established) could result from strong intra-company competition which results in the dismissal of underperforming employees. In this case, Zeta's superiority over Alpha is hardly proven. Feedback from the two company's previous clients regarding employee performance would allow for a more comprehensive assessment of the true quality of each company's employees.

In conclusion, although the vice president provides some information to support his/her argument, there are still some problems with his/her lines of reasoning. Zeta may indeed be a good candidate, but we cannot logically draw this conclusion based solely on the information provided by the vice president. More evidence is needed to determine whether Alpha or Zeta should be selected as the new project's contractor. (641 words)

**中文翻译**

在这份备忘录中，一家大型公司的副总裁提议让 Zeta 而不是 Alpha 来负责他们的新建筑项目。该副总裁坚持认为尽管 Alpha 的出价更具竞争力，但考虑到二者十年前所建的楼，Zeta 是一个更好的选择。虽然 Zeta 的建筑成本高于 Alpha，但维护成本和能耗都低于 Alpha 的建筑。不仅如此，副总裁还援引了 Zeta 稳定的员工队伍和低流失率来证明 Zeta 的竞争力。虽然乍一看副总裁的论点很有说服力，但并不能确凿证明他/她对 Zeta 的背书是正确的。我们需要更多的证据以充分评估副总裁的建议。

首先，我们需要更多关于两幢建筑的维护成本和能耗的信息。这是因为副总裁暗示了 Zeta 和 Alpha 的工作质量造成了不同的维护成本和能耗。然而，这可能是错的，因为环境因素也可能会影响维护成本和能耗。例如，Alpha 所建的建筑可能地处寒冷恶劣的地区，时常遭遇极端天气，天气造成的损坏导致了更高的维护成本，而对暖气的更多需求导致了更高昂的电费账单。如果有证据能证明这一点，那么副总裁的论点就会被大大削弱。另一方面，如果证据表明两幢建筑所处地的自然条件非常接近，那么副总裁的比较就显得更为合理了。

即使是 Alpha 的建设直接导致了更高的维护成本和能耗，我们也不清楚 Alpha 所建建筑的总成本是否高于 Zeta 所建的建筑。所谓总成本指的是建筑成本和后续运营成本之和。副总裁提到 Zeta 的建筑成本更高，所以就总成本而言，Zeta 建筑可能更为昂贵。然而，缺乏量化信息让我们无法做出详细评估。无疑，我们需要确切的建筑成本和过去十年的运营数据来决定哪家公司的方案更为经济。

更重要的是，即使 Zeta 建筑的总成本低于 Alpha 公司，由于成本不应当是唯一考虑的因素，我们对是否应该签约 Zeta 公司仍然存疑。在成本之外，诸如建筑质量、安全标准和作业速度之类的因素也应当被考虑在内。虽然 Zeta 的建筑更便宜，但如果它非常破旧或含有高剂量的有毒物质、对其居民构成了严重的健康威胁，那么让 Zeta 负责项目是非常危险的。相反，若有来自经认证的独立质量控制机构的报告为 Zeta 建筑的整体质量背书，那么副总裁的建议就获得了大力支持。

此外，作者提到了 Zeta 的员工流动率更低，因此拥有更稳定的工作队伍。然而，我们并不清楚一家公司工作队伍的稳定性是否等同于它的服务质量。所谓 Alpha 更高的流动率（虽然这还没有被证实）可能是因为激烈的公司内部竞争，那些表现不佳的员工被解雇了。在这种情况下，Zeta 并不一定优于 Alpha。两家公司服务过的客户对员工表现的反馈能让我们对其员工的真实素质做出更全面的评估。

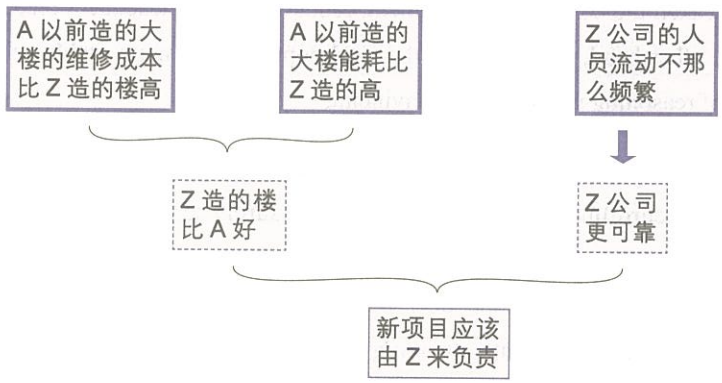
总而言之，虽然副总裁提供了一些信息来支持他/她的论点，其推理思路仍然存在一些问题。Zeta 也许确实是很好的候选者，但我们无法从副总裁给出的区区信息中推理出这一结论。我们需要更多的证据来决定应当选择 Alpha 还是 Zeta 作为新项目的承包商。

### 文章解析与点评

涉及两个对象做比较的 Argument 题目，如这道题目，在题库中并不少见。很显然，对于两方比较类的题目，最基本的思考切入点在于“究竟现有信息能否判断孰优孰劣”。对本文而言，由于写作指令限定了要从证据出发，因此上述的问题变成“需要什么样的信息才能帮助我们判断 A 和 Z 哪家公司更好”。

本文有一个疑点在最后一句“Alpha's bid promises lower construction costs.”是否需要讨论。有同学认为这一句也需要分析，但注意，作者自己的结论是支持 Z 而反对 A，因此我们要看的是现有证据能否推导出 Z 比 A 好，如果不能的话，还需要什么证据。对此，A 的成本更低并非支持Z的证据，所以我们后续讨论过程中不用围绕这一点展开（但在文章中简单提及一句是可以的）。

与之类似的一句话是“Although the two buildings had identical floor plans, the building constructed by Zeta cost 30 percent more to build.”这里，因为我们不需要对作者的结论本身发表意见，所以我们没有用这个事实来反驳作者立场。注意：作者不一定对不代表其一定错，我们要用更客观的视角来看待问题（见第三段“The vice president mentions that the Zeta building's construction costs were higher so it is possible that Zeta's building was more expensive in terms of total cost.”）。




**30** The following appeared as a recommendation by a committee planning a ten-year budget for the city of Calatrava.

"The birthrate in our city is declining: in fact, last year's birthrate was only one-half that of five years ago. Thus the number of students enrolled in our public schools will soon decrease dramatically, and we can safely reduce the funds budgeted for education during the next decade. At the same time, we can reduce funding for athletic playing fields and other recreational facilities. As a result, we will have sufficient money to fund city facilities

and programs used primarily by adults, since we can expect the adult population of the city to increase."

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

In this argument, the planning committee of the city of Calatrava argues that due to the alleged declining birthrate and the projected lower enrollment numbers in Calatrava's public schools, the city should reduce funding for education, as well as other athletic playing fields and recreational facilities. At the same time, the committee proposes to allocate more fund to programs used by adults since the adult population is purportedly going to increase. While the recommendation may seem valid and reasonable at first glance, more evidence is needed to better evaluate the strength of this recommendation.

In the first place, whether or not the decline in the birthrate over a five-year period will lead to a future decline in the number of the newborn population requires more information to examine. Behind this deduction lies the assumption that the increase in the total population, if any, is not able to balance the decrease in the birthrate, which is not substantiated by any evidence. Imagine, for example, that the total population has doubled during the past five years despite the halving birthrate; in this case, the absolute number of newborn babies would remain the same as five years ago. Such scenarios would seriously weaken the committee's argument, rendering their subsequent recommendation highly suspicious. On the other hand, if data shows the total population remains stable or has even declined, the author's lines of reasoning will be more convincing.

Even if we concede the aforementioned assumption, more evidence is needed to answer the question whether the enrollment in public schools will surely fall. Here, the committee makes an implicit assumption that the number of students in Calatrava's public schools is low. Indeed, if the enrollment Calatrava's public school has been much lower than the supply of educational resources, and there are few out-of-town students attending schools in Calatrava, the author's argument can be strengthened. Nevertheless, the premise about student enrollment does not receive adequate support by the committee. For example, while the local student population may be declining, it is possible that students from other areas are also eager to attend public schools in Calatrava, perhaps due to the quality education offered by Calatrava's public education system. If this is true, the claim that education budget can be safely reduced is cast into serious doubt.

Finally, without further clarification, the change in the student population in Calatrava does not necessarily reflect the population variations among the adults. One assumption the committee makes is that the total population will stay the same; however, there is no evidence presented to support it.

Common sense tells us that population can fluctuate quite a lot within a short period of time, due to reasons like job availability, environmental pollution, and government taxes. If, for instance, Calatrava's air quality is worsening rapidly over the past decades and there is city-wide emigration to other towns, the total population as well as the adult population will steadily decrease. Such a scenario could also explain why the birthrate has declined: because of pollution and health concerns, parents are not willing to give birth in Calatrava. As a result, without proper evidence to demonstrate the real changes in adult populations, it is far from conclusive that the government can spend more in adult programs.

To summarize, although the number of students enrolled in public schools could decrease in response to the declining birthrate, the committee does not convincingly deliver its recommendation because of some unsubstantiated assumptions in its argument. Without evidence to evaluate the validity of those assumptions, we cannot effectively evaluate whether the recommendation by the committee is reasonable and advisable. (598 words)

**中文翻译**

在这一论证中，卡拉特拉瓦市规划委员会认为，由于所谓的出生率的下降以及预计卡拉特拉瓦公立学校入学人数会减少，该市应减少教育经费以及其他运动场和娱乐设施方面的费用。同时，该委员会建议拨出更多的资金用于成年人使用的项目，因为据称成年人人口将会增加。虽然这项建议乍一看似乎是有效且合理的，但需要更多的证据来更好地评估这项建议的力度。

首先，五年内出生率的下降是否会导致未来新生人口数量的下降，需要更多的信息来验证。在这一推理背后，隐含着这样一个假设，即总人口的增长（如果有的话）无法平衡出生率的下降，这一假设没有任何证据加以证实。例如，想象一下，尽管出生率下降了一半，但总人口在过去五年里翻了一番；在这种情况下，新生儿的绝对人数将与五年前保持一致。这种情况将严重削弱委员会的论点，使其随后的建议非常可疑。另一方面，如果数据显示总人口保持稳定甚至下降，作者的推理将更有说服力。

即使我们承认上述假设，我们也需要更多的证据来回答公立学校的入学率是否一定会下降这个问题。在这里，委员会做出了一个隐含假定，即卡拉特拉瓦公立学校的学生人数很少。的确，如果卡拉特拉瓦公立学校的入学率已经远远低于教育资源的供给，而且卡拉特拉瓦很少有来自外地的学生，那么作者的论证就可以得到加强。尽管如此，有关学生入学的前提并未得到委员会的充分支持。例如，虽然当地学生人数可能在下降，但其他地区的学生也可能渴望进入卡拉特拉瓦的公立学校，这可能是由于卡拉特拉瓦的公共教育系统提供的优质教育。如果这是真的，那么可以放心削减教育预算的说法就遭到了严重的质疑。

最后，在没有进一步说明的情况下，卡拉特拉瓦学生人数的变化并不一定会反映成年人的人口变化。委员会的一个假设是，总人口将保持不变；然而，没有证据支持这一假设。按理说，由于工作机会、环境污染和政府税收等原因，人口在短时间内会有很大的波动。例如，如果卡拉特拉瓦的空气质量在过去几十年里迅速恶化，并且整个城市都有向其他城镇移民的现象，那么总人口以及成年人人口将稳步下降。这种情况也可以解释为什么出生率会下降：由于污染和健康问题，父母不愿意在卡拉特拉瓦生育。因此，如果没有适当的证据来证明成年人人口的真实变化，政府是否可以在成人项目上投入更多的资金还远没有定论。

总而言之，尽管公立学校的入学人数可能会随着出生率的下降而减少，但委员会没有提出令人信服的建议，因为其论证中存在一些未经证实的假设。如果没有证据来评估这些假设的有效性，我们就无法有效地评价委员会的建议是否合理和可取。

**文章解析与点评**

本题的思路比较简单，呈现出单一的线性发展模式——从最开始的生育率下降，推导出人口下降，所以公立学校的招生人数会下降，进而可以把钱投入到成年人的项目当中。中间没有绕弯，也没有并行的信息，从头到尾非常简洁：

在这种简洁的论证中，我们只需要把握住每一个论证环节即可。首先从 50% 的生育率是否能推出入学人口将会下降？这是不一定的，首先就是 50% 相对值的问题。在备考 Argument 的世界中流传着这样一个亘古不变的近似真理：如果出现了相对数字，则考虑绝对数字；反之，如果题目中出现的是绝对数字，要考虑相对数字。在本题中，50% 是一个相对数字，除了新生儿的数量下降会引起出生率下降之外，有没有可能是分母（总人口）发生了变化呢？如果是这样的话，那么生育率减半引起的绝对效应也不一定大。

其次，我们还可以看到，就算本地出生的新生儿的绝对数量下降，也不代表未来入学的人数会下降，原因是作者假设了“只有本地出生的人才会来这里上学”，但很明显这个假设是存在问题的，因为一个地区的学校可能会有来自全国乃至世界各地的学生。最后如果学生数量真的下降了，资源是否可以投入到成人项目之中还有待商榷，这一点相信大家可以理解——可选择的选项并非只有学生和成人两种。至此，文章可以写满三段，大功告成。

50 An ancient, traditional remedy for insomnia—the scent of lavender flowers—has now been proved effective. In a recent study, 30 volunteers with chronic insomnia slept each night for three weeks on lavender-scented pillows in a controlled room where their sleep was monitored electronically. During the first week, volunteers continued to take their usual sleeping medication. They slept soundly but wakened feeling tired. At the beginning of the second week, the volunteers discontinued their sleeping medication. During that week, they slept less soundly than the previous week and felt even more tired. During the third week, the volunteers slept longer and more soundly than in the previous two weeks. Therefore, the study proves that lavender cures insomnia within a short period of time.

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

In this argument, the author claims that the scent of lavender flowers can effectively cure insomnia. This conclusion comes from an experiment involving 30 volunteers, in which patients with chronic insomnia were treated with lavender-scented pillows. It was observed that after the exposure to lavender scent patients slept longer and more soundly than before. Hence the author concludes that the improved sleeping quality must be attributable to the scent of lavender. Under close scrutiny, although it might be true that lavender is effective in curing insomnia, this is not a conclusion that can reasonably derived by the current experimental setup. More evidence is certainly needed to fully evaluate the effect of lavender scent on sleeping.

To begin with, we need more evidence to evaluate if the duration and the quality of sleeping equal to the readiness to fall asleep. Insomnia, by definition, is somebody's inability to fall asleep due to various reasons. Here in the experiment, however, the time each patient took to fall asleep was not reported. As a result, it remains unclear if those patients fall asleep faster when exposed to lavender scent than before. To solve this question, we need data on how fast (or slow) those patients fall asleep during the experiment period. It might turn out, for example, that patients find it even harder to fall asleep with the presence of an unfamiliar scent, which would invalidate the author's conclusion. On the other hand, if the monitoring data suggests that once the lavender-scented pillows were introduced, patients fell asleep significantly faster, it would be reasonable to attribute the lessening of insomnia to lavender scent.

Furthermore, even if we assume momentarily that sleeping quality and duration can represent how easily one falls asleep in this experimental condition, more evidence is needed to elucidate what effect lavender treatment has on insomnia. The current experiment involving 30 volunteers has a serious confounding factor: while the patients showed improved sleep quality at the beginning of the third week is due to the scent of lavender, they had also taken their regular sleeping medication at the

beginning of the trial. It could be the case that the lavender-scented pillows did not have any substantial improving effect, and the improvement observed in the third week was the result of the discontinuation of medications. To more clearly examine the effect (or lack thereof) of lavender scent, more information is certainly needed and may be produced by additional experiments. For example, a trial with both controlled and experimental groups subjecting to the same conditions except the scent of the pillows would help answer if the lavender scent is effective. A negative result would of course weaken the author's current conclusion, while a positive result would strengthen it.

Finally, granted that the aforementioned assumptions are true, the author's conclusion relies on another important assumption that chronic insomnia and regular insomnia are the same. However, this assumption has not been substantiated, and we need more evidence to evaluate such a linkage. New information may show that chronic insomnia has a different cause compared to the regular one, and what is effective in treating chronic insomnia turns out to be futile with regard to the other. Yet, it is chronic insomnia that all volunteers suffer from in the experiment testing the efficacy of lavender-scented pillows and the author's conclusion somehow applies to all insomnia patients. In this case, this assumption turns out wrong and his or her conclusion would be seriously challenged. On the other hand, new evidence that shows a common pathological trigger of different types of insomnia will strengthen the author's argument.

To sum up, while the experiment indeed found better sleeping quality and longer sleeping duration in insomnia patients after exposure to lavender-scented pillows, it remains unclear first whether the inability to fall asleep is actually alleviated and second whether the effect of lavender is immediate. Lastly, chronic insomnia and regular insomnia might have different origins and more evidence is needed to investigate the applicability of lavender scent in treating insomnia. (667 words)

**中文翻译**

在此文中，作者认为薰衣草花香能有效治疗失眠。这一结论来自一项由 30 名志愿者参与的实验。在该实验中，用薰衣草香枕头治疗慢性失眠患者。据观察，置身于薰衣草香味之中，患者会比之前睡得更长更香。因此，作者得出结论，认为睡眠质量的改善必须归因于薰衣草的香味。仔细观察之下，虽然薰衣草确实能有效地治疗失眠，但这并不是当前实验所能得出的合理结论。当然，还需要更多证据来全面评估薰衣草香味对睡眠的影响。

首先，我们需要更多的证据来评估睡眠的持续时间和质量是否等于入睡的准备程度。失眠，顾名思义，是指由于各种原因而无法入睡。然而，在这个实验中，并未说明每个患者入睡所需要的时间。因此，目前尚不清楚这些患者在接触薰衣草香味时是否会比以前更快入睡。为了解决这个问题，我们需要有关这些患者在实验期间入睡速度快慢的数据。比如，结果也有可能是患者发现在有不熟悉香味的情况下更难入睡了，这就说明作者的推断是无效的。另一方面，如果监测数据表明，一旦使用薰衣草香味的枕头，患者明显睡得更快，那么将失眠的缓解归功于薰衣草香味就合情合理了。

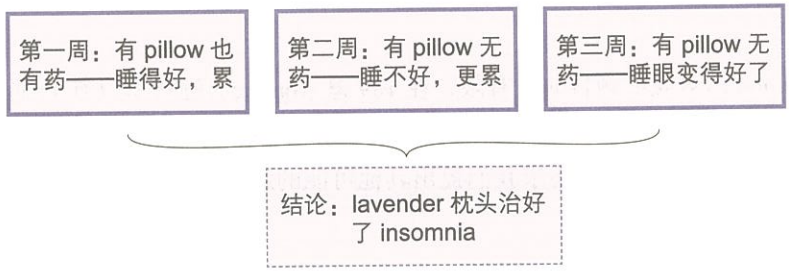
此外，即使我们暂时假设睡眠质量和持续时间可以代表一个人在这种实验条件下是多么容易入睡，但仍需要更多的证据来阐明薰衣草疗法对失眠的影响。当前这 30 名志愿者参与的实验存在一个严重的混淆因素：尽管患者在第三周开始时表现出睡眠质量的改善是源自熏衣草香味，但是他们在试验开始时服用了常规的睡眠药物。也有可能是薰衣草香味的枕头没有任何实质性的改善效果，第三周观察到的睡眠质量的改善是停药的结果。为了更加清楚地验证薰衣草香味的效果，当然需要更多的信息，也有可能需要进行其他的实验。比如，除了枕头的香味外，对照组和实验组在相同条件下进行的试验将有助于回答薰衣草香味是否有效。消极的结果当然会削弱作者目前的结论，而积极的结果会加强作者的这一结论。

最后，假设上述推断是正确的，那么作者的结论则需依赖于另一个重要的设想，即慢性失眠和经常性失眠是相同的。但是，这种设想还没有得到证实，我们需要更多的证据来推断这样一种联系。新的信息也可能表明，慢性失眠与经常性失眠的原因不同，能有效治疗慢性失眠的方法对于治疗经常性失眠是无用的。然而，在测试薰衣草香枕头功效的实验中，所有志愿者都患有慢性失眠症，而作者的结论在某种程度上适用于所有失眠症患者。在这种情况下，这个假设被证明是错误的，他或她的结论将受到严重挑战。另一方面，新的证据表明不同类型的失眠有一个共同的病理诱因，这会强化作者的论点。

综上所述，虽然实验确实表明失眠患者在接触薰衣草香味的枕头后，睡眠质量和睡眠时间得到了改善，但是仍旧不清楚无法入睡的情况是否真正得到了缓解，也不清楚薰衣草的效果是否能立竿见影。最后，慢性失眠和经常性失眠可能有不同的原因，因此需要更多的证据来研究薰衣草香味在治疗失眠症中的适用性。

### 文章解析与点评

本题是 GRE Argument 题库当中最难的几道题之一，究其原因在于它的逻辑乍看之下是合理的：




换而言之，如果我们只看患者随着时间的变化，似乎确实可以得出有了熏衣草香味的枕头之后睡眠质量变好的结论。这道题的难点就在于，如果我们只纠缠病人随着时间的症状变化，可以写的点并不多——最主要的点是存在药物和时间这两个混淆因素，这也是本文第二主旨段所说的。接受过一些基础生物学训练的同学会知道，要想研究一种药物对于人体是否有作用，最好的办法是大样本随机双盲实验，并且对照组是安慰剂。很显然我们不能按照一个科学实验

的要求来审视本题，但是我们不妨想一想为什么要通过对照实验来证明一个物质的有效性？

对于很多同学来说，本题分析完实验设计的缺陷之后就突然发现无话可说了，在考场上要么草草收场，要么就围绕着实验设计翻来覆去地说。这两种思路的分数都不会很高。这里我们要引出本题最大的问题，也是这个 Argument 中非常隐蔽、很高级的一条线：偷换概念。本题中作者至少偷换了两次概念，首先是把失眠（难以入睡）换成了睡眠质量。不可否认，也许失眠的人睡眠质量会差，但是从严格定义来说，不能从睡眠质量反推有没有失眠的现象存在。如果我们要真正研究薰衣草对于失眠患者是否有帮助，要记录的信息不是他们的睡眠质量，而应该是入睡的时间！本题存在的第二个偷换概念之处是，默认引发不同失眠的因素是一致的，具体来说是把志愿者所得的慢性失眠症推广到了所有的失眠症患者上。从慢性失眠的描述就不难看出，也许还有短暂性失眠，对于这些人薰衣草是否有效呢？题目没有给出足够的信息来回答这一问题。

当我们把这条偷换概念的暗线指出来之后，文章的思路就豁然开朗了，文章的分数也自然不会低。因为题目概念偷换的技巧很高，隐蔽性很强，所以是 GRE 最难的几道题之一。但是，相信读完本书的你已经对这些题目驾轻就熟了。

## 3 “Explanation 类” Direction

Write a response in which you discuss one or more alternative explanations that could rival the proposed explanation and explain how your explanation(s) can plausibly account for the facts presented in the argument.

### 中文翻译

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中，讨论一个或者更多的解释，这个解释也同样能合理地说明文章中的事实。

### 讲　解

这种 Direction 所对应的题目非常有限，在 189 道 Argument 题目里只有 11 道。这种题目首先会陈述一个事实或现象，接着会给出作者对这个事实或现象的解释，然而，这种解释可能并非唯一的解释。因此，Direction 要求我们提出其他可能的解释，并具体说明这些解释能够如何说明文章中的事实和现象。

### 例题举证

Workers in the small town of Leeville take fewer sick days than workers in the large city of Masonton, 50 miles away. Moreover, relative to population size, the diagnosis of stress-related illness is proportionally much lower in Leeville than in Masonton. According to the

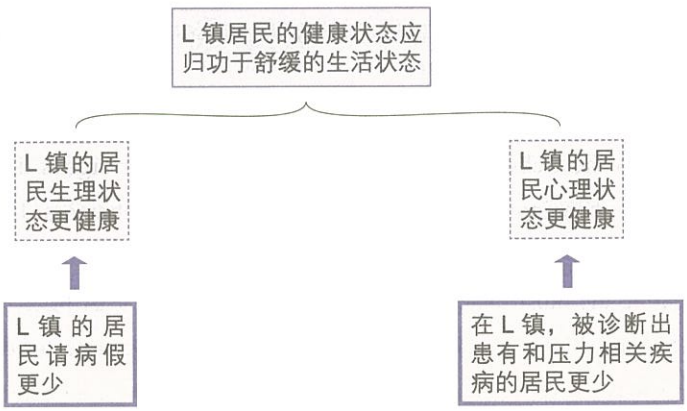
Leeville Chamber of Commerce, these facts can be attributed to the health benefits of the relatively relaxed pace of life in Leeville.

Write a response in which you discuss one or more alternative explanations that could rival the proposed explanation and explain how your explanation(s) can plausibly account for the facts presented in the argument.

这道题中，作者列举了两个现象：L 地的人们请病假少；L 地诊断出的关于压力的疾病少。作者对这两个现象给出了统一的解释：L 地的生活节奏舒缓。

其实，我们可以进一步细化作者的推理过程：首先，作者暗示，一方面人们请病假少是因为人们身体状况好；另一方面由压力引起的疾病的低诊断量可以被归结为人们心理状况好。之后，作者把人们良好的身体和心理状况归功于当地舒缓的生活节奏。然而，作者的解释并不唯一。例如，我们可以把人们请病假少归结为人们不愿意请假，或者公司不给病假；我们也可以认为压力引起的疾病很难被诊断出来是因为医院的仪器落后，或者医生水平低下；所以，当地人的身体和心理状况不一定好。最后，即便我们承认当地人口的健康状况良好，这也不一定是由于舒缓的生活节奏，完全可能是因为当地的环境好、食品安全等。当然，对于题目中的现象，可能还存在其他解释，这些解释都可以出现在我们的写作中，在这里就不一一列举了。

综上，应对 Explanation 类的 Direction，我们只需要找出其他可能的解释，并运用这些解释来说明原 Argument 当中的现象即可。当然，我们也可以通过逻辑图来理清楚原文的论证结构，并以此为据来组织我们的段落。如下图所示：




希望大家注意的是，我们应对 Explanation 类 Direction 的逻辑图和其他几类 Direction 的逻辑图有所不同。在其他几种 Direction 的逻辑图中，事实性的信息被置于逻辑图最上层，而题目中的最终结论被放在了最下层。这种构图原则是希望反映出：作者以这些事实性信息为基础，得出了关于未来的预测或者建议。而 Explanation 类题目的思考方向刚好相反，作者是根据现有的事实性信息，追溯过去，探讨可能导致这一事实的原因。可以说，Explanation 类题目的思考过程和其他几类题目相反。

如图中所示，作者推导了三次结论，所以我们也可以据此写三个中间段来分别评论这三次推导过程。

总结一下对应这种 Direction 的答题步骤：

单段写法（每一段中都应包含下面所示的①②，而不是①②各成一段）：
①复述作者对题目中现象的解释，指出其解释不唯一。
②给出其他解释并详细说明。

如何把各个中间段组织起来：
根据逻辑图，作者做了几次从现象到原因的推导，就写几个中间段。

## 题库范文

180* The following appeared on the website *Science News Today*.

"In a recent survey of more than 5,000 adolescents, the teens who reported eating the most meals with their families were the least likely to use illegal drugs, tobacco, or alcohol. Family meals were also associated with higher grades, better self-esteem, and lower rates of depression. Almost 30 percent of the teens said they ate at least seven meals per week with their families. Clearly, having a high number of family meals keeps teens from engaging in bad behaviors."

Write a response in which you discuss one or more alternative explanations that could rival the proposed explanation and explain how your explanation(s) can plausibly account for the facts presented in the argument.

In an article published on the website *Science News Today*, the author argues that a high number of family meals is the key to keeping teenagers from engaging in bad behaviors. His or her conclusion is based on two important pieces of observations. First, among more than 5,000 respondents, the teens who reported eating the most meals with their families were the least likely to use illegal drugs, tobacco, or alcohol. Second, higher grades, better self-esteem, and lower rates of depression are found to correlate with family meals. While family meals may be the very reason that keeps teens from those bad behaviors, there are other possible alternative explanations that could rival the author's explanation. Specifically, we must ask if the apparent correlation between family meals and better behaviors, instead of being causally linked as the author suggests, has some common reasons.

First, a higher number of family meals may simply mean the parents have more free time at their disposal and therefore able to pay more attention to their children's education and behaviors. When a family is financially struggling, it is not uncommon that parents will have to work extra hours or find additional

jobs to make the ends meet. In this case, it is not a lack of family meals that lead to teens' bad behaviors and worse performance at school. Instead, the real reason is the fact that their parents cannot pay enough attention to their behavior and afford quality education. By inference, it could even be hypothesized that the financial hardship may force the family to live in neighborhoods with high crime rates. In those environments, it is not surprising to see the adolescents, without the proper supervision from their legal guardians, fell prey to the drug dealers on the street. In this case, what is behind the apparent connection between family meals and teenage behavior is a shared fundamental factor: the socioeconomical class that the family is in. Families with more income would naturally be able to have family meals more.

Second, to extend the argument above even further, one could envision another alternative hypothesis that focuses on the relationship within the family. That is, even if a family is rich, what if the parents are in constant fight? In such a hypothetical scenario the teenager may have witnessed domestic violence and could be more prone to committing offenses themselves, thereby explaining why in the survey they were more likely to possess illegal drugs, tobacco, and alcohol. Perhaps their parents were doing the same. To extrapolate this possibility to the extreme, teenagers with most severe crime behaviors and worst school performance might come from single-parent family, in which the parents got divorced. This could be a serious psychological shock to the child, making them unconfident at school and leading to depression. As sad as it may sound, these poor kids with bad behaviors and/or low self-confidence cannot have family meals because they do not have a happy family in the first place.

To wrap up, I have presented two alternative hypotheses to explain the observation that teenagers have more family meals tend to behave better. While the author claims that family meals are the cause of those good behaviors, a causal relationship is not the only explanation. Instead, they could share a common cause, such as the family's financial situation and/or the family relationship. Without more in-depth analysis of those families, we cannot hastily conclude what the real reason behind the teens' bad behaviors is. (578 words)

**中文翻译**

在《今日科学新闻》网站上发表的一篇文章中，作者提出，多和家人一起吃饭是防止青少年不良行为的关键。他或她的结论基于两个重要的观察结果。首先，在 5000 多名受访者中，报告和家人一起吃饭最多的青少年吸毒、抽烟或酗酒的可能性最小。第二，更好的成绩、更强的自尊和更低的抑郁率被发现与和家人一起吃饭相关。虽然和家人一起吃饭可能正是让青少年远离这些不良行为的原因，但还有其他可能的解释可以与作者的解释相抗衡。具体地说，我们必须知道，和家人一起吃饭与良好行为之间的明显相关性是否有一些共同的原因，而不是像作者所说的因果联系。

首先，更多地和家人一起吃饭可能意味着父母有更多的空闲时间可以支配，因此他们能够更加关注孩子的教育和行为。当一个家庭经济困难时，父母不得不加班或找额外的工作来维持

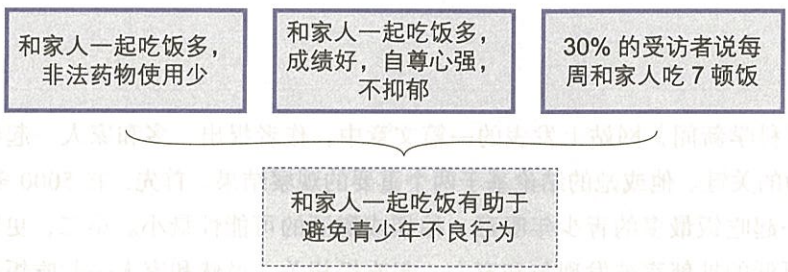
生计的情况并不少见。在这种情况下，并不是缺乏和家人一起吃饭导致了青少年的不良行为和在学校的糟糕表现。相反，真正的原因是他们的父母不能对他们的行为给予足够的重视，也负担不起高质量的教育。由此推断，甚至可以假设，经济困难可能会迫使这个家庭住在犯罪率高的社区。在这种环境下，青少年在没有法定监护人的适当监督下，沦为街头毒贩的牺牲品，也就不足为奇了。在这种情况下，和家人一起吃饭与青少年行为之间的明显联系背后是一个共同的基本因素：家庭所处的社会经济阶层。收入多的家庭自然可以更多地和家人一起吃饭。

其次，为了进一步扩展上述论证，我们可以设想另一种侧重于家庭内部关系的假设。也就是说，即使一个家庭很富有，但是如果父母经常吵架将会怎样呢？在这样一个假设情景中，青少年可能目睹了家庭暴力，或许更容易去犯罪，从而解释了为什么在调查中他们更有可能持有非法药物、烟草和酒精。也许他们的父母也这么做了。把这种可能性推到极端，犯罪行为最严重、学习成绩最差的青少年可能来自父母离异的单亲家庭。这可能对孩子造成严重的心理冲击，使他们在学校缺乏自信，导致抑郁。尽管听起来很悲伤，但这些有着不良行为和 / 或自信心低下的贫穷孩子不能和家人一起吃饭是因为他们一开始就没有一个幸福的家庭。

总之，我在上文提出了两个不同的假设来解释和家人一起吃饭更多的青少年往往表现更好。虽然作者声称和家人一起吃饭是这些良好行为的原因，但因果关系并不是唯一的解释。相反，他们可能有共同的原因，比如家庭经济状况和 / 或家庭关系。如果不对这些家庭进行更深入的分析，我们就不能草率地得出青少年不良行为背后的真正原因是什么。

### 文章解析与点评

在 2021 的作文题库中，ETS 新加入了几道 Alternative Explanation 类的题目，本文就是其中之一。新加入这一类型的几篇文章都有一个共同的特征：一系列同时发生的现象，被认为具有因果关系。例如本题中作者把“和家人一起吃饭”和“青少年表现更好”这两件同时发生的事情进行了因果关联，并认为前者是后者的原因，其逻辑为：




这一类型逻辑推导的问题在于，两件同时发生的事情不代表它们之间有因果关系，也有可能是具有共同的原因。在本题中至少有两种可能性，其一是家庭足够有钱，才能让全家一起吃饭，否则家长需要去打工，这也就意味着他们无法陪伴自己的小孩。其次，一块吃饭可能象征着家庭和睦，亲子关系好，这就使得小孩成长过程中能够感受到更多的关爱。在这种情况下，“和家人一起吃饭多”只是诸多背后深层因素的外在表现之一，不是青少年表现更好的原因。

当然，从理论上来说本题可能有一个相反的因果关系，也即只有小孩表现好，家长才愿意与孩子一块吃饭当作奖赏。但就本题的情况，从共同原因（经济、家庭关系）的角度出发更加合适。

184* Several recent studies have shown a link between health and stair usage. One recently completed study shows that people who live in stairs-only apartment buildings (that is, buildings without elevators) live an average of three years longer than do people who live in buildings with both elevators and stairs. A second study shows that elderly residents of buildings with elevators make, on average, twice as many visits to doctors each year as do residents of buildings without elevators. Furthermore, several doctor's offices are reporting that residents of stairs-only buildings scored higher than average on questionnaires administered to new patients, in which the patients were asked to rate several aspects of their own health (e.g., fitness, sleep quality, susceptibility to injury, etc.). The clearest explanation for these findings is that the moderate daily exercise required of residents who must use the stairs instead of elevators increases people's health and longevity.

Write a response in which you discuss one or more alternative explanations that could rival the proposed explanation and explain how your explanation(s) can plausibly account for the facts presented in the argument.

The author of this argument attributes the observed differences in life expectancy, hospital visits, and survey results to the fact that when people use stairs, they are actually doing moderate exercise. As a result, their health and longevity benefit from this moderate level of exercise every day. While it could be true that stairs are the key to a healthier and longer life, there are so many confounding factors in the studies mentioned by the author that several alternative explanations exist. Those explanations may well account for the differences in personal health observed in each example cited by the author.

To begin with, the observed differences could entirely be due to different geography. High-rise apartment buildings in the city are unlikely to have no elevator, so one may reasonably assume that people living in buildings with elevators are urban residents. On the other hand, apartment buildings with only stairs may refer to those two- or three-story duplexes often found in the suburbs and the countryside, or even include townhouses commonly located very far away from the bustling and congested urban core. In this scenario, the fact that people living in buildings with only stairs live longer and healthier can be attributed to their suburban and rural lifestyle, in which there is much less noise and less air pollution due to the urban traffic. The pace of life may play a role, too, as urban life is intense and could exert a negative psychological effect on the urban dwellers. This may well explain why respondents of the survey report lower scores if they are living in building with elevators. The

main reason is not the presence or absence of elevators, but whether they live inside or outside the city center.

Second, let's take a look at the observation that elderly residents in buildings with elevators are likely to pay twice as many visits to doctors each year as do people who live in stair-only buildings. The author here associates the number of visits to doctor's offices with their health conditions, but this may not necessarily be the case. Instead, to visit doctors more could simply mean that they have better healthcare and more money to spend, so they could afford doing so. This is not unreasonable, as buildings with elevators are likely to cost more in monthly rents than buildings with no elevators. Therefore, the reason behind the fact that the elderly people living in an elevator-equipped building pay more visits to their doctors could be entirely socioeconomical and has no connection to the amount of exercise from the use of stairs.

Finally, even if we acknowledge the inference made above that more hospital visits means poorer health, the author interprets this correlation implies a causal link. Specifically speaking, people go to doctors more because they indulge in the convenience of elevators and lack exercise. Yet, real link could be the other way around: it is because of their poorer health that those elderly people specifically look for elevators in the building. This could as well explain why people living in buildings with elevators tend to live a shorter life than those do not. Apparently, it is not surprising that people with more severe health issues will have a shorter life expectancy. At any rate, the key here is that the choice of stair-only buildings versus elevators is the consequence of, not the reason for, their health conditions.

To conclude, while the correlations between better health and stair-only buildings are intriguing, they do not necessarily imply that the exercise from the forced use of stairs is the key to better health and longevity. Other factors, such as geographic locations, socioeconomical classes, and pre-existing health conditions, could be what is really determining people's health. (622 words)

**中文翻译**

这个论点的作者将观察到的预期寿命、医院就诊和调查结果的差异归因于这样一个事实：当人们走楼梯时，他们实际上是在做适度的运动。因此，他们的健康和长寿得益于每天适度的锻炼。虽然楼梯确实是健康长寿的关键，但作者提到的研究中有许多令人困惑的因素，因此存在几种不同的解释。这些解释可以很好地阐明作者引用的每个例子中观察到的个人健康差异。

首先，观察到的差异可能完全是由于不同的地理位置造成的。城市中的高层公寓楼不太可能没有电梯，因此人们可以合理地假设，住在有电梯楼内的人是城市居民。另一方面，只有楼梯的公寓楼可能是指那些经常出现在郊区和农村的两层或三层复式建筑，甚至包括通常远离繁华拥挤的城市核心的联排别墅。在这种情况下，居住在只有楼梯的建筑物中的人们寿命更长、更健康，这可归因于他们的郊区和农村生活方式，在这种生活方式中，城市交通带来的噪音和

空气污染要少得多。生活节奏也可能发挥作用，因为城市生活紧张，这可能对城市居民的心理产生负面影响。这很好地解释了为什么调查对象报告说，如果他们住在有电梯的楼房里，分数会更低。这其中的主要原因不在于电梯的存在与否，而在于居民是住在市中心内还是市中心外。

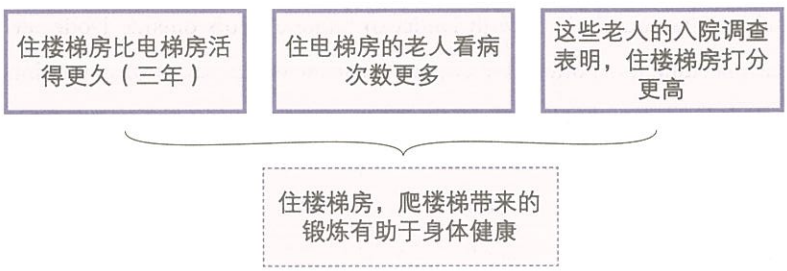
第二，让我们讨论这个观点：有电梯的楼房里的老年居民每年看病的次数可能是只有楼梯的楼房里的老年人的两倍。作者把到医生办公室就诊的次数与他们的健康状况联系起来，但情况未必如此。相反，常看医生可能只是意味着他们有更好的医疗保健和更多的钱，所以他们可以负担得起这样做。这是合理的理由，因为有电梯的建筑物的月租金可能比没有电梯的建筑物要高。因此，居住在配备电梯的楼房里的老年人更多地去看医生这一事实背后可能完全是社会经济的原因，与走楼梯的运动量无关。

最后，即使我们承认上述推断，即更多的医院就诊意味着更差的健康，作者认为这种相关性意味着因果关系。具体来说，人们去看医生更多是因为习惯于电梯的便利，缺乏锻炼。然而，真正的联系可能恰恰相反：正是因为他们的健康状况较差，这些老年人才专门找有楼梯的楼房。这也可以解释为什么用电梯的人比没有用电梯的人寿命要短。显然，有更严重健康问题的人预期寿命缩短并不奇怪。无论如何，这里的关键是，选择只有楼梯的楼房而不是有电梯的楼房是他们健康状况导致的结果，而不是原因。

总而言之，虽然更好的健康与只有楼梯的建筑物之间的关系很有趣，但并不一定意味着被迫走楼梯的锻炼是健康长寿的关键。其他因素，如地理位置、社会经济阶层和原有的健康状况，可能是真正决定人们健康的因素。

### 文章解析与点评

本题和上题一样，都是将同时发生的事情通过因果关系联系起来。在本题中，作者通过列举住楼梯房的人的健康状况更好（活得更久、看病次数少、健康问卷打分更高），将这种更好的个人健康归因于楼梯的使用，其逻辑框架为：




这篇文章非常有意思，因为它乍看之下确实很有道理，甚至有些符合我们的认知预期——爬楼梯做运动是合乎逻辑的。但和上一题一样，我们还是要把作者背后的逻辑思路捋清楚，而不能陷入到我们的直觉当中。在这里，两件同时发生的事情可能互为因果。原文中认为住楼梯房是良好健康状况的原因，但或许另一种反过来的情况也是对的——恰恰是因为老人身体不好，他们才需要住电梯房。

除了互为因果之外，同时发生的事情之间可能存在一个共同的原因，譬如能经常看医生不代表身体就一定差，而是他们有钱、能够支付好的医疗资源和服务。这样一来，住电梯房的人看医生更多就不再是身体不好的体现，而是经济实力的象征：有钱才可以看医生，才可以住电梯房，这两者之间存在一个共同的原因。

我个人很赞同这道题目加入到 ETS 的 Argument 题库当中，因为它可以给我们在现实生活中一些符合直觉的结论给出警示：在对事物进行因果联系时，有没有考虑相反的情况？有没有考虑到它们可能有一个共同的原因？

183* Archaeologists have long thought that an artifact called the pemchint was used by Dodecan people solely as a musical instrument. Pemchints consist of hollowed pieces of bone, shell, or wood that are tied together with long straps. When whirled in the air, the pemchints create pleasant tones. Until recently, pemchints were found only at locations known to be used for Dodecan rituals and celebrations. Additionally, they were always excavated in proximity to other musical artifacts. Recently, however, a pemchint was found along with Dodecan hunters' tools located miles from the nearest known Dodecan settlement, while no other music-related objects were found in the area. Clearly, then, the pemchint was used by Dodecan hunters, who most probably used the sounds to repel dangerous wildlife.

Write a response in which you discuss one or more alternative explanations that could rival the proposed explanation and explain how your explanation(s) can plausibly account for the facts presented in the argument.

In this article, the author challenges a long-held notion that an artifact called the pemchint is a musical instrument used by the ancient Dodecan people. The author's argument is based on a recent discovery in which a pemchint was found along with Dodecan hunters' tools outside Dodecan settlement with no other musical instruments spotted. By contrast, earlier occurrences of pemchints were found at sites associated with Dodecan rituals and celebrations. Consequently, the author interprets pemchints to be a tool used by Dodecan hunters probably to repel dangerous wildlife. While the defensive use of pemchints proposed by the author is certainly a possibility, there may be other scenarios in which pemchints are indeed a musical instrument but somehow ended up being co-located with other hunting tools.

First, the presence of pemchints in the archeological site does not necessarily mean it was being used. Instead, one possibility is that this group of hunters were a team of explorers trying to find new locations of settlements. Once a new suitable location was located, they would hold rituals and celebrations and only by then would the pemchints be used. The author mentions in his or her text that

pemchints consist of hollowed pieces of bone, shell, or wood that are tied together with long straps. This description appears to suggest its portability. In other words, it is easy for hunters and explorers to carry them, perhaps by wearing them around the neck. Then those explorers might encounter some calamity in nature and failed their expedition, leaving the pemchints behind along with other hunting tools. In this case, pemchints were still carried as a musical instrument waiting to be used in a celebratory ritual that sadly didn't happen.

An alternative possibility is that the pemchints and the hunting tools were not deposited at the same time. In other words, it was not those hunters who carried the pemchints in the first place. Rather, pemchints were brought to the spot by later Dodecan people for another reason. Maybe the hunters succeeded in hunting a game that was large enough for the tribe to survive a harsh winter, and therefore Dodecan people went to the hunting site and celebrated their kill. Or it could be the case that those hunters suffered a great loss in the process of killing a wild game, and the tribe came to hold rituals to let them rest in peace. Either way, a pemchint could well likely be used in those rituals, and later could be left in the spot by accident or deliberately to honor the event. In either case, the main point is that hunters were not those who carried or used pemchints.

Finally, even if we assume hunters were carrying them at that time, there is another possible use of pemchints as a musical instrument: to lure preys that the hunters aimed to kill. We do not know about what sound a pemchint would make (other than the fact is pleasant to human ear according to the author), but it is plausible that such a sound could spark the curiosity in the wildlife. In this case, as a piece of musical instruments, pemchints were capable of producing musical tones, but they were just used to attract wild animals, not to repel them.

To summarize, while the presence of a pemchint along with hunting tools may suggest its use as a defensive weapon to repel potentially dangerous animals, there are many plausible alternative explanations. To find out exactly how they were used, especially in the hunting relics site, more information is needed. (590 words)

**中文翻译**

在这篇文章中，作者挑战了一个长期存在的观念，即一个被称为佩姆钦特的文物是一种古老的多德坎人使用的乐器。作者的论证是基于最近的一项发现，在多德坎人聚居地外同时发现了一个佩姆钦特和多德坎猎人的工具，且没有发现其他乐器。相比之下，早期的佩姆钦特出现在与多德坎人的仪式和庆祝活动有关的地点。因此，作者将佩姆钦特解释为一种可能被多德坎猎人用来驱赶危险野生动物的工具。虽然作者提出的佩姆钦特的防御用途是有可能的，但也可能有其他情况，佩姆钦特确实是一种乐器，但不知为什么最终同其他狩猎工具放在了一起。

首先，佩姆钦特于考古遗址中被发现，并不一定意味着它就被使用过。相反，一种可能性是，这群猎人是一群探险家，他们试图寻找新的定居点。一旦一个新的合适的地点被发现，他们将举行仪式和庆祝活动，只有到那时才使用佩姆钦特。作者在文中提及，佩姆钦特是由中空的骨头、贝壳或木头用长带子绑在一起制成的。这个描述似乎暗示了它是可携带的。换言之，猎人和探险家很容易带着它，也许他们把它戴在脖子上。然后那些探险家可能会遇到一些大自然的灾难，他们的探险失败了，留下了佩姆钦特和狩猎工具。在这种情况下，佩姆钦特仍然是一种在庆祝仪式中被使用的乐器，只是可惜仪式没有发生。

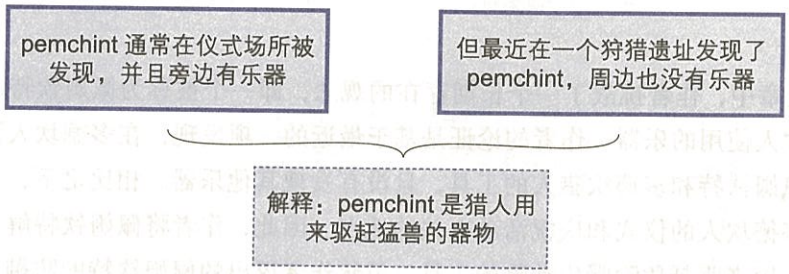
另一种可能性是，佩姆钦特和狩猎工具不是同时存放的。换句话说，并不是那些猎人首先携带了佩姆钦特。相反，佩姆钦特被后来的多德坎人带到现场还有另一个原因。也许猎人成功地猎取了足以让部落在严冬中生存的猎物，因此多德坎人来到狩猎地点来庆祝。也有可能是那些猎人在捕杀猎物的过程中损失惨重，部落举行仪式让他们安息。不管是哪种方式，佩姆钦特很可能被用于这些仪式中，后来可能是被意外地留在现场或故意纪念这一事件。在这两种情况下，猎人并不是携带或使用佩姆钦特的人。

最后，即使我们假设猎人当时携带着它们，还有另一种可能的用途是把佩姆钦特当作乐器来诱捕猎人想要猎杀的猎物。我们不知道佩姆钦特会发出什么样的声音（除了作者认为这种乐器很悦耳的观点），但这种声音也有可能会激起野生动物的好奇心。在这种情况下，作为一种乐器，佩姆钦特能够产生音调，但它们只是用来吸引野生动物，而不是驱赶它们。

总而言之，虽然佩姆钦特和狩猎工具的出现可能表明它是一种用来抵御潜在危险动物的防御武器，但有许多其他可能的解释。我们需要更多的信息才能弄清楚它们是如何被使用的，尤其是在狩猎遗址中。

### 文章解析与点评

本题是 2021 年 ETS 加入 Argument 题库的新题之一。和以往一些看起来很虚无缥缈的架空题目相比，这道题读起来还真的有一点正儿八经考古学的感觉，写起来更有挑战性，也更有趣味性。首先我们不妨来看看题目文章的逻辑框架：




本题有点像“篮子是不是 Palea 独有”的题目，都是新的发现挑战了传统的认知。不过，鉴于本题的写作指令是考虑 Alternative Explanation，我们倒不必去强调传统的结论不一定被推翻。

相反，我们的重点应该是作者给出的解释：pemchint 是猎人用来驱赶猛兽的器物，而非一种祭祀仪式上使用的乐器。

为此，我们可以从两个方面来分析，第一是 pemchint 仍然为仪式上使用的乐器，但是出于种种原因被埋藏在狩猎遗址处，这既包括可能是猎人带在身上而掉落于此的（第一论证段），也可能是后来的人在此处举行祭祀活动遗留于此的（第二论证段）。第二种可能是 pemchint 的确不仅仅用于祭祀，但是在猎人手中不一定是像作者所言的用来驱赶大型的肉食动物。相反，猎人可能拿它用来吸引猎物（第三论证段）。

这里有必要再强调一遍，我们写文章不需要讨论“pemchint 是一种祭祀用的物件”这一个结论是不是被新证据推翻了，因为题目要考查的不是这一点。相反，对于 Alternative Explanation 类的题目而言，我们只需要去考虑有哪些其他的可能性能解释题目当中描述的客观现象（pemchint 在狩猎遗址被找到了），至于新的解释对于原有的认知会带来什么样的冲击，这不是本题需要考虑的点。

176 The following appeared as part of an article in a Dillton newspaper.

"In an effort to bring new jobs to Dillton and stimulate the city's flagging economy, Dillton's city council voted last year to lower the city's corporate tax rate by 15 percent; at the same time, the city began offering generous relocation grants to any company that would move to Dillton. Since these changes went into effect, two new factories have opened in Dillton. Although the two factories employ more than 1,000 people, the unemployment rate in Dillton remains unchanged. The only clear explanation for this is that the new factories are staffed with out-of-town workers rather than Dillton residents."

Write a response in which you discuss one or more alternative explanations that could rival the proposed explanation and explain how your explanation(s) can plausibly account for the facts presented in the argument.

In this article in a Dillton newspaper, the author concludes that the two new factories, which recently moved to Dillton where the city began offering generous relocation grants, must be staffed with out-of-town workers instead of Dillton residents. He/She arrives at his/her conclusion from Dillton's unchanged unemployment rate despite the fact that the factories employ more than 1,000 people. While the author's explanation could be the reason for this, there are at least two alternative explanations that could rival the one endorsed by the author. Unfortunately, due to very limited amount of information, it is too early to state with certainty which is the most likely explanation.

To begin with, the proposed explanation is related to the actual number of the unemployed. Although the two factories hire more than 1,000 employees, these newly employed may actually be

Dillton residents who already have a job in Dillton. That is to say, the total number of employed and unemployed people in Dillton remains the same. The reason for this migration within the labor force could be that those positions require highly skilled workers, while those who are currently unemployed in Dillton are not qualified. In this scenario, the unemployment rate would not be affected because the addition of more than 1,000 positions are accompanied by the exact same number of job vacancies elsewhere that cannot be fulfilled by the existing labor force.

If we divide the labor force into the employed and unemployed population, the abovementioned scenario indicates internal turnover within the employed population without any impact on either the number of the unemployed or the total work force. With this definition at hand, a second possibility emerges: the 1,000 new jobs were accompanied by a reduction of 1,000 jobs elsewhere, possibly due to fierce market competition brought by the advent of the new factories. Hence there is an exchange between the employed pool and the unemployed population, but the net effect on employment rate is nil.

Finally, another possible explanation originates from the fluctuation of total population, and specifically speaking, the total size of the work force. While in pure theory the new factories could incorporate more than 1,000 new employees from the unemployed population, the change in the total size of work force is capable of offsetting this increase. For argument's sake, let's suppose that the city's unemployment rate is 50% and the total work force increased by more than 2,000, exactly twice as many as newly hired employees in the aforementioned two factories. In this case, the employment rate and thus the unemployment rate, remains unchanged. Multiple reasons for the increase in the size of the work force can be put forward, one of these being immigration from other areas in hopes of seeking better jobs. Another reason could be a large number of people in Dilton turning 20 and being considered as the member in labor force. Regardless of the specific reasons, we can achieve a steady unemployment rate by adjusting both the number of employees and the size of the labor force.

To summarize, the three possibilities discussed above are alternative explanations that can challenge the one proposed by the author. However, due to a lack of critical evidence, we cannot determine which one is best until a more thorough investigation of Dillton's job market is presented. (550 words)

**中文翻译**

在 Dillton 报纸的这篇文章中，作者认为因 Dillton 开始提供丰厚的搬迁补助金而迁徙到本地的两家工厂，一定聘用了外地员工而不是 Dillton 本地人。他/她从“尽管两家工厂雇用了超过 1000 人，但 Dillton 失业率没有变化”得出这一结论。尽管作者的这一解释可能是造成该事实的原因，然而还有至少两种解释可以同作者认可的解释一争高下。不过受限于信息，现在宣称哪种解释最有可能仍为时尚早。

首先，作者提出的解释和失业人员的实际人数有关。虽然两家公司雇用了 1000 多名员工，但这些新近雇用的员工可能是已有工作的 Dillton 人。也就是说，Dillton 就业和失业人口总数保持不变。这些劳动力换了工作可能是因为那些岗位需要技术高超的工人，而当前的失业人口不能胜任。在这种情况下，失业率不会受到影响，因为新增的 1000 多个岗位意味着其他地方空出了同样多的岗位，而现有的劳动力无法填补这些空位。

如果我们将劳动力分为就业和失业人口，上述情况表明了就业人口的内部流动，对失业人口或总劳动力没有影响。根据这一定义，第二种可能性出现了：这 1000 个新岗位意味着其他地方减少了 1000 个岗位，这可能是因为新工厂的到来引发了激烈的市场竞争。因此，就业人口和失业人口中存在交换（译者注：即，有的就业人口失业了，有的失业人口就业了），但对就业率的净效应为零。

最后，另一种可能的解释源自总人口的波动，具体而言，是劳动力的总规模。虽然在纯理论层面，新工厂可以吸纳来自失业人口的 1000 多名新员工，但劳动力总体规模的变化可能会抵消这一增长。为了方便讨论，我们假设城市的失业率是 50%，总的劳动力增加了 2000 多人，正是上述两家公司新雇用员工的两倍。在这种情况下，就业率和失业率保持不变。我们可以举出许多造成劳动力规模上升的原因，其中之一就是来自其他地区的、希望找到更好工作的人迁移到了此地。另一个原因可能是 Dilton 有大量的将满 20 岁的人口，他们也被当作了劳动力。无论具体原因如何，通过调整雇员人数和劳动力规模，我们可以获得稳定的失业率。

总而言之，上面讨论的三种可能性都是可以同作者提出的解释一争高下的替代解释。然而，由于缺乏关键信息，在对 Dillton 的就业市场进行更彻底的调查之前，我们无法判断哪一个是最佳解释。

### 文章解析与点评

文章严格按照写作指令的要求，没有花太多篇幅去讨论作者的论证哪里存在问题。本文一个易错点在于过度讨论背景信息，从正文的第一句到 two new factories have opened in Dillton 都属于背景信息，和原文的论证没有太多关系。但我们发现有不少学生花了很大篇幅去论证这些信息是错误的，这就偏离了题目的要求。

根据逻辑图可以看出，原文的推理结构相当简单。但如何为题目的现象找到其他解释则是难点。另外，值得注意的是，这里并没有强调原文给出的解释是错的，也没有强调我们给出的他因就比原解释更合理，全文更多是在探索可能性。

本题的突破点在于对失业率的理解，文章从“失业率 = 失业人数 / 适业人数”这一定义出发，分别分析了“失业人数不变”和“就业人数变化但比例不变”的情况。即，造成失业率不变的可能性包括：1. 新工厂的确新招了 1000 人，但同时在其他地方又有相同的人数失业；2. 新工厂新招的 1000 人是来自被其他地方解雇的工人。

外地人占了新职位

↑

两个新工厂新招了1000人，但D镇的失业率保持不变

**84** （微臣线下 325 班讲解文章）The following is a letter to the editor of an environmental magazine.

"Two studies of amphibians in Xanadu National Park confirm a significant decline in the numbers of amphibians. In 1975 there were seven species of amphibians in the park, and there were abundant numbers of each species. However, in 2002 only four species of amphibians were observed in the park, and the numbers of each species were drastically reduced. One proposed explanation is that the decline was caused by the introduction of trout into the park's waters, which began in 1975. (Trout are known to eat amphibian eggs.)"

Write a response in which you discuss one or more alternative explanations that could rival the proposed explanation and explain how your explanation(s) can plausibly account for the facts presented in the argument.

The author of this letter attributes the decline in the number of amphibians in Xanadu National Park between 1975 and 2002 to the introduction of trout into the park's waters beginning in 1975. While trout could be the reason behind the decline, since they are known to eat amphibian eggs, the information currently available is not conclusive to qualify the proposed explanation the only one capable of elucidating the fact in the argument. Several alternative possibilities could also account for the decrease in both the number and species of amphibians.

Before considering the cause of the reduced amphibian population, we must consider the possibility that the studies confirming the decline are inaccurate. The alleged decline both in species and population could be the result of an underestimate in the 2002 investigation. For example, researchers may have only surveyed a specific area of the park where the amphibian population was particularly low and subsequently extrapolated this regional observation to the entire park. Such a methodology would lead to an ostensible decline in numbers despite the accurate numbers of each species actually remaining constant or even rising.

Even if we acknowledge that the amphibian population and number of species had dropped in the 27-year period, there are at least two explanations apart from the introduction of trout that can account

for the change. The first is anthropogenic factors. For example, environmental pollution resulting from economic development in the nearby region could have adversely affected the amphibian species' survival. Amphibians spend the first stage of their life in natural water bodies and may be very sensitive to water quality. If pollution, such as waste discharge containing toxic elements, enters the amphibian habitats, the amphibian population might decrease consequently. Another possible anthropogenic factor which may have impacted the amphibian population is hunting. Amphibians may be hunted for their medical values. If demand for amphibian-derived medicine increased between 1975 and 2002, amphibian hunting in Xanadu National Park could have intensified.

Other than human causes, natural factors may also play a role in wiping out amphibians. Drastic environmental changes, other than the presence of trout, could have occurred in the park. Climate change is a likely candidate, which would have a huge impact on amphibians because they cannot regulate their body temperature. Reduced precipitation is capable of worsening the quality of amphibian habitat as well. In these scenarios, amphibians would migrate from the park because it had become inhabitable for them.

In a nutshell, there are multiple possible explanations that can account for the decline in the amphibian population and number of species in Xanadu National Park, if the decline is accurate in the first place. However, given the limited information at hand, it is difficult, if not impossible, to determine the real cause(s). Additional information on changes in the park, both manmade and natural, during this timeframe would be helpful. (475 words)

**中文翻译**

这封信的作者将 1975~2002 年间 Xanadu 国家公园两栖动物数量的下降归咎于 1975 年鲑鱼被引入了公园的水域。尽管以两栖动物的蛋为食的鲑鱼可能是两栖动物数量下降的罪魁祸首，但现有的信息并不足以证明作者提出的解释是唯一可以阐明事实的解释。其他几种可能性也可以解释两栖动物数量和物种的减少。

在考虑两栖动物群体减少的原因前，我们必须考虑这样一种可能性——那份证实数量下降的研究是不准确的。所谓的物种和数量的减少可能是因为 2002 年的研究低估了物种和数量。例如，研究者可能只调查了公园里两栖动物数量特别低的特定区域，随后又将对该区域的观察结果推广到了整个公园。尽管每个物种的确切数量实际上保持不变甚至有所上升，但这种方法得到的结果会显示数量的明显下降。

即使我们承认 27 年间，两栖动物的物种和数量都有所下降，在引入鲑鱼之外，还有至少两种原因能解释这一变化。首先是人为因素。例如，附近地区经济发展所造成的环境污染可能会对两栖动物的生存造成不利影响。两栖动物在水中度过生命的第一阶段，它们可能对水质非常敏感。如果像含有毒元素的废物这样的污染物进入了两栖动物的栖息地，它们的数量可能会因此下降。另一个可能影响两栖动物数量的人为因素是狩猎。人们可能会因为两栖动物的药用

价值而猎杀它们。如果对以两栖动物为来源的药物的需求在 1975~2002 年有所增加，那么在 Xanadu 国家公园的两栖动物的狩猎可能会加剧。

除人为因素外，自然因素也可能造成两栖动物的减少。除了鲑鱼之外，公园里可能发生了剧烈的环境变化。气候变化很有可能对两栖动物产生了巨大的影响，因为两栖动物不能调节自己的体温。降水的减少可能加剧了两栖动物栖息地的恶化。在这些情况下，两栖动物可能从公园中迁徙出走，因为那里已变得不再宜居。

总而言之，如果 Xanadu 国家公园的两栖动物的物种和数量确实减少了，那么有多种原因可以解释为何下降。然而，鉴于信息有限，我们不能或很难确定真正的原因。这段时间内发生在公园里的变化——人为的和自然的，与此相关的信息都是有用的。

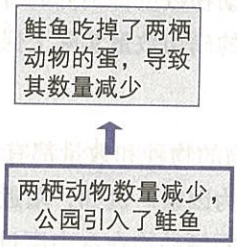
**文章解析与点评**

文章开头简明扼要地分析了原作者的逻辑，这一方面是体现考生对于原文意思的理解，另一方面也是为自己后文的写作定下一个提纲，使之不至于跑偏。但需要注意，开头段大家需要同义改写题目，而不是照抄题目。

第二段在分析原因之前先对数据的合理性进行分析——很明显，如果数据本身不能让人信服，对于数据的分析也失去了意义。这不仅是 Argument 作文可以用到的技巧，也可以运用到现实的学术写作中。并且，这种分析也同样贴合了 Direction 的要求。即被观测到的 amphibian 数量的减少并非源于其真实数量的减少，而是源于错误的观测方法。

在假设数据本身没有问题时，本文考虑了如何对数据进行不一样的解读，即寻找两栖类动物数量减少的他因。之后两段的分析分别从人类活动（包括污染和捕杀）以及自然环境改变两方面进行了讨论。

需要注意的是，有的同学花了很多笔墨来论证“引入 trout”和“两栖动物数量减少”之间不存在因果关系是不对的。第一，我们不能确定它们真的没有因果关系；第二，题目写作指令考查的不是作者自己的逻辑问题。因此要像本文开头所说的：“While trout could be the reason behind the decline, since they are known to eat amphibian eggs, the information currently available is not conclusive...”



## 4 “Question 类” Direction

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the recommendation is likely to have the predicted result. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the recommendation.

### 中文翻译

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中，讨论需要问什么问题来判断题目中的建议是否会取得预想的结果。解释这些问题的答案会如何帮助你评价题目中的建议。

### 讲　解

这一种 Direction 在本质上和其他几种 Direction 并没有区别，都是引导我们评价作者的论证过程。只不过，评价的方式变成了“问问题”。

还是拿最初的那道题举例。要评价“新爵士乐俱乐部在本地没有竞争对手”这一论断是否正确，除了“旧爵士乐俱乐部在 65 英里外”这一信息，我们还需要问一些问题，诸如：“本地人是否有车？”“旧爵士乐俱乐部的服务质量、音乐品质和消费水平如何？”，等等。如果本地人有车，或者旧爵士乐俱乐部的服务好、音乐品质高、消费低，那么人们可能就不会去新开的爵士乐俱乐部，这样一来，即便开新的爵士乐俱乐部，也可能不会取得作者预期的结果。反之，则新爵士乐俱乐部可能会赢利。

这道题的剩余部分，以及诸段落之间的组织，可以参照第一种 Direction 的讲解。唯一的不同是，在 Question 类 Direction 的要求下，我们需要遵循以下的破题步骤：

如何写单段（每一段中都应包含下面所示的①②③，而不是①②③各成一段）：

① 指出我们现在还无法评价原 Argument 中的某一论断。

② 说明为了更好地评价这一建议，我们还需要问什么样的问题。

③ 给出问题的答案并用答案来评价题目中的建议（既可以正面评价，也可以负面评价）。

如何把各个中间段组织起来：

根据逻辑图，作者做了几次结论的推导，就写几个中间段。

除了到此为止介绍的四类 Direction 之外，Argument 还有其他四个 Direction，但是这四个 Direction 都可以归并到“Question 类” Direction 中，应对方法也一致。在这里就不再赘述，只给出这些 Direction 及其中文释义。

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the recommendation and the argument on which it is based are

reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the recommendation.

中文翻译

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中，讨论需要问什么问题来判断题目中的建议和论证是否合理。解释这些问题的答案会如何帮助你评价题目中的建议。

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the prediction and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the prediction.

中文翻译

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中，讨论需要问什么问题来判断题目中的预测和论证是否合理。解释这些问题的答案会如何帮助你评价题目中的预测。

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the advice and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the advice.

中文翻译

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中，讨论需要问什么问题来判断题目中的建议和论证是否合理。解释这些问题的答案会如何帮助你评价题目中的建议。

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be addressed in order to decide whether the conclusion and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to the questions would help to evaluate the conclusion.

中文翻译

写一篇文章，在这篇文章中，讨论需要问什么问题来判断题目中的结论和论证是否合理。解释这些问题的答案会如何帮助你评价题目中的结论。

## 题库范文

**11** The council of Maple County, concerned about the county's becoming overdeveloped, is debating a proposed measure that would prevent the development of existing farmland in the county. But the council is also concerned that such a restriction, by limiting the supply of new housing, could lead to significant increases in the price of housing in the county. Proponents of the measure note that Chestnut County established a similar measure ten years ago, and its housing prices have increased only modestly since. However, opponents of the measure note that Pine County adopted restrictions on the development of new residential housing fifteen years ago, and its housing prices have since more than doubled. The council currently predicts that the proposed measure, if passed, will result in a significant increase in housing prices in Maple County.

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the prediction and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the prediction.

The council of Maple County is considering a policy proposal that would prohibit the development of the farmland in the county. Within the Maple County council opinions are divided on this subject. On one hand, opponents who fear that limited supply of new houses will cause a significant rise in the housing prices in Maple County argue that a similar policy adopted in Pine County 15 years ago led to the doubling of housing prices there. On the other hand, proponents of this policy shrug off such concerns, citing the case of Chestnut County where similar development restriction ten years ago only led to a modest increase in housing prices. Although currently the council's view leans towards the opponents and posits that if the proposed measure is passed and enacted, it will lead to a significant increase in housing prices in Maple County, we cannot fully evaluate whether such a prediction is true, unless some critical questions about the three counties are fully addressed.

To begin with, we need to take a closer look at the arguments made by each side of the debate. The opponents use the case of Pine County to demonstrate that the policy is capable of significantly increasing the housing prices. Here, a critical question is whether such a policy 15 years ago was truly responsible for the Pine County's skyrocketing housing prices. In the opponents' lines of reasoning, a causal link is implied but not fully supported by additional evidence. Hence, some other factors might also exist. For instance, could it be the case that Pine County was experiencing a massive influx of immigrants that caused the housing demand to spike? If there were other factors potentially at play in the housing market 15 years ago, the council cannot rely on the case of Pine County to infer the future housing landscape here at Maple County. Conversely, if the opponents of the policy can convincingly rule out other possibilities, their claim on the effect of the proposed measure will be strengthened.

Similarly, to evaluate the case of Chestnut County quoted by the proponents of the measure of restricting farmland conversion, we need to ask if Chestnut's government implemented any other measures to keep the land supply to housing development stable. Unlike the case of Pine County, Chestnut County's housing price only increased modestly after the implementation of such restriction. Here, one may reasonably question whether Chestnut County provided other types of land for real estate development to keep the housing prices stable. If, for example, Chestnut County had a large industrial land and converted it for housing development, the supply of housing could still catch up with the demand. In this scenario, Chestnut County's modest housing price increase cannot be credibly used to indicate Maple County could also avoid a significant increase in housing prices. However, it might also be the case that Chestnut County implemented no other policy. The housing price was indeed insensitive to the farmland conversion restriction, which could make the proponents' case stronger.

Next, let's acknowledge for a moment that for whatever reasons, the same policy triggered a doubling housing price in Pine County and had little effect in Chestnut County. One important question that seems to be ignored by the council members is that whether Maple County is comparable to either of the two aforementioned counties. If Maple County more closely resemble the socioeconomic structure of Pine County, perhaps a drastic increase in housing price can be expected, as the council currently predicts. Yet, it could well be the other way around: Chestnut County is a better analog of Maple County, so the proposed measure would not lead to a large increase in housing prices, contrary to the leading prediction now. A third possibility also exists. That is, Maple County could neither resemble Pine County nor be similar to Chestnut County. In this case, the peculiarities of Maple County demand a more thorough investigation on effect of the proposed land restriction on housing prices. Until such an investigation is carried out, we cannot predict whether the Maple County housing prices will go up significantly or not.

To sum up, even though the same policy had seemingly different consequences in two Counties, its projected effect on the Maple County housing market remains to be seen. The council needs to not only consider the specific questions about the Pine County and Chestnut County but also answer if Maple County is similar to any of those two. (744 words)

**中文翻译**

枫树县议会正在考虑一项禁止在该县开发农田的政策建议。该县议会内部对这一问题有意见分歧。一方面，反对者担心限制新房供应会导致枫树县房价大幅上涨，他们认为 15 年前松树县采取的类似政策导致当地房价翻番。另一方面，这项政策的支持者对这种担忧不屑一顾，以栗树县为例，10 年前类似的开发限制只导致房价小幅上涨。尽管目前议会的观点倾向于反对者，并认为如果拟议的措施获得通过和颁布，将导致枫树县的房价大幅上涨，但除非有关这三个县的一些关键问题得到充分解决，否则我们无法全面评估这种预测是否属实。

首先，我们需要更仔细地研究辩论双方提出的论点。反对者以松树县为例，证明这一政策

能够显著提高房价。在这里，一个关键的问题是，15 年前这样的政策是否真的是松树县房价飞涨的原因。在反对者的推理中，因果关系是隐含的，但没有得到额外证据的充分支持。因此，也可能存在其他一些因素。例如，是不是松树县正在经历大量移民涌入，导致住房需求激增？如果说 15 年前的房地产市场还有其他因素在起作用，那么议会就不能以松树县为例来推断枫树县未来的住房状况。相反，如果政策的反对者能够令人信服地排除其他可能性，他们对拟议措施效果的主张将得到加强。

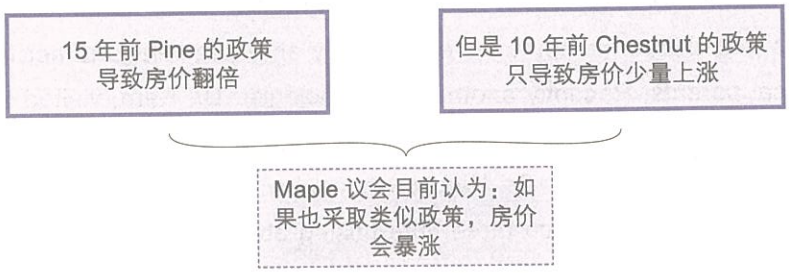
同样，为了评估该措施的支持者提出的栗树县限制耕地转化的情况，我们需要确定栗树县政府是否采取了其他措施来保持住房开发的土地供应稳定。与松树县的情况不同，栗树县的房价只是在限购实施后小幅上涨。人们有理由质疑栗树县是否提供其他类型的土地用于房地产开发，以保持房价稳定。比如栗树县有一块很大的工业用地，如果把它改造成住房开发用地，住房的供给还是可以赶上需求的。在这种情况下，栗树县适度的房价上涨不能令人信服地用来表明枫树县也可以避免房价大幅上涨。然而，栗树县也可能没有实施其他政策。房价的确对耕地转化限制不敏感，这可能使支持者的观点更加有力。

接下来，让我们暂时承认，无论出于何种原因，同样的政策在松树县引发了房价翻番，在栗树县却收效甚微。议会成员似乎忽视了一个重要问题，即枫叶县是否可以与上述两个县中的任何一个相比较。如果枫树县与松树县的社会经济结构更为相似的话，也许正如议会目前预测的那样，房价会大幅上涨。然而，情况可能正好相反：栗树县是枫树县的一个更好的类比，因此拟议的措施不会导致房价大幅上涨，这与目前的主要预测相反。第三种可能性也存在。也就是说，枫树县既不能像松树县，也不能像栗树县。在这种情况下，枫树县的特殊性使得他们需要对拟议的土地限制对房价的影响进行更深入的调查。在进行这样的调查之前，我们无法预测枫树县的房价是否会大幅上涨。

综上所述，尽管同一政策在两个县的效果看似不同，但其对枫林县房价的预期效果仍有待观察。议会不仅要考虑松树县和栗树县的具体问题，还要回答枫树县的情况是否与这两个县相似。

### 文章解析与点评

本文是题库当中非常特别的题目之一，原因在于作者不仅给出了自己支持的观点，也提出了反对的观点（有一点像 Issue 当中的“敌方观点”）。这对于 Argument 通常一边倒的论证而言可以说是颠覆性的。如果我们总结一下题目的逻辑框架，不难看出它的核心就是围绕 Pine County 和 Chestnut County 两地进行分析：



乍看之下这道题目有点让人不知所措，如果说 Pine County 的房价翻倍不一定能够推导出 Maple County 的房价也会暴涨比较好理解，我们要如何面对 Chestnut County 房价没有上涨的这一信息呢？为此，有的同学认为我们可以“借力打力”，把这一信息当作我们可以利用的反例，拿来攻击作者的结论。可惜的是，这种做法是错误的。因为当我们用 Chestnut County 的例子反驳作者的观点时，其实我们就在不知不觉中站在了作者的对立面。试想一下，作者的结论不一定对，代表作者的结论一定错吗？或者说我们写 Argument 的目的是证明作者错误吗？

以上两个问题答案都是否定的，对于本文我们正确的态度应该是：目前的结论尚不明确，房价既有可能上涨，也有可能不变，而现在作者所呈现的两组证据并不能很好地帮助我们判断结果究竟是哪种情况。想清楚这一点之后，Chestnut County 的例子我们就很好处理了：首先 Chestnut County 房价未上涨不一定代表了政策对于房价没有效果，因为可能当地还发生了一些别的变化。第二，就算 Chestnut County 的房价变化真的意味着限制开发令对于 Chestnut 房价没有影响，我们也不清楚 Chestnut 的案例能否推广到 Maple County 来。总之，作者所举的 Pine County 和 Chestnut County 两个地方的例子其实都不一定能足够支撑任何一方的结论，最后政令会不会引起 Maple County 的房价变化我们只能说不知道。注意这里的态度是“不知道”，而非“作者的结论不正确”。

与本题类似的是“Grove College 要不要保持女校传统”，其中也包括了敌方的观点：

“Recently, there have been discussions about ending Grove College's century-old tradition of all-female education by admitting male students into our programs. At a recent faculty meeting, a majority of faculty members voted in favor of coeducation, arguing that it would encourage more students to apply to Grove. However, Grove students, both past and present, are against the idea of coeducation. Eighty percent of the students responding to a survey conducted by the student government wanted the school to remain all female, and over half of the alumnae who answered a separate survey also opposed coeducation. Therefore, we recommend maintaining Grove College's tradition of all-female education. We predict that keeping the college all-female will improve morale among students and convince alumnae to keep supporting the college financially.”

大家可以尝试用本题的思路练练手，检验一下自己是否真的掌握了这种类型的题目。

**10** Twenty years ago, Dr. Field, a noted anthropologist, visited the island of Tertia. Using an observation-centered approach to studying Tertian culture, he concluded from his observations that children in Tertia were reared by an entire village rather than by their own biological parents. Recently another anthropologist, Dr. Karp, visited the group of islands that includes Tertia and used the interview-centered method to study child-rearing practices. In the interviews that Dr. Karp conducted with children living in this group of islands, the children spent much more time talking about their biological parents than

about other adults in the village. Dr. Karp decided that Dr. Field's conclusion about Tertian village culture must be invalid. Some anthropologists recommend that to obtain accurate information on Tertian child-rearing practices, future research on the subject should be conducted via the interview-centered method.

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the recommendation and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the recommendation.

In this article regarding the children-rearing culture in Tertia, the author claims that the research team led by Dr. Karp found out children are not raised by the village because they spent more time talking about their parents. This finding, in contradiction with what Dr. Field, another noted anthropologist, discovered 20 years ago using an observation-centered approach, suggests that interview-based technique is more appropriate in studying child-rearing cultures not only in Tertia but also elsewhere. Although the lines of reasoning in this article seem to be fine at first glance, close scrutiny reveals a series of unsubstantiated assumptions that demand answers to fully evaluate the claim. Until some critical questions can be properly answered, we cannot conclude that the approach adopted by Dr. Karp is superior to what Dr. Field used 20 years ago.

To begin with, we must ask if spending more time talking about child's parents means the child must be raised by them. Apparently, this assumption made by Dr. Karp without providing firm evidence might not hold true because talking about parents may simply arise from the fact that parents are being dearly missed by their children. A more specific piece of information that could elucidate the role of parents in Tertia child-rearing culture may be directly asking how much time a child's parents usually spend with him or her. If it turns out that parents spend little time with the children, it means child-rearing must be achieved collectively through the entire village. Nevertheless, the role of parents in raising children in Tertia could be strengthened if parents are found to spend a substantial amount of time with the kids.

Even if we acknowledge the validity of Dr. Karp's assessment today that children are reared by their parents instead of the entire village, it remains unclear whether this discovery necessarily invalidates previous findings by Dr. Field. The main reason is that Dr. Field conducted his research 20 years ago. Since then, the island culture could have undergone substantial changes and the child-rearing style has migrated from communal to purely parental. To fully understand the island culture 20 years ago, researchers need to resort to historical documents and/or conducting interviews with those who have been living on the island for more than 20 years. If the documents and the interviewee all pointed to a change in the island culture over the past two decades, Dr. Field's original conclusion would still

hold water. Conversely, if no significant cultural shift has occurred on this island, then Dr. Field's argument would be weakened.

Finally, granted that Dr. Field's conclusion regarding Tertia's culture proved to be wrong in light of the new discovery by Dr. Karp, we need to ask if one can conclude that observational approach is not as effective as in-person interviews based on one case in the study of island culture of Tertia. Perhaps the applicability of interview-centered approach is a peculiar case on the island of Tertia, whereas in other island cultures interviews may be hard to conduct or aboriginal people could be reluctant to share their cultural information. If this is the case, Dr. Karp's argument would clearly be weakened. However, if new information suggests common similarities between Tertia and other island cultures, the interview-based approach is perhaps indeed more superior.

To summarize, it remains to be seen whether interview is more effective than observations in studying the child-rearing traditions on islands such as Tertia, but we cannot effectively evaluate this argument because Dr. Karp has not provided sufficient amount of information to answer those important questions raised above. (592 words)

**中文翻译**

在这篇关于特提亚的育儿文化的文章中，作者声称由卡普博士领导的研究小组发现，儿童不是由村庄抚养的，因为他们花了更多的时间谈论他们的父母。这一发现与另一位著名的人类学家菲尔德博士 20 年前使用以观察为主的方法发现的结果相矛盾，表明基于访谈的方法不仅适用于特提亚地区，而且适用于其他地区的育儿文化研究。虽然这篇文章中的推理思路乍一看似乎很好，但更仔细的研究揭示了一系列未经证实的假设，这些假设需要答案来全面评估这一主张。在一些关键问题得到回答之前，我们不能断定卡普博士采用的方法优于菲尔德博士 20 年前采用的方法。

首先，我们必须问，孩子花更多时间谈论父母是否意味着孩子必定是由父母抚养。显然，卡普博士在没有提供确凿证据的情况下做出的这一假设可能不成立，因为谈论父母可能仅仅是因为孩子们非常想念父母。一个更具体的信息可以阐明父母在特提亚育儿文化中的作用，可能是直接询问一个孩子的父母通常花多少时间和他或她在一起。如果事实证明，父母很少花时间和孩子在一起，那就意味着必须通过全村实现集体育儿。然而，如果发现父母花大量的时间和孩子在一起，那么在特提亚，父母在抚养孩子方面的作用将得到加强。

即使我们承认卡普博士如今关于孩子是由父母而不是整个村庄抚养的评估是正确的，我们仍然不清楚这一发现是否一定会使菲尔德博士先前的发现无效。主要原因是菲尔德博士是在 20 年前进行了他的研究。从那时起，岛上的文化可能发生了实质性的变化，育儿方式也从集体向纯父母抚养转变。为了充分了解 20 年前的岛屿文化，研究人员需要借助历史文献和 / 或对在岛上生活了超过 20 年的人进行采访。如果这些文献和受访者都指出过去 20 年来岛上文化发生了变化，那么

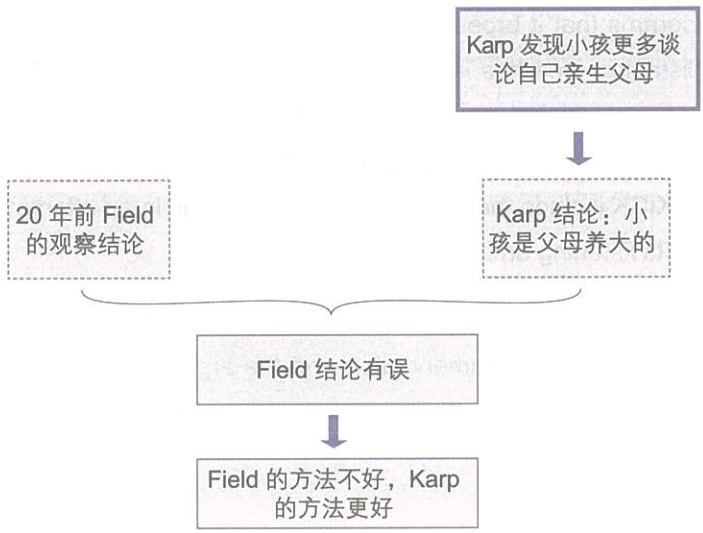
菲尔德博士最初的结论仍然成立。相反，如果这个岛上没有发生重大的文化变迁，那么菲尔德博士的论证就会被削弱。

最后，假定菲尔德博士关于特提亚文化的结论确实被卡普博士的新发现证实是错误的，我们需要问的是，在特提亚岛文化研究的一个案例中，是否有人能得出观察法不如面对面访谈法有效的结论。也许以访谈为主的方法的适用性在特提亚岛是一个特殊的例子，而在其他岛屿文化中，访谈可能很难进行，或者土著人可能不愿意分享他们的文化。如果是这样，卡普博士的论点显然会被削弱。然而，如果新的信息表明特提亚和其他岛屿文化之间有共同的相似之处，那么基于访谈的方法也许确实更为优越。

总而言之，在研究特提亚等岛屿的育儿传统时，访谈是否比观察更有效仍不能确定。但因为卡普博士没有提供足够的信息来回答上述重要问题，我们无法有效地评估这一论证。

### 文章解析与点评

本题是 GRE 考试中高频的经典 Argument 题目，它的逻辑导图如下所示：




这篇文章之所以成为经典，一方面是因为出现的次数多（Assumption、Evidence 和 Question 三类写作指令都有出现），另一方面是它涵盖了 Argument 考试中一个非常经典的逻辑问题：时间不变，这也成为本文的第二段。

在分析这两点之前，我们还需要考虑 Karp 本身的结论，也即小孩究竟是不是父母带大的。这里作者（Karp 博士本人）假设小孩访谈中更多讨论他们的父母等于和父母的相处时间更多，但我们不难设想另一种场景：小孩可能恰恰是因为与父母的相处时间太短，而更多表达出对于父母的思念。这一段另一个可以讨论的点是，我们不知道访谈是如何进行的，调查者有没有提出带有暗示性的问题，如果问题本身具有倾向性，那么受访者更多讨论父母也许只是由于调查者的缘故。

接着我们再来看本题所呈现的经典逻辑问题——时间不变原则。在很多 Argument 的题目当中，作者会将过去发生的事情作为证据来推导现在的结论。例如本题就是在尝试解释 20 年前 Field 博士的结论和今天 Karp 博士的结论之间的矛盾，并将其解读为 20 年前的结论是错的。碰到这种论证我们可以马上思考：有无可能当地的习俗随着时间发生了变化？也即 20 年前小孩确实由全村带大，但是在 20 年间因为种种原因（也许是和外界社会的接触）导致当地的育儿文化发生了变化，小孩由父母来带了。推而广之，如果一个题目当中提到了过去的现象 / 统计数据 / 调查结果，我们也可以思考随着时间的变迁这一结论是否在如今也适用。

最后一段，我们在假设 Karp 博士的结论正确、Field 博士 20 年前的结论不正确的前提下，再分析作者的一个拓展逻辑：我们能否从一个岛屿的案例推出在所有岛屿的结论？很显然，为了让这个答案是“可以”，其背后需要的假设是各个岛屿之间的文化是相似的，但实际情况可能并非如此。不妨设想如果一个岛屿无法或者不愿意与研究者沟通，那么访谈可能会一无所获，进而使用观察的方法或许会更有效。

19 Two years ago, radio station WCQP in Rockville decided to increase the number of call-in advice programs that it broadcast; since that time, its share of the radio audience in the Rockville listening area has increased significantly. Given WCQP's recent success with call-in advice programming, and citing a nationwide survey indicating that many radio listeners are quite interested in such programs, the station manager of KICK in Medway recommends that KICK include more call-in advice programs in an attempt to gain a larger audience share in its listening area.

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the recommendation and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the recommendation.

In this article, the manager of KICK radio station in Medway argues for the inclusion of more call-in advice programs in hopes of securing a larger share of audience in the region. To substantiate this piece of recommendation, the station manager cites the alleged success at the WCQP radio station in Rockville and the national survey that many radio listeners are interested in such call-in programs. Although such lines of reasoning appear valid at first glance, close examination reveals that they lack critical evidence to support. As a result, it remains unclear whether introducing more call-in programs at KICK will actually promote the audience share, unless some important questions can be properly addressed.

To begin with, the author cites the recent success enjoyed by radio station WCQP in Rockville and attributes its increase in radio audience to the adoption of more call-in advice programs. While

in general two events occurring sequentially may indeed imply some kinds of causal relationship, we need to ask if the call-in advice programs are indeed responsible for the higher number of listeners. Could it be the case that WCQP has introduced other shows in addition to the call-in advice programs? For example, if WCQP hired a famous music DJ, or began broadcasting radio talk shows that attracted more audience, its later success might well have little to do with the decision to include more call-in programs. In this case, the effect of call-in advice programs at KICK may not be as promising as the manager predicts. On the contrary, if it turns out that the call-in advice programs are the only change WCQP made two years ago, such programs may indeed play a key role in boosting WCQP's audience share.

Granted that WCQP's higher audience share can be confidently attributed to the call-in advice programs, whether or not similar programs could potentially benefit KICK radio station as well is unresolved. We need to ask if WCQP and KICK are comparable in the sense of the composition of radio listeners. It is possible that in Rockville most of the radio listeners are young people who are more eager to participate in call-in programs to express their views, while the average age of Medway residents is significantly older and hence more reluctant to call the radio station. If this is the case, KICK radio station would benefit little from the call-in advice programs. Yet, the opposite is possible, too. Medway and Rockville may be two similar towns in many ways so that the radio audience has the same taste. If so, the success at WCQP radio station could be replicated in KICK station as well, as the station manager projects.

In addition to the case of WCQP, the manager uses a national survey among radio listeners to claim the popularity of call-in programs, but there are two questions related to this survey that must be answered before the success of call-in advice programs in KICK radio station can be reasonably evaluated. First, it remains unclear how valid the survey itself is. If for instance the study only surveys a very small number of people, its intrinsic mathematical validity would be called into serious doubt and the implication be questioned. Second, even if we acknowledge that the survey is statistically valid, whether the conclusion can reasonably be applied to Medway is another question. Here the author assumes Medway represents the national average in terms of radio program preference, but this assumption may well prove wrong. If Medway residents prefer music programs on radio and do not particularly enjoy call-in shows, KICK radio station's new programs may not end well. On the other hand, perhaps Medway is indeed well represented by the national poll, and in this case the station manager's proposal would be more well-founded.

To summarize, despite the purported success at WCQP radio station thanks to call-in advice programs and the national survey claiming public interest in such programs, whether or not KICK radio station could enlarge its audience share from call-in programs remain to be seen. Specifically, a number of questions pertaining the case of WCQP and the national survey must be answered. Depending on

the answers to those questions, KICK may succeed in gaining a larger audience, but could also end up failing in that objective. (711 words)

**中文翻译**

在这篇文章中，麦德威 KICK 电台的经理主张加入更多的来电咨询节目，以期在该地区获得更大的听众份额。为了证实这一建议，电台经理引用了洛克维尔 WCQP 电台所谓的成功案例，以及全国范围内的一项调查，即许多电台听众对此类来电咨询节目感兴趣。虽然这样的推理乍一看似乎是有效的，但仔细检查发现，它们缺乏关键的证据来支撑。因此，除非一些重要问题能够得到妥善解决，否则在 KICK 推出更多的来电咨询节目是否真的能增加听众份额这一问题目前还不明确。

首先，作者提到了洛克维尔 WCQP 电台最近取得的成功，并将其广播听众的增加归因于更多的来电咨询节目。一般来说，连续发生的两个事件可能确实意味着某种因果关系，但我们需要问的是，来电咨询节目是否确实是导致更多听众的原因。会不会是 WCQP 除了电话咨询节目之外，还推出了其他节目？例如，如果 WCQP 聘请了一位著名的音乐 DJ，或者开始播出吸引更多观众的广播脱口秀节目，那么它后来的成功很可能与加入更多的来电咨询节目的决定没有多大关系。在这种情况下，KICK 电话咨询节目的效果可能不像经理预测的那样有希望。相反，如果事实证明，电话咨询节目是两年前 WCQP 唯一的改变，那么这类节目确实可能在提高 WCQP 的听众份额方面发挥关键作用。

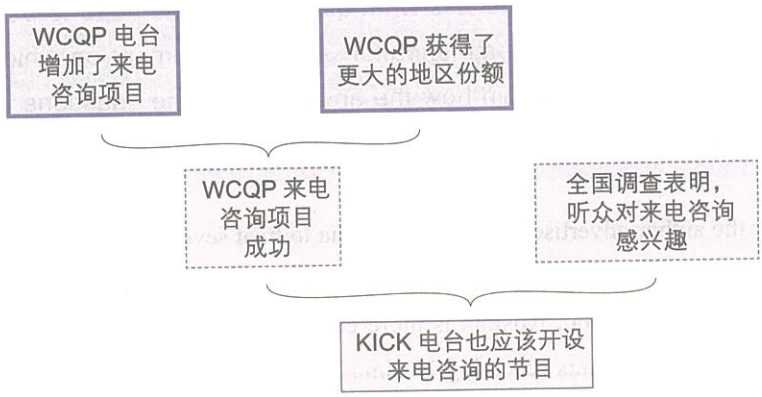
尽管 WCQP 较高的听众份额可以肯定地归因于来电咨询节目，但类似节目是否也有可能对 KICK 电台带来好处的问题还没有解决。我们需要问 WCQP 和 KICK 在广播听众的构成上是否具有可比性。在洛克维尔，可能大多数广播听众都是年轻人，他们更渴望参与广播节目来表达自己的观点，而麦德威居民的平均年龄明显偏大，因此更不愿意给广播电台打电话。如果是这样的话，KICK 电台将不会从来电咨询节目中受益。然而，反过来也是可能的。麦德威和洛克维尔在许多方面可能是两个相似的城镇，因此广播听众有相同的品味。如果是这样的话，WCQP 电台的成功也可以在 KICK 电台得到复制，就像电台经理预计的那样。

除了 WCQP 的例子外，经理还引用对电台听众的全国性调查以证明来电咨询节目的受欢迎程度，但在合理评估 KICK 广播电台来电咨询节目的成功之前，必须回答与本次调查有关的两个问题。首先，调查本身的有效性尚不清楚。例如，如果这项研究只调查了极少数人，其内在的数学有效性将受到严重质疑，其含义也将受到质疑。第二，即使我们承认这项调查在统计学上是有效的，结论是否可以合理地应用于麦德威是另一个问题。在这里，作者假设麦德威代表了全国广播节目偏好的平均水平，但这个假设很可能被证明是错误的。如果麦德威的居民更喜欢收音机里的音乐节目，而不是特别喜欢来电咨询节目，KICK 电台的新节目可能不会有好的效果。另一方面，也许麦德威在全国民调中确实有很好的代表性，在这种情况下，电台经理的提议会更有依据。

综上所述，尽管 WCQP 电台凭借来电咨询节目和声称公众对此类节目感兴趣的全国调查取得了据称的成功，但 KICK 电台能否通过来电节目扩大其听众份额仍有待观察。具体而言，一些与 WCQP 电台和全国调查有关的问题必须得到回答。根据这些问题的答案，KICK 可能会成功地赢得更多的听众，但也可能最终无法实现这一目标。

### 文章解析与点评

本题再次反映了 Argument 题目中常见的逻辑问题：他山之石，可以攻玉。一个政策看似在其他地方获得了成功，因此可以嫁接到本地。在本题中，WCQP 成功的来电咨询节目就是他山之石，应该被运用到 KICK 电台上。除此之外，作者的论证还利用到了一个全国范围的调查，如下图所示：




关于其他人的成功我们可以套用前面提到过的思维模板：WCQP 真的成功吗？成功的原因真的是来电咨询节目吗？它的成功可以复制到 KICK 电台吗？这里我们要注意的是，第一点 WCQP 的成功与否，题目中说的获得了更大的市场份额不太好讨论，因此我们跳过这一点，直接进入第二点：WCQP 的成功是否能够归结于来电咨询项目。为此，我们要指明可能存在同期的其他因素改变了 WCQP 电台的受欢迎程度，我们还需要回答同期 WCQP 做出了哪些改变。

接着我们再来思考就算 WCQP 的成功要归功于来电咨询节目，这一成就能否在 KICK 电台重现。所有这一系列类比的论证都有一个很重要的假设，也即比较对象之间存在可比性，或者说他们有很高的相似性。很显然，如果 KICK 的听众和 WCQP 的听众组成差别很大，那我们很难得出 KICK 的听众也会对来电咨询类节目感兴趣这一结论（但注意我们也没有否定这一可能性，只是说“现有的信息无法推导出这一结论”），进而需要更多的信息来帮助我们判断。

最后，关于全国范围的调查则又可以说是集结了 Argument 中调查的典型问题：调查人数有多少？是否随机取样？样本是否具有代表性？问题是否有倾向性？这些都是可以涉及的，但不建议纠缠过久，因为这个调查还有一个更加明显的问题，那就是全国的调查可否适用于 KICK 电台所在的地方。这一点也是调查类问题常见的一个通病，即调查结果是 A，但是结论却推广或缩放到了 B。本文中，全国的趋势不一定能够代表洛克维尔的情况，因此 KICK 电台引入来电咨询节目不一定对收听率有好处。

179 The following appeared in a health newsletter.

Nosinia is a herb that many users report to be as effective as prescription medications at fighting allergy symptoms. Researchers recently compared Nosinia to a placebo in 95 men and women with seasonal allergies to ragweed pollen. Participants in the study reported that neither Nosinia nor the placebo offered significant relief. However, for the most severe allergy symptoms, the researchers reported that Nosinia was more effective than the placebo in providing relief. Furthermore, at the end of the study, participants given Nosinia were more likely than participants given a placebo to report feeling healthier. We therefore recommend using Nosinia to help with your severe allergy symptoms.

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the recommendation and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the recommendation.

In this newsletter the author advertises the use of Nosinia to treat severe allergy symptoms based on an experiment involving 95 men and women who are allergic to ragweed pollen. The experiment claims that when compared to a placebo, Nosinia is more effective in helping those with the most severe allergy symptoms and participants receiving Nosinia are more likely to report better feelings at the end of the study. Although Nosinia could be an effective alternative to medications in relieving the pains of allergic reactions, existing information cannot help us confidently make that conclusion. Some important questions about and beyond the study mentioned in the newsletter must be addressed before the efficacy of Nosinia can be reasonably evaluated.

The first series of questions that warrant further examination is about the very study reported by the author. For example, how were the 95 participants selected and can they reasonably represent the general population with allergies? If the 95 participants in the study are heavily biased towards certain age group, have non-evenly distributed body weight, or have certain chronic underlying conditions, the validity of the study would be substantially weakened. In addition, at the end of the study it is reported that those given Nosinia reported better feelings in terms of personal health than those given a placebo. Here the definition of healthier may or may not be directly linked to their allergies. Maybe Nosinia, an herb in nature, has some soothing effects that give the recipient a better psychological feeling but, in reality, helps little in terms of fighting allergy symptoms. This scenario again would weaken the author's recommendation. Of course, the study may as well turn out to be valid in terms of sample selection process and the Nosinia indeed helps people with allergy symptoms so they feel better, in which case the author's argument would be made stronger.

Next, granted that Nosinia has a stronger effect than the placebo in the 95-person study, the fact that those volunteers in the experiment are all allergic ragweed pollen raises another critical question demanding answers. That is, can one reasonably extrapolate allergy reactions to ragweed pollen to other types of irritants? The answer could be negative, as the underlying pathological mechanisms of different kinds of allergy symptoms may differ widely. If this is the case, the mere success of Nosinia in treating allergic reactions to ragweed pollen may not imply a similar success to other allergy causes. This would undoubtedly weaken the case for using Nosinia to treat severe allergy symptoms in generic sense. At the same time, however, it is possible that the power of Nosinia in alleviating allergies extends beyond ragweed pollen, perhaps because its allergy-relieving mechanism is universal and not allergen-specific. In this scenario the recommendation for Nosinia use will be significantly strengthened.

Finally, if we acknowledge the effectiveness of Nosinia in treating all types of severe allergy symptoms compared to placebo, it remains unclear how Nosinia's performance compares to other medications. While many users report Nosinia to be as effective as prescription drugs, the study in the newsletter only involves Nosinia and a placebo. That is, we do not know if Nosinia is better or worse at treating severe allergy symptoms than conventional medicines. If additional experiments directly comparing Nosinia with common medications, prescription and non-prescription alike, show Nosinia is far less effective, the recommendation of using Nosinia to fight allergy cannot be fully validated. However, if it can be shown that Nosinia is no less effective than medications in alleviating severe allergy symptoms, the case for using Nosinia can be made much stronger indeed.

To summarize, while Nosinia may have the potential to become a powerful substitute for prescription medications to fight severe allergy symptoms, this is not a conclusion that can be safely arrived based on existing information. Questions related to the validity of the study mentioned in the letter and concerning the efficacy of Nosinia compared to other medications must be answered before one can decide whether or not Nosinia is really worth recommending. (668 words)

**中文翻译**

在这篇新闻通讯中，作者根据一项涉及 95 名对豚草花粉过敏的男性和女性的实验，宣传使用诺西尼亚来治疗严重过敏症状。实验声称，与安慰剂相比，诺西尼亚能更有效地帮助那些过敏症状最严重的患者，而且接受诺西尼亚治疗的参与者在研究结束时更有可能报告更好的感受。虽然诺西尼亚可能是一种减轻过敏反应造成疼痛的有效替代药物，但是现有的信息不能帮助我们肯定地得出这一结论。在对诺西尼亚的疗效进行合理评估之前，必须解决一些有关或超出通讯中提到的重要问题。

首先，需要进一步检验的问题是关于作者提到的研究。例如，95 名参与者是如何被挑选出来的，他们能否合理地代表有过敏症的普通人群？如果研究的 95 名参与者严重偏向某一年龄组，体重分布不均，或有某些慢性基础疾病，研究的有效性将被大大削弱。此外，在研究结束时，据称服用诺西尼亚的人在个人健康方面比服用安慰剂的人感觉更好。在这里，更健康的定义可能与他们的过敏症直接相关，也可能不直接相关。诺西尼亚是自然界的一种草本植物，也许它有一些舒缓的作用，可以让接受者有更好的心理感受，但实际上，在对抗过敏症状方面帮助不大。这种情况再次削弱了作者的建议。当然，这项研究也可能在样本选择过程中被证明是有效的，诺西尼亚确实帮助有过敏症状的人，使他们感觉更好，在这种情况下，作者的论证将更加有力。

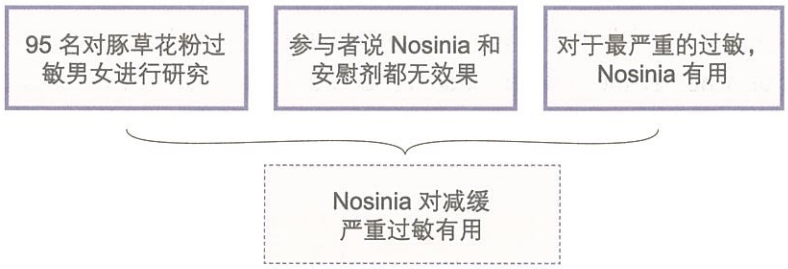
其次，在针对 95 人的研究中，即便诺西尼亚比安慰剂有更强的效果，实验中的志愿者都是对豚草花粉过敏的事实引出了另一个需要回答的关键问题。也就是说，人们能否合理地由对豚草花粉的过敏反应推知其他刺激物引起的过敏反应？答案可能是否定的，因为不同种类过敏症状的潜在病理机制可能有很大差异。如果是这样的话，仅仅是诺西尼亚治疗豚草花粉过敏反应的成功可能并不意味着其他类似过敏治疗的成功。这无疑会削弱使用诺西尼亚治疗一般意义上的严重过敏症状。然而，与此同时，诺西尼亚在减轻过敏方面的作用可能不止于豚草花粉，这可能是因为它的过敏缓解机制是普遍的，而不是过敏原特异性的。在这种情况下，使用诺西尼亚的建议力度将大大加强。

最后，如果我们承认与安慰剂相比，诺西尼亚在治疗各种严重过敏症状方面的有效性，那么诺西尼亚的效能与其他药物相比仍不清楚。虽然许多使用者报告诺西尼亚和处方药一样有效，但通讯中的研究只涉及诺西尼亚和安慰剂。也就是说，我们不知道诺西尼亚在治疗严重过敏症状方面是否比传统药物更好或更差。如果更多的实验直接比较诺西尼亚与普通处方药和非处方药，显示诺西尼亚远远不够有效，则使用诺西尼亚抗过敏的建议不能完全证明是正确的。然而，如果能证明诺西尼亚在缓解严重过敏症状方面的效果不亚于药物，那么使用诺西尼亚的理由确实会更加有力。

总而言之，虽然诺西尼亚有可能成为治疗严重过敏症状的处方药的有力替代品，但根据现有信息，这并不是一个可以安全得出的结论。在决定诺西尼亚是否值得推荐之前，必须回答与通讯中提到的研究的有效性以及诺西尼亚与其他药物相比的疗效相关的问题。

### 文章解析与点评

本题的题材和本书中前几节里提到的“薰衣草治疗失眠”一题有些相似，都是医药作为背景的题目。这道题也是一道难题，因为相比于薰衣草一题，它更加具有迷惑性，确实有了实验组和对照组，看起来像那么一回事。其逻辑框架大致可总结为：




因为本题所做的推论比较少，因此在这里我们有必要对于每一个信息本身都进行深挖，首先看到的就是这个实验设计——95 名志愿者的数量也许太少了，这里我们就可以提出调查类的经典问题：样本量是不是够大？采样是否有代表性？是不是随机分组抽样的？选择一到两个点，第一个论证段就可以成型了。

第二个论证段则需要考虑本题另一个隐藏得比较深的点：偷换概念。注意在研究中 95 名男女对于一种特定的物质（豚草花粉）有过敏反应，而最后的结论却是 Nosinia 对于严重的过敏反应有缓解作用，这里作者进行了一个外推，其成立的条件是豚草花粉和其他过敏原引起人体过敏反应的机制是相同的。但生活常识告诉我们，有人只对某些物质过敏，这说明过敏反应可能针对不同的过敏原有着不同的机制。如果是这样，那么这个实验只能说明 Nosinia 对于豚草花粉引起的严重过敏有一定作用，而可能对其他类型的过敏原无能为力。

最后，题目当中还有一个更加隐蔽的点：在开头作者所说的是 Nosinia 有潜力代替处方药用于治疗过敏，但在实验当中却没有把 Nosinia 和处方药进行直接比较。相反，与安慰剂的比较实验最多只能够证明 Nosinia 对于豚草花粉引起的严重过敏有效果，但具体的效果与现有的处方药相比如何呢？我们不得而知，因为题目当中没有给出相关的信息。

总而言之，本题是 Argument 考试中最难的几道题之一。通常来说，如果大家感觉一道题目很难，没有明确的逻辑问题，很大概率是因为它的逻辑问题是隐蔽的“偷换概念”，因此在读题的时候要额外注意。

150 The following appeared in a letter from a firm providing investment advice to a client.

“Homes in the northeastern United States, where winters are typically cold, have traditionally used oil as their major fuel for heating. Last year that region experienced 90 days with below-average temperatures, and climate forecasters at Waymarsh University predict that this weather pattern will continue for several more years. Furthermore, many new homes have been built in this region during the past year. Because these developments will certainly result in an increased demand for heating oil, we recommend investment in Consolidated Industries, one of whose major business operations is the retail sale of home heating oil.”

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the recommendation and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the recommendation.

In this letter to potential investors, the author recommends investment in Consolidated Industries, one of whose major business operations is residential heating oil, because of the anticipated greater demand for heating oil. To support his/her claim, the author quotes the climate forecast indicating continuing harsh winter weather as well as the increasing number of houses being built in this region. Quite convincing though his/her argument may seem at first glance, there are a number of questions regarding his/her lines of reasoning that requires further analysis. The argument could end up being pretty convincing or invalid in the end, depending on the answers to those questions.

To begin with, the author's reasoning relies heavily on the accuracy of the climate forecaster, a question that is not answered. It is possible that the predictions about future climate are completely wrong, because the Earth's climate system is highly complex and can change rather unpredictably. Without additional information to evaluate future climate and winter weather conditions, it is possible that the northeastern United States could actually experience warmer winters. This scenario would seriously challenge the predicted increase in oil demand, and render the author's recommendation much less advisable. On the other hand, any valid proof that the forecast is well founded will strengthen the author's argument.

Granted that future climate will be extremely cold and given the fact that new houses are being built in this region, whether or not oil demand will increase in response to colder winters and increasing population needs a second look. Behind the author's argument lie two critical implied assertions. The first one is that people will spend their winter in this very region, which could be wrong. The possibility that people would migrate to warmer areas, such as the southeastern United States, during the winter to escape from the bitter cold must be considered and addressed. Yet, if the author can provide information to unequivocally demonstrate that a substantial number of people live in the northeast during the winter, his/her conclusion will have weight.

Furthermore, the second assertion is that oil will remain the major fuel for heating in the future. Although in the past people have traditionally used oil for residential heating, the possibility that new heating methods may emerge cannot be excluded. For example, residential heating powered by nuclear or solar energy may enter the market and begin to compete with traditional fossil fuels. We have no clue if the dominance of oil in energy market will still persist. If no, the demand for oil is unlikely to increase despite the fact that there is indeed a huge demand for residential heating. On the other hand,

increased oil demand can be expected from a continued heavy reliance on oil, creating favorable market conditions for Consolidated.

Finally, even if we acknowledge for a moment that oil demand does rise in response to harsh weather and population growth, it remains to be seen whether Consolidated Industries can capitalize on this as the author assumes. Other factors, such as management efficiency and local competition, could potentially affect Consolidated's financial performance. If, for instance, Consolidated is poorly managed and there is widespread corruption within the corporation, it is doubtful that Consolidated will be hugely profitable and worth investment.

To sum up, although a cold, harsh climate and a rising population have the potential to elevate the demand for heating oil, this is not a conclusion that can be derived from the information available in this argument. Furthermore, even if oil demand does rise, the investment recommendation is built upon a shaky assertion, which is still open to different possibilities. Only after those questions are adequately addressed can we effectively evaluate the author's argument and reach a logically sound conclusion. (619 words)

**中文翻译**

在给潜在投资者的这封信中，作者建议投资 Consolidated 工业公司，因为他/她预期住宅取暖用油的需求会上升，而该公司的主要业务之一是住宅取暖用油。为了支持其主张，作者援引天气预报表明严冬仍将继续，并表示在该地建造的房屋数量不断增加。尽管这个论点乍一看很有说服力，但其推理思路存在一些问题，需要进一步分析。对下列问题的回答决定了该论点最终是令人信服抑或是一无是处。

首先，作者的推理在很大程度上依赖于气候预报的准确性，但我们并不知道这个问题的答案。对于未来天气的预测很有可能是完全错误的，因为地球的气候系统高度复杂，且变幻莫测。我们没有额外信息来评估未来的天气和冬季气候条件，有可能美国东北部正在经历暖冬。这种情况将严重挑战对石油需求增长的预测，并使得作者的建议不那么可取。另一方面，任何有效的、能证明预测是有根据的证据则会加强作者的论点。

姑且认为未来气候将极端寒冷并鉴于该地区正在建造新房屋，我们需要再次考察更寒冷的天气和增长的人口是否会导致石油需求的增长。作者的论点背后暗含着两个重要的主张。第一，人们会在此地度过冬天。这可能是错的。我们必须考虑到并指出人们可能会在冬天迁徙到更温暖的地方，诸如美国东南部，来躲避严寒。然而，如果作者能够提供信息，明确证明相当数量的居民在冬天仍会住在东北部，那么我们应当重视作者的结论。

此外，第二个主张是石油仍然会是未来供暖的主要燃料。虽然在过去，人们传统上将石油用于住宅供暖，但我们不能排除出现新的取暖方法。例如，由核能或太阳能供电的宅用暖气可能会进入市场并同传统的化石燃料展开竞争。我们不知道石油是否能继续在能源市场上占据

统治地位。如果不是这样的话，尽管对住宅供暖有大量的需求，但该地对石油的需求未必会增加。另一方面，如果人们依然严重依赖石油，那么对石油的需求的增长是可预期的，这为 Consolidated 公司创造了有利的市场条件。

最后，即使我们暂且承认严酷的天气和增长的人口会带来石油需求的增长，我们仍然需要考察 Consolidated 公司是否能如作者所言借此获利。诸如管理效率、本地竞争等其他因素可能会潜在影响 Consolidated 的财务表现。例如，如果 Consolidated 管理不善，内部腐败丛生，那么 Consolidated 是否会获得巨大利润、是否值得投资，都是存疑的。

总而言之，尽管严寒的气候和增长的人口可能会提高对供暖用油的需求，但这并不是一个可以根据文中所给的信息就能得出的结论。此外，即使石油需求确实增加了，投资建议的根基并不可靠，它存在不同的可能性。只有在上述问题都得到充分的解决后，我们才能有效评估作者的论点，并得出符合逻辑的、可靠的结论。

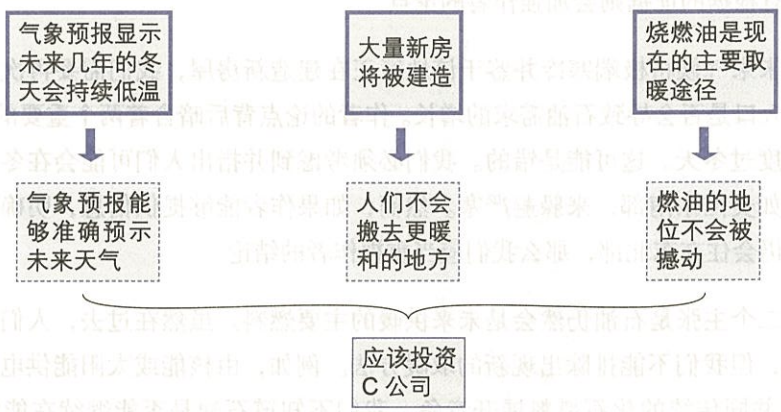
### 文章解析与点评

本题的逻辑关系比较复杂（见原文逻辑图），进行的推论和演绎也比较多，这要求在写作前对题目当中的逻辑框架有足够认识，否则可能分析不到重点。

本文覆盖了原文论证当中比较重要的几个问题，并且层层推进，最后引出了“是否盈利”的关键点。因为题目当中最后给出的建议是投资，因此全文最为关键的问题是“要不要投资”。曾经有同学全文都在纠结当地气温会不会下降以及下降之后石油需求会否走高两个问题而忽略了投资这个中心问题。

本文论证的整体节奏很快，这是因为原题的逻辑问题太多，需要在文中把重要的问题全部涵盖，所以为了保证规定时间内完成写作，段落的结构十分紧凑。这种精练的表达大家可以效仿。

由于题目的写作指令是讨论还要回答什么问题才能判断作者的论证和结论，因此形式上自由度比较大，不像其他几类写作指令针对论证的特定环节（假设、其他可能解释、新证据）提出要求。这一点从本文比较多变的语言表达中可窥一二。



下面来把前面的题目的全篇分别以 Question、Evidence、Assumption 的方式来写一下，方便同学看出三种 Direction 本质上的相通。

**Question:**

In this letter, the author states that in the northeastern regions of the United States, oil has been traditionally used for heating in winter months, and, due to decreasing temperatures and an increasing population rate, the author forecasts an increased demand for heating oil and, therefore, recommends investment in Consolidating Industries, a major retailer of home heating oil. That being said, before any action is taken in regards to the author's recommendation, there are several questions that need to be taken into account.

**Question:**

To begin with, before any money is allocated for investments, we must deliberate whether the tradition of using heating oil in homes to fend of the cold will continue in the future. It can be said that the tradition of using heating oil in homes is the fulcrum upon which the author's recommendation rests, for if the aforementioned tradition didn't exist, there wouldn't be any talk of investment in Consolidating Industries. If, in the future, the tradition of using home heating oil in the winter begins to peter out, the client would, undoubtedly, lose a portion of the money invested in the company. On a more serious note, if said tradition is abolished and ceases entirely, the client may lose a great sum of money and could potentially reprimand the investment firm for poor advice and judgement, thus marring the name of the firm. Therefore, making a hasty decision without giving further consideration to possible fluctuations in heating materials may end up negatively affecting the company, the consulting firm may, in turn, lose credibility, and clients may lose money, which would all invalidate the author's claim.

**Evidence:**

Second, in addition to answering the above questions, before the consulting firm advises the client to invest in Consolidating Industries, they need to provide more evidence in regard to the climate cooling in northeastern America. As we know, weather conditions are volatile and quite susceptible to erratic changes. Without being certain that weather conditions will not fluctuate drastically in the years to come, the consulting firm should not encourage an investment with such ease. If the weather gradually gets warm over the next couple of years, the need for heating oil would, consequentially, likely be met with a gradual decrease in sales, and the author's claim will be negatively influenced; however, if evidence proves that the weather will remain stable or gradually get cold, the author's claim will be fortified.

**Assumption:**

Furthermore, there is an assumption the author makes in the above letter. The author seems to assume that more homes in the region are directly associated to an increased population rate in

these regions and a higher demand for home oil. While this could be true, it is only one of myriad possibilities. Some of the homes bought in this region may only be used as summer homes, and the owners may visit only in warmer months of the year, thus they would have little need for home heating oil. Additionally, there may be better, more efficient ways of heating homes in the future, for example, using new construction materials to improve insulation of homes, which could severely diminish or completely eliminate the need for heating oil. Therefore, if the client follows along with the author's shaky assumption, they could end up losing money, and the author's original claim would be weakened.

**Assumption:**

Lastly, even if the tradition of using heating oil remains consistent, the weather proceeds to get cold, and the increase in homes and population does stimulate an increase in heating oil sales, there still remains one assumption that needs to be addressed. In the final words of the letter, the writer recommends that the client invest in Consolidating Industries due to their prominence in the home heating oil sales market. However, there is no guarantee that Consolidating Industries' success will persist in the future; perhaps other companies will outnumber Consolidating Industries in sales and flourish in years to come. If this were to be the case, then the client would end up losing the money initially invested in Consolidating Industries. Therefore, the consulting firm should first carry out risk assessment measures, then advise their client on the foundation of their findings. If evidence shows that other companies are predicted to surpass Consolidating Industries in the future, or possess the potential to do so, then the author's original recommendation would lose force.

**Assumption:**

To conclude, in order to decide whether or not the client should accept and implement the author's recommendation depends on the validity of certain assumptions within the author's letter. If there is little or no foundation and evidence to support the author's assumptions, then alternative options should be considered in order to address the decreasing climate and home heating issue in the northeastern region of the United States.

**中文翻译**

**Question:**

在这封信中，作者指出，在美国的东北部地区，燃油历来用于冬季取暖。由于温度的降低和人口增长率，作者预测，燃油需求会增加。因此，建议投资 Consolidating Industries，一家大型燃油零售商。尽管如此，在对作者的建议采取任何行动之前，有几个问题需要加以考虑。

**Question:**

首先，在分配资金用于投资之前，我们必须考虑一下在家里使用燃油来抵御寒冷的传统是否会继续下去。在家里使用燃油的传统是作者建议所依赖的内容，因为如果上述传统不存在，就不会有投资 Consolidating Industries 的讨论。如果将来在冬天使用家用燃油的传统开始消失，

客户无疑会损失投资于公司的一部分钱。更严重的问题是，如果上述传统被完全废除，客户可能损失一大笔钱，可能会谴责投资公司错误的建议和判断，从而影响公司名声。因此，如果不进一步考虑加热材料可能发生的波动，草率做出决定，最终会对公司产生负面影响，咨询公司可能反过来失去信誉，客户可能会赔钱，这将使作者的观点无效。

**Evidence:**

其次，除了回答上述问题之外，在咨询公司建议客户投资 Consolidating Industries 之前，他们需要提供更多关于美国东北部气候变冷的证据。正如我们所知，天气状况是不稳定的，而且很容易受到不稳定变化的影响。如果不确定未来几年天气状况是否会发生剧烈波动，咨询公司就不应如此轻易地鼓励投资。如果天气在未来几年内开始逐渐变暖，对采暖油的需求将会导致销售量的逐渐减少，而作者的主张将受到负面影响；然而，如果证据证明天气将保持稳定或逐渐变冷，作者的主张将得到加强。

**Assumption:**

此外，作者在上面的信中有一个假设。作者似乎认为，该地区更多的住房与这些地区人口增长有直接联系，并且导致家庭对于燃油有更高需求。虽然这可能是真的，但它只是无数可能性中的一种。在这个地区购买的一些房屋有可能只是作为避暑别墅使用，而且业主可能只在较暖和的月份访问，这样他们就不需要家庭燃油了。此外，在未来可能会有更好、更有效的供暖方式，例如，使用新的建筑材料来改善房屋的隔热，这将严重减少或完全消除燃油的需要。因此，如果客户听从了作者的不可靠的假设，他们最终可能会损失金钱，而作者一开始的观点将被削弱。

**Assumption:**

最后，即使使用燃油的传统保持不变，天气继续变冷，家庭和人口的增加确实刺激燃油的销售，仍然有一个需要解决的假设。在信的最后几句中，作者建议客户投资于 Consolidating Industries，因为他们在家庭取暖石油销售市场上占有重要地位。然而，并不能保证 Consolidating Industries 的成功将会持续下去；也许其他公司在未来几年将会超过 Consolidating Industries 的销售和繁荣。如果是这样的话，那么客户最终将失去最初投资于 Consolidating Industries 的资金。因此，咨询公司应该首先进行风险评估，然后根据他们的发现给客户提供建议。如果有证据表明，其他公司预计在未来超过 Consolidating Industries，或有潜力这样做，那么作者最初的建议将会被削弱。

**Assumption:**

总之，为了决定客户是否应该接受和执行作者的建议，取决于作者信中某些假设的有效性。如果没有足够的基础和证据来支持作者的假设，那么就应该考虑其他选择，以解决美国东北地区日益减少的气候和家庭供暖问题。

# 附 录 所有 Argument 3s 版本及专业词汇

## 附录说明

对于写作想拿高分的同学，如果把全部 189 篇 Argument 题目（独立题目 97 篇）学完，需要花费不少的时间和精力。每篇 Argument 的题干（Prompt）大约 100 个单词，同学们认真看完，需要消化近 10 000 个英文单词。

鉴于绝大部分同学没有足够的时间和耐心完成这样的任务，微臣团队精心为大家整理出了所有 Argument 文章的 3s 版本，用 1500 字左右的中文汇总了所有 Argument 的核心内容。这样同学们大约用 3 分钟时间就可以看完所有 Argument 题目，堪称考前“速效救心丸”。

希望大家在上考场之前，认真将附录的表格多读几遍，表格使用方法如下：

1. Direction：告诉同学们这篇文章的写作指令，也是希望同学们严格按照 Direction 去行文，不然写的文章再好最多也只能得 3 分；

2. 3s 版本：帮助同学们熟悉每篇题目的话题，不至于在考场上将题目意思都理解错误，写跑题；

3. 类似题目：出现的类似题目越多则表示该题目的出题频率越高，越应该引起同学们的重视，出现 3 次以上的题目建议同学们考前将原文进行分析，并画出逻辑图；

4. 专有名词：专有名词能够帮同学们在考场上一眼识别出这个题目，同时这些名词也是大家打字最慢的一些词汇，是练习打字的同学们应该优先选择的材料。建议考前 30 天将这些专有名词每天练习打一遍，既可以熟悉题目又能提升打字速度，一举两得。

这个表格的作用就是帮助同学们在考场上省去 3 分钟读题的时间，并且为大家提供更多的答题思路，省时提效，最终实现提分的目的。

另外，表格中标记“x”的题目在 2021 年更新的题库中被删除了，但是本书为了保持一致性，以及让同学们能找到更早版本的范文，我们仍然保留了旧的题号；而从 178 题开始，则是更新后题库增加的新题，我们将其标记为“*”。

| 题号 | Direction | 专有名词 | 3s 版本 | 类似题目 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Evidence | Palea Lithos Brim | 篮子并非 Palea 地方独有 | |
| 2 | Explanation | cortisol | 生育顺序影响个体应激水平 | |
| 3 | Question | Plaza Monroe | 应禁止在中央广场玩滑板 | 171 Question, 175 Question |
| 4 | Assumption | Adam Fitch Realty | Adam Realty 能让房子卖得又快又好 | |
| 5 | Question | Balmer Gazette Seaville Torseau | Balmer 应限制 moped 的出租数量 | 159 Question, 173 Assumption |
| 6 | Evidence | Arctic | 北极鹿数量下降是因为无法按迁移习惯穿越结冰海面 | |
| 7 | Question | Monarch Collegeville | Monarch 书店应该用咖啡馆取代儿童图书区 | 98 Assumption, 99 Evidence |
| 8 | Evidence | Buckingham | Buckingham 应建新宿舍 | |
| 9 | Assumption | Plainsville | Nature's Way 健康食品店的新分店会成功 | 88 Evidence, 90 Assumption |
| 10 | Question | Tertia Karp | 为获得关于 Tertia 儿童抚养方式的精确信息，应采用对话的研究方式 | 21 Evidence, 23 Assumption |
| 11 | Question | Maple Chestnut Pine | 如果议案通过，Maple County 房价将大幅上涨 | |
| 12 | Evidence | Omega Alpha | Omega 应停止学生对教授的评价 | |
| 13 | Evidence | Prunty Butler | Prunty 应实施和 Butler 一样的道路改善计划 | |
| 14 | Assumption | Mentian | 企业要想成功，应只雇睡眠时间少于 6 小时的员工 | 118 Question |
| 15 | Explanation | margarine Pancake | Pancake 应该用人造黄油代替天然黄油 | 51 Question, 130 Assumption, 131 Question, 133 Evidence |
| 16x | Assumption | Manson | Manson 市政府应增加用于河边休闲设施的预算 | |
| 17 | Evidence | | 应该将电台的摇滚乐节目改为新闻和访谈的节目 | 93 Question, 109 Assumption, 110 Question |
| 18 | Assumption | | 应在所有新闻节目中增加天气和地方新闻的播报 | 20 Evidence |
| 19 | Question | Rockville Medway | KICK 应播放更多的电话咨询节目 | |
| 22 | Question | Groveton | 所有大学应采用诚信制度 | 119 Explanation, 120 Question, 138 Evidence |

续表

| 题号 | Direction | 专有名词 | 3s 版本 | 类似题目 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 24 | Question | Mentia salicylate aspirin | 食品添加水杨酸可以减少 Mentia 地区居民的头痛情况 | 26 Evidence, 28 Assumption |
| 25 | Evidence | Monroe | 在 Monroe 新建爵士俱乐部能赚钱 | 100 Assumption, 102 Question, 164 Question |
| 27 | Evidence | | Blue Highway 应修一条自行车道 | 29 Question |
| 30 | Evidence | Calatrava | Calatrava 市会有更充足的资金用于主要供成年人使用的城市设施 | |
| 31 | Evidence | Trillura Parson | Parson 居民比 Blue 市的更关注为公立学校提供良好教育 | |
| 32 | Assumption | Panobly Quiot Butler Alta | Panoply 工厂报告的事故少是因为员工睡眠更充足 | 104 Explanation, 105 Evidence, 106 Question, 167 Question |
| 33 | Assumption | | 电力公司认为无须建造新的发电厂 | |
| 34 | Assumption | Climpson | 给 Climpson 公司安装监视系统会提高员工的工作效率和公司利润 | 58 Evidence, 94 Question |
| 35 | Question | Sunnyside Towers | Sunnyside Towers 限制所有建筑的水龙头最大出水量会增加利润 | 52 Question, 128 Evidence, 129 Assumption |
| 36 | Evidence | Meria Ichthaid | 吃鱼油提取物可以预防感冒，从而降低请假率 | 163 Question, 166 Question |
| 37 | Evidence | Transopolis | 应将 Transopolis 市另一侧的居住区住房改造为工业用途 | |
| 38 | Evidence | Sartorian alpaca | Sartorian 厂应重新开始生产高档羊毛外套 | 95 Assumption, 96 Question |
| 39 | Evidence | Captain | Captain Seafood 会受欢迎并获利 | 174 Question |
| 40 | Evidence | calcium osteoporosis | 富含奶制品的饮食会增加患骨质疏松症的风险 | |
| 41 | Assumption | | 想减少事故，应加强骑车安全教育，而非强调戴头盔 | 123 Question, 125 Evidence |
| 42 | Evidence | Tria Batia | 应该对使用 Tria 海滩的人收费 | |
| 43 | Evidence | | West Egg 镇的垃圾填埋地的使用时间会很长 | |
| 44 | Assumption | Crust Copper Fredonia | 如果 CCC 公司不放弃采矿，消费者只要停止购买 CCC 的产品，依然可以减少灾害 | |

续表

| 题号 | Direction | 专有名词 | 3s 版本 | 类似题目 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 45 | Question | Humana Omni | 开设在线教学项目有助于增加 Humana 的报名人数并解决预算问题 | 49 Assumption |
| 46x | Assumption | Corpora | 专家关于长时间使用电脑导致健康状况下降的观点是错误的 | |
| 47 | Evidence | Galore Marston | Movies Galore 在其他分店实施和 Martson 店类似的方法 ( 减少营业时间和库存 ) 可以增加利润 | 111 Assumption, 112 Question |
| 48 | Evidence | Clearview | 人们应选择 Clearview 作为退休地 | |
| 50 | Evidence | insomnia lavender | 薰衣草花香可以治疗失眠 | |
| 53 | Evidence | Forsythe Kiran Cholesterol Sulia Benton | Forsythe 居民选择了更健康的生活方式 | 144 Assumption, 151 Question |
| 54 | Assumption | Kaliko | 人类的捕杀导致了 Kaliko 岛上哺乳动物的灭亡 | 165 Explanation |
| 55 | Assumption | Whirlwind | Whirlwind 公司的游戏销量在未来几个月会猛增 | |
| 56 | Assumption | Dura Endure | 可以通过停止 Endure 工艺来增加利润 | 57 Evidence, 82 Question |
| 59 | Assumption | Bower Domus | Bower Builders 公司在所建的住宅中增加家庭娱乐室的面积，并将先进厨房作为标配可以增加利润 | |
| 60 | Assumption | Waymarsh Consolidated | 应该投资 Consolidated 公司 | 145 Question, 146 Evidence, 150 Question, 154 Question, 155 Evidence |
| 61 | Question | Grandview Beacon Symphony Orchestra | Grandview 市在下一年的预算中停止对交响乐团的资助 | 139 Question, 141 Evidence, 143 Assumption, 162 Question |
| 62 | Assumption | UltraClean | 为了防止严重的感染，应使用 UltraClean | 121 Assumption, 122 Explanation, 124 Evidence |
| 63 | Assumption | Parkville | Parkville 应停止组织 9 岁以下儿童的体育比赛 | |
| 64x | Question | Kalinese | Kali 岛的古代等身黏土人物雕塑会贬值，而微缩雕像会升值 | |
| 65 | Assumption | Stanley Carlton | Stanley 公园增加长凳，会变得受欢迎 | |

续表

| 题号 | Direction | 专有名词 | 3s 版本 | 类似题目 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 66 | Question | Wisconsin Cheddar | 增加奶酪店利润的最好方式是停止储备过多进口奶酪、集中储备国产的 | 107 Assumption, 108 Evidence |
| 67 | Question | Rialto Apex Arcade | Rialto 必须模仿 Apex 才能保持电影市场份额 | |
| 68 | Assumption | Sherwood | Sherwood 医院应和动物收容站合作建立一个“收养狗”的项目 | |
| 69 | Question | Alpha Zeta | 新项目应由 Zeta 公司来负责 | 70 Evidence, 115 Assumption |
| 71 | Evidence | Waymarsh Garville | Waymarsh 应向拼车通勤的人发放免费的汽油券作为奖励 | |
| 72 | Evidence | Elthyria | “大多因裁员失业的有能力的工人在找到合适的工作前常连续几年面临严重的经济困难”的观点不对 | |
| 73 | Assumption | Mozart | Mozart 音乐学校是想把孩子送去学音乐的家长的首选 | |
| 74 | Question | Grove Alumnae | 需要在男女合招政策和保留女校传统中选一个方案 | 147 Evidence, 148 Assumption, 149 Question, 156 Question |
| 75 | Question | Batavia Excello | Batavia 政府应限制奶价来为消费者保证公平的价格 | |
| 76 | Question | Cholesterol | Old Dairy 公司的销量和利润会降低，所以要抛售此公司的股票 | |
| 77 | Assumption | Hopewell Brindleburg Vista | 改善 Hopewell 经济的最好方式就是建和 Ocean View 类似的高尔夫球场和度假旅店 | 169 Question |
| 78 | Evidence | Palm Buzzoff Wintervale | 节省花费的最好方式就是重新使用 Buzzoff 公司提供的灭害虫服务 | 114 Question, 116 Explanation, 117 Assumption |
| 79 | Question | *Newsbeat* | *Newsbeat* 杂志是否采取减少对政治、而增加对经济和个人理财的关注 | |
| 80x | Question | Super Screen | 电影公司应把下一年预算的更大份额用于广告以提升公众辨识度 | |
| 81 | Question | Promofoods tuna nausea | 金枪鱼罐头不会产生健康威胁 | |
| 83 | Evidence | Xanadu trout | 引进 trout 导致两栖动物数量减少 | 84 Explanation |
| 85 | Evidence | Waymarsh | Waymarsh 的第一项研究的受访者错误地表达了自己的阅读习惯 | 87 Assumption |

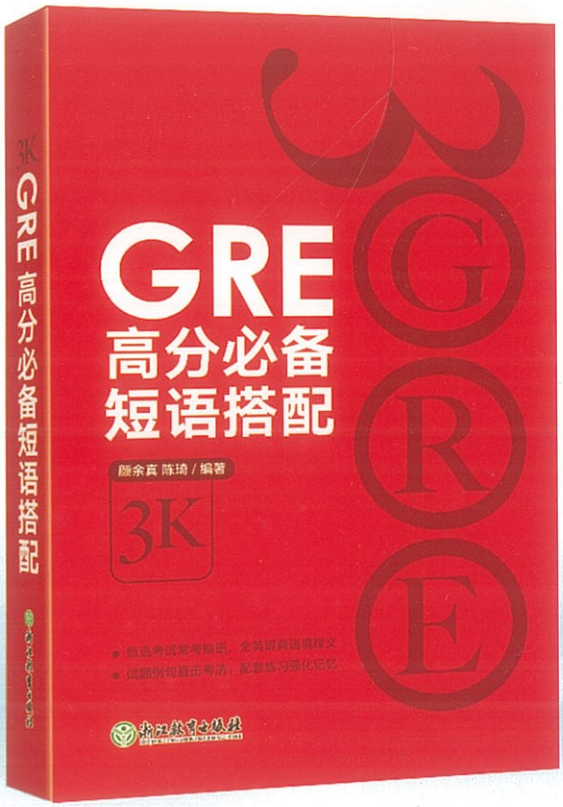
续表

| 题号 | Direction | 专有名词 | 3s 版本 | 类似题目 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 86 | Evidence | Delany Personnel Walsh | “用收费较少的 Walsh 人事公司代替 Delany”是个错误 | 89 Assumption |
| 91 | Evidence | Palean Gazelle | 西 Palean 瞪羚绝迹是由东部保护区的大量食肉动物导致的 | |
| 92 | Explanation | Leeville Masonton | Leeville 居民的健康状态归功于舒缓的生活节奏 | 101 Assumption，103 Explanation |
| 97 | Question | Shakespeare Bardville Avon Repertory | 如果开展“公园莎士比亚”活动，剧场的利润会增加 | |
| 113 | Question | Acme Spruce | 为提高生产率，所有 Acme 员工应参加 Easy Road 课程 | 126 Evidence，127 Question，161 Assumption |
| 132 | Assumption | Centerville | 由高中赞助的强制性的驾驶课程是唯一的交通问题解决方案 | 134 Evidence，136 Question |
| 135 | Evidence | Attra Sanlee Marlee | 本校老师布置作业的频次不能超过一周两次 | 137 Assumption，140 Question |
| 142 | Assumption | | 通过购买高质量保护装置和反光设备，溜冰者将能极大地降低他们在事故中受到严重伤害的风险 | |
| 152 | Question | Bargain Cereal | Bargain Brand 应尽快扩展业务，开始推出其他廉价食品 | 153 Assumption |
| 157 | Assumption | Emporium Exotic Gulf | 在 Exotic Pets Monthly 上刊登广告能使商店重新盈利 | 158 Evidence |
| 160 | Question | Amburg Chamber Belleville | 如果安装高照度灯，Amburg 的犯罪率会显著降低 | 172 Evidence |
| 168 | Question | Oak Gazette | 没有外地人干扰的情况下，委员会有能力使 Oak 城成为更美好的适于生活、工作的地方 | |
| 170 | Question | Route Appian | 建议雇用 Appian 公司为新商业街修通道 | |
| 176 | Explanation | Dillton | 因为外地人占了新岗位，所以 Dillton 镇失业率保持不变 | |
| 177 | Question | Ventures Grilldon | 应在西南 Grilldon 建新的兴趣店 | |
| 178* | Question | | 家庭尽可能多地一起吃饭，有利于青少年远离不良行为 | 180* Explanation |
| 179* | Question | Nosinia ragweed pollen | 建议使用诺西尼亚来帮助缓解严重过敏症状 | |
| 181* | Explanation | | 对教育机构捐款减少最好的解释是，人们实际上比过去更加不重视教育 | |

续表

| 题号 | Direction | 专有名词 | 3s 版本 | 类似题目 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 182* | Explanation | Relanna | 雷兰纳牛奶价格大幅上涨的唯一解释是，农民为了增加利润而抬高奶油价格 | |
| 183* | Explanation | pemchint Dodecan | Dodecan 猎人很可能用 pemchint 的声音来驱赶危险的野生动物 | |
| 184* | Explanation | | 使用楼梯而不是电梯的居民每天进行适度的锻炼可以改善人们的健康并延长寿命 | |
| 185* | Question | Arko Satellite | 为了恢复 Bridge Bay 海滩的游客数量，建议尽快恢复与 Arko 的合同 | |
| 186* | Question | Canbury Plexma | 为了促进 Canbury 的整体经济，建议允许 Plexma 开始在坎伯里生产和销售车辆 | |
| 187* | Question | Dexter Gorman | 建议要求 Dexter Gorman 的员工每周工作 40 小时，并仅在紧急情况下才加班 | |
| 188* | Explanation | Greenhorne Motilac gastrointestinal | 对于吗丁啉酸销量下降，而胃肠道症状的患者增加的解释是，吗丁啉酸可有效预防许多严重的胃肠道疾病 | |
| 189* | Question | Skyway Linford | 建议要求所有艺术系学生在毕业前完成 Skyway design 的实习 | |
| | 独立题目数量：97 道 | | | |
| | Question：70 道 3 5 7 10 11 19 22 24 29 35 45 51 52 61 64 66 67 69 74 75 76 79 80 81 82 93 94 96 97 102 106 110 112 113 114 118 120 123 127 131 136 139 140 145 149 150 151 152 154 156 159 160 162 163 164 166 167 168 169 170 171 174 175 177 178 179 185 186 187 189 | | | |
| | Evidence：52 道 1 6 8 12 13 17 20 21 25 26 27 30 31 36 37 38 39 40 42 43 47 48 50 53 57 58 70 71 72 78 83 85 86 88 91 99 105 108 124 125 126 128 133 134 135 138 141 146 147 155 158 172 | | | |
| | Assumption：50 道 4 9 14 16 18 23 28 32 33 34 41 44 46 49 54 55 56 59 60 62 63 65 68 73 77 87 89 90 95 98 100 101 107 109 111 115 117 121 129 130 132 137 142 143 144 148 153 157 161 173 | | | |
| | Explanation：17 道 2 15 84 92 103 104 116 119 122 165 176 180 181 182 183 184 188 | | | |

# 精选常考短语，突破词汇瓶颈




## 学习伴侣！

**优势卖点**

甄选考试常考短语

准确词典语境释义

试题例句直击考法

配套练习强化记忆

**内容简介**

本书基于历年GRE考试真题，收录了GRE考试中常见的365个短语搭配。所有短语释义均参考常用词典，结合语境给出相应的中英文释义，并配有简单例句和GRE试题例句。在每个单元后还配备了相应的检测练习，包括短语填空、释义匹配和写作句子翻译。本书密切贴近GRE考试，可帮助考生深入学习并巩固短语用法。

**购书方式**

1. 新东方大愚连锁书店购买：详情登录http://www.dogwood.com.cn/dysd
2. 新东方图书销售网点购买：详情登录http://www.dogwood.com.cn/Agentlist.html
3. 新东方大愚图书官方天猫店购买：详情登录https://xindongfang.tmall.com
4. 新东方大愚图书官方京东旗舰店购买：详情登录http://xdfdyts.jd.com

浏览更多精彩图书，请登录新东方图书网：www.dogwood.com.cn

**多样语料：** 从GRE写作官方题库中精选40道常考题目，编写高分范文，并由外教审校，为考生提供论证逻辑、立场、例证、语言等参考素材。

**创新分类：** 创新性地将写作题库按照14种具体性指令分类，针对每类指令透彻分析写作中的易失分点，并提出应对策略。

**写作标准：** 逐条深入讲解官方评分标准，将“要求”转化为“方法论”，指导考生写出符合要求的GRE作文。

**错误分析：** 总结700余篇学生习作，细致梳理写作常犯错误，包括从审题、立意、例证、观点组织到句子连接、代词使用、从句等各个方面。

**更新升级：** 结合近两年考试题目，更新了18篇Issue文章、14篇Argument文章，帮助考生掌握GRE写作方向。

**陈　琦：** 微臣教育创始人。毕业于清华大学精密仪器与科学系。从大四时开始教授GRE，常年活跃在GRE考场与教学一线，GRE培训领域的标杆性人物，GRE高分组织“小牛人俱乐部”的管理者。著有《GRE核心词汇考法精析》及其便携版、《GRE核心词汇助记与精练》、《GRE高分必备短语搭配》、《GRE/GMAT/LSAT长难句300例精讲精练》、《GRE基础填空24套精练与精析》、《GRE强化填空36套精练与精析》、《GRE阅读白皮书》、《GRE语文高频题目精练与精析》、《GRE写作高频题目及考点精析》、《GRE备考胜经》、《GRE阅读170篇精讲精析》等。

**颜余真：** 本科毕业于北京大学环境科学与工程学院，博士毕业于普林斯顿大学地球科学系。陈琦老师GRE高分组织“小牛人俱乐部”会员（V 167 + Q 170 + AW 5.0）。著有《GRE核心词汇考法精析》及其便携版、《GRE高分必备短语搭配》、《GRE/GMAT/LSAT长难句300例精讲精练》、《GRE写作高频题目及考点精析》。现任微臣教育线上作文课讲师及地球科学、环境科学留学导师。

微臣教育 WEICHEN EDUCATION

上架建议：出国考试/GRE

ISBN 978-7-5722-3090-5

9 787572 230905 >

定价：50.00元

GRE全科视频讲解

每日备考资讯